BCS · BANK JOBS · UNIVERSITY ADMISSION · SAT · GRE · GMAT

English for Competitive Exams

A complete guide to Grammar, Vocabulary & Usage,
English Literature and Miscellaneous topics

Part A — Grammar (Chapters 01–44)

Part B — Vocabulary & Usage (Chapters 45–53)

Part C — English Literature (Chapters 54–64)

Part D — Miscellaneous (Chapter 65)

How to read the boxes: **Rule** boxes state a rule; **Exam Tip** boxes show traps set in BCS, Bank and admission papers; **Note** boxes give exceptions and fine points; **SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner** boxes connect the topic to international tests. In examples, ✘ marks an incorrect sentence and ✔ its correct form. In word lists a ★ marks words that appear very frequently in Bangladeshi competitive exams.

Contents

Part A · Grammar

01 Parts of Speech & Its Identification 4
02 Noun 8
03 Uncountable Problems 12
04 Determiner 16
05 Article 19
06 Number 23
07 Gender 27
08 Pronoun 30
09 Adjective 34
10 Latin Adjective 38
11 Verb 40
12 Conjugation of Verb 45
13 Modal Auxiliary 48
14 Gerund & Participle 51
15 Adverb 55
16 Inversion 58
17 Preposition 61
18 Appropriate Preposition 65
23 Subject-Verb Agreement 71

Part B · Vocabulary & Usage

45 Vocabulary with Synonyms & Antonyms 82

PART A

Grammar

Chapters 01–44 · Parts of speech, sentence structure, usage, error detection and correction

CHAPTER 01

Parts of Speech & Its Identification

Part A · Grammar

1.1 What Is a Part of Speech?

Every word in an English sentence does a particular **job**. Some words name things, some describe them, some show action, some join other words, and so on. The **part of speech** of a word is simply the name of the job that the word is doing **in that sentence**.

Traditional grammar recognises **eight parts of speech**:

No.	Part of speech	Job it does	Examples
1	Noun	names a person, place, thing, idea	Rahim, Dhaka, book, honesty
2	Pronoun	stands in place of a noun	he, she, it, they, who, this
3	Adjective	describes / qualifies a noun or pronoun	good, tall, five, some, Bangladeshi
4	Verb	shows action or state	run, write, is, seem, become
5	Adverb	modifies a verb, adjective or another adverb	quickly, very, often, here
6	Preposition	shows relation of a noun/pronoun to another word	in, on, at, by, with, of
7	Conjunction	joins words, phrases or clauses	and, but, or, because, although
8	Interjection	expresses sudden feeling	Alas! Hurrah! Oh! Bravo!

Modern grammars often add a ninth class, the **determiner** (a, an, the, this, my, some, every, each), which earlier grammars put under adjectives. Many Bangladeshi exam papers still follow the eight-part system and call *a, an, the* "articles" and *this, my, some* "adjectives". Know both systems (see Chapters 04 and 05).

> **The golden rule:** *A word's part of speech depends on its function in the sentence, not on the word itself.* The same word can be a noun in one sentence, a verb in another and an adjective in a third.

- He went **round** the field. (preposition)
- The earth is **round**. (adjective)
- The doctor is on his **round**. (noun)
- The ship **rounded** the cape. (verb)
- Winter comes **round** again. (adverb)

This is why exam questions say, *"Identify the part of speech of the underlined word"* — you must look at what the word is **doing**, not merely at what it looks like. Chapter 42 gives a long list of such words.

1.2 Content Words and Function Words

It helps to divide the parts of speech into two broad groups:

- **Content (lexical / open-class) words** carry the main meaning: nouns, main verbs, adjectives and adverbs. New words of these types enter the language all the time (*selfie, google, upload*).
- **Function (grammatical / closed-class) words** hold the sentence together: pronouns, prepositions, conjunctions, determiners/articles and auxiliary verbs. Their number is fixed; English rarely gets a new preposition.

In a telegram or a newspaper headline we drop the function words and keep the content words: *"Minister visits flood area" = The Minister visits the flood area.*

1.3 The Noun

A **noun** is a word used as the name of a person, place, thing, animal, quality, action, idea or feeling.

- **Person:** Nazrul, teacher, farmer, sister
- **Place:** Sylhet, village, school, Asia
- **Thing / animal:** pen, river, tiger, computer
- **Quality / idea:** honesty, beauty, freedom, wisdom
- **Action / state:** movement, arrival, childhood, sleep

1.3.1 How to Identify a Noun

1. **It can follow an article or determiner:** *a* **book**, *the* **river**, *this* **idea**, *my* **sister**.
2. **It can be made plural or possessive:** *book → books; boy → boy's*.
3. **It acts as subject, object or complement: Rahim** plays. I saw **Rahim**. He is a **doctor**.
4. **It can follow a preposition:** in **Dhaka**, of **gold**, with **care**.
5. **Typical noun suffixes:** -tion (*action*), -sion (*decision*), -ment (*movement*), -ness (*kindness*), -ity (*ability*), -hood (*childhood*), -ship (*friendship*), -dom (*freedom*), -ance/-ence (*importance, silence*), -er/-or (*teacher, actor*), -ist (*artist*), -ism (*patriotism*), -age (*marriage*), -th (*growth*), -cy (*accuracy*).

> **Gerunds are nouns too.** A verb + *-ing* used as a noun is called a *gerund*: **Swimming** is good exercise. I like **reading**. (Chapter 14.) A whole clause can also work as a noun: **What he said** is true. (noun clause, Chapter 31.)

1.4 The Pronoun

A **pronoun** is a word used **instead of a noun** to avoid repetition.

- Rahim is a good boy. **He** is honest. (*he* = Rahim)
- The book is on the table. Give **it** to me.
- **Who** is knocking at the door?
- **This** is my pen. (demonstrative pronoun — it stands alone)

Identification: a pronoun **stands alone** in place of a noun. If the same word stands *before* a noun, it is not a pronoun but an adjective/determiner:

- **This** is my house. → pronoun (stands alone)
- **This** house is mine. → adjective/determiner (qualifies *house*)
- **Which** do you want? → pronoun
- **Which** book do you want? → adjective
- **Some** of the students were absent. → pronoun
- **Some** students were absent. → adjective

1.5 The Adjective

An **adjective** describes, qualifies or limits a noun or pronoun. It answers *What kind? Which one? How many? How much?*

- She is a **clever** girl. (what kind?)
- I bought **five** mangoes. (how many?)
- He has **little** money. (how much?)
- **That** boy is my cousin. (which one?)
- The sky is **blue**. (adjective after a linking verb — *predicative* use)

1.5.1 Attributive and Predicative Adjectives

- **Attributive:** stands before the noun — *a* **red** *rose*, *a* **tall** *man*.
- **Predicative:** comes after a linking verb (be, seem, look, become, feel, grow, appear, taste, smell, sound) — *The rose is* **red**. *He looks* **tired**.

The milk tastes **sour**.

Some adjectives are only predicative: *afraid, alive, alone, asleep, awake, aware, ashamed, ablaze, alike, content, unable.* ✘ *an asleep child* ✔ *a sleeping child / The child is asleep.*

Some are only attributive: *main, chief, principal, mere, sheer, utter, very (= exact), former, latter, elder, eldest, inner, outer, upper.* ✘ *The reason is main.* ✔ *The main reason is…*

1.5.2 How to Identify an Adjective

1. It can come between *a/the* and a noun: *the* **old** *house*.
2. It can follow *very / too / so / quite*: **very** *old*. (Not always: *very main* is wrong.)
3. It has comparative/superlative forms: *old – older – oldest; beautiful – more beautiful – most beautiful.*
4. **Typical adjective suffixes:** -ful (*useful*), -less (*careless*), -ous (*famous*), -ive (*active*), -able/-ible (*readable, visible*), -al (*national*), -ic (*historic*), -ish (*childish*), -y (*healthy*), -ant/-ent (*important, different*), -ary (*necessary*), -some (*handsome*), -like (*childlike*), -ly (*friendly, lovely, manly*).

> **Exam Tip — *-ly* is not always an adverb.** *Friendly, lovely, lonely, ugly, silly, costly, manly, womanly, brotherly, elderly, cowardly, timely, deadly, likely, orderly, holy, kindly, daily, weekly, early* can be adjectives. *She is a* **lovely** *girl* (adj). *He gave a* **friendly** *smile* (adj). Since these have no adverb form in -lyly, we say *in a friendly way / manner*: ✘ *He spoke friendly.* ✔ *He spoke in a friendly manner.*

1.6 The Verb

A **verb** is a word that says something about the subject — what it **does**, what **happens** to it, or what it **is**.

- The baby **cries**. (action)
- The glass **was broken**. (something happens to the subject)
- She **is** a doctor. (state of being)
- He **seems** happy. (linking)
- They **have** a car. (possession)

Every complete sentence (clause) must contain a **finite verb** — a verb that shows tense and agrees with its subject (*goes, went, is, was, has gone*). Infinitives (*to go*), gerunds (*going*) and participles (*going, gone*) are **non-finite** and cannot make a sentence on their own: ✘ *He going to school.* ✔ *He is going to school.*

1.6.1 Kinds of Verbs at a Glance (detailed in Chapter 11)

- **Main (principal / lexical) verbs:** *eat, write, think, run.*
- **Auxiliary (helping) verbs:** *be, have, do* (primary) and *can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must, ought to, need, dare, used to* (modal).
- **Transitive verbs** take an object: *He* **wrote** *a letter.*
- **Intransitive verbs** do not take an object: *The baby* **slept**.
- **Linking (copular) verbs:** *be, become, seem, appear, look, feel, grow, turn, remain, taste, smell, sound.*

1.6.2 How to Identify a Verb

1. It changes with tense: *walk – walked – walking.*
2. It can follow a subject pronoun: *I* **go**, *they* **sing**.
3. It can follow a modal or *to*: *can* **swim**, *to* **swim**.
4. **Typical verb suffixes:** -ise/-ize (*realise*), -ify (*simplify*), -en (*widen, strengthen*), -ate (*activate*); prefixes en-/em- (*enrich, empower, enlarge, endanger*), be- (*befriend, belittle*).

1.7 The Adverb

An **adverb** modifies (adds to the meaning of) a **verb**, an **adjective**, another **adverb**, a **preposition**, a **conjunction** or a **whole sentence**. It tells *how, when, where, how often, how much* or *to what degree*.

- He runs **fast**. (modifies verb — how?)
- She is **very** beautiful. (modifies adjective)
- He runs **too** fast. (modifies adverb)
- The bird flew **right** over the house. (modifies preposition)
- I came **simply** because you called me. (modifies conjunction)
- **Fortunately**, nobody was hurt. (modifies whole sentence)

1.7.1 How to Identify an Adverb

1. It answers *how? when? where? how often? to what extent?*
2. It is often movable within the sentence: **Suddenly** the light went out. / The light **suddenly** went out. / The light went out **suddenly**.
3. Many adverbs = adjective + *-ly*: *quick → quickly, happy → happily, careful → carefully.*
4. Many common adverbs have no *-ly*: *fast, hard, late, early, well, soon, now, then, here, there, often, never, always, very, too, quite, almost, still, yet, already, again.*

> **Hard / hardly, late / lately, near / nearly, high / highly** have different meanings. *He works* **hard** (= with effort). *He* **hardly** *works* (= almost never). *He came* **late**. *I haven't seen him* **lately** (= recently). See Chapter 15.

1.8 The Preposition

A **preposition** is a word placed **before a noun or pronoun** to show its relation to some other word in the sentence. The noun/pronoun after it is called its **object**.

- The book is **on** the table. (place)
- He came **at** 10 o'clock. (time)
- She went **to** school **by** bus. (direction, means)
- This gift is **for** you. (purpose)
- He is fond **of** music. (fixed combination)

Identification: a preposition must have an **object**. If the same word has no object, it is usually an **adverb**:

- He walked **down** the hill. (preposition — object: *the hill*)
- Please sit **down**. (adverb — no object)
- He is **in** the room. (preposition) / Come **in**. (adverb)
- I have seen him **before**. (adverb) / I came **before** him. (preposition) / I came **before** he did. (conjunction)

Prepositions may be simple (*in, on, at, by, with*), compound (*inside, within, without, beneath, across*), double (*from behind, from under, out of*), participial (*concerning, regarding, considering, during, pending*) or phrasal (*in spite of, on account of, because of, in front of, with regard to, by means of*). See Chapters 17 and 18.

1.9 The Conjunction

A **conjunction** joins words, phrases, clauses or sentences.

- Rahim **and** Karim are friends. (joins words)
- He is poor **but** honest.
- Hurry up, **or** you will miss the train.
- I stayed at home **because** it was raining.
- **Although** he is rich, he is not happy.
- **Either** you **or** he must go. (correlative conjunction)

Coordinating conjunctions join equal parts: the seven **FANBOYS** — *For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So*. **Subordinating conjunctions** join a dependent clause to a main clause: *because, since, as, although, though, if, unless, when, while, until, after, before, that, so that, lest.* **Correlatives** come in pairs: *either…or, neither…nor, both…and, not only…but also, whether…or, no sooner…than, hardly…when, scarcely…when.*

Identification: a conjunction joins; it does not govern a noun as an object. Compare:

- He came **after** dinner. → preposition (object: dinner)

- He came **after** we had finished dinner. → conjunction (joins two clauses)
- He came **after**. → adverb

1.10 The Interjection

An **interjection** is a word or phrase that expresses a sudden feeling or emotion — joy, sorrow, surprise, pain, approval — and has no grammatical connection with the rest of the sentence. It is usually followed by an exclamation mark.

- **Hurrah!** We have won the match. (joy)
- **Alas!** He is no more. (sorrow)
- **Oh!** What a surprise! (surprise)
- **Ouch!** That hurts. (pain)
- **Bravo!** Well played. (approval)
- **Hush!** The baby is sleeping. (call for silence)
- **Fie!** You should be ashamed. (disgust)

1.11 Step-by-Step Method for Identifying the Part of Speech

When an exam asks for the part of speech of an underlined word, follow these steps:

1. **Read the whole sentence.** Never judge from the word alone.
2. **Find the main verb and subject.** This shows you the skeleton.
3. **Ask what the word does:** Is it naming? (noun) Replacing a noun? (pronoun) Describing a noun? (adjective) Showing action/state? (verb) Telling how/when/where/how much? (adverb) Linking a noun to another word? (preposition) Joining clauses? (conjunction) Exclaiming? (interjection)
4. **Check its neighbours.** After *a/the/my* → probably noun (or adjective + noun). After a modal or *to* → verb. Before a noun → adjective/determiner. Before a noun phrase showing relation → preposition. Before a clause (subject + verb) → conjunction.
5. **Check whether it can be replaced.** Replace it with a typical member of the class: *He ran* **fast** → *He ran* **quickly** (adverb ✔). *It is a* **fast** *train* → *It is a* **quick** *train* (adjective ✔).

1.12 Words That Change Their Part of Speech — Classic Exam Items

Word	Sentence	Part of speech
Light	The **light** is on.	Noun
	This box is **light**.	Adjective
	Light the lamp.	Verb
	Travel **light**.	Adverb
Down	He fell **down**.	Adverb
	He ran **down** the hill.	Preposition
	Life has its ups and **downs**.	Noun
	They **downed** three aircraft.	Verb
	He took the **down** train.	Adjective
Well	He sings **well**.	Adverb
	I am quite **well**.	Adjective
	Water from the **well** is cool.	Noun
	Tears **welled** up in her eyes.	Verb
	Well, what do you want?	Interjection
That	**That** is my house.	Pronoun
	That house is mine.	Adjective
	He said **that** he would come.	Conjunction
	This is the book **that** I bought.	Relative pronoun
	It is not **that** difficult.	Adverb
But	He is poor **but** honest.	Conjunction
	Nobody **but** him came.	Preposition (= except)
	He is **but** a child.	Adverb (= only)
	There is no one **but** loves his country.	Relative pronoun (= who not)
	No **buts**, please.	Noun
Since	I have been here **since** Monday.	Preposition
	Since you are ill, take rest.	Conjunction
	I have not seen him **since**.	Adverb
Like	He is **like** his father.	Preposition
	I **like** mangoes.	Verb
	We shall not see his **like** again.	Noun
	They are of **like** mind.	Adjective
Enough	I have **enough** money.	Adjective
	He is old **enough** to vote.	Adverb
	I have had **enough**.	Pronoun/Noun
Fast	He is on a **fast**.	Noun
	Muslims **fast** in Ramadan.	Verb
	This is a **fast** train.	Adjective
	He runs **fast**.	Adverb
Before	I have seen him **before**.	Adverb
	He came **before** me.	Preposition
	Look **before** you leap.	Conjunction

Exam Tip — *Round, near, after, before, since, for, but, that, as, like, all, about* and *what* are the most frequently tested words. Practise writing one sentence for each part of speech these words can be. (See Chapter 42 for a fuller list.)

1.13 *As* — A Word with Many Jobs

- **As** he was ill, he could not come. (conjunction — reason)
- He works **as** a clerk. (preposition — in the role of)
- He is **as** tall as his brother. (first *as* = adverb, second *as* = conjunction)
- Such men **as** are honest are respected. (relative pronoun)
- **As** you sow, so you reap. (conjunction — manner)

1.14 *What* — Pronoun, Adjective, Interjection

- **What** do you want? (interrogative pronoun)
- **What** book is this? (interrogative adjective)
- **What!** You failed again? (interjection)
- I know **what** you mean. (relative pronoun = that which)
- **What** a beautiful scene! (exclamatory adjective)

1.15 Phrases and Clauses Doing the Job of a Part of Speech

A group of words can also do the job of a single part of speech:

Group	Example	Works as
Noun phrase	**To err** is human. / I like **playing chess**.	Noun
Adjective phrase	A man **of wealth** came. (= a wealthy man)	Adjective
Adverb phrase	He spoke **in a loud voice**. (= loudly)	Adverb
Noun clause	**That he is honest** is known to all.	Noun

Group	Example	Works as
Adjective clause	The man **who came here** is my uncle.	Adjective
Adverb clause	I will go **if you come**.	Adverb
Prepositional phrase	**In spite of** his illness, he came.	Preposition
Conjunctional phrase	He worked hard **so that** he might pass.	Conjunction

These are treated in detail in Chapters 30 and 31.

1.16 Common Errors Linked to Wrong Parts of Speech

1. ✘ He sings very **good**. ✔ He sings very **well**. (*good* is an adjective; a verb needs an adverb.)
2. ✘ She looks **beautifully**. ✔ She looks **beautiful**. (*look* here is a linking verb, so it takes an adjective.)
3. ✘ The rose smells **sweetly**. ✔ The rose smells **sweet**.
4. ✘ He is a **foolish** fellow and behaves **foolish**. ✔ …behaves **foolishly**.
5. ✘ This is a **real** good book. ✔ This is a **really** good book. (adverb needed to modify the adjective *good*)
6. ✘ He gave me an **advise**. ✔ He gave me a piece of **advice**. (*advice* = noun; *advise* = verb)
7. ✘ I **practice** football every day (BrE). ✔ I **practise** football every day. (BrE: *practice* = noun, *practise* = verb.)
8. ✘ He is **sick** of fever. ✔ He is **suffering from** fever. / He is **ill** with fever.
9. ✘ The **beautify** of the scene charmed us. ✔ The **beauty** of the scene charmed us.
10. ✘ He **succeed** in life through hard work. ✔ He **succeeded** … / Hard work brings **success**. / He is **successful**.

> **SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Word Form Errors:** The SAT Writing & Language section and GMAT Sentence Correction often test the "wrong word form": an adjective where an adverb is needed (*The committee acted* **quick → quickly**), a noun where a verb is needed, or an *-ing* form where a finite verb is needed (*The scientists* **having discovered** *a new species* **→ have discovered**). Train your eye to ask: *What job is this word doing, and is it the right form for that job?*

1.17 Practice Identification (Worked Examples)

Study the reasoning in each example.

- "He is a **hard** worker." — describes the noun *worker* → **adjective**.
- "He works **hard**." — tells *how* he works → **adverb**.
- "The **poor** are often neglected." — *the* + adjective used as a plural noun (= poor people) → **noun**.
- "Better **late** than never." — tells *when* → **adverb**.
- "He **bettered** his record." → **verb**; "Respect your **betters**." → **noun**.
- "Every **dog** has his day." → **noun**; "The police **dogged** him." (followed closely) → **verb**.
- "I have **no** money." → **adjective/determiner**; "He is **no** better today." → **adverb**; "Answer yes or **no**." → **noun**.
- "**Only** he passed." → **adverb** (focusing adverb); "He is the **only** son." → **adjective**; "You may go, **only** come back early." → **conjunction** (= but).
- "He has gone **out**." → **adverb**; "He jumped **out of** the window." → **preposition** (double preposition).
- "The plane flew **above** the clouds." → **preposition**; "the sky **above**" → **adverb**; "the **above** statement" → **adjective**; "Read **the above** carefully." → **noun**.

CHAPTER 02

Noun

Part A · Grammar

2.1 Definition

A **noun** is a naming word. It is the name of a **person, place, animal, thing, substance, quality, action, state, feeling or idea**. The word *noun* comes from the Latin *nomen*, meaning "name".

- **Person:** Kazi Nazrul Islam, mother, engineer, child
- **Place:** Chattogram, market, hospital, Bangladesh
- **Animal:** tiger, cow, hilsa, eagle
- **Thing:** chair, mobile, newspaper, bridge
- **Substance / material:** gold, water, rice, cotton
- **Quality:** kindness, courage, beauty, wisdom
- **Action / state:** laughter, journey, sleep, poverty
- **Feeling / idea:** love, fear, freedom, democracy

2.2 Kinds of Nouns

Traditional grammar divides nouns into **five kinds**: Proper, Common, Collective, Material and Abstract. Modern grammars also classify them as **concrete/abstract** and **countable/uncountable**. You must know both systems.

2.2.1 Proper Noun

A **proper noun** is the name of a **particular** person, place or thing. It always begins with a **capital letter**.

- **Persons:** Rabindranath, Sheikh Hasina, Shakespeare, Newton
- **Places:** Dhaka, Cox's Bazar, the Padma, the Himalayas, Asia
- **Days, months, festivals:** Friday, December, Eid-ul-Fitr, Pahela Baishakh
- **Books, newspapers, ships, organisations:** the Gitanjali, The Daily Star, the Titanic, the United Nations
- **Languages and nationalities:** Bangla, English, Japanese

Proper nouns used as common nouns. When a proper noun stands for a *type* or *quality*, it behaves like a common noun and may take an article:

- He is **the Newton** of our college. (= a great scientist)
- Kalidasa is called **the Shakespeare** of India. (= a great dramatist)
- Is there **a Daniel** among you? (= a wise judge)
- Shakespeare is the **Kalidasa** of England. (the comparison works both ways)
- There are two **Rahims** in our class. (two persons named Rahim)

2.2.2 Common Noun

A **common noun** is a name given in common to **every person or thing of the same class or kind**.

- **boy** (any boy), **city** (any city), **river**, **book**, **teacher**, **country**, **flower**

Dhaka is a proper noun, but *city* is a common noun. *The Padma* is a proper noun, but *river* is a common noun.

Common nouns used as abstract nouns. Sometimes a common noun stands for a *quality*:

- **The mother** in her rose up when she saw the child. (= motherly feelings)
- **The judge** in him prevailed over **the father**. (= sense of justice / fatherly love)
- **The pen** is mightier than **the sword**. (= writing / military force)
- **The cradle** and **the grave**. (= birth and death)

2.2.3 Collective Noun

A **collective noun** is the name of a **group or collection** of persons, animals or things taken together and regarded as one whole.

Collective noun	Group of	Collective noun	Group of
a **class**	students	a **herd**	cattle, elephants
a **team**	players	a **flock**	sheep, birds, goats
a **jury**	jurors	a **swarm**	bees, insects
a **committee**	members	a **pack**	wolves, dogs, cards
an **army**	soldiers	a **school / shoal**	fish
a **crowd**	people	a **pride**	lions
an **audience**	listeners	a **bevy**	ladies, quails
a **mob**	rioters	a **galaxy**	stars, beauties
a **crew**	sailors, airmen	a **bunch**	grapes, keys, flowers
a **fleet**	ships, vehicles	a **cluster**	stars, grapes
a **gang**	thieves, labourers	a **bouquet**	flowers
a **band**	musicians, robbers	a **library**	books
a **troupe**	actors, dancers	a **litter**	puppies, kittens
a **staff**	employees	a **brood**	chickens
a **regiment**	soldiers	a **caravan**	travellers, camels
a **congregation**	worshippers	a **chain**	mountains, shops
a **panel**	experts, judges	a **range**	mountains, products
a **board**	directors	a **heap / pile**	stones, books
a **choir**	singers	a **posse**	police, armed men
a **gaggle**	geese (on ground)	a **colony**	ants, bats
a **murder**	crows	a **parliament**	owls
a **troop**	monkeys, scouts	a **sheaf**	corn, papers
a **hive**	bees	a **suite**	rooms, furniture
a **pod**	whales, dolphins	an **anthology**	poems
a **flight**	stairs, birds	a **constellation**	stars
a **group**	islands (archipelago)	a **fleet**	ships

Collective nouns are a favourite exam item, both for vocabulary ("A group of lions is called a ___") and for **subject-verb agreement**. A collective noun takes a **singular verb** when the group acts **as one unit**, and a **plural verb** when the members act **individually**:

- The **jury has** given **its** verdict. (as one unit)
- The **jury were** divided in **their** opinions. (as individuals)
- The **committee has** submitted its report.
- The **committee are** quarrelling among themselves.

See Chapter 23 for complete agreement rules.

2.2.4 Material Noun

A **material noun** is the name of a **substance or material** of which things are made. It is usually **uncountable** and does not normally take *a/an* or a plural form.

- **gold, silver, iron, copper, wood, cotton, wool, silk, glass, stone**
- **water, milk, oil, rice, wheat, sugar, salt, tea, coffee, bread, butter, sand, air**

- **Gold** is a precious metal. (✘ *The gold is…* when speaking in general)
- **Rice** is the staple food of Bangladesh.
- **The gold** in this ring is pure. (*the* is used when the material is particular/specified)
- She bought **two kilos of rice** / **a bar of soap** / **a loaf of bread** / **a piece of chalk** / **a cup of tea**.

Material nouns used as common nouns (when they mean an object made of the material):

- She wears **glasses**. (spectacles)

- He drank two **coffees**. (cups of coffee — informal)
- He was given **irons**. (chains / fetters)
- Bring me a **paper**. (a newspaper) / He has submitted a **paper**. (an article)
- He threw a **stone**. (a piece of stone)

2.2.5 Abstract Noun

An **abstract noun** is the name of a **quality, action, state, feeling or idea** — something we can think of or feel but cannot see or touch.

- **Quality:** honesty, goodness, kindness, cruelty, bravery, wisdom, height, length
- **Action:** laughter, theft, movement, judgement, flight, hatred
- **State:** childhood, boyhood, slavery, sleep, sickness, death, poverty, youth
- **Arts and sciences:** grammar, music, chemistry, mathematics, literature

2.2.6 Formation of Abstract Nouns

Abstract nouns are formed from **adjectives**, **verbs** and **common nouns**. This is a very frequently tested area (also see Chapter 41).

From adjectives:

Adjective	Abstract noun	Adjective	Abstract noun
able	ability	humble	humility
brave	bravery	just	justice
broad	breadth	long	length
cruel	cruelty	poor	poverty
deep	depth	proud	pride
dark	darkness	prudent	prudence
free	freedom	strong	strength
high	height	true	truth
honest	honesty	vain	vanity
wise	wisdom	young	youth
wide	width	hot	heat
decent	decency	brief	brevity
curious	curiosity	generous	generosity
anxious	anxiety	grand	grandeur

From verbs:

Verb	Abstract noun	Verb	Abstract noun
advise	advice	know	knowledge
believe	belief	laugh	laughter
choose	choice	live	life
die	death	move	movement
fly	flight	obey	obedience
grow	growth	please	pleasure
hate	hatred	punish	punishment
judge	judgement	serve	service
think	thought	succeed	success
seize	seizure	pursue	pursuit
deceive	deceit / deception	defend	defence
expand	expansion	permit	permission
sit	session	steal	theft

From common nouns:

Common noun	Abstract noun	Common noun	Abstract noun
child	childhood	hero	heroism
boy	boyhood	king	kingship / kingdom
friend	friendship	slave	slavery
man	manhood	thief	theft
mother	motherhood	patriot	patriotism
agent	agency	rogue	roguery
captain	captaincy	owner	ownership
infant	infancy	priest	priesthood

2.3 Countable and Uncountable Nouns

This modern division is extremely important for the use of articles, determiners and verbs (see Chapters 03, 04 and 05).

- **Countable nouns** name things that can be counted: *one book, two books; a chair, three chairs.* They have singular and plural forms and take *a/an* in the singular.
- **Uncountable (mass) nouns** name things that cannot be counted as separate units: *water, rice, information, advice, furniture.* They normally have no plural form, do not take *a/an*, and take a **singular verb**.

Use with	Countable	Uncountable
a / an	a book ✔	✘ an advice
plural form	books ✔	✘ informations
many / few / a few / several / a number of	many books ✔	✘ many furnitures
much / little / a little / a great deal of / an amount of	✘ much books	much water ✔
some / any / a lot of / lots of / plenty of / no	✔	✔

> **Exam Tip:** The words *information, advice, furniture, luggage, baggage, equipment, scenery, machinery, poetry, news, knowledge, work* (= job), *homework, bread, money, traffic, weather, evidence, research, progress, damage, mischief, jewellery, stationery* are **uncountable** in English (although some are countable in Bangla). Chapter 03 deals with them in detail.

2.4 Concrete and Abstract Nouns

- **Concrete nouns** name things that can be perceived by the five senses — seen, touched, heard, smelt or tasted: *table, music, perfume, mango, Rahim.* Proper, common, collective and material nouns are all concrete.
- **Abstract nouns** name ideas or qualities: *honesty, joy, freedom.*

2.5 Compound Nouns

A **compound noun** is made of two or more words that together act as a single noun.

Pattern	Examples
noun + noun	bookshelf, toothbrush, football, bus stop, sister-in-law
adjective + noun	blackboard, greenhouse, software, full moon
verb + noun	pickpocket, breakfast, washing machine
noun + verb	haircut, sunrise, rainfall, nosebleed
verb + adverb/particle	breakdown, take-off, drawback, setback, check-in
adverb/particle + noun	bystander, underworld, outbreak, input
noun + prepositional phrase	commander-in-chief, man-of-war, mother-in-law

Compound nouns can be written **closed** (*notebook*), **hyphenated** (*passer-by*) or **open** (*post office*). Plural forms are treated in Chapter 06 (*sisters-in-law, passers-by, commanders-in-chief, spoonfuls*).

2.6 Functions (Uses) of a Noun in a Sentence

A noun (or noun phrase/clause) can do these jobs:

Function	Example
Subject of a verb	**Karim** plays football.
Direct object of a verb	I met **Karim**.

Function	Example
Indirect object	I gave **Karim** a book.
Object of a preposition	He is fond of **music**.
Subjective complement	He is a **doctor**. / She became a **minister**.
Objective complement	They made him **captain**. / We elected Rahim **chairman**.
Appositive	Mr. Rahman, **our headmaster**, is ill.
Vocative (address)	**Rahim**, come here.
Adjective-like (noun adjunct)	a **cotton** shirt, a **village** school, a **gold** ring
Adverbial noun	He walked **ten miles**. / Wait **a moment**. / He came **home**.

> **Noun used as an adjective (noun adjunct).** When a noun modifies another noun, it is normally **singular**, even if the meaning is plural: *a* **ten-taka** *note* (✘ ten-takas), *a* **five-year** *plan*, *a* **three-mile** *walk*, *a* **two-storey** *building*, *a* **shoe** *shop*, *a* **toothbrush**. (Exceptions: *sports car, sales manager, arms race, customs officer, savings account, goods train.*)

2.7 Case of Nouns

Case shows the relationship of a noun or pronoun to other words in the sentence. English nouns have three cases:

1. **Nominative (subjective) case** — when the noun is the subject or subjective complement: **Rahim** went home. That man is **Rahim**.
2. **Objective (accusative) case** — when the noun is the object of a verb or preposition: I saw **Rahim**. I went with **Rahim**.
3. **Possessive (genitive) case** — shows ownership or relation: **Rahim's** book; the **boys'** hostel.

(Some grammars add the **dative** case for the indirect object — *I gave* **Rahim** *a pen* — and the **vocative** case for a noun of address — **Rahim**, *come here*.)

For nouns, nominative and objective forms look the same; only the **possessive** has a different form. For pronouns all three forms differ (*he / him / his*), so pronoun case errors are much more common (Chapter 08).

2.8 The Possessive Case — Rules

2.8.1 How to Form the Possessive

Rule	Example
Singular noun → add **'s**	the boy**'s** bag, my sister**'s** room
Plural noun ending in *s* → add only **'**	the boys**'** hostel, the girls**'** school, my parents**'** house
Plural noun **not** ending in *s* → add **'s**	the children**'s** park, men**'s** clothes, women**'s** rights, the people**'s** will
Singular noun ending in *s* → **'s** (or only' in classical names)	James**'s** car (also James'), the boss**'s** office; Moses' laws, Jesus' teachings, Socrates' philosophy
For goodness' sake type phrases (hissing sound before *sake*)	for goodness' sake, for conscience' sake, for justice' sake
Compound nouns → add 's to the **last** word	my brother-in-law**'s** car, the commander-in-chief**'s** order, somebody else**'s** pen
Joint possession → 's on the **last** name only	Rahim and Karim**'s** shop (one shop owned together)
Separate possession → 's on **each** name	Rahim**'s** and Karim**'s** shops (two shops)
Apposition → 's on the **second** noun	This is my friend Kamal**'s** book. / I bought it at Hossain the bookseller**'s**.

2.8.2 When to Use 's and When to Use *of*

In general, the **'s** form is used for **living beings** (persons and animals), and the **of** form for **lifeless things**:

- ✔ the **man's** hand, the **dog's** tail, the **teacher's** advice
- ✘ the **table's** leg ✔ the **leg of the table**
- ✘ the **house's** roof ✔ the **roof of the house**
- ✘ the **book's** cover ✔ the **cover of the book**

Exceptions — 's is also used with:

- **Personified things:** *Nature's laws, Fortune's favourite, Death's door, the Sun's rays, the Moon's light, the Earth's surface.*
- **Time, distance, weight, value:** *a* **day's** *journey, a* **week's** *holiday,* **today's** *paper, a* **stone's** *throw, a* **mile's** *distance, a* **pound's** *weight, ten* **takas'** *worth, two* **hours'** *drive.*
- **Dignified or collective names of places/organisations:** *the* **nation's** *pride,* **Bangladesh's** *economy, the* **government's** *decision, the* **company's** *profit, the* **world's** *population.*
- **Some fixed phrases:** *at his* **wits'** *end, at* **arm's** *length, for* **mercy's** *sake, out of* **harm's** *way, to his* **heart's** *content, by a* **hair's** *breadth, in my* **mind's** *eye, at* **death's** *door, the* **needle's** *eye.*

2.8.3 The Double Possessive

A noun with **of** + **'s** (or of + possessive pronoun) is called the **double possessive**. It shows that the item is **one of several**:

- He is a friend **of my father's**. (= one of my father's friends)
- This is a book **of mine**. (= one of my books) ✘ *a book of me*
- That is a novel **of Tagore's**.

Compare: *a picture of the King* (= a picture showing the King) vs *a picture of the King's* (= a picture owned by the King).

2.8.4 Omission of the Noun after the Possessive

The noun after a possessive is often left out when it is understood, especially *house, shop, church, office*:

- I stayed at my **uncle's** (house).
- He went to the **chemist's** (shop) / the **barber's** / the **doctor's**.
- She attended **St. Paul's** (Cathedral).
- This book is **Rahim's**, not **Karim's**.

2.8.5 Common Possessive Errors

1. ✘ The **its** colour is red. / ✘ **It's** colour is red. ✔ **Its** colour is red. (*its* = possessive; *it's* = it is.)
2. ✘ This pen is **your's**. ✔ This pen is **yours**. (No apostrophe in *yours, hers, ours, theirs, its.*)
3. ✘ The **girl's** hostel is far (meaning hostel for many girls). ✔ The **girls'** hostel is far.
4. ✘ I went to **the barber**. (the person) — acceptable; but *I went to the* **barber's** is the idiomatic form for the shop.
5. ✘ **Childrens'** books ✔ **Children's** books.
6. ✘ He is a friend **of me**. ✔ He is a friend **of mine**.
7. ✘ The **chair's leg** is broken. ✔ The **leg of the chair** is broken.
8. ✘ **Rahim's and Karim's** father is a doctor. (if they are brothers) ✔ **Rahim and Karim's** father is a doctor.
9. ✘ He walked a **mile** distance. ✔ He walked a **mile's** distance / a distance of a mile.
10. ✘ The **mother-in-law's** of the bride. ✔ The bride's **mother-in-law**. / The **mother-in-law's** house.

2.9 Nouns and Their Gender and Number

Gender (*masculine, feminine, common, neuter*) and number (*singular, plural*) are treated fully in Chapters 06 and 07. For now remember:

- *Teacher, student, parent, friend, child, cousin, doctor* are **common gender** (either sex).
- *Table, book, river* are **neuter**.
- *Ship, moon, nation* are often personified as **feminine**; *sun, death, time, war* as **masculine**.

2.10 Noun Phrases and Noun Clauses

A **noun phrase** is a group of words with a noun as its head: *a very tall old man in a black coat*. A **noun clause** is a clause doing the job of a noun: *I know* **that he is honest**. (See Chapters 30–31.)

- **The tall boy in the last bench** is my cousin. (noun phrase as subject)
- **To err** is human; **to forgive**, divine. (infinitive as noun)
- **Smoking** is injurious to health. (gerund as noun)
- **Whatever he says** is true. (noun clause)

2.11 Common Errors in the Use of Nouns

1. ✘ He gave me **an advice**. ✔ He gave me **some advice** / **a piece of advice**.
2. ✘ The **sceneries** of Sylhet are charming. ✔ The **scenery** of Sylhet is charming.
3. ✘ I have bought new **furnitures**. ✔ I have bought new **furniture** / some pieces of furniture.
4. ✘ He has many **informations**. ✔ He has a lot of **information**.
5. ✘ The **poets** Rabindranath and Nazrul **was** great. ✔ The poets … **were** great.
6. ✘ He is a **ten years** old boy. ✔ He is a **ten-year-old** boy. / The boy is **ten years old**.
7. ✘ I have two **dozens** of eggs. ✔ I have two **dozen** eggs. (But: *dozens of eggs* = an indefinite number.)
8. ✘ He bought a **five hundreds** taka note. ✔ He bought a **five-hundred-taka** note.
9. ✘ The **cattles** are grazing. ✔ The **cattle** are grazing. (*cattle* is plural in form and meaning.)
10. ✘ **Mathematics are** my favourite subject. ✔ **Mathematics is** my favourite subject.
11. ✘ The **news are** good. ✔ The **news is** good.
12. ✘ The **police has** arrested the thief. ✔ The **police have** arrested the thief.
13. ✘ He is my **cousin brother**. ✔ He is my **cousin**. (A Bangla-influenced error: *cousin* is common gender.)
14. ✘ My **family members is** large. ✔ My **family is** large. / My family members **are** many.
15. ✘ She is senior **than** me. ✔ She is senior **to** me. (See Chapter 10 on Latin adjectives.)

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Noun Precision: GMAT Sentence Correction punishes **countable/uncountable mismatches** (*fewer* with countables, *less* with uncountables; *number* with countables, *amount* with uncountables): ✘ *The amount of people…* ✔ *The number of people…*; ✘ *less errors* ✔ *fewer errors*. It also tests **noun–noun parallelism** in comparisons: ✘ *The population of Dhaka is larger than Chattogram.* ✔ *The population of Dhaka is larger than* **that of** *Chattogram.* (We compare population with population, not population with a city.)

2.12 Noun-forming Suffixes — Quick Reference for Word Formation

Suffix	Meaning	Examples
-er, -or, -ar, -ist, -ant, -ent, -ee	doer / receiver	teacher, actor, beggar, scientist, assistant, student, employee, payee
-tion, -sion, -ion	act / state	action, admission, union
-ment	act / result	movement, judgement, agreement
-ness	state / quality	happiness, kindness, darkness
-ity, -ty	quality	ability, cruelty, safety
-hood	state / period	childhood, manhood, neighbourhood
-ship	state / skill / rank	friendship, leadership, scholarship
-dom	condition / realm	freedom, kingdom, wisdom
-ism	doctrine / practice	patriotism, socialism, heroism
-ance, -ence, -ancy, -ency	state / act	importance, silence, vacancy, efficiency
-age	collection / act / place	baggage, marriage, orphanage
-al	act of	arrival, refusal, approval
-ure	act / result	failure, pressure, departure
-cy	state	accuracy, privacy, democracy
-th	state	growth, warmth, depth
-ery, -ry	place / practice	bakery, slavery, bravery
-let, -ling, -ette, -kin	small	booklet, duckling, cigarette, lambkin

Learning these suffixes will help you instantly recognise a noun in an unfamiliar sentence and answer “change the part of speech” questions (Chapter 41) with confidence.

CHAPTER 03

Uncountable Problems

Part A · Grammar

3.1 Why “Uncountable Problems”?

Learners in Bangladesh make the same mistakes with a group of English nouns year after year: *informations, furnitures, an advice, sceneries, many luggages, a good news, poetries*. These errors arise because in Bangla we can count almost anything (*একটি উপদেশ, অনেক তথ্য*), but English treats certain nouns as **uncountable** — they cannot be counted with numbers, cannot take *a/an*, cannot be made plural, and take a **singular verb**. Examiners know this weakness well; therefore questions on these nouns appear in almost every BCS Preliminary, Bank and admission paper, usually as *error detection*, *correction* or *fill in the gaps*.

This chapter lists those “problem” nouns, explains the rules that govern them, and shows the correct ways to express quantity with them.

3.2 The Five Golden Rules of Uncountable Nouns

Rule 1 — No *a/an*: ✘ *an information*, ✘ *an advice*, ✘ *a furniture*.

Rule 2 — No plural form: ✘ *informations*, ✘ *advices*, ✘ *furnitures*, ✘ *sceneries*.

Rule 3 — Singular verb and singular pronoun: *The information* **is** *correct; I will check* **it**.

Rule 4 — Use uncountable quantifiers: *much, little, a little, a great deal of, a large amount of, less, least* — not *many, few, a few, a number of, several, fewer.*

Rule 5 — To count, use a “unit” (partitive) word: *a piece of advice, two items of news, an article of furniture.*

3.3 The Master List of Problem Uncountable Nouns

Learn this list thoroughly. Each of these nouns is **uncountable in normal English**.

Noun	✘ Wrong	✔ Right
advice	an advice, advices	some advice, a piece of advice, a word of advice
information	an information, informations	some information, a piece/bit of information
furniture	a furniture, furnitures	some furniture, a piece/an article of furniture
luggage	a luggage, luggages	some luggage, a piece of luggage, three items of luggage
baggage	baggages	a piece of baggage
equipment	equipments	a piece of equipment, some equipment
machinery	machineries	a piece of machinery, machines
scenery	sceneries, a scenery	the scenery, a beautiful scene / view
poetry	poetries, a poetry	a poem, a piece of poetry, poems
news	a news, the news are	a piece/an item of news, the news is
knowledge	knowledges	some knowledge, *a good knowledge of* (accepted idiom)
work (labour)	works (in this sense)	some work, a piece of work, a job
homework / housework	homeworks	some homework, a homework assignment
bread	a bread, breads	a loaf / slice / piece of bread
money	moneys (except in legal/financial “moneys/monies”)	some money, a sum of money, a coin, a note
traffic	traffics	heavy traffic, a traffic jam
weather	a fine weather	fine weather, a spell of fine weather
evidence	evidences, an evidence	a piece of evidence, some evidence
research	researches (avoid in exams)	some research, a piece of research, studies
progress	progresses, a progress	much progress, some progress
damage (harm)	damages (= harm)	much damage; *damages* = money paid as compensation
mischief	mischiefs	a piece of mischief, much mischief
jewellery (AmE jewelry)	jewelleries	a piece of jewellery, jewels
stationery	stationeries	some stationery, items of stationery
hair (on head)	hairs (in this sense)	her hair is long; *a hair / two hairs* = individual strands
crockery / cutlery	crockeries	pieces of crockery
clothing	clothings	an item/article of clothing
software / hardware	softwares	a piece of software, software programs
feedback	feedbacks	some feedback
wildlife	wildlives	—
behaviour	behaviours (in general sense)	his behaviour is good
health / wealth	healths	good health
fun	a fun	great fun, a lot of fun
accommodation (BrE)	accommodations	some accommodation, a place to stay
slang / vocabulary	slangs	some slang, a slang word; a large vocabulary (countable sense)
applause / laughter	applauses	a round of applause, a burst of laughter
litter / rubbish / garbage	rubbishes	a piece of litter
paper (material)	papers (material)	a sheet of paper; *papers* = documents/newspapers
dust / sand / grass / rice	sands (normally), rices	a grain of sand, a blade of grass, a grain of rice
lightning / thunder	a lightning	a flash of lightning, a clap of thunder
produce (farm products)	produces	fresh produce
percentage / data	—	see notes below

Exam Tip — the most tested eight: *advice, information, furniture, luggage, scenery, poetry, news, machinery.* If any of these appears with *a/an*, with an *-s* ending, with *many/few*, or with a plural verb, the sentence is almost certainly wrong.

3.4 Rules Illustrated with Examples

3.4.1 Advice

- ✘ He gave me **an advice**. ✔ He gave me **a piece of advice**.
- ✘ Your **advices are** valuable. ✔ Your **advice is** valuable.
- ✘ I need **many advices**. ✔ I need **a lot of advice**.
- **Advise** (verb, pronounced with *z*) vs **advice** (noun, pronounced with *s*): *I* **advise** *you to work hard. — That is good* **advice**.

3.4.2 Information

- ✘ I have **an important information**. ✔ I have **an important piece of information** / **some important information**.
- ✘ **These informations are** wrong. ✔ **This information is** wrong.
- ✘ He gave **few informations**. ✔ He gave **little information**.

3.4.3 Furniture

- ✘ The room is full of **furnitures**. ✔ The room is full of **furniture**.
- ✘ He bought **a new furniture**. ✔ He bought **a new piece of furniture** (a table, a sofa).
- ✘ **The furniture were** old. ✔ **The furniture was** old.

3.4.4 Luggage / Baggage

- ✘ How many **luggages** do you have? ✔ How many **pieces of luggage** / **bags** do you have?
- ✘ My **luggages have** been lost. ✔ My **luggage has** been lost.

3.4.5 Scenery

Scenery means the general appearance of the natural features of a place. It is uncountable. A single view is a **scene**.

- ✘ The **sceneries** of Rangamati **are** beautiful. ✔ The **scenery** of Rangamati **is** beautiful.
- ✘ I saw **a beautiful scenery**. ✔ I saw **a beautiful scene / view**.
- ✔ The **scenes** of the film were shot in Bandarban. (*scene* is countable)

3.4.6 Poetry and Poem

Poetry = poems in general, the art (uncountable). *Poem* = one composition (countable).

- ✘ He has written **many poetries**. ✔ He has written **many poems** / **a lot of poetry**.
- ✘ Nazrul wrote **a poetry** named *Bidrohi*. ✔ Nazrul wrote **a poem** named *Bidrohi*.
- Similar pairs: *machinery / machine, scenery / scene, jewellery / jewel, clothing / garment, laughter / laugh, vocabulary (the stock) / word.*

3.4.7 News

News looks plural (it ends in -*s*), but it is **uncountable and singular**.

- ✘ **The news are** very good. ✔ **The news is** very good.
- ✘ I heard **a sad news**. ✔ I heard **a sad piece of news** / **some sad news**.
- ✘ **These news have** shocked us. ✔ **This news has** shocked us.
- ✔ Here **is** the news. (BBC style)

3.4.8 Work vs Works

- *Work* (= labour, employment) is uncountable: *I have* **a lot of work** *today. He is looking for* **work** (✘ *a work*). Say *a job* for one position.
- *Works* (countable plural) has other meanings: (a) creations of art/literature: *the* **works** *of Shakespeare*; (b) a factory: *a gas* **works**, *steel* **works** (singular or plural in sense); (c) building or engineering projects: *public* **works**, *road* **works**.

- ✘ I have **many works** to do. ✔ I have **a lot of work** / **many tasks** to do.
- ✔ *Gitanjali* is one of the best-known **works** of Tagore.

3.4.9 Hair

- ✘ Her **hairs are** black. ✔ Her **hair is** black. (hair on the head as a mass)
- ✔ I found **two grey hairs** on my head. (individual strands — countable)
- ✔ There is **a hair** in my soup.

3.4.10 Damage vs Damages

- ✔ The flood caused **much damage** to the crops. (✘ many damages)
- ✔ The court ordered him to pay **damages** of Tk 5 lakh. (*damages* = compensation money)

3.4.11 Knowledge

Knowledge is uncountable, but the idiom **"a good / sound / thorough knowledge of"** is accepted: *He has* **a good knowledge of** *English.* ✘ *He has* **knowledges** *in English.* ✘ *He has* **a knowledge in** *English.*

3.4.12 Bread

- ✘ I ate **two breads**. ✔ I ate **two slices of bread** / **two loaves of bread**.
- ✔ **Bread is** made from flour.

3.4.13 Money and Its Partners

Money, cash, change are uncountable, but *taka, dollar, coin, note, rupee, pound* are countable.

- ✘ How **many money** do you have? ✔ How **much money** do you have?
- ✔ I have **five hundred taka**. (*taka* has the same form in singular and plural.)
- ✘ Have you got **a change**? ✔ Have you got **any change**?

3.5 Partitives — Expressing Quantity with Uncountable Nouns

A **partitive** (unit noun) lets you count a part of an uncountable mass. Learn these collocations — they also appear in vocabulary questions.

Partitive	Used with
a **piece of**	advice, information, news, furniture, luggage, equipment, cake, paper, chalk, land, music, evidence, work, jewellery
an **item / article of**	news, furniture, clothing, luggage
a **bit of**	information, advice, luck, trouble, fun
a **loaf / slice / piece of**	bread
a **bar of**	soap, chocolate, gold
a **cake of**	soap
a **lump of**	sugar, coal, clay
a **cube of**	sugar, ice
a **grain of**	rice, sand, salt, wheat, truth
a **blade of**	grass
a **sheet / ream of**	paper (ream = 500 sheets)
a **drop of**	water, rain, oil, blood
a **cup / glass / bottle of**	tea, water, milk, juice
a **spoonful of**	sugar, medicine
a **pinch of**	salt, snuff
a **sack / bag of**	rice, flour, cement
a **tube of**	toothpaste
a **jar of**	jam, honey
a **pane of**	glass
a **plot of**	land
a **stroke of**	luck, genius, bad luck
a **flash of**	lightning, inspiration
a **clap / peal of**	thunder
a **gust / breath of**	wind, fresh air
a **fit of**	anger, laughter, coughing
a **burst of**	applause, laughter, gunfire
a **round of**	applause, talks, drinks
a **spell of**	fine weather, rain, bad luck
a **state of**	confusion, war, emergency
a **means of**	transport, livelihood
a **word of**	advice, warning, praise

Partitive	Used with
a **pair of**	trousers, scissors, spectacles (see Chapter 06)

3.6 Nouns That Are Countable in One Sense and Uncountable in Another

Many nouns change their meaning when they change their countability. These are favourites of the SAT, GRE and GMAT as well.

Noun	Uncountable meaning	Countable meaning
paper	material: *Write on* **paper**.	newspaper / document / essay: *I bought* **a paper**. *He presented* **a paper** *at the seminar.*
glass	material: *The window is made of* **glass**.	a drinking vessel: *a* **glass** *of water*; **glasses** = spectacles
iron	metal: *Iron is useful.*	an instrument for pressing clothes: *an* **iron**
light	brightness: *Light travels fast.*	a lamp: *Turn off* **the lights**.
experience	knowledge gained over time: *He has five years'* **experience**.	an event: *It was* **a strange experience**.
time	the abstract idea: *Time is money.*	an occasion: *I have been there* **three times**. *We had* **a good time**.
room	space: *Is there* **room** *for me?*	a part of a house: *a big* **room**
business	trade in general: *Business is good.*	a company: *He runs* **a small business**.
work	labour, job	a creation: *the* **works** *of Nazrul*
hair	all the hair on the head	a single strand: *a* **hair**
chicken / fish / lamb	meat: *I like* **chicken**.	the animal: *three* **chickens**; *two* **fishes** (different species) / *two fish*
coffee / tea / beer	the drink: *I like* **coffee**.	a cup/serving: *Two* **coffees**, *please.* (informal)
cake	the food: *Have some* **cake**.	a whole one: *She baked* **a cake**.
stone	material: *a house of* **stone**	a piece: *He threw* **a stone**.
language	the human ability: *Language is a means of communication.*	a particular one: *Bangla is* **a sweet language**.
noise	noise in general: *Don't make* **noise**.	a particular sound: *I heard* **a strange noise**.
sound	—	always countable: *a* **sound**
education	in general: *Education is the backbone of a nation.*	*a* **good education** (accepted with an adjective)
knowledge	in general	*a good knowledge of* (idiom)
success / failure	in general	*The event was* **a great success**. (a successful event/person)
youth	the period: *in his* **youth**	a young man: *a* **youth** *of twenty*; **the youth** = young people

3.7 Plural-looking Nouns That Are Singular

These nouns end in *-s* but are singular in meaning and take a singular verb:

- **News** — *The news is good.*
- **Subjects of study:** *mathematics, physics, economics, statistics, politics, ethics, linguistics, phonetics, civics, electronics — Physics* **is** *my favourite subject.* (But when they mean *qualities / activities / figures*, they can be plural: *His* **politics are** *questionable. The* **statistics show** *a rise in crime.*)
- **Diseases:** *measles, mumps, rickets, diabetes, rabies, herpes — Measles* **is** *infectious.*
- **Games:** *billiards, darts, draughts, dominoes, cards* (when referring to the game) — *Billiards* **is** *an indoor game.*
- **Names of countries/books:** *the United States* **is** *a big country; "Gulliver's Travels"* **is** *a satire; the Netherlands* **is** *in Europe; the Philippines* **is** *an archipelago.*
- **Means / series / species / headquarters / crossroads / innings** — same form singular and plural: *a* **means** *of transport / many* **means**; *a* **series** *of lectures / two* **series**; *this* **species** *is rare / these* **species** *are rare.*

3.8 Singular-looking Nouns That Are Always Plural

These have no *-s* but are always plural and take a plural verb:

- **Cattle, people (= persons), police, poultry, vermin, gentry, clergy, peasantry, livestock (usually singular), folk** — *The* **cattle are** *grazing. The* **police have** *come. The* **poultry are** *fed twice a day.*
- ✘ *a cattle* ✔ *a cow, a head of cattle*; ✘ *a police* ✔ *a policeman / police officer*; ✘ *a poultry* ✔ *a hen.*
- *People* (= persons) is plural: *Many* **people were** *present.* (But *a people* = a nation is countable: *The Bengalis are* **a brave people**. *The* **peoples** *of Asia.*)

3.9 Nouns Always Plural in Form and Meaning

- **Tools and garments with two parts:** *scissors, tongs, pliers, spectacles, glasses, binoculars, trousers, pants, jeans, pyjamas, shorts, tights — My* **trousers are** *new.* Use *a pair of* to make them singular: *A pair of scissors* **is** *on the table.*
- Others: *alms, thanks, riches, wages* (often), *premises, proceeds, outskirts, surroundings, belongings, savings, goods, arrears, archives, annals, congratulations, credentials, earnings, lodgings, odds, remains, stairs, contents, valuables, environs, amends, assets.*

› **Thanks are** due to the organisers.
› His **riches have** not made him happy.
› The **premises are** under CCTV surveillance.
› The **proceeds** of the concert **were** donated to flood victims.
› **Alms are** given to the poor.

3.10 Data, Media, Criteria — Latin and Greek Plurals

These are plural forms borrowed from Latin/Greek. Formal English (and exam keys) usually treat them as plural:

Singular	Plural
datum	**data**
medium	**media**
criterion	**criteria**
phenomenon	**phenomena**
bacterium	**bacteria**
curriculum	**curricula** (or curriculums)
memorandum	**memoranda**
stratum	**strata**

› The **data are** reliable. (formal; *data is* is common in modern usage)
› The **criteria are** clear. ✘ *a criteria*
› This **phenomenon is** strange. These **phenomena are** strange.
› The **media have** a great influence on society.

3.11 Using *the* with Uncountable Nouns

- No article when the noun is used **in a general sense**: *Honesty is the best policy. Milk is good for health. Gold is costly.*
- *The* is used when the noun is **particular / specified**: *The milk in this jug is sour. The honesty of the clerk impressed us. The information you gave me was useful.*

1. ✘ **The honesty** is the best policy. ✔ **Honesty** is the best policy.
2. ✘ **The water** is necessary for life. ✔ **Water** is necessary for life.
3. ✘ **Gold** of this ring is pure. ✔ **The gold** of this ring is pure.

3.12 Quantifiers with Countable and Uncountable Nouns

Countable only	Uncountable only	Both
many, few, a few, fewer, fewest, several, a number of, a couple of, each, every, either, neither, one, two…	much, little, a little, less, least, a great deal of, a large amount of, a large quantity of	some, any, no, a lot of, lots of, plenty of, enough, all, most, more

- **Few** students / **little** water / **fewer** mistakes / **less** sugar
- **A number of** books / **an amount of** money
- **Many** chairs / **much** furniture

> **Less vs Fewer.** Strict usage: *fewer* with plural countables, *less* with uncountables — *fewer cars, less traffic*. But *less* is accepted with amounts of time, money and distance treated as a single quantity: *less than 10 kilometres, less than 500 taka, less than two hours*; and in *one less*.

3.13 Common Errors — Consolidated Practice

1. ✘ The **furnitures** of this room **are** costly. ✔ The **furniture** of this room **is** costly.
2. ✘ He gave me **many advices**. ✔ He gave me **a lot of advice**.
3. ✘ I have **an urgent work**. ✔ I have **some urgent work** / **an urgent job**.
4. ✘ **A large number of** money was stolen. ✔ **A large amount of** money was stolen.
5. ✘ **The sceneries** of Sylhet **attract** tourists. ✔ **The scenery** of Sylhet **attracts** tourists.
6. ✘ He has **little friends**. ✔ He has **few friends**.
7. ✘ There were **less** people at the meeting. ✔ There were **fewer** people at the meeting.
8. ✘ **The cattle is** grazing. ✔ **The cattle are** grazing.
9. ✘ Give me **an information** about the train. ✔ Give me **some information** about the train.
10. ✘ **Mathematics are** difficult. ✔ **Mathematics is** difficult.
11. ✘ I bought **a new trouser**. ✔ I bought **a new pair of trousers** / **new trousers**.
12. ✘ **The scissor is** blunt. ✔ **The scissors are** blunt.
13. ✘ He has **many luggages**. ✔ He has **much luggage** / **many bags**.
14. ✘ We need **some equipments**. ✔ We need **some equipment**.
15. ✘ **His hairs are** grey. ✔ **His hair is** grey.
16. ✘ The flood caused **many damages**. ✔ The flood caused **much damage**.
17. ✘ He has **a good command over** English. ✔ He has **a good command of** English.
18. ✘ **Poultries are** kept in this farm. ✔ **Poultry are** kept on this farm.
19. ✘ He told me **a news**. ✔ He told me **a piece of news**.
20. ✘ I have **no much** time. ✔ I do not have **much** time. / I have **little** time.

> **SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner:** GMAT Sentence Correction frequently pairs countable nouns with the wrong quantifier: ✘ *The* **amount** *of* **students** *enrolled has risen.* ✔ *The* **number** *of students…* ✘ *Less* **cars** ✔ *Fewer cars.* Note also: ✔ *"The number of applicants* **is** *rising"* (singular — *the number*), but ✔ *"A number of applicants* **are** *waiting"* (plural — *a number of* = many).

CHAPTER 04

Determiner

Part A · Grammar

4.1 What Is a Determiner?

A **determiner** is a word placed **before a noun** (or before the adjectives that describe the noun) to **limit or specify** it. It tells us *which one, whose, how many* or *how much*. It does not describe a quality the way an ordinary adjective does.

- **the** book, **a** pen, **an** apple (articles)
- **this** boy, **those** houses (demonstratives)
- **my** father, **their** school (possessives)
- **some** water, **many** students, **few** friends (quantifiers)
- **each** player, **every** citizen, **either** side (distributives)
- **three** books, **the first** day (numerals)
- **which** book? **whose** car? (interrogatives)

Compare an **adjective** and a **determiner**: in *the old house*, *old* tells us the **quality** of the house (adjective) while *the* tells us **which** house (determiner). Determiners come **first** in a noun phrase: *these* **two** *beautiful old* houses.

> **Determiner vs Pronoun.** Many determiners can also stand alone as pronouns. When the word is followed by a noun, it is a determiner; when it stands alone, it is a pronoun: **This** *book is mine* (determiner) / **This** *is mine* (pronoun). **Some** *boys came* (determiner) / **Some** *came* (pronoun). Exceptions: *every, no, the, a/an, my, your, her, our, their* can only be determiners (their pronoun forms are *everyone, none, mine, yours, hers, ours, theirs*).

4.2 Classes of Determiners

Class	Members
Articles	a, an, the
Demonstratives	this, that, these, those
Possessives	my, your, his, her, its, our, their, whose, one's; noun + 's (*Rahim's*)
Quantifiers	some, any, no, much, many, more, most, little, a little, few, a few, less, fewer, enough, several, all, both, half, a lot of, plenty of, a number of, a great deal of
Distributives	each, every, either, neither
Numerals	cardinal (one, two, three…) and ordinal (first, second, last, next…)
Interrogatives	which, what, whose
Pre-determiners	all, both, half, double, twice, such, quite, rather, what (exclamative)
Others	another, other, such, certain, own (after possessive)

4.3 Order of Determiners

When more than one determiner is used, they follow a fixed order:

Pre-determiner → Central determiner → Post-determiner → Adjective(s) → Noun

Pre	Central	Post	Adjective	Noun
all	the	—	—	students
both	my	—	elder	brothers
half	the	—	—	class
—	the	first	three	chapters
—	these	two	old	houses
—	my	many	good	friends
twice	the	—	—	price
such	a	—	lovely	day
what	a	—	beautiful	scene

- ✔ **All the** students were present. ✘ *The all students*
- ✔ **Both my** brothers are doctors. ✘ *My both brothers*
- ✔ **The first two** chapters are easy. (In modern English *the first two* is preferred to *the two first*.)
- ✔ **Half the** class was absent. / **Half of the** class…
- ✔ It costs **twice the** price.
- ✔ It was **such a** lovely day. ✘ *a such lovely day*
- ✔ It was **quite a** good show. / **a quite** good show (both accepted; *quite a* is more common)

4.4 Articles

Articles (*a, an, the*) are the most common determiners. They are treated in full detail in **Chapter 05**.

4.5 Demonstratives: *this, that, these, those*

Near	Far
this (singular)	**that** (singular)
these (plural)	**those** (plural)

- **This** book is mine; **that** book is yours.
- **These** mangoes are sweet; **those** mangoes are sour.
- ✘ **This** news **are** good. ✔ **This** news **is** good.
- ✘ **These kind of** books are useless. ✔ **This kind of** book is useless. / **These kinds of** books are useless.
- ✘ **That** sort of men are dangerous. ✔ **That sort of man is** dangerous. / **Men of that sort are** dangerous.

Those is used to avoid repeating a plural noun in comparisons: *The streets of Dhaka are busier than* **those** *of Rajshahi.* (✘ *than Rajshahi*). **That** replaces a singular noun: *The climate of Sylhet is wetter than* **that** *of Rajshahi.*

4.6 Possessive Determiners

my, your, his, her, its, our, their, whose, one's (and nouns in the possessive case). They show ownership.

- **My** pen, **her** bag, **its** tail, **their** house, **Rahim's** car
- ✘ **It's** wings are broken. ✔ **Its** wings are broken.
- ✘ Everyone should do **their** duty. (informal) ✔ Everyone should do **his or her** duty / **his** duty (traditional exam answer). (See Chapter 08 and Chapter 23.)
- ✘ One should respect **his** parents. ✔ One should respect **one's** parents. (Traditional British usage; *his* is accepted in American English.)

4.7 Quantifiers

4.7.1 *Some* and *Any*

Some	*Any*
Affirmative sentences: *I have* **some** *money.*	Negative sentences: *I don't have* **any** *money.*
Offers and requests (expecting *yes*): *Would you like* **some** *tea? Could you lend me* **some** *money?*	Questions (neutral): *Do you have* **any** *questions?*

Some	*Any*
—	Conditional: *If you need* **any** *help, call me.*
—	Affirmative meaning "it does not matter which": **Any** *child can do this. Take* **any** *pen you like.*

- ✘ I don't have **some** friends here. ✔ I don't have **any** friends here.
- ✔ **Some** people believe in ghosts. (= certain people)
- ✔ **Some** boy has broken the window. (= an unknown boy — singular use)
- ✔ It happened **some** twenty years ago. (= about — adverb)
- ✘ I have not **no** money. (double negative) ✔ I have **no** money. / I do not have **any** money.

4.7.2 *Much* and *Many*

- **Many** + plural countable: *many books, many people.*
- **Much** + uncountable: *much water, much time.*
- In affirmative sentences, *much* sounds formal; *a lot of / plenty of / a great deal of* is more natural: *He has* **a lot of** *money.* In negatives and questions *much* is normal: *I don't have* **much** *time. Is there* **much** *traffic?*

- ✘ **Much** people attended. ✔ **Many** people attended.
- ✘ **Many** furniture ✔ **Much** furniture
- ✔ **Many a** student **has** failed. (*many a* + singular noun + singular verb — see Chapter 23)
- ✔ **A great many** people came. (*a great many* + plural)

4.7.3 *Few, A Few, The Few* and *Little, A Little, The Little*

This is one of the **most frequently tested** areas in Bangladeshi exams.

Word	Used with	Meaning	Feeling
few	countable plural	almost none, not many	negative
a few	countable plural	some, a small number	positive
the few	countable plural	the not many that exist — all of them	"all of the small number"
little	uncountable	almost nothing, hardly any	negative
a little	uncountable	some, a small amount	positive
the little	uncountable	the small amount that exists — all of it	"all of the small amount"

- **Few** people are honest nowadays. (= hardly anyone — negative)
- **A few** people came to help. (= some came — positive)
- **The few** friends he had deserted him. (= all of his small number of friends)
- There is **little** hope of his recovery. (= almost no hope)
- There is **a little** hope of his recovery. (= some hope)
- **The little** money he had was stolen. (= all of his small amount of money)
- ✔ "**A little** learning is a dangerous thing." (Alexander Pope, *An Essay on Criticism*) — here *a little* = some, a small amount.

Exam Tip — Spot the feeling. If the sentence is negative in feeling, choose *few/little*; if it is positive, choose *a few/a little*; if the sentence speaks of *all* of a small quantity (usually followed by a relative clause such as *he had*), choose *the few/the little*.

- *He has ____ friends, so he feels lonely.* → **few**
- *He has ____ friends who help him in danger.* → **a few**
- *He spent ____ money he had.* → **the little**

Quite a few (= a fairly large number) and **not a few** (= many) are positive: *Quite a few students got GPA 5.* **Only a few / only a little** = very few / very little, but used with *a*: ✔ *Only a few people came.* ✘ *Only few people came* (informal).

4.7.4 *Fewer / Less* and *More / Most*

- **Fewer** (comparative of *few*) + plural countable: *fewer mistakes, fewer students.*
- **Less** (comparative of *little*) + uncountable: *less sugar, less noise.*
- **More / most** with both: *more books, more water; most people, most of the time.*

- ✘ **Less** students passed this year. ✔ **Fewer** students passed this year.
- ✘ **Most of** students are poor. ✔ **Most students** are poor. / **Most of the** students are poor.
- ✘ **The most** people like music. ✔ **Most** people like music.

4.7.5 *Enough*

Enough comes **before** a noun but **after** an adjective or adverb:

- We have **enough** money / **enough** chairs.
- He is **old enough** to vote. ✘ *enough old*
- She did not run **fast enough**.

4.7.6 *Several, A Number of, A Lot of, Plenty of*

- **Several** (= more than two but not many) + plural countable: *several times, several books.*
- **A number of** + plural countable + plural verb: *A number of students* **were** *absent.*
- **The number of** + plural noun + **singular** verb: *The number of students* **is** *increasing.*
- **A lot of / lots of / plenty of** + countable or uncountable; verb agrees with the noun: *A lot of* **water is** *wasted. A lot of* **people are** *waiting.*
- **A great deal of / a large amount of** + uncountable: *a great deal of* **money**.

4.7.7 *All, Both, Half*

- **All** (whole quantity) + plural or uncountable: *all the students, all the milk, all day.* ✔ *All of us / all of them* (with pronouns, *of* is required). ✘ *All we* → ✔ *We all / All of us.*
- **Both** (= the two together) + plural: *both the boys / both boys / both of the boys / both of them.* ✘ *Both of them are not present* (ambiguous) → ✔ *Neither of them is present.*
- **Half** + *(of) the* + noun: *half the class, half an hour* (✘ *a half hour* is AmE), *half of them.*

- ✘ **Both** Rahim **as well as** Karim came. ✔ **Both** Rahim **and** Karim came.
- ✘ **The both** brothers are clever. ✔ **Both the** brothers are clever.
- ✘ **All** of students passed. ✔ **All (of) the** students passed. / **All** students passed.

4.7.8 *No* and *None*

- **No** is a determiner (needs a noun): *There is* **no** *water. He has* **no** *friends.*
- **None** is a pronoun (stands alone): **None** *of them came. I wanted some milk, but there was* **none**.
- ✘ *None student came.* ✔ *No student came. / None of the students came.*
- *None* takes a singular verb in formal style when it means *not one* (**None of them is** *present*), but a plural verb is also accepted with plural nouns (**None of them are** *present*). Exam keys usually prefer the singular. (See Chapter 23.)

4.8 Distributives: *each, every, either, neither*

Distributives refer to members of a group **one at a time**.

Word	Use	Example
each	two or more, considered **individually**	*Each* boy has a book. / *Each of* the two boys…
every	three or more, considered **as a whole group, one by one**	*Every* student must attend.
either	one or the other **of two**	You may take *either* road.
neither	not one nor the other **of two**	*Neither* answer is correct.

> All four take a **singular noun** and a **singular verb**: *Each student* **has**…, *Every citizen* **is**…, *Either answer* **is** *correct*, *Neither of the boys* **was** *present.*

- ✘ **Every** students **are** present. ✔ **Every** student **is** present.
- ✘ **Each of** the girls **have** a pen. ✔ **Each of** the girls **has** a pen.
- ✘ **Every of** the students ✔ **Every one of** the students / **Each of** the students (*every* cannot be followed directly by *of*).
- ✘ **Either of** the three boys can go. ✔ **Any of** the three boys can go. / **Any one** of the three… (*either/neither* for two only)
- ✘ **Neither of** the four… ✔ **None of** the four…
- ✔ **Each** and **every** member **was** consulted. (emphatic; singular verb)
- ✔ He comes **every** other day (= on alternate days). / **every** few days / **every** three hours (*every* + number + plural noun = interval).
- ✔ There are trees on **either side** of the road. (= on both sides — *either side* takes a singular noun)

> **Each** can come after the subject: *The boys* **each** *have a pen* (here the verb agrees with *the boys* — plural). Compare: **Each of the boys has** *a pen.* Also: *They gave us ten taka* **each**.

4.9 Numerals as Determiners

- **Cardinal numbers** (*one, two, three, hundred*) tell **how many**: *two pens, five hundred taka.*
- **Ordinal numbers** (*first, second, third, last, next*) tell **position/order**: *the first boy, the third chapter.* They normally take *the*.

- ✘ He was **first** to come. → ✔ He was **the first** to come.
- ✘ **The** chapter **ten** → ✔ **Chapter ten** / **the tenth** chapter (no *the* with "noun + cardinal"): *page 10, chapter 3, room 12, gate 2, World War II.*
- ✘ **The first two** boys / **the two first** boys → modern standard: **the first two** boys (the first two in order).
- ✔ **Hundreds of** people / **two hundred** people (✘ two hundreds people)
- ✔ **Dozens of** eggs / **three dozen** eggs (✘ three dozens eggs)
- ✔ **One and a half** hours / **an hour and a half**

4.10 Interrogative Determiners: *which, what, whose*

- **Which** — choice from a limited, known set: **Which** *colour do you prefer, red or blue?*
- **What** — choice from an open/unlimited set: **What** *colour is your car?*
- **Whose** — possession: **Whose** *pen is this?*

4.11 *Other, Another, Others, The Other*

Form	Use	Example
another	one more / a different one (singular countable)	Have **another** cup of tea. Give me **another** pen.
other	+ plural or uncountable noun	**Other** people may disagree.
the other	the remaining one(s) of a definite set	I have two pens; one is red, **the other** is blue.
others	pronoun = other people/things	Some like tea, **others** like coffee.
the others	the remaining ones (pronoun)	Rahim stayed; **the others** left.
each other	between two (traditionally)	The two brothers love **each other**.
one another	among more than two (traditionally)	The students helped **one another**.

- ✘ I need **another** books. ✔ I need **other** books / **another** book / **more** books.
- ✘ Help the **others** people. ✔ Help **other** people. / Help **others**.
- ✔ *Wait* **another two days**. (*another* + number + plural noun is correct when the period is treated as one unit.)
- ✔ **Every other** day (= alternate days); **one after the other**; **on the other hand**.

4.12 *Such* and *What* (Exclamative / Pre-determiner)

- It was **such a** good film that I saw it twice.
- They are **such** good friends.
- **What a** beautiful day! / **What** lovely flowers! / **What** nonsense!
- ✘ **Such** a beautiful **a** girl. ✔ **Such a** beautiful girl. / **So** beautiful **a** girl (formal).

4.13 *Own*

Own is used after a possessive to emphasise ownership: *my own house, his own car.* ✘ *an own house* ✔ *a house of his own*.

4.14 Common Errors with Determiners

1. ✘ **Every** boys must come. ✔ **Every** boy must come.
2. ✘ He has **less** friends than his brother. ✔ He has **fewer** friends than his brother.
3. ✘ **Both of** them are not present. ✔ **Neither of** them is present.
4. ✘ I have **little** books. ✔ I have **few** books.
5. ✘ **Each** of the student **were** given a prize. ✔ **Each** of the students **was** given a prize.
6. ✘ **Either of** the ten applicants may be selected. ✔ **Any** of the ten applicants…
7. ✘ He gave me **a few** advice. ✔ He gave me **a little** advice.
8. ✘ **All the both** boys came. ✔ **Both the** boys came.
9. ✘ I don't have **no** time. ✔ I don't have **any** time. / I have **no** time.
10. ✘ **The most** of the people are poor. ✔ **Most** of the people are poor.
11. ✘ He is **enough strong** to lift it. ✔ He is **strong enough** to lift it.
12. ✘ **These** kind of mistakes **are** common. ✔ **This** kind of mistake **is** common.
13. ✘ I met him **the last** week. ✔ I met him **last** week. (no article with *last/next* + time word in relation to now)
14. ✘ **None** student was present. ✔ **No** student was present.
15. ✘ I bought **three dozens** pens. ✔ I bought **three dozen** pens.
16. ✘ The house has **much** rooms. ✔ The house has **many** rooms.
17. ✘ **Little** knowledge is dangerous. ✔ **A little** knowledge is a dangerous thing.
18. ✘ The bus leaves **every two hour**. ✔ The bus leaves **every two hours**. (*every* + number + plural noun)
19. ✘ He is one of **my** friend. ✔ He is one of **my friends**. (*one of* + plural noun)
20. ✘ I have read **this both** books. ✔ I have read **both these** books.

> **SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Quantifier Logic:** The GMAT tests *the number of / the amount of, fewer/less,* and *each/every* agreement. Example: ✘ *"Each of the proposals* **have** *merit, but neither* **are** *practical."* ✔ *"Each of the proposals* **has** *merit, but neither* **is** *practical."* GRE Reading passages exploit *few* (negative) vs *a few* (positive) to reverse the author's attitude —"Few critics have praised the novel" means the novel was largely **not** praised.

CHAPTER 05

Article

Part A · Grammar

5.1 What Are Articles?

A, **an** and **the** are called **articles**. They are the most frequently used words in English and are a special kind of determiner (Chapter 04). Traditional grammar calls them "demonstrative adjectives" because they point out or limit nouns.

- **A / An** — the **indefinite article**. It points to *any one* person or thing, not a particular one: *a book* (any book), *an orange*.
- **The** — the **definite article**. It points to a *particular* person or thing that the listener can identify: *the book* (the one we both know about).

› I saw **a** dog in the street. (any dog — mentioned for the first time)
› **The** dog was barking loudly. (the particular dog already mentioned)

Because Bangla has no exact equivalent of English articles (we use *-টি, -টা* or nothing), article errors are extremely common among Bangladeshi learners and are tested in every competitive exam — in fill-in-the-blanks, error detection and correction.

5.2 *A* or *An*? — The Sound Rule

The choice between *a* and *an* depends on the **first sound** (not the first letter) of the next word.

- **A** before a **consonant sound**: *a book, a cat, a university, a European, a one-taka coin, a uniform, a useful thing, a once-famous actor.*
- **An** before a **vowel sound**: *an apple, an egg, an hour, an honest man, an heir, an MA, an MBBS doctor, an SSC candidate, an X-ray, an LLB degree.*

5.2.1 Letters That Trick You

Starts with	Sound	Article	Examples
u pronounced "you" (ইউ)	consonant /j/	**a**	a university, a union, a unique case, a useful book, a usual thing, a European, a ewe, a uniform, a unit, a utensil
u pronounced "aa" (আ)	vowel	**an**	an umbrella, an uncle, an ugly sight, an umpire, an urgent letter, an undertaking
o pronounced "wa" (ওয়া)	consonant /w/	**a**	a one-eyed man, a one-way road, a once-popular singer
silent h	vowel	**an**	an hour, an honest man, an honour, an heir, an heiress, an honorarium, an honorary post
sounded h	consonant	**a**	a house, a horse, a hotel, a historic event, a hero, a hospital, a habit
abbreviations read letter by letter, starting with a vowel sound (A, E, F, H, I, L, M, N, O, R, S, X)	vowel ("eff", "aitch", "em", "es")	**an**	an MP, an M.A., an S.S.C. examinee, an F.R.C.S., an LL.B., an X-ray, an NGO, an HSC candidate, an R.A.B. officer, an IAS officer
abbreviations starting with a consonant sound (B, C, D, G, J, K, P, Q, T, U, V, W, Y, Z)	consonant	**a**	a B.A., a B.Sc., a UNO official, a UN agency ("you-en"), a BCS cadre, a PhD student
abbreviations read as a word (acronyms)	according to the word		a NATO member, a UNESCO site ("you-nes-co"), an OPEC country, a SAARC country

Exam Tip — say it aloud. Silently pronounce the next word: if the very first *sound* is a, e, i, o, u (as in *apple, egg, ink, ox, umbrella*), use *an*; otherwise use *a*. The most-tested items: **an hour, an honest man, an heir, a university, a European, a one-taka note, a unique, an MA, an M.Sc., an SSC, a useful, an umbrella, an LLB, a UN, a historical** (both *a historical* and the old-fashioned *an historical* exist; *a historical* is the modern standard).

5.3 Uses of the Indefinite Article *A / An*

5.3.1 Before a singular countable noun mentioned for the first time

› I have **a** cat. **The** cat is white.
› Once there lived **a** king. **The** king had three sons.

5.3.2 In the sense of *one*

› **A** day or two. / Twelve inches make **a** foot. / **A** stitch in time saves nine.
› He did not say **a** word. (= even one word)
› Wait **a** minute.

5.3.3 In the sense of *any* / representing a class

› **A** cow is a useful animal. (= any cow / cows in general)
› **A** student should be punctual.
› **A** dog has four legs.

5.3.4 Before a profession, job or role (singular)

› He is **a** doctor. (✘ He is doctor.)
› She wants to be **an** engineer.
› My father is **a** banker.

5.3.5 In the sense of *per / each* (rate)

› Rice sells at fifty taka **a** kilo.
› He visits us twice **a** week.
› The car runs at eighty kilometres **an** hour.

5.3.6 In the sense of *a certain* (before a proper noun)

› **A** Mr. Hasan came to see you. (= a certain person named Hasan whom I do not know)
› **A** Rahim from Comilla has applied for the job.

5.3.7 Before a proper noun used as a common noun (= someone like)

› He is **a** second Newton. (= a great scientist like Newton)
› He thinks he is **a** Shakespeare.
› **A** Daniel come to judgement!

5.3.8 In exclamations with *what* and *such* (singular countable nouns)

› **What a** beautiful bird! (✘ What beautiful bird!)
› He is **such a** fool!

- **What a** pity! / **What a** shame!

5.3.9 With *quite, rather, half, many, so, too, as* (word-order rules)

- It is **quite a** long way. / It is **rather a** good idea (or *a rather good idea*).
- **Half an** hour ✔ / a **half-hour** (AmE)
- **Many a** man has died for his country.
- It is **so** difficult **a** problem that I cannot solve it. (formal: *so + adj + a + noun*)
- It is **too** big **a** house for me. (formal: *too + adj + a + noun*)
- He is **as** good **a** player **as** his brother.

5.3.10 In certain fixed expressions

a lot of, a great deal of, a great many, a good many, a few, a little, a couple of, a dozen, a hundred, a thousand, in a hurry, in a fix, at a loss, at a glance, as a rule, as a matter of fact, in a nutshell, at a stretch, a short while, all of a sudden, to put an end to, to make a noise, to make a fool of, to take a fancy to, to have a mind to, to keep an eye on, to have a headache / a fever / a cold, to go for a walk / a swim / a drive, to take a seat, to make an effort, to tell a lie, in a low voice, with a view to, for a long time, a matter of time.

5.3.11 Before uncountable nouns with an adjective (a kind of / an instance of)

- He has **a** good knowledge of English.
- She has **a** sweet voice.
- We had **a** wonderful time.
- ✘ He showed **a** great courage. ✔ He showed **great courage**. (*courage, advice, information, weather, progress* do not take *a* even with an adjective.)
- ✔ **A** heavy rain fell last night. (common, but *heavy rain fell* is safer.)

5.4 Uses of the Definite Article *The*

5.4.1 For something already mentioned or known to both speaker and listener

- I bought a pen and a book. **The** pen is red.
- Please shut **the** door. (the door of this room)
- Where is **the** teacher? (our teacher)

5.4.2 For things that are one of a kind (unique)

the sun, the moon, the earth, the sky, the world, the universe, the equator, the North Pole, the horizon, the Prime Minister, the Holy Quran, the Bible, the Ramayana, the Internet.

- **The** sun rises in **the** east.
- **The** earth moves round **the** sun.

5.4.3 Before a singular noun representing a whole class (generic *the*)

- **The** cow is a useful animal. (= cows in general)
- **The** rose is the sweetest of all flowers.
- **The** computer has changed our lives.
- **The** dog is a faithful animal.

> **Man** and **woman**, when used for the whole race/sex, take **no article**: **Man** *is mortal*. **Woman** *is the better half of man.* ✘ *The man is mortal* (that would mean a particular man).

5.4.4 Before an adjective used to mean a class of people (plural)

the rich, the poor, the old, the young, the sick, the blind, the deaf, the dumb, the dead, the wounded, the unemployed, the brave, the wise, the honest, the learned.

- **The rich are** not always happy. (= rich people — plural verb)
- **The poor** should be helped.
- **The wounded were** taken to hospital.
- Only **the brave** deserve the fair. (Dryden)

5.4.5 Before superlatives and ordinals

- He is **the best** student in the class.
- Mount Everest is **the highest** peak in the world.
- Friday is **the sixth** day of the week.
- He was **the first** to arrive. / **the last** day / **the next** chapter (in a sequence)
- **The only** son / **the same** book / **the very** man / **the main** reason / **the whole** story

5.4.6 Before a comparative to show two corresponding increases

- **The more** you read, **the more** you learn.
- **The sooner, the better.**
- **The higher** you go, **the colder** it becomes.
- He is **the taller of the two** brothers. (comparative + *of the two*)

5.4.7 Before proper nouns of these types (Geography)

Category	Use the	Examples
Rivers	✔	the Padma, the Meghna, the Jamuna, the Ganges, the Nile, the Thames
Seas, oceans, gulfs, bays, canals, straits	✔	the Bay of Bengal, the Pacific (Ocean), the Red Sea, the Persian Gulf, the Suez Canal, the English Channel
Mountain ranges	✔	the Himalayas, the Alps, the Andes, the Chittagong Hill Tracts
Groups of islands	✔	the Maldives, the Andamans, the West Indies, the Philippines
Deserts	✔	the Sahara, the Gobi, the Thar
Plural country names / names with *Republic, Kingdom, States, Union*	✔	the USA, the UK, the Netherlands, the People's Republic of China, the UAE
Directions as regions	✔	the Middle East, the Far East, the West, the North
Single mountains	✘	Mount Everest, Keokradong, Tajingdong (Bijoy)
Single lakes	✘	Lake Kaptai (but *the Kaptai Lake* is common in BD usage), Lake Victoria
Single islands	✘	St. Martin's Island, Bhola, Sri Lanka
Continents, countries, cities, states	✘	Asia, Bangladesh, India, Dhaka, London, Texas
Streets, roads, squares, parks	✘	Mirpur Road, Elephant Road, Times Square, Hyde Park

- ✘ **The Bangladesh** is a riverine country. ✔ **Bangladesh** is a riverine country.
- ✘ **The Mount Everest** is the highest peak. ✔ **Mount Everest**…
- ✘ **Padma** is a mighty river. ✔ **The Padma** is a mighty river.
- ✔ **The Sundarbans** is the largest mangrove forest in the world.

5.4.8 Before names of these (non-geographical) proper nouns

Category	Examples
Holy and famous books	the Quran, the Bible, the Gita, the Ramayana, the Mahabharata, the Vedas (but *Gitanjali*, *Hamlet* — titles of ordinary books take no article unless "the" is part of the title: *The Waste Land*)

Category	Examples
Newspapers and magazines	the Daily Star, the Prothom Alo, the Times, the Economist (the article is often part of the name)
Ships, trains, aircraft	the Titanic, the Subarna Express, the Bangabandhu Satellite
Famous buildings, museums, hotels	the Taj Mahal, the National Museum, the Shaheed Minar, the White House, the Sonargaon Hotel
Historical events and periods	the French Revolution, the Liberation War, the Renaissance, the Middle Ages
Organisations, political parties	the United Nations, the World Bank, the Awami League, the BNP
Nations (as a people)	the English, the French, the Japanese, the Bengalis
Families (plural surname)	the Khans, the Tagores, the Smiths

5.4.9 Before musical instruments

- He plays **the** guitar / **the** flute / **the** harmonium / **the** violin.
- (But games take no article: He plays **cricket / football / chess**.)

5.4.10 Before an adjective/noun used in the singular for an abstract quality

- **The** pen is mightier than **the** sword.
- He felt **the** patriot in him rise.
- **The** beautiful is not always **the** good.

5.4.11 *The* + noun + *of* (when the noun is defined by a phrase)

- **The** history **of** Bangladesh / **The** water **of** this well / **The** honesty **of** the man / **The** capital **of** France
- (But: *History is interesting* — general sense, no article.)

5.4.12 With body parts after a preposition (instead of a possessive)

- He caught me by **the** hand. (✘ by my hand)
- She was shot in **the** leg.
- He patted the boy on **the** back.

5.4.13 Fixed expressions with *the*

in the morning/afternoon/evening, by the way, on the whole, in the end, at the moment, in the meantime, to tell the truth, out of the question, on the contrary, at the same time, by the dozen, on the other hand, all the same, in the long run, the day after tomorrow, the day before yesterday, to go to the cinema/theatre, in the dark, in the sun, at the top, at the bottom.

5.5 Omission of Articles (Zero Article)

No article is used in these cases:

5.5.1 Before plural or uncountable nouns used in a general sense

- **Books** are our best friends. (✘ The books are…)
- **Honesty** is the best policy. (✘ The honesty…)
- **Milk** is good for health.
- **Gold** is a precious metal.

5.5.2 Before most proper nouns (names of persons, countries, cities, continents, days, months, festivals)

- **Rahim** is my friend. **Dhaka** is a big city. **Asia** is the largest continent.
- **Sunday** is a holiday. **December** is the month of victory.
- **Eid** is a happy festival. (*the Eid* is also heard, but zero article is standard.)

5.5.3 Before names of languages, subjects, games, meals, diseases (most)

- He speaks **English**. (But *the English language*, *the English* = the people.)
- I like **mathematics**. She plays **badminton**.
- We have **breakfast** at eight. **Lunch** is ready. (But *a heavy breakfast*, *the lunch I had yesterday*.)
- He is suffering from **fever / cholera / diabetes / cancer**. (But *a cold*, *a headache*, *a fever* — informal, *the measles*, *the flu*.)

5.5.4 Before *school, college, university, hospital, church, mosque, temple, prison, jail, court, bed, sea, market, home, work, office* used for their primary purpose

Primary purpose (no article)	Other purpose (with *the*)
He goes to **school** (as a student).	His father went to **the school** to meet the headmaster.
She is in **hospital** (as a patient).	I went to **the hospital** to see her.
The thief was sent to **prison**.	His wife visited **the prison**.
We go to **mosque** on Friday (to pray).	The tourists visited **the mosque**.
He went to **bed** at ten (to sleep).	He sat on **the bed**.
He went to **sea** (became a sailor).	We went to **the sea** for a holiday.
He is at **home**. / He came **home**.	He visited **the home** for the elderly.
She goes to **work** by bus.	—

5.5.5 Before nouns of time, transport and place in fixed phrases

by bus, by train, by car, by air, by sea, on foot, at night, at noon, at midnight, at dawn, at sunset, by day, by night, at home, at school, in bed, in hospital, at present, at last, at first, in time, on time, by mistake, by chance, by heart, in fact, in debt, in trouble, at hand, on fire, on duty, on board, at sea, from door to door, from hand to hand, day by day, face to face, side by side, arm in arm.

- He came **by bus**. (✘ by a bus / by the bus — but *in the bus*, *on the 8 o'clock bus* are fine)
- We met **at night**. (but *in the night*, *during the night*)

5.5.6 Before titles and positions used as complements or after *as / turned / elected / appointed*

- He was elected **chairman** of the committee. (✘ the chairman)
- They made him **captain**.
- He was appointed **Principal** of the college.
- He turned **Muslim / traitor**.
- As **Prime Minister**, she visited China.

5.5.7 With *man* (mankind), *woman* (womankind), *nature, society, God, heaven, hell, parliament* in general sense

- **Man** is mortal. **Nature** is the best teacher. **God** is great. **Society** must protect children.

5.5.8 With *next, last* + time word (relative to now)

- I saw him **last** week. He will come **next** Monday. (✘ the last week / the next Monday)
- But: *He left* **the next day**. (= the following day, in a past story) / **the last week of** *March*.

5.5.9 In headlines, notices, instructions and after *kind of / sort of / type of*

- *Minister opens bridge.* / *Push button to start.*
- What **kind of man** is he? (✘ kind of a man — informal AmE)

5.5.10 In paired or balanced expressions

father and son, husband and wife, day and night, from top to bottom, rich and poor, young and old, from head to foot, hand in hand, body and soul.

5.6 Repetition of Articles

When two nouns/adjectives refer to **different** persons/things, the article is **repeated**; when they refer to the **same** person/thing, the article is used **once**.

- **The** Secretary and Treasurer **is** present. (one person holds both posts)

- **The** Secretary and **the** Treasurer **are** present. (two persons)
- I have **a** black and white cow. (one cow, black-and-white in colour)
- I have **a** black and **a** white cow. (two cows)
- **The** poet and philosopher **is** dead. (one person)
- **The** poet and **the** philosopher **are** dead. (two persons)

This rule connects with subject-verb agreement (Chapter 23) and is a favourite BCS item.

5.7 Position of the Article

The article normally comes **before** the noun and its adjectives: *a good boy, the tall man.* Exceptions:

- After *such, what, many, half, quite, rather*: *such a man, what a pity, many a time, half an hour, quite a crowd, rather a long story.*
- After an adjective preceded by *so, too, as, how, however*: *so great a man, too heavy a load, as clever a boy as, how tall a man, however great a sinner.*
- After *all, both, double, twice* (pre-determiners): *all the boys, both the girls, double the amount, twice the size.*

5.8 Articles with Countable and Uncountable Nouns

Noun type	General sense	Specific sense
Singular countable	**a/an** or **the** (generic): *A dog barks. The dog is faithful.*	**the**: *The dog next door barks all night.*
Plural countable	**zero**: *Dogs bark.*	**the**: *The dogs next door bark.*
Uncountable	**zero**: *Water is essential.*	**the**: *The water in this bottle is dirty.*

A **singular countable noun** can never stand alone. It must have *a/an, the*, or another determiner (*my, this, every*…): ✘ *I bought pen.* ✔ *I bought a pen / the pen / my pen.*

5.9 Special Cases Frequently Tested

Case	Correct form	Explanation
Few / A few / The few	See Chapter 04	meaning changes
Little / A little / The little	See Chapter 04	meaning changes
Most (= majority)	**Most** people… (✘ the most people)	no article
Most (superlative)	She is **the most** beautiful girl.	*the*
Most (= very)	It is **a most** interesting book.	*a* (= very)
Other	**the other** day (= a few days ago)	idiom
Musical instruments vs games	play **the** flute / play **cricket**	—
Diseases	**the** measles / **the** flu (informal) / **a** cold / **a** headache / **fever**	—
Meals	**breakfast** / **a** good breakfast / **the** breakfast we had	—
Seasons	in (**the**) winter — both acceptable	—
Instruments of the press	**the** press, **the** media	—
Unique positions	**the** President, **the** Prime Minister (but *He became President*)	—
Cinema / theatre / radio	go to **the** cinema, listen to **the** radio, but watch **television** / **TV**	idiom

5.10 Common Errors with Articles

1. ✘ He is **an** university student. ✔ He is **a** university student.
2. ✘ She is **a** honest girl. ✔ She is **an** honest girl.
3. ✘ I waited for **a** hour. ✔ I waited for **an** hour.
4. ✘ He is **a** M.A. ✔ He is **an** M.A.
5. ✘ **The** honesty is the best policy. ✔ **Honesty** is the best policy.
6. ✘ **Sun** rises in **east**. ✔ **The** sun rises in **the** east.
7. ✘ He is **best** boy in the class. ✔ He is **the best** boy in the class.
8. ✘ **The** Dhaka is **a** capital of Bangladesh. ✔ Dhaka is **the** capital of Bangladesh.
9. ✘ **Meghna** is a big river. ✔ **The Meghna** is a big river.
10. ✘ I go to **the** school every day (as a student). ✔ I go to **school** every day.
11. ✘ He plays **the** football. ✔ He plays **football**.
12. ✘ She plays **violin**. ✔ She plays **the violin**.
13. ✘ **The** man is mortal. ✔ **Man** is mortal.
14. ✘ He came by **the** bus. ✔ He came **by bus**.
15. ✘ **Rich** are not always happy. ✔ **The rich** are not always happy.
16. ✘ What **beautiful** day! ✔ What **a** beautiful day!
17. ✘ He is **a** M.P. from Sylhet. ✔ He is **an** M.P. from Sylhet.
18. ✘ **A** English is an international language. ✔ **English** is an international language.
19. ✘ He was elected **the** President. ✔ He was elected **President**.
20. ✘ It is **an** unique opportunity. ✔ It is **a** unique opportunity.
21. ✘ Give me **a** water. ✔ Give me **some** water / **a glass of** water.
22. ✘ **The** Mount Everest ✔ **Mount** Everest
23. ✘ He is **an** European. ✔ He is **a** European. (*European* begins with the "you" sound.)
24. ✘ I have **a** headache and **the** fever. ✔ I have **a** headache and **a** fever (informal) / and **fever**.
25. ✘ The Rajshahi is famous for **the** mangoes. ✔ **Rajshahi** is famous for **mangoes**.
26. ✘ **Hamlet** was written by **the** Shakespeare. ✔ *Hamlet* was written by **Shakespeare**. (Titles of ordinary books take no article unless *The* is part of the title: *Gitanjali, Hamlet, Paradise Lost* but *The Tempest, The Waste Land*.)
27. ✘ He takes **a** tea every morning. ✔ He takes **tea** every morning / **a cup of** tea.
28. ✘ The Prime Minister visited **the** Japan. ✔ … visited **Japan**.
29. ✘ He went to **the** bed early. ✔ He went to **bed** early.
30. ✘ **A** Bangladesh is my motherland. ✔ **Bangladesh** is my motherland.

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Articles and Idiom: International tests rarely test *a/an* directly but do test idiomatic article usage inside larger structures, e.g. ✔ *"the more…, the more…"*, ✔ *"as + adjective + a + noun + as"* (*as good a choice as*), ✔ *"so + adjective + a + noun + that"* (*so strong a case that*), and the difference between **"the number of"** (singular verb) and **"a number of"** (plural verb). In Reading, the generic *the* (*"The cheetah is endangered"*) signals a statement about a species, not an individual animal.

CHAPTER 06

Number

Part A · Grammar

6.1 What Is Number?

Number is the form of a noun or pronoun that shows whether it refers to **one** or **more than one**.

- **Singular number** — one person or thing: *boy, book, child, I, he.*
- **Plural number** — more than one: *boys, books, children, we, they.*

Only **countable nouns** have both numbers. Uncountable nouns (Chapter 03) are used only in the singular. Number affects the choice of verb (*is/are, has/have*), determiner (*this/these, much/many*) and pronoun (*it/they*), so plural formation is basic to correctness.

6.2 Regular Plurals

6.2.1 Most nouns: add -s

book → books, pen → pens, girl → girls, cat → cats, tree → trees, river → rivers.

6.2.2 Nouns ending in -s, -ss, -sh, -ch (soft), -x, -z: add -es

bus → buses, gas → gases, class → classes, glass → glasses, brush → brushes, dish → dishes, bench → benches, watch → watches, box → boxes, tax → taxes, fox → foxes, buzz → buzzes, quiz → quizzes.

But *-ch* pronounced /k/ takes only **-s**: *stomach → stomachs, monarch → monarchs, epoch → epochs, patriarch → patriarchs.*

6.2.3 Nouns ending in consonant + y: change *y* to i and add -es

baby → babies, lady → ladies, city → cities, army → armies, story → stories, fly → flies, country → countries, duty → duties.

Nouns ending in **vowel + y** simply add **-s**: *boy → boys, day → days, key → keys, monkey → monkeys, toy → toys, valley → valleys, chimney → chimneys, journey → journeys, essay → essays.*

Proper nouns ending in *-y* add **-s**: *the two Marys, the Kennedys.*

6.2.4 Nouns ending in -o

Add -es (mostly consonant + o, common words)	Add -s (vowel + o; short forms; foreign/musical words)
hero → heroes	radio → radios
potato → potatoes	studio → studios
tomato → tomatoes	bamboo → bamboos
mango → mangoes (also mangos)	zoo → zoos
buffalo → buffaloes	cuckoo → cuckoos
echo → echoes	photo → photos
volcano → volcanoes	piano → pianos
negro → negroes (dated)	kilo → kilos
cargo → cargoes	logo → logos
mosquito → mosquitoes	dynamo → dynamos
torpedo → torpedoes	solo → solos, soprano → sopranos
veto → vetoes	memo → memos, canto → cantos
motto → mottoes (also mottos)	ratio → ratios, portfolio → portfolios

6.2.5 Nouns ending in -f or -fe: change to -ves (common group)

leaf → leaves, loaf → loaves, life → lives, knife → knives, wife → wives, wolf → wolves, half → halves, calf → calves, shelf → shelves, thief → thieves, self → selves, sheaf → sheaves, elf → elves.

But many simply add **-s**: *roof → roofs, chief → chiefs, proof → proofs, belief → beliefs, cliff → cliffs, gulf → gulfs, safe → safes, chef → chefs, grief → griefs, reef → reefs, handkerchief → handkerchiefs, dwarf → dwarfs, strife → strifes, serf → serfs.*

Both forms: *scarf → scarfs/scarves, wharf → wharfs/wharves, hoof → hoofs/hooves, dwarf → dwarfs/dwarves.*

6.3 Irregular Plurals

6.3.1 Change of inner vowel (mutation)

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
man	men	foot	feet
woman	women	tooth	teeth
goose	geese	mouse	mice
louse	lice	dormouse	dormice

Compounds follow the same rule: *Englishman → Englishmen, policeman → policemen, fireman → firemen, chairman → chairmen.* But *German → Germans, Roman → Romans, Norman → Normans, human → humans, talisman → talismans, Mussulman → Mussulmans* (because *-man* here is not the word “man”).

6.3.2 Adding -en / -ren

ox → oxen, child → children, brother → brethren (= members of a religious society; normal plural *brothers*).

6.3.3 Same form in singular and plural

sheep, deer, swine, fish (also fishes for species), aircraft, spacecraft, hovercraft, cod, salmon, trout, series, species, means, corps, headquarters, crossroads, gallows, offspring, yoke (of oxen), Chinese, Japanese, Swiss, Portuguese, Vietnamese, Bengali (people) → Bengalis.

- **A sheep** is grazing. / **Ten sheep** are grazing. (✘ sheeps)
- I saw **a deer** / **three deer**.
- This **series** is popular. / Both **series** are popular.
- **A means** of transport / Various **means** of transport.

6.3.4 Nouns of number, measure, weight with a numeral before them

dozen, score, hundred, thousand, million, gross, stone (weight), pair, head (of cattle), yoke, hundredweight keep the singular form after a definite number:

- **two dozen** eggs (✘ two dozens eggs), **three hundred** taka, **five thousand** people, **ten million** dollars, **four score** years (= 80), **two pair** of shoes (also two pairs), **fifty head** of cattle, **a ten-stone** man / He weighs **ten stone**.
- But without a number, the plural is used: **dozens of** eggs, **hundreds of** people, **thousands of** birds, **millions of** stars, **scores of** students.

6.3.5 Foreign plurals (Latin, Greek, French, Italian, Hebrew)

These are favourites of BCS, Bank and admission tests as well as the GRE.

Singular	Plural	Origin
addendum	addenda	Latin
agendum	agenda (now used as singular: *the agenda is*)	Latin
alumnus (male) / alumna (female)	alumni / alumnae	Latin
analysis	analyses	Greek
antenna	antennae (insects) / antennas (radio)	Latin
appendix	appendices (books) / appendixes (body)	Latin
axis	axes	Latin

Singular	Plural	Origin
bacterium	bacteria	Latin
basis	bases	Greek
cactus	cacti / cactuses	Latin
crisis	crises	Greek
criterion	criteria	Greek
curriculum	curricula / curriculums	Latin
datum	data	Latin
diagnosis	diagnoses	Greek
erratum	errata	Latin
focus	foci / focuses	Latin
formula	formulae / formulas	Latin
fungus	fungi / funguses	Latin
genus	genera	Latin
hypothesis	hypotheses	Greek
index	indices (math) / indexes (books)	Latin
larva	larvae	Latin
locus	loci	Latin
matrix	matrices	Latin
medium	media (mass media) / mediums (spiritual-ists)	Latin
memorandum	memoranda / memorandums	Latin
nebula	nebulae	Latin
nucleus	nuclei	Latin
oasis	oases	Greek
parenthesis	parentheses	Greek
phenomenon	phenomena	Greek
radius	radii	Latin
stimulus	stimuli	Latin
stratum	strata	Latin
syllabus	syllabi / syllabuses	Latin
synopsis	synopses	Greek
terminus	termini	Latin
thesis	theses	Greek
vertebra	vertebrae	Latin
vertex	vertices	Latin
bureau	bureaux / bureaus	French
beau	beaux	French
chateau	chateaux	French
tableau	tableaux	French
madam	mesdames	French
monsieur	messieurs	French
bandit	banditti / bandits	Italian
libretto	libretti / librettos	Italian
virtuoso	virtuosi	Italian
cherub	cherubim / cherubs	Hebrew
seraph	seraphim / seraphs	Hebrew

Exam Tip — patterns that help: *-us* → *-i* (radius → radii), *-um* → *-a* (datum → data), *-is* → *-es* (crisis → crises), *-on* → *-a* (criterion → criteria), *-a* → *-ae* (formula → formulae), *-ex/-ix* → *-ices* (index → indices), *-eau* → *-eaux* (bureau → bureaux). The most-asked items: **crisis, criterion, phenomenon, datum, medium, analysis, hypothesis, bacterium, oasis, radius, stimulus, memorandum, formula, alumnus, bureau.**

6.3.6 Plurals of compound nouns

Rule 1: In most compounds, the **principal (most important) word** takes the plural sign:

Singular	Plural
commander-in-chief	commanders-in-chief
father-in-law	fathers-in-law
mother-in-law	mothers-in-law
son-in-law, daughter-in-law	sons-in-law, daughters-in-law
brother-in-law, sister-in-law	brothers-in-law, sisters-in-law
passer-by	passers-by
man-of-war	men-of-war
step-son	step-sons
court-martial	courts-martial (also court-martials)
attorney-general	attorneys-general
governor-general	governors-general
maid-servant	maid-servants
hanger-on	hangers-on
looker-on	lookers-on
runner-up	runners-up
coat-of-mail	coats-of-mail
editor-in-chief	editors-in-chief
lady-love	lady-loves

Rule 2: When no word is a noun, or the compound is written as one word, the **last word** takes the plural sign: *forget-me-not → forget-me-nots, draw-back → drawbacks, grown-up → grown-ups, go-between → go-betweens, take-off → take-offs, handful → handfuls, spoonful → spoonfuls* (or *spoonsful*), *cupful → cupfuls, mouthful → mouthfuls, breakdown → break-downs.*

Rule 3: Compounds with *man/woman* as the first word pluralise **both** parts: *man-servant → men-servants, woman-doctor → women-doctors, woman-servant → women-servants, lady-doctor → lady-doctors* (only the second).

6.3.7 Plurals of letters, figures, signs and abbreviations

Mind your p's and q's. / Dot your i's and cross your t's. / Two 5's (or 5s) / in the 1990s / three M.A.s (or M.A.'s) / MPs / PhDs / ifs and buts / dos and don'ts / yeses and noes.

6.3.8 Plurals of proper nouns and titles

- *The two Rahims, the Khans, the Joneses.*
- Titles: *Mr. → Messrs. (Messrs. Rahman & Sons), Mrs. → Mmes. (rare), Miss → Misses (the Misses Smith / the Miss Smiths), Dr. → Drs.*

6.4 Nouns Used Only in the Plural

6.4.1 Things made of two parts

trousers, pants, jeans, shorts, pyjamas, breeches, scissors, shears, tongs, pliers, pincers, spectacles, glasses, goggles, binoculars, bellows.

› My **spectacles are** broken. / **A pair of** spectacles **is** on the table.

› ✘ I bought **a scissor**. ✔ I bought **a pair of scissors**.

6.4.2 Other "plural-only" nouns

alms, amends, annals, archives, arrears, assets, belongings, clothes, congratulations, credentials, dregs, earnings, embers, environs, goods, lodgings, manners (= behaviour), means (= wealth), oats, odds, outskirts, premises, proceeds, regards, remains, riches, savings, shambles, spirits (= mood), stairs, surroundings, thanks, tidings, valuables, victuals, wages, whereabouts.

6.4.3 Nouns always plural in meaning though singular in form

cattle, poultry, vermin, people, police, gentry, clergy, peasantry, folk — always a plural verb: *The* **police are** *investigating. The* **cattle are** *grazing.*

6.5 Nouns Plural in Form but Singular in Meaning

news, mathematics, physics, economics, politics, ethics, statistics, civics, phonetics, measles, mumps, rickets, billiards, innings, gallows, summons (= a court order), the United States, the Philippines.

- **No news is** good news.
- **Measles is** a contagious disease.
- **Economics is** my major subject.
- The **summons was** issued yesterday. (plural: *summonses*)

6.6 Nouns with Two Plurals and Different Meanings

Singular	Plural 1 (meaning)	Plural 2 (meaning)
brother	brothers (sons of the same parents)	brethren (members of a community/religion)
cloth	cloths (pieces of cloth)	clothes (garments)
die	dies (stamps for coining)	dice (cubes for games)
genius	geniuses (very talented persons)	genii (spirits)
index	indexes (lists in books)	indices (signs in algebra)
penny	pennies (coins)	pence (amount/value)
staff	staffs (sticks; groups of employees)	staves (sticks / music lines, archaic)
fish	fish (number of fish)	fishes (different kinds)
shot	shots (discharges)	shot (balls of lead)
pea	peas (separate seeds)	pease (a mass, archaic)
person	persons (formal, legal: *two persons*)	people (general)
medium	media (newspapers, TV)	mediums (spiritualists)
antenna	antennae (of insects)	antennas (aerials)
appendix	appendices (in books)	appendixes (body organs)

6.7 Nouns with Different Meanings in Singular and Plural

Singular (meaning)	Plural (meaning)
advice (counsel)	advices (commercial information/notices)
air (atmosphere)	airs (affected manners: *He puts on airs*)
arm (limb)	arms (weapons)
compass (instrument for direction)	compasses (instrument for drawing circles)
content (satisfaction)	contents (things contained; table of contents)
custom (habit)	customs (duties on imports)
colour (hue)	colours (flag of a regiment)
effect (result)	effects (property, belongings)
force (strength)	forces (army)
good (benefit)	goods (merchandise)
ground (earth)	grounds (reasons; gardens around a building)
iron (metal)	irons (fetters)
manner (way)	manners (polite behaviour)
moral (lesson)	morals (character)
minute (time)	minutes (record of a meeting)
pain (suffering)	pains (trouble, effort: *He took pains*)
part (portion)	parts (abilities: *a man of parts*; regions)
physic (medicine)	physics (a science)
premise (proposition)	premises (building with land)
quarter (one-fourth)	quarters (lodgings)
respect (regard)	respects (compliments: *pay one's respects*)
spectacle (sight)	spectacles (eye-glasses)
spirit (soul)	spirits (mood; alcohol)
term (period / word)	terms (conditions; relations: *on good terms*)
letter (alphabet / message)	letters (literature: *a man of letters*)
work (labour)	works (writings; factory)
wood (timber)	woods (forest)
sand (particles)	sands (sandy beach / desert)
water (liquid)	waters (sea, a body of water: *territorial waters*)
damage (harm)	damages (compensation)
return (coming back)	returns (statement of income)

6.8 Collective Nouns and Number

A collective noun is singular in form but may take a singular or plural verb depending on the meaning (unit vs individuals). See Chapter 02 and Chapter 23.

- The **team is** strong. (unit) / The **team are** taking their seats. (individuals)
- The **family is** large. / The **family are** at dinner. (BrE)

6.9 Number of Pronouns

Singular	Plural
I / me / my / mine	we / us / our / ours
you / your / yours	you / your / yours
he, she, it / him, her, it / his, her, its	they / them / their / theirs
myself	ourselves
yourself	yourselves
himself / herself / itself	themselves
this / that	these / those

6.10 Common Errors with Number

1. ✘ The **sheeps** are grazing. ✔ The **sheep** are grazing.
2. ✘ I have **two dozens** pens. ✔ I have **two dozen** pens.
3. ✘ He gave me **a five hundreds taka** note. ✔ He gave me **a five-hundred-taka** note.
4. ✘ My **mother-in-laws** are kind. ✔ My **mothers-in-law** are kind.
5. ✘ The **criterias** are clear. ✔ The **criteria** are clear.
6. ✘ This **phenomena** is strange. ✔ This **phenomenon** is strange.
7. ✘ There are many **datas**. ✔ There are a lot of **data**.
8. ✘ The **passer-bys** stopped. ✔ The **passers-by** stopped.
9. ✘ He bought two **pair** shoes. ✔ He bought two **pairs of** shoes. (or *two pair of shoes*)
10. ✘ **Hundred of** people came. ✔ **Hundreds of** people came.
11. ✘ I saw **many deers**. ✔ I saw **many deer**.
12. ✘ The **thiefs** were caught. ✔ The **thieves** were caught.
13. ✘ He has two **wifes**. ✔ He has two **wives**.
14. ✘ The **chieves** met. ✔ The **chiefs** met.
15. ✘ The **potatos** are fresh. ✔ The **potatoes** are fresh.
16. ✘ The **radioes** are cheap. ✔ The **radios** are cheap.
17. ✘ Three **Englishmans** came. ✔ Three **Englishmen** came. / ✘ Three **Germen** ✔ Three **Germans**.
18. ✘ He has three **brother-in-laws**. ✔ He has three **brothers-in-law**.
19. ✘ The **crisises** deepened. ✔ The **crises** deepened.
20. ✘ He is a **ten-years** old boy. ✔ He is a **ten-year-old** boy.
21. ✘ The **headquarter** of the UN is in New York. ✔ The **headquarters** of the UN **is/are** in New York.
22. ✘ Please accept my **thank**. ✔ Please accept my **thanks**.
23. ✘ He lives in the **outskirt** of the town. ✔ He lives on the **outskirts** of the town.
24. ✘ He gave me **a good news**. ✔ He gave me **good news**.

25. ✘ All **the staffs** of the office were present. ✔ All **the staff** (members) of the office were present.

> **SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Number Consistency:** GMAT and SAT items test whether a noun's number matches the noun it refers to. ✘ "Each applicant must submit an essay with **their applications**." ✔ "Each applicant must submit an essay with **his or her application**." Watch for **logical number**: ✘ "Both parents signed their consent on **their form**." ✔ "Both parents signed their consent on **their forms**." (each parent has a form). Be ready for Latin and Greek plurals in GRE reading passages too: *data, criteria, phenomena, strata, media.*

CHAPTER 07

Gender

Part A · Grammar

7.1 What Is Gender?

In grammar, **gender** is the classification of nouns and pronouns according to **sex** — male, female, either, or none. English gender is mostly **natural gender** (based on real-life sex), unlike languages such as French, German, Arabic or Hindi, where a table or a river can be "masculine" or "feminine". This makes English gender simpler, but exams still test the masculine–feminine pairs, common-gender nouns, personification and pronoun agreement.

7.2 The Four Genders

Gender	Refers to	Examples
Masculine	male beings	man, boy, father, king, lion, cock, he
Feminine	female beings	woman, girl, mother, queen, lioness, hen, she
Common	either male or female	child, parent, student, teacher, friend, baby, cousin, doctor, person, servant, orphan, enemy, pupil, relative, citizen, leader
Neuter	lifeless things / things with no sex	book, table, river, house, tree, stone, it

> Very young children and animals whose sex is unknown or unimportant are often referred to as **it**: *The baby is crying; it is hungry. The cat has hurt its paw.* Insects and small creatures are usually neuter: *The ant carried its food.*

7.3 Three Ways of Forming the Feminine

7.3.1 By using an entirely different word

Masculine	Feminine	Masculine	Feminine
bachelor	spinster / maid	lord	lady
boy	girl	man	woman
brother	sister	monk	nun
bull / ox	cow	nephew	niece
buck	doe	papa	mama
bullock	heifer	ram	ewe
cock	hen	sir	madam
colt	filly	son	daughter
dog	bitch	stag	hind
drake	duck	uncle	aunt
drone	bee	wizard	witch
father	mother	gander	goose
gentleman	lady	husband	wife
hart	roe	king	queen
horse / stallion	mare	boar	sow
sire	dam	swain	nymph
earl	countess	friar	nun
fox	vixen	lad	lass
hero	heroine	widower	widow
milkman	milkmaid	bridegroom	bride
beau	belle	Sultan	Sultana

> **Exam Tip — the "reverse" pairs.** In two famous pairs the **feminine is the base word** and the masculine is formed from it: *widow* → *widow**er***, *bride* → *bride**groom***. Examiners love to ask for the masculine of *widow* (= widower), *bride* (= bridegroom), *duck* (= drake), *goose* (= gander), *bee* (= drone), *vixen* (= fox), *spinster* (= bachelor), *ewe* (= ram), *mare* (= horse/stallion), *nun* (= monk/friar), *doe* (= buck), *filly* (= colt), *heifer* (= bullock), *hind* (= stag), *roe* (= hart), *sow* (= boar), *countess* (= earl/count).

7.3.2 By adding a suffix to the masculine (-ess, -ine, -ix, -a, -trix)

(a) Adding -ess without change:

Masculine	Feminine	Masculine	Feminine
author	authoress	lion	lioness
baron	baroness	mayor	mayoress
count	countess	patron	patroness
giant	giantess	poet	poetess
heir	heiress	priest	priestess
host	hostess	prince	princess
Jew	Jewess	prophet	prophetess
shepherd	shepherdess	steward	stewardess
manager	manageress	peer	peeress

(b) Dropping the vowel of the last syllable and adding -ess:

Masculine	Feminine	Masculine	Feminine
actor	actress	instructor	instructress
conductor	conductress	inspector	inspectress
director	directress	preceptor	preceptress
enchanter	enchantress	protector	protectress
hunter	huntress	tiger	tigress
waiter	waitress	traitor	traitress
benefactor	benefactress	founder	foundress

(c) Irregular -ess forms:

Masculine	Feminine	Masculine	Feminine
abbot	abbess	lad	lass
duke	duchess	marquis	marchioness
emperor	empress	master	mistress
god	goddess	murderer	murderess
governor	governess	sorcerer	sorceress
votary	votaress	ogre	ogress

(d) Other suffixes:

Masculine	Feminine	Suffix
hero	heroine	-ine
czar / tsar	czarina / tsarina	-ina
sultan	sultana	-a
signor	signora	-a
don	donna	-a
testator	testatrix	-trix
executor	executrix	-trix
administrator	administratrix	-trix
aviator	aviatrix	-trix
prosecutor	prosecutrix	-trix

Masculine	Feminine	Suffix
fiancé	fiancée	-e (French)
beau	belle	(French)
landgrave	landgravine	-ine
Paul	Pauline	-ine
Augustus	Augusta	-a
Joseph	Josephine	-ine
infante	infanta	-a (Spanish prince/princess)

7.3.3 By adding a word (compound)

Masculine	Feminine
grandfather	grandmother
landlord	landlady
milkman	milkwoman / milkmaid
washerman	washerwoman
salesman	saleswoman
peacock	peahen
he-goat / billy-goat	she-goat / nanny-goat
tom-cat	tabby-cat / she-cat
jack-ass	jenny-ass
man-servant	maid-servant
step-son	step-daughter
son-in-law	daughter-in-law
great-uncle	great-aunt
cock-sparrow	hen-sparrow
bull-calf	cow-calf
bull-elephant	cow-elephant
headmaster	headmistress
policeman	policewoman
chairman	chairwoman
grandson	granddaughter
boy-friend	girl-friend

7.4 Common Gender Nouns

These nouns can refer to **either sex**: *baby, child, cousin, enemy, friend, guardian, leader, monarch, neighbour, orphan, parent, person, pupil, relation, relative, servant, spouse, student, teacher, thief, citizen, doctor, lawyer, engineer, writer, artist, singer, cook, clerk, infant, owner, passenger, president, minister, member, candidate, voter, deer, sheep, cattle, bird, fish, animal, calf, foal, cub.*

To specify sex, add a word: *a* **woman** *doctor* (plural *women doctors*), *a* **male** *nurse*, *a* **female** *engineer*, *a* **lady** *teacher*.

> **Gender-neutral modern usage.** International tests (IELTS, SAT, GRE, GMAT) and modern style guides prefer neutral words: *chairperson/chair* (for chairman), *police officer* (policeman), *firefighter* (fireman), *flight attendant* (steward/stewardess), *actor* for both sexes, *author* and *poet* for both (*authoress*, *poetess* are now old-fashioned), *humankind* (mankind), *spokesperson* (spokesman), *salesperson*. Bangladeshi exams still ask the traditional feminine forms, so learn both.

7.5 Gender of Neuter Nouns by Personification

When lifeless things or abstract ideas are spoken of **as if they were living beings**, they are said to be **personified** and are given a gender.

Masculine (things strong, powerful, violent, great): *the Sun, Death, Time, War, Summer, Winter, Anger, Fear, Love (Cupid), Ocean, Thunder, Mountain, Autumn, Despair, Murder, Wind, Day.*

- The **Sun** sheds **his** light on all.
- **Death** lays **his** icy hand on kings. (James Shirley)
- **Time** waits for no one; **he** flies on.
- **Winter** came with **his** cold breath.

Feminine (things gentle, beautiful, graceful, fruitful): *the Moon, the Earth, Nature, Spring, Hope, Peace, Mercy, Justice, Liberty, Charity, Faith, Fortune, Virtue, Night, Religion, Science, Truth, Victory, Ship, Country/Nation, University, Church, Fame, Music, Art.*

- The **Moon** has hidden **her** face behind the clouds.
- **Nature** is kind to those who love **her**.
- The **ship** lost **her** way in the storm. / **She** sails tomorrow.
- **Bangladesh** is proud of **her** freedom fighters.
- **Spring** has come with all **her** beauty.
- **Fortune** favours the brave; **she** is fickle.

7.6 Gender and Pronoun Agreement

A pronoun must agree with its antecedent (the noun it refers to) in gender as well as number and person (Chapter 08).

- The boy lost **his** pen. / The girl lost **her** pen. / The tree lost **its** leaves.
- Each of the girls brought **her** own lunch.
- Every student must bring **his or her** ID card. (traditional exam form: *his*)
- ✘ The baby is crying for **his** mother (sex unknown) → ✔ … for **its** mother. (Both are accepted when the sex is known.)
- The cow gave **her** calf milk. (Higher animals are often referred to as *he/she*; pets almost always.)

- **Common-gender noun + both sexes:** *Each of the students — boys and girls — must submit* **his or her** *assignment.*
- **Mixed group:** *Rahim and Salma did* **their** *work.*

7.7 Some Special Notes

1. **Masculine-for-both rule (traditional):** When a statement refers to both sexes, traditional grammar uses the masculine: *Man is mortal. Everyone should love* **his** *country.* (Modern English prefers *people / humans* and *his or her / their*.)
2. **Feminine for the larger/more important in some pairs:** *duck* (the general name for both sexes; *drake* only for the male), *goose* (general; *gander* for the male), *bee* (general), *cow* (general for cattle in everyday speech).
3. **Masculine as general:** *dog* (general; *bitch* for the female), *horse* (general; *mare* for female), *fox* (general; *vixen* for female), *lion*, *tiger*.
4. **Same word, two genders:** *cousin, friend, parent, spouse, neighbour*.
5. **Gender of compound titles:** *Lord Mayor → Lady Mayoress, Prince Consort → Queen (consort = spouse of the reigning monarch), Sultan → Sultana.*
6. **Fiancé** (man) / **fiancée** (woman) — the doubled *e* marks the feminine (from French). Similarly *blond* (m) / *blonde* (f), *protégé / protégée*, *divorcé / divorcée*, *née* (born as — feminine: *Mrs. Rahman, née Chowdhury*).

7.8 Common Errors with Gender

1. ✘ She is my **cousin sister**. ✔ She is my **cousin**.
2. ✘ They are **woman doctors**. ✔ They are **women doctors**.
3. ✘ The feminine of *bachelor* is **bacheloress**. ✔ **spinster / maid**.
4. ✘ The masculine of *widow* is **widow-man**. ✔ **widower**.
5. ✘ The masculine of *duck* is **duckling**. ✔ **drake** (*duckling* = a young duck).
6. ✘ The feminine of *fox* is **foxess**. ✔ **vixen**.
7. ✘ The feminine of *wizard* is **wizardess**. ✔ **witch**.
8. ✘ The moon sheds **his** light. ✔ The moon sheds **her** light. (traditional personification)
9. ✘ Bangladesh is proud of **his** freedom fighters. ✔ Bangladesh is proud of **her** freedom fighters.
10. ✘ The feminine of *hero* is **heroess**. ✔ **heroine**.
11. ✘ The feminine of *monk* is **monkess**. ✔ **nun**.

12. ✘ The masculine of *mare* is **mare-horse**. ✔ **horse / stallion**.
13. ✘ The feminine of *stag* is **stagess**. ✔ **hind**.
14. ✘ The feminine of *testator* is **testatoress**. ✔ **testatrix**.
15. ✘ The feminine of *emperor* is **emperoress**. ✔ **empress**.

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Pronoun Gender and Clarity: International tests treat gender mainly through **pronoun reference**. A sentence like *"When Ayesha met Salma, she told her the news"* is **ambiguous** (who told whom?), and such ambiguity is always wrong on the GMAT/SAT. Rewrite with a noun: *"When Ayesha met Salma, Ayesha told her the news."* Also note that the SAT accepts singular *they* only in informal contexts; with a singular antecedent like *each student*, the safe choice remains *his or her*.

7.9 Additional Masculine–Feminine Pairs for Practice

Masculine	Feminine	Masculine	Feminine
abbot	abbess	lord	lady
actor	actress	maharaja	maharani
bachelor	spinster	mister (Mr.)	mistress (Mrs.)
baron	baroness	monk	nun
boar	sow	nephew	niece
bridegroom	bride	ogre	ogress
buck	doe	peacock	peahen
bull	cow	priest	priestess
cock	hen	prince	princess
colt	filly	rajah	rani
czar	czarina	ram	ewe
dog	bitch	sir	madam
drake	duck	sorcerer	sorceress
drone	bee	stag	hind
duke	duchess	steward	stewardess
earl	countess	sultan	sultana
emperor	empress	swain	nymph
fox	vixen	testator	testatrix
gander	goose	tiger	tigress
god	goddess	uncle	aunt
hart	roe	viscount	viscountess
heir	heiress	waiter	waitress
hero	heroine	widower	widow
host	hostess	wizard	witch
husband	wife	Babu	Bibi
king	queen	Nawab	Begum
lad	lass	Shah	Shahbanu
landlord	landlady	Thakur	Thakurain

CHAPTER 08

Pronoun

Part A · Grammar

8.1 Definition

A **pronoun** is a word used **in place of a noun** so that the noun need not be repeated. The noun that a pronoun refers to is called its **antecedent**.

- **Rahim** is absent today because **he** is ill. (*he* → Rahim)
- **The students** said that **they** would come. (*they* → the students)
- I bought **a book** and gave **it** to my sister. (*it* → a book)

Without pronouns English would be clumsy: *Rahim said that Rahim had lost Rahim's book.* → *Rahim said that* **he** *had lost* **his** *book.*

8.2 Kinds of Pronouns

Kind	Members	Example
Personal	I, we, you, he, she, it, they (and their object/possessive forms)	**She** loves **him**.
Possessive	mine, ours, yours, his, hers, its, theirs	This pen is **mine**.
Reflexive	myself, ourselves, yourself, yourselves, himself, herself, itself, themselves, oneself	He hurt **himself**.
Emphatic (Intensive)	the same *-self* forms used for emphasis	I **myself** saw it.
Demonstrative	this, that, these, those, such, the same	**This** is my house.
Indefinite	one, none, some, any, all, many, few, each, either, neither, someone, anybody, everything, nothing, other, another, several, both	**Someone** has stolen my bag.
Distributive	each, either, neither	**Each** of them got a prize.
Reciprocal	each other, one another	They love **each other**.
Relative	who, whom, whose, which, that, what, as, but	The man **who** came is my uncle.
Interrogative	who, whom, whose, which, what	**Who** is there?
Exclamatory	what	**What!** You failed?

8.3 Personal Pronouns

8.3.1 Person, Number and Case

Person	Number	Subjective (Nominative)	Objective	Possessive determiner	Possessive pronoun	Reflexive
1st	Singular	I	me	my	mine	myself
1st	Plural	we	us	our	ours	ourselves
2nd	Sing./Plural	you	you	your	yours	yourself / yourselves
3rd	Sing. masc.	he	him	his	his	himself
3rd	Sing. fem.	she	her	her	hers	herself
3rd	Sing. neuter	it	it	its	its	itself
3rd	Plural	they	them	their	theirs	themselves

- **First person** = the speaker (*I, we*).
- **Second person** = the person spoken to (*you*).
- **Third person** = the person or thing spoken about (*he, she, it, they*, and all nouns).

8.3.2 The Case Rules — The Heart of Pronoun Errors

Rule 1 — Subjective case for the **subject** of a finite verb and for the **complement** after *be*: **He** *and* **I** *went there. It is* **I**. (formal) / *It is* **he** *who did it.*

Rule 2 — Objective case for the **object of a verb**, **object of a preposition**, and the **subject of an infinitive**: *She called* **him**. *Between you and* **me**. *I want* **him** *to go.*

Rule 3 — Possessive case before a **gerund** (formal): *I dislike* **his** *coming late.* (✘ him coming late)

- ✘ **Me and Rahim** went to the market. ✔ **Rahim and I** went to the market.
- ✘ Let **we** go. ✔ Let **us** go.
- ✘ This is between **you and I**. ✔ This is between **you and me**.
- ✘ He is taller than **me**. ✔ He is taller than **I** (am). (formal; *than me* is common informally)
- ✘ He likes you more than **I**. (meaning "more than he likes me") ✔ He likes you more than **me**. — the case shows the meaning!
- ✘ **Whom** do you think is the best? ✔ **Who** do you think is the best? (*who* is the subject of *is*)
- ✔ It was **she** who helped me. (formal) / It was **her** … (informal)
- ✔ Everyone except **him** came. (*except* is a preposition)
- ✔ The teacher wanted **us** students to stay. (✘ *we students*)
- ✔ **We** students demand justice. (✘ *us students* — here it is the subject)

Exam Tip — the "cover-up" test. In a compound subject or object, cover the other noun and test the pronoun alone. *"The prize was given to Karim and (I/me)."* → *given to me* ✔. *"(He/Him) and his brother came."* → *He came* ✔. *"Let you and (I/me) try."* → *Let me try* ✔.

8.3.3 Order of Personal Pronouns — "231" and "Courtesy" Rules

When pronouns of different persons stand together, follow these rules:

For good or neutral statements: 2-3-1 — second person first, third person next, first person last (out of courtesy).

You, he and I are good friends. / *You and I* must go. / *He and I* are classmates.

When admitting a fault or guilt: 1-2-3 — first person first (we accept the blame ourselves).

I, you and he are to blame. / *I and he* were guilty of the crime.

In the plural, 1-2-3 is common: *We, you and they* must work together.

- ✘ **I and you** will go. ✔ **You and I** will go.
- ✘ **I and Rahim** are friends. ✔ **Rahim and I** are friends.
- ✔ **I and my brother** are responsible for the loss. (confession — 1st person first is acceptable)

8.3.4 Agreement of Pronoun with Antecedent

A pronoun must agree with its antecedent in **number, gender and person**.

- **Every** boy must bring **his** book. (singular)
- **The girls** did **their** homework. (plural)
- **One** must do **one's** duty. (✘ *his* in strict BrE; ✔ *his* in AmE)
- **Each** of the members cast **his/her** vote.
- **Neither** of the girls lost **her** bag.

- **Rahim and Karim** have lost **their** books. (compound with *and* → plural)
- **Either Rahim or Karim** has lost **his** book. (with *or/nor* → agree with the nearer noun)
- **The committee** has submitted **its** report. / **The committee** are divided in **their** opinions.
- **Everybody** should love **his** country. (traditional exam answer)

> **Singular *they*.** In modern English, *they/their* is widely used for a singular person whose sex is unknown (*Someone left* **their** *umbrella*). Bangladeshi exam keys, however, almost always expect **his** (or *his or her*) after *everyone, everybody, each, every, anyone, nobody, no one, someone, a person*. Use *his* (or *his or her*) in exams.

8.3.5 Special Uses of *It*

1. **For lifeless things, animals and babies (sex unknown):** *The baby stretched* **its** *arms.*
2. **As an empty (dummy) subject for time, weather, distance: It** *is ten o'clock.* **It** *is raining.* **It** *is five kilometres from here.*
3. **As an introductory (anticipatory) subject** for an infinitive, gerund or clause placed later: **It** *is difficult* **to learn Chinese**. **It** *is no use* **crying over spilt milk**. **It** *is true* **that he is honest**.
4. **For emphasis (cleft sentence): It was Rahim who** *broke the glass.* **It is** *in Dhaka* **that** *he lives.*
5. **To identify a person:** *Who is at the door?* — **It** *is the postman.*

8.3.6 *One* as a Pronoun

- **General person: One** *should keep* **one's** *promise.* (Keep *one/one's/oneself* consistent — ✘ *One should keep his promise* in strict BrE.)
- **Substitute for a countable noun:** *I need a pen. Can you lend me* **one**? *This shirt is old; I want a new* **one**. *These shoes are small; show me bigger* **ones**.
- **Not with uncountables:** ✘ *I like red wine more than white one.* ✔ … *than white.*

8.4 Possessive Pronouns

Mine, ours, yours, his, hers, its, theirs stand alone (no noun after them). *My, our, your, his, her, its, their* are possessive determiners (followed by a noun).

- This is **my** book. → This book is **mine**.
- That is **your** pen. → That pen is **yours**.
- ✘ This pen is **your's** / **yours'**. ✔ This pen is **yours**.
- ✘ **Its** a cat. **It's** tail is long. ✔ **It's** a cat. **Its** tail is long.
- ✔ A friend **of mine** (double possessive — ✘ *a friend of me*).
- ✔ **Yours** sincerely / **Yours** faithfully (letter closings — no apostrophe).

> **Exam Tip — no apostrophe in possessive pronouns.** *hers, its, ours, yours, theirs, whose* never take an apostrophe. *It's* = it is / it has. *Who's* = who is / who has. *They're* = they are; *there* = place; *their* = possessive.

8.5 Reflexive and Emphatic Pronouns

8.5.1 Reflexive Pronouns

A **reflexive pronoun** is used as the **object** when the subject and the object are the **same** person/thing. The action "reflects" back on the doer.

- He hurt **himself**. / She looked at **herself** in the mirror.
- We enjoyed **ourselves** at the party.
- The cat licked **itself**.
- They blamed **themselves** for the failure.

Verbs often used reflexively: *absent oneself, avail oneself of, pride oneself on, revenge oneself on, acquit oneself, apply oneself to, enjoy oneself, help oneself, introduce oneself, behave oneself, amuse oneself, devote oneself to, exert oneself, resign oneself to.*

- ✘ He **absented** from the class. ✔ He **absented himself** from the class.
- ✘ I **availed** the opportunity. ✔ I **availed myself of** the opportunity.
- ✘ He **prides** on his wealth. ✔ He **prides himself on** his wealth.
- ✔ **Help yourself** to the sweets.

Verbs not normally reflexive in English (though they are in Bangla or other languages): *keep, rest, hide, stop, bathe, qualify, spread, open, turn, move, feel, wash, shave, dress, relax, concentrate, meet.*

- ✘ **Stop yourself!** ✔ **Stop!**
- ✘ He **bathed himself** in the river. ✔ He **bathed** in the river.
- ✘ We should **qualify ourselves** for the job. ✔ We should **qualify** for the job.
- ✘ I **feel myself** happy. ✔ I **feel** happy.
- ✘ He **rested himself** for a while. ✔ He **rested** for a while.

8.5.2 Emphatic (Intensive) Pronouns

The same *-self* forms used **for emphasis**, placed after the noun/pronoun or at the end. They can be removed without making the sentence wrong.

- I **myself** saw the accident. / I saw the accident **myself**.
- The Principal **himself** came to the classroom.
- You **yourselves** are to blame.

8.5.3 Errors with *-self* Pronouns

1. ✘ Rahim and **myself** went there. ✔ Rahim and **I** went there. (A reflexive cannot be a subject on its own.)
2. ✘ He gave it to **myself**. ✔ He gave it to **me**.
3. ✘ **Hisself** / **theirselves** ✔ **himself** / **themselves**.
4. ✘ They love **themselves** (meaning each loves the other). ✔ They love **each other**.

8.6 Demonstrative Pronouns

This, that, these, those, such, the same used **alone**:

- **This** is my book; **that** is yours.
- **These** are mangoes; **those** are lichis.
- The climate of Dhaka is hotter than **that** of Sylhet. (*that* avoids repeating *climate*)
- The students of this school are better than **those** of that school.
- **Such** was his fate.
- He is a rogue, and I treat him as **such**.

8.7 Indefinite Pronouns

Indefinite pronouns refer to people or things **in general**, not specific ones.

8.7.1 Singular Indefinite Pronouns (singular verb)

anybody, anyone, anything, everybody, everyone, everything, nobody, no one, nothing, somebody, someone, something, each, either, neither, one, another, much, little.

- **Everyone is** happy. (✘ are)
- **Nobody has** come yet.
- **Something is** wrong.
- **Each** of the students **has** a book.
- **Neither** of the answers **is** correct.

8.7.2 Plural Indefinite Pronouns (plural verb)

both, few, many, several, others.

- **Both are** good. / **Many were** absent. / **Few have** passed. / **Several** of them **are** here.

8.7.3 Singular or Plural (depends on the following noun) — *SANAM*

Some, Any, None, All, Most (also *more, half, part, a lot, plenty, the rest*):

- **Some** of the **milk is** sour. / **Some** of the **mangoes are** sour.
- **All** of the **money was** stolen. / **All** of the **students were** present.

- **Most** of the **work is** done. / **Most** of the **books are** new.
- **None** of the **food was** eaten. / **None** of the **students was/were** absent.

8.7.4 *None, No one, Nobody*

- *None* refers to persons or things; often followed by *of*: *None of them came.*
- *No one / nobody* refer to persons only and are never followed by *of*: ✘ *No one of them* → ✔ *None of them* / *No one*.

8.8 Distributive and Reciprocal Pronouns

Distributive pronouns — *each, either, neither* — refer to persons/things one at a time and take a **singular verb** (see Chapter 04).

- **Each** of the boys **was** given a prize.
- **Either** of you **is** fit for the post. (one of two)
- **Neither** of the two brothers **is** married.

Reciprocal pronouns — *each other* (traditionally for two) and *one another* (for more than two):

- The two sisters love **each other**.
- The members of the team helped **one another**.
- ✔ They looked at **each other's** faces.

(Modern usage often uses the two interchangeably, but exam keys prefer the traditional distinction.)

8.9 Relative Pronouns

A **relative pronoun** does two jobs: it **stands for a noun** (its antecedent) and it **joins** two clauses (so it also acts like a conjunction).

- I know the man. He came here yesterday. → I know the man **who** came here yesterday.

8.9.1 Forms and Uses

Relative pronoun	Used for	Case	Example
who	persons	subjective	The boy **who** won the prize is my brother.
whom	persons	objective	The man **whom** you met is my uncle.
whose	persons (and things)	possessive	The girl **whose** bag was stolen is crying. / A house **whose** roof is red.
which	things, animals	subj./obj.	The book **which** I bought is interesting.
that	persons, animals, things	subj./obj.	The man **that** came here is a doctor. / This is the pen **that** I lost.
what	things (= *that which*; no antecedent)	subj./obj.	I know **what** you want. / **What** he said is true.
as	after *such, the same, as*	—	Such books **as** you need are here.
but	after a negative (= *who not / which not*)	—	There is no one **but** loves his country. (= who does not love)

8.9.2 Special Uses of *That* (where *that* is preferred over *who/which*)

1. After **superlatives**: *He is the best student* **that** *I have ever taught.*
2. After **all, any, none, nothing, everything, something, anything, much, little, only, same, very**: *All* **that** *glitters is not gold. This is the same pen* **that** *I lost. He is the only man* **that** *can help us.*
3. After **two antecedents — a person and an animal/thing**: *The man and his dog* **that** *came here were hungry.*
4. After **interrogative who/what**: *Who is it* **that** *knocks? What is it* **that** *troubles you?*
5. After **It is / It was** (cleft): *It is the teacher* **that** *(who) deserves praise.*

- ✘ He is the best player **who** I have seen. ✔ He is the best player **that** I have seen.
- ✘ All **which** glitters is not gold. ✔ All **that** glitters is not gold.

8.9.3 *That* Cannot Be Used

- **After a preposition**: ✘ *the house in that he lives* ✔ *the house in* **which** *he lives* / *the house* **that** *he lives in*.
- **In a non-defining clause (after a comma)**: ✘ *My father,* **that** *is a doctor, …* ✔ *My father,* **who** *is a doctor, …*

8.9.4 Defining and Non-defining Relative Clauses

- **Defining (restrictive):** identifies *which* person/thing — **no commas**; *that* may be used. *The students* **who** *worked hard passed.* (only those students)
- **Non-defining (non-restrictive):** adds extra information — **commas**; *that* not allowed. *The students,* **who** *worked hard, passed.* (all the students worked hard and passed)

8.9.5 *Who* or *Whom*? — The Substitution Test

Replace the relative pronoun with *he/him* inside its own clause. If *he* fits → **who**; if *him* fits → **whom**.

- The man **(who/whom)** I thought was honest cheated me. → *I thought* **he** *was honest* → **who** ✔
- The man **(who/whom)** I trusted cheated me. → *I trusted* **him** → **whom** ✔
- Give it to **whoever** needs it. (*whoever* is the subject of *needs*; the whole clause is the object of *to*)
- Give it to **whomever** you like. (*you like* **him**)

8.9.6 Agreement of the Relative Pronoun

The verb in the relative clause agrees with the **antecedent** of the relative pronoun.

- I, **who am** your friend, will help you. (✘ who is)
- You, **who are** my friend, should help me.
- He is one of the best players **who have** ever played for Bangladesh. (antecedent = *players*, plural)
- He is **the only one** of the players **who has** scored a century. (antecedent = *the only one*, singular)

> **SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — "One of those who":** This is a classic GMAT/SAT trap. In *"She is one of those students who **___** always on time,"* the antecedent of *who* is *students* (plural), so the verb is **are**. But in *"She is the only one of the students who **___** always on time,"* the antecedent is *the only one*, so the verb is **is**.

8.9.7 Position of the Relative Pronoun

Place the relative pronoun **as near as possible** to its antecedent to avoid absurdity:

- ✘ I have a dog for my brother **that** barks loudly. ✔ For my brother I have a dog **that** barks loudly.
- ✘ He bought a horse from a farmer **which** was lame. ✔ He bought from a farmer a horse **which** was lame.

8.9.8 Omission of the Relative Pronoun

The relative pronoun can be left out when it is the **object** in a defining clause: *The book (that) I bought is good. The man (whom) you met is my uncle.* It cannot be omitted when it is the **subject**: ✘ *The man came here is my uncle.*

8.10 Interrogative Pronouns

Who, whom, whose, which, what used to ask questions:

- **Who** is knocking? (subject — person)
- **Whom** did you see? / **Who** did you see? (informal)
- **Whose** is this bag?
- **Which** of these do you want? (choice from a definite set)
- **What** is your name? (open choice)
- To **whom** did you give the money? (✘ To who)

8.11 Pronoun Reference — Clarity Problems

A pronoun must clearly point to one antecedent. Vague or ambiguous pronouns are always wrong in SAT/GMAT and are tested in Bangladeshi correction questions too.

1. ✘ Rahim told Karim that **he** had passed. (Who passed?) ✔ Rahim told Karim, "I have passed." / Rahim told Karim that Karim had passed.
2. ✘ In the newspaper **it** says that prices will rise. ✔ The newspaper says that prices will rise.
3. ✘ **They** say that the government is planning a new tax. (vague *they*) ✔ **Reports** say …
4. ✘ The teacher spoke to the students about **his** behaviour. (ambiguous) ✔ … about **their** behaviour / about **the students'** behaviour.
5. ✘ He failed in the exam, **which** upset his father. (*which* refers vaguely to the whole clause — acceptable in speech) ✔ His **failure** in the exam upset his father.

8.12 Common Pronoun Errors — Consolidated

1. ✘ **Who** are you looking for? (formal) ✔ **Whom** are you looking for? / For **whom** are you looking?
2. ✘ He and **me** are friends. ✔ He and **I** are friends.
3. ✘ It is **me**. (formal exams) ✔ It is **I**.
4. ✘ Let **he** go. ✔ Let **him** go.
5. ✘ Every student must do **their** homework. ✔ Every student must do **his** homework.
6. ✘ **One** should do **his** duty. ✔ **One** should do **one's** duty.
7. ✘ **Each** of the girls **have** done **their** work. ✔ **Each** of the girls **has** done **her** work.
8. ✘ The book is **her's**. ✔ The book is **hers**.
9. ✘ I **myself and Rahim** went. ✔ Rahim and **I** went.
10. ✘ He **enjoyed** at the party. ✔ He **enjoyed himself** at the party.
11. ✘ **I and you** will go. ✔ **You and I** will go.
12. ✘ The man **which** came here is my uncle. ✔ The man **who** came here is my uncle.
13. ✘ This is the boy **whom** I think deserves the prize. ✔ … **who** I think deserves the prize.
14. ✘ He is one of the best boys who **has** passed. ✔ … who **have** passed.
15. ✘ **None of them** are present (exam key). ✔ **None of them is** present.
16. ✘ The two brothers quarrelled with **one another**. ✔ … with **each other**.
17. ✘ **Whom** do you think will win? ✔ **Who** do you think will win?
18. ✘ I don't like **him** coming late. ✔ I don't like **his** coming late.
19. ✘ He is taller than **her**. ✔ He is taller than **she** (is).
20. ✘ My friend, **that** lives in Khulna, is a doctor. ✔ My friend, **who** lives in Khulna, is a doctor.
21. ✘ All **what** he said is false. ✔ All **that** he said is false. / **What** he said is false.
22. ✘ The boy **whom** came first got a prize. ✔ The boy **who** came first got a prize.
23. ✘ Neither of the **three** boys is guilty. ✔ **None** of the three boys is guilty.
24. ✘ **Everybody** have done **their** duty. ✔ **Everybody** has done **his** duty.
25. ✘ He **availed** of the chance. ✔ He **availed himself** of the chance.

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Pronoun Shift and Antecedent: The SAT punishes **pronoun shifts** in person or number within a passage: ✘ *"If* **one** *wants to succeed,* **you** *must work hard."* ✔ *"If* **one** *wants to succeed,* **one** *must work hard."* The GMAT requires every pronoun to have a clear **noun** antecedent: ✘ *"Although Professor Rahman's research is well known,* **he** *rarely gives interviews" — he* refers to *Professor Rahman's*, a possessive, which many GMAT editors reject. ✔ *"Although Professor Rahman is well known for his research,* **he** *rarely gives interviews."*

CHAPTER 09

Adjective

Part A · Grammar

9.1 Definition

An **adjective** is a word that **qualifies** (describes, limits or adds to the meaning of) a **noun or pronoun**. The word comes from the Latin *adjectivum*, "something added".

- Rahim is a **clever** boy. (*clever* describes *boy*)
- I have **five** pens. (*five* tells how many)
- **This** house is ours. (*this* points out which house)
- He is **happy**. (*happy* describes the pronoun *he*)

9.2 Kinds of Adjectives

9.2.1 Adjectives of Quality (Descriptive Adjectives)

They show the **kind or quality** of a person or thing and answer *What kind?*

good, bad, honest, brave, tall, beautiful, red, round, large, wise, cruel, hot, soft, rich, poor, intelligent.

- Dhaka is a **large** city. / He is an **honest** man. / The **red** rose is **beautiful**.

Proper adjectives (formed from proper nouns) are a sub-group; they begin with a capital letter: *Bangladeshi, English, Shakespearean, Indian, Chinese, Islamic, Victorian, Elizabethan, Socratic, Herculean (task), Napoleonic.*

9.2.2 Adjectives of Quantity

They show **how much** of a thing (used with uncountable nouns) and answer *How much?*

much, little, a little, no, some, any, enough, sufficient, all, whole, half, great, a lot of.

- He has **much** patience. / There is **little** hope. / I ate **some** rice. / I have **enough** money. / He spent the **whole** day reading.

9.2.3 Adjectives of Number (Numeral Adjectives)

They show **how many** or **in what order** and answer *How many?* They are of three types:

1. **Definite numeral adjectives** — show an exact number.
   - *Cardinals:* one, two, three, hundred…
   - *Ordinals:* first, second, third, last…
   - *Multiplicatives:* single, double, triple, twofold, threefold…
2. **Indefinite numeral adjectives** — do not show an exact number: *all, many, few, a few, several, some, any, no, enough, certain, sundry, numerous.*
3. **Distributive numeral adjectives** — refer to each one of a number: *each, every, either, neither.*

- I have **two** sisters. / He was the **first** boy. / A **double** bed.
- **Many** people came. / **Several** books are missing. / **Few** students passed.
- **Each** boy got a prize. / **Every** citizen must pay tax. / **Neither** answer is correct.

> Some words (*some, any, enough, all, no, more, most*) can be adjectives of **quantity** or of **number** depending on the noun:
>
> - I ate **some** rice. (quantity — uncountable) / **Some** boys came. (number — countable)
> - He has **enough** money. (quantity) / We have **enough** chairs. (number)
> - **All** the milk (quantity) / **All** the boys (number)

9.2.4 Demonstrative Adjectives

They **point out** which person or thing is meant: *this, that, these, those, such, same, yonder, the former, the latter.*

- **This** pen is mine. / **Those** boys are naughty. / I have never seen **such** a sight. / He made the **same** mistake again.

9.2.5 Interrogative Adjectives

What, which, whose used **with nouns** to ask questions.

- **What** colour is it? / **Which** book do you want? / **Whose** car is this?

9.2.6 Possessive Adjectives

my, our, your, his, her, its, their — show possession (modern grammar: possessive determiners).

- **My** house / **Their** school / **Its** colour

9.2.7 Emphasizing Adjectives

own, very — used for emphasis.

- I saw it with my **own** eyes. / This is the **very** book I wanted. / He is the **very** man.

9.2.8 Exclamatory Adjectives

What used in exclamations: **What** *a genius!* **What** *folly!* **What** *a beautiful scene!*

9.3 Position of Adjectives

9.3.1 Attributive (before the noun)

a **tall** *man, a* **beautiful** *garden, the* **old** *house.*

9.3.2 Predicative (after a linking verb)

The man is **tall**. *The garden looks* **beautiful**. *He became* **famous**. *The food smells* **good**.

9.3.3 Postpositive (immediately after the noun)

Adjectives come **after** the noun in these cases:

1. **With indefinite pronouns** (*something, anything, nothing, someone, everyone*): *something* **new**, *nothing* **important**, *someone* **reliable**. (✘ *new something*)
2. **In some fixed titles and phrases** (from French/Latin): *Heir* **apparent**, *Prince* **Royal**, *Poet* **Laureate**, *Governor* **General**, *Attorney* **General**, *Secretary* **General**, *President* **elect**, *court* **martial**, *God* **Almighty**, *the body* **politic**, *time* **immemorial**, *sum* **total**, *notary* **public**, *things* **Bangladeshi**.
3. **When the adjective has its own complement**: *a man* **proud of his wealth**, *a basket* **full of mangoes**, *a box* **too heavy to lift**.
4. **Adjectives ending in -able/-ible** after superlatives or *every/only*: *the best hotel* **available**, *every means* **possible**, *the only person* **responsible**.
5. **For emphasis or in poetry**: *Mountains* **high**, *rivers* **deep**. / *A man* **brave and honest**.
6. **Measurement**: *ten feet* **tall**, *five years* **old**, *two metres* **wide**.
7. Words like *present, concerned, involved, responsible* change meaning with position: *the* **present** *members* (current) / *the members* **present** (attending); *the* **concerned** *mother* (worried) / *the people* **concerned** (affected).

9.3.4 Adjectives Used Only Predicatively

afraid, alike, alive, alone, ashamed, asleep, awake, aware, ablaze, afloat, akin, content, glad (mostly), ill (BrE in sense of "sick"), well (healthy), unable, worth.

- ✘ an **asleep** baby ✔ a **sleeping** baby / The baby is **asleep**.
- ✘ an **alone** man ✔ a **lonely** man / He lives **alone**.
- ✘ **alike** brothers ✔ **similar** brothers / The brothers are **alike**.
- ✘ an **afraid** child ✔ a **frightened** child / The child is **afraid**.
- ✘ an **alive** fish ✔ a **live** fish / a **living** creature / The fish is **alive**.

9.3.5 Adjectives Used Only Attributively

main, chief, principal, mere, sheer, utter, elder, eldest, former, latter, inner, outer, upper, lower (in sense of position), only, very, live (= living), drunken, sole, total, entire, damn.

- ✘ The reason is **main**. ✔ This is the **main** reason.
- ✘ My brother is **elder** than me. ✔ My brother is **older** than me. / He is my **elder** brother.
- ✘ It was **sheer**. ✔ It was **sheer** luck.

9.4 Order of Adjectives

When several adjectives describe one noun, they follow a natural order. Remember **"OSASCOMP"**:

Order	Category	Examples
1	**O**pinion	beautiful, nice, ugly, lovely, delicious
2	**S**ize	big, small, tall, tiny, huge
3	**A**ge	old, new, young, ancient
4	**S**hape	round, square, oval, flat
5	**C**olour	red, blue, white, black
6	**O**rigin (nationality)	Bangladeshi, Japanese, Chinese, Indian
7	**M**aterial	wooden, cotton, silk, plastic, gold
8	**P**urpose (often a noun/gerund)	sleeping (bag), writing (desk), running (shoes)

Determiners and numbers come **before** all of these: *the two …*

- a **beautiful old Italian** car (opinion – age – origin)
- a **big round wooden** table (size – shape – material)
- a **lovely little white** cat
- **two small red plastic** balls
- an **expensive new black leather** bag
- ✘ a **wooden big round** table ✔ a **big round wooden** table
- ✘ a **silk red beautiful** saree ✔ a **beautiful red silk** saree

> **Exam Tip:** In "Which order is correct?" questions, check first that **opinion** comes before fact, and **material/purpose** comes last, right before the noun. Also: *first, last, next* + **number**: *the* **first two** *pages*, *the* **last three** *days* (✘ the two first).

Coordinate adjectives (of the same category) are separated by commas or *and*: *a* **long, boring** *speech*; *a* **kind and honest** *man*. Test: if you can reverse them or put *and* between them, use a comma.

9.5 Adjectives Used as Nouns

Some adjectives are used as nouns when preceded by *the*:

1. **Plural noun meaning a class of persons**: *the rich, the poor, the old, the young, the sick, the dead, the blind, the deaf, the wise, the learned, the brave, the virtuous, the wicked, the unemployed* — always plural verb: *The rich* **are** *not always happy.*
2. **Singular abstract idea**: *the good, the beautiful, the true, the unknown, the impossible — The beautiful* **is** *not always the good.*
3. **Nationality ending in -sh, -ch, -ese, -ss**: *the English, the French, the Dutch, the Chinese, the Japanese, the Swiss, the Irish* — plural meaning: *The English* **are** *a practical people.*
4. **Some adjectives became full nouns**: *a native, the natives, a criminal, a savage, an intellectual, a liberal, Christians, Muslims, the elders, our superiors, valuables, sweets, greens, eatables, drinkables, the ancients, the moderns, the blacks, the whites, the Rohingyas.*
5. **Fixed phrases**: *in short, in general, in private, in public, at best, at present, for good (= for ever), at large, in particular, from bad to worse, through thick and thin, in the dark, at last, before long.*

- ✘ **The poor is** neglected. ✔ **The poor are** neglected.
- ✘ **A rich** should help **a poor**. ✔ **The rich** should help **the poor**. / **A rich man** should help **a poor man**.
- ✘ He helped **the poors**. ✔ He helped **the poor**.

9.6 Nouns Used as Adjectives

A noun placed before another noun works as an adjective (noun adjunct). It is normally **singular**:

a **gold** *watch, a* **cotton** *shirt, a* **village** *school, the* **Dhaka** *University, a* **summer** *day, a* **bus** *stop, a* **ten-taka** *note, a* **five-year** *plan, a* **two-mile** *walk, a* **three-storey** *building, a* **six-day** *week.*

- ✘ a **five-years** plan ✔ a **five-year** plan
- ✘ a **ten-takas** note ✔ a **ten-taka** note
- ✘ a **two-miles** walk ✔ a **two-mile** walk
- ✘ a **three-storeys** building ✔ a **three-storey(ed)** building

9.7 Participial Adjectives: *-ing* vs *-ed*

Present and past participles of verbs work as adjectives, and the two forms have different meanings:

-ing (cause of the feeling — describes the thing/situation)	-ed (person who feels it)
The film was **boring**.	I was **bored**.
The news is **surprising**.	We were **surprised** at the news.
The lecture was **interesting**.	The students were **interested**.
The result was **disappointing**.	He was **disappointed** with the result.
The journey was **tiring**.	We were **tired**.
The situation is **confusing**.	I am **confused**.
It was a **frightening** experience.	The child was **frightened**.
His behaviour is **annoying**.	I am **annoyed** with him.
The story is **exciting**.	The children are **excited**.
The weather is **depressing**.	She felt **depressed**.

- ✘ I am **interesting** in music. ✔ I am **interested** in music.
- ✘ The match was very **excited**. ✔ The match was very **exciting**.
- ✘ He was **boring** in the class. (unless you mean he was dull for others) ✔ He was **bored** in the class.

Other participial adjectives: *a* **running** *train, a* **rolling** *stone, a* **broken** *chair, a* **fallen** *tree, a* **retired** *officer, a* **learned** *(learn-id) man, a* **drunken** *man, a* **sunken** *ship, a* **shrunken** *face, a* **molten** *metal, a* **swollen** *river.*

9.8 Compound Adjectives

Two or more words joined (usually by hyphens) to act as one adjective **before** a noun:

Pattern	Examples
number + noun	a **five-star** hotel, a **ten-year-old** boy, a **two-hour** journey
adjective + noun + -ed	a **kind-hearted** man, **blue-eyed**, **left-handed**, **long-legged**, **absent-minded**
noun + -ing participle	**heart-breaking**, **time-consuming**, **mouth-watering**, **eye-catching**, **peace-loving**
adjective/adverb + -ing	**good-looking**, **hard-working**, **easy-going**, **far-reaching**, **long-lasting**
noun/adjective/adverb + past participle	**man-made**, **hand-written**, **well-known**, **badly-paid**, **sun-dried**, **home-made**, **state-owned**

Pattern	Examples
adjective + noun	**full-time**, **last-minute**, **high-level**, **low-cost**, **first-class**
others	**up-to-date**, **out-of-date**, **day-to-day**, **face-to-face**, **door-to-door**, **once-in-a-lifetime**

> Compound adjectives are hyphenated **before** a noun but usually not after a linking verb: *a* **well-known** *writer* / *The writer is* **well known**. *An* **up-to-date** *list* / *The list is* **up to date**.

9.9 Formation of Adjectives

From	Suffix	Examples
Nouns	-ful	beauty → beautiful, use → useful, care → careful
Nouns	-less	care → careless, home → homeless, hope → hopeless
Nouns	-ous	danger → dangerous, fame → famous, courage → courageous
Nouns	-al	nation → national, nature → natural, culture → cultural
Nouns	-ic	hero → heroic, science → scientific, history → historic
Nouns	-y	health → healthy, wealth → wealthy, dirt → dirty
Nouns	-ly	friend → friendly, man → manly, cost → costly
Nouns	-ish	child → childish, fool → foolish, self → selfish
Nouns	-en	gold → golden, wood → wooden, wool → woollen
Nouns	-some	trouble → troublesome, quarrel → quarrelsome
Nouns	-like	child → childlike, life → lifelike
Nouns	-ary	moment → momentary, custom → customary
Verbs	-able / -ible	read → readable, accept → acceptable, permit → permissible
Verbs	-ive	act → active, attract → attractive, create → creative
Verbs	-ent / -ant	depend → dependent, please → pleasant, obey → obedient
Verbs	-ory	satisfy → satisfactory, compel → compulsory
Verbs	participles	interest → interesting/interested, break → broken

(Detailed lists appear in Chapters 40 and 41.)

9.10 Degrees of Comparison (Brief)

Adjectives of quality have three degrees:

- **Positive:** *tall, beautiful, good*
- **Comparative:** *taller, more beautiful, better* (comparing two)
- **Superlative:** *tallest, most beautiful, best* (comparing more than two)

The full rules — formation, irregular forms, *than/to* (Latin comparatives), double comparatives, transformation — are given in **Chapter 24**, and Latin adjectives (*senior to, superior to, prefer to*) in **Chapter 10**.

9.11 Some Adjectives Often Confused

Pair	Use
little / small	*little* (quantity: little water; also size with emotion: a little girl) / *small* (size: a small house)
elder / older	*elder*: family members, only before a noun, no *than* (my elder brother) / *older*: persons and things, used with *than* (He is older than me)
eldest / oldest	same distinction
later / latter	*later*: time (He came later) / *latter*: second of two (Of tea and coffee, I prefer the latter)
latest / last	*latest*: most recent (the latest news) / *last*: final (the last chapter)
farther / further	*farther*: distance / *further*: additional (further information) — also distance in BrE
nearest / next	*nearest*: distance / *next*: order or position (the next house)
less / fewer	*less*: quantity / *fewer*: number
many / much	*many*: countable / *much*: uncountable
each / every	*each*: two or more individually / *every*: three or more as a group
some / any	affirmative / negative-question (Chapter 04)
verbal / oral	*verbal*: in words (spoken or written) / *oral*: spoken
economic / economical	*economic*: of economics (economic policy) / *economical*: thrifty (an economical car)
historic / historical	*historic*: famous in history (a historic day — 16 December 1971) / *historical*: related to history (a historical novel)
childish / childlike	*childish*: silly (negative) / *childlike*: innocent (positive)
healthy / healthful	*healthy*: in good health / *healthful*: good for health (also *healthy food* is accepted)
official / officious	*official*: authorised / *officious*: meddlesome
respectable / respectful / respective	worthy of respect / showing respect / relating to each
sensible / sensitive / sensual / sensuous	wise / easily affected / bodily pleasure / pleasing to the senses
industrial / industrious	of industry / hard-working
imaginary / imaginative / imaginable	not real / creative / possible to imagine
momentary / momentous	lasting a moment / very important
luxurious / luxuriant	expensive and comfortable / growing richly (luxuriant hair/vegetation)
ingenious / ingenuous	clever, inventive / innocent, frank
contemptible / contemptuous	deserving contempt / showing contempt
credible / credulous / creditable	believable / too ready to believe / praiseworthy
judicial / judicious	of a court / wise
alternate / alternative	every other / another choice
continual / continuous	repeated with breaks / without a break
definite / definitive	clear / final, authoritative
exceptional / exceptionable	unusual, outstanding / objectionable

(More such pairs: Chapter 52.)

9.12 Common Errors with Adjectives

1. ✘ He is **more stronger** than I. ✔ He is **stronger** than I.
2. ✘ She is **most cleverest**. ✔ She is **the cleverest**.
3. ✘ He is my **older** brother. ✔ He is my **elder** brother.
4. ✘ My brother is **elder than** me. ✔ My brother is **older than** me.
5. ✘ I want **new something**. ✔ I want **something new**.

6. ✘ He is a **five years** old boy. ✔ He is a **five-year-old** boy.
7. ✘ The **poor is** suffering. ✔ The **poor are** suffering.
8. ✘ I am **boring** with this class. ✔ I am **bored** with this class.
9. ✘ She is **senior than** me. ✔ She is **senior to** me.
10. ✘ He has **less** friends. ✔ He has **fewer** friends.
11. ✘ This is a **historical** day for the nation. ✔ This is a **historic** day for the nation.
12. ✘ Of the two plans, the **later** is better. ✔ … the **latter** is better.
13. ✘ Please give me **farther** details. ✔ Please give me **further** details.
14. ✘ He looks **sadly**. ✔ He looks **sad**.
15. ✘ The flower smells **sweetly**. ✔ The flower smells **sweet**.
16. ✘ He is an **alone** man. ✔ He is a **lonely** man.
17. ✘ She bought a **silk beautiful red** saree. ✔ She bought a **beautiful red silk** saree.
18. ✘ He is **too much** tired. ✔ He is **very (much)** tired. / **too** tired to walk.
19. ✘ Rahim is **more taller** of the two. ✔ Rahim is **the taller** of the two.
20. ✘ This is the **most unique** opportunity. ✔ This is a **unique** opportunity. (*unique, perfect, complete, round, square, ideal, extreme, chief, universal, entire* are absolute — not compared.)
21. ✘ He is **very** stronger than me. ✔ He is **much** stronger than me.
22. ✘ It is a **mouth watering** dish. ✔ It is a **mouth-watering** dish.
23. ✘ The **concerned** officer was absent (= the officer in charge). ✔ The officer **concerned** was absent.
24. ✘ I have **a few** water. ✔ I have **a little** water.
25. ✘ He is **economic** in his habits. ✔ He is **economical** in his habits.

> **SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Adjective vs Adverb after Linking Verbs:** *Feel, look, seem, smell, taste, sound, appear, become, grow, remain, stay, turn, prove* take an **adjective** when they describe the subject: *She felt* **bad** *(✘ badly) about the mistake. The plan sounds* **good**. But when the same verb describes an action, use an **adverb**: *She looked* **angrily** *at him* (the act of looking was angry). GRE Text Completion often uses precise adjective pairs — **sanguine/sanguinary, credible/credulous, ingenious/ingenuous, luxurious/luxuriant** — so knowing exact meanings pays off.

CHAPTER 10

Latin Adjective

Part A · Grammar

10.1 What Are Latin Adjectives?

Most English comparatives are followed by **than**: *taller than, better than, more beautiful than.* But a small group of comparative adjectives, which English borrowed from **Latin**, are followed by **to**, not *than*. These are called **Latin comparatives** or **Latin adjectives**. In Latin they ended in **-ior** (the Latin comparative suffix), and in English they end in **-or**.

Latin adjective	Meaning	Correct use
senior	older / higher in rank	He is **senior to** me by two years.
junior	younger / lower in rank	She is **junior to** me.
superior	better / higher	This cloth is **superior to** that.
inferior	worse / lower	His work is **inferior to** yours.
prior	earlier	He arrived **prior to** the meeting.
posterior	later / behind	This event was **posterior to** the war.
anterior	earlier / in front	The front legs are **anterior to** the hind legs.
exterior	outer	The **exterior** walls (rarely used comparatively)
interior	inner	The **interior** of the house (rarely used comparatively)
major	greater	(not used with *to* in modern English)
minor	lesser	(not used with *to* in modern English)
ulterior	hidden / further	an **ulterior** motive (no comparison)

Rule: *Senior, junior, superior, inferior, prior, posterior, anterior* take **to** instead of *than*.

✘ He is **senior than** me. ✔ He is **senior to** me.

✘ This pen is **superior than** that. ✔ This pen is **superior to** that.

10.2 Five Golden Rules for Latin Adjectives

Rule 1 — Use *to*, never *than*

- ✘ Rahim is **junior than** Karim. ✔ Rahim is **junior to** Karim.
- ✘ Bangladeshi jute is **superior than** Indian jute. ✔ Bangladeshi jute is **superior to** Indian jute.
- ✘ Nothing is **inferior than** dishonesty. ✔ … **inferior to** …

Rule 2 — Never use *more* or *most* with them

They are **already comparative** in meaning, so adding *more* is a double comparative.

- ✘ He is **more senior to** me. ✔ He is **senior to** me.
- ✘ This is **more superior to** that. ✔ This is **superior to** that.
- ✘ He is **most senior** officer. ✔ He is **the senior-most** officer (Indian/Bangladeshi usage) / **the most senior** officer (accepted in modern British English as a *superlative*, but avoid *more senior to*).

In modern English, *senior* and *junior* are also used as ordinary adjectives meaning *high-ranking* / *low-ranking*: *a* **senior** *officer, a* **junior** *clerk.* In that use they can take *very/most*: *She is a* **very senior** *journalist.* But **in comparison** (*X is senior/junior to Y*) only *to* is correct.

Rule 3 — Use *much / far / by far / a little* (not *very*) to intensify

- ✔ He is **much senior** to me. / He is **far superior** to his rivals.
- ✘ He is **very superior** to me. (in comparison) ✔ He is **much superior** to me.
- ✔ He is senior to me **by three years**. (✘ He is three years senior than me.)

Rule 4 — Pronoun after *to* must be in the objective case

Because *to* is a preposition, the pronoun after it must be objective.

- ✘ He is senior **to I**. ✔ He is senior **to me**.
- ✘ She is junior **to he**. ✔ She is junior **to him**.

Rule 5 — Compare like with like

As with all comparisons, the two things compared must be of the same kind (Chapter 24, Chapter 39).

- ✘ The climate of Sylhet is superior **to Rajshahi**. ✔ The climate of Sylhet is superior **to that of** Rajshahi.
- ✘ Your handwriting is inferior **to your brother**. ✔ Your handwriting is inferior **to your brother's** (that of your brother).

10.3 Other Words That Take *to* Instead of *than*

Besides the Latin comparatives, several other words also take **to** and are tested along with them in BCS and Bank exams:

Word	Correct use	Wrong use
prefer (verb)	I **prefer** tea **to** coffee.	✘ prefer tea **than** coffee
preferable	Death is **preferable to** dishonour.	✘ more preferable than
preference	He showed a **preference for** tea **over** coffee.	—
elder / older	*elder* takes no comparison word (my elder brother); *older* takes **than**	✘ He is elder **than** me
outnumber / outweigh (no comparison word)	The advantages **outweigh** the disadvantages.	✘ outweigh than
similar	His car is **similar to** mine.	✘ similar than / with
equal	Five plus five is **equal to** ten.	✘ equal with / than
identical	This copy is **identical to (with)** the original.	✘ identical than
compare to / with	Life is **compared to** a journey (likeness). / **Compare** this book **with** that (examine differences).	✘ compare than
different	This is **different from** that. (BrE also *different to*; AmE *different than*)	exam key: **from**
opposite	His views are **opposite to** mine.	✘ opposite than
contrary	This is **contrary to** the rules.	—
analogous	Analogous **to**	—
akin / averse / adjacent / close / due / indifferent / prone / subject / vulnerable / liable	all take **to**	(Chapter 18)

10.3.1 *Prefer* — Patterns to Master

Prefer is one of the most frequently tested verbs. Learn all four patterns:

1. **prefer + noun + to + noun:** I prefer **tea to coffee**.
2. **prefer + gerund + to + gerund:** I prefer **walking to cycling**.
3. **prefer + to-infinitive + rather than + bare infinitive:** I prefer **to walk rather than cycle**. (✘ prefer to walk than to cycle)
4. **would rather + bare infinitive + than + bare infinitive:** I **would rather walk than cycle**.

- ✘ I prefer reading **than** writing. ✔ I prefer reading **to** writing.
- ✘ I prefer **to die than** beg. ✔ I prefer **to die rather than** beg. / I **would rather** die **than** beg.
- ✘ I **would prefer** to stay home **than** going out. ✔ I **would rather** stay home **than** go out.
- ✘ Death is **more preferable** to dishonour. ✔ Death is **preferable** to dishonour.

10.3.2 *Preferable*

Preferable already means "more desirable", so: ✘ *more preferable* ✔ *preferable*; ✘ *preferable than* ✔ *preferable to*.

10.4 Latin Words with Absolute Meaning

A related rule: some adjectives (many from Latin) have an **absolute** meaning and cannot be compared at all: *unique, perfect, complete, ideal, supreme, extreme, universal, eternal, infinite, absolute, entire, total, chief, round, square, empty, full, excellent, matchless, impossible, unanimous.*

- ✘ This is **the most unique** design. ✔ This is **a unique** design.
- ✘ It is **more perfect** than that. ✔ It is **more nearly perfect** than that. / It is **better** than that.
- ✘ It was **the most extreme** case. (common in speech) — careful exam style: **an extreme** case.
- ✘ The decision was **very unanimous**. ✔ The decision was **unanimous**.

10.5 Latin Comparatives in Context — Worked Sentences

- Mr. Hasan is **senior to** Mr. Rahman in service, though **junior to** him in age.
- A soldier must obey his **superior** officers.
- Quality is **superior to** quantity.
- Prevention is **superior to** (better than) cure.
- The **prior** permission of the authority is necessary. / He had left **prior to** my arrival.
- In status, the Deputy Commissioner is **superior to** the Upazila Nirbahi Officer.
- He felt **inferior to** his talented classmates — he had an **inferiority** complex.
- The **interior** of the Sundarbans is dense; the **exterior** villages face cyclones.
- The **posterior** part of the brain controls balance.
- A **minor** (person under 18) cannot vote. / Bangla is a **major** language of the world.

10.6 Nouns Formed from Latin Adjectives

Adjective	Noun
senior	seniority (*promotion by seniority*)
junior	juniority (rare)
superior	superiority (*a sense of superiority*)
inferior	inferiority (*an inferiority complex*)
prior	priority (*Education gets top priority*)
major	majority (*the majority of people*)
minor	minority (*ethnic minorities*)
exterior	exteriority (rare)
interior	interiority (rare)
posterior	posteriority (rare) / posterity (*future generations*)

10.7 Common Errors — Consolidated

1. ✘ He is **senior than** me by two years. ✔ He is **senior to** me by two years.
2. ✘ Your pen is **superior than** mine. ✔ Your pen is **superior to** mine.
3. ✘ He is **more junior** to me. ✔ He is **junior to** me.
4. ✘ I prefer milk **than** tea. ✔ I prefer milk **to** tea.
5. ✘ He prefers **to walk than to ride**. ✔ He prefers **to walk rather than ride**. / He prefers **walking to riding**.
6. ✘ Death is **more preferable** than dishonour. ✔ Death is **preferable to** dishonour.
7. ✘ He is **very senior** to me. ✔ He is **much senior** to me.
8. ✘ She is junior to **I**. ✔ She is junior to **me**.
9. ✘ This cloth is **inferior from** that. ✔ This cloth is **inferior to** that.
10. ✘ This is **most unique**. ✔ This is **unique**.
11. ✘ My brother is **elder than** me. ✔ My brother is **older than** me. / He is my **elder** brother.
12. ✘ He is three years **senior than** me. ✔ He is **senior to** me **by three years**. / He is three years **older than** me.
13. ✘ The climate of Rangpur is **inferior to** Sylhet. ✔ … **inferior to that of** Sylhet.
14. ✘ I would rather die **than to** beg. ✔ I would rather die **than** beg.
15. ✘ He reached there **prior than** me. ✔ He reached there **before** me / **prior to** my arrival.

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Idiomatic Comparison: The GMAT's idiom list includes **"prefer X to Y"**, **"X is preferable to Y"**, **"superior to"**, **"different from"**, **"regard X as Y"** (✘ regard X to be Y), and **"so X as to Y"**. A typical item: ✘ *"Many investors consider bonds* **as being superior than** *stocks in a downturn."* ✔ *"Many investors consider bonds* **superior to** *stocks in a downturn."* (Note also that *consider* takes no *as*: ✔ *consider X Y*.)

CHAPTER 11

Verb

Part A · Grammar

11.1 Definition

A **verb** is a word that says something about a person or thing — what it **does**, what **is done** to it, or what it **is** (its state). The word comes from the Latin *verbum*, "word", because the verb is the most important word in a sentence: **no sentence is complete without a finite verb**.

- The baby **cries**. (action)
- The thief **was caught**. (something done to the subject)
- Allah **is** merciful. (state of being)
- She **has** two cars. (possession)
- He **seems** tired. (linking)

11.2 Finite and Non-finite Verbs

Finite verb	Non-finite verb
Limited by the **subject** (number, person) and by **tense**	Not limited by subject or tense
Can form a sentence by itself with a subject	Cannot form a sentence by itself
He **goes** *to school. They* **went** *home. She* **is** *reading.*	**To go** (infinitive), **going** (gerund / present participle), **gone** (past participle)

- He **wants** (finite) **to learn** (non-finite) English.
- I **saw** (finite) him **crossing** (non-finite) the road.
- **Having finished** (non-finite) the work, he **went** (finite) home.
- ✘ He **going** to school. ✔ He **is going** / He **goes** to school.

Non-finite verbs (infinitive, gerund, participle) are treated fully in **Chapter 14**.

11.3 Principal (Main) and Auxiliary (Helping) Verbs

- **Principal verbs** carry the main meaning: *eat, go, write, think, play.*
- **Auxiliary verbs** help principal verbs to form tenses, voice, mood, questions and negatives.

Auxiliary type	Members	Uses
Primary auxiliaries	*be* (am, is, are, was, were, be, being, been), *have* (have, has, had), *do* (do, does, did)	continuous tenses (*is going*), passive (*was written*), perfect tenses (*has gone*), questions/negatives/emphasis (*Do you know? I did not go. I do love her.*)
Modal auxiliaries	can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must, ought to, need, dare, used to	ability, permission, possibility, obligation, etc. (Chapter 13)

> *Be, have* and *do* can also be **principal verbs**: *He* **is** *a doctor* (main verb). *I* **have** *a car* (main verb). *He* **does** *his homework* (main verb). In *He* **has done** *it, has* is auxiliary and *done* is principal.

11.4 Transitive and Intransitive Verbs

11.4.1 Transitive Verbs

A **transitive verb** passes its action from the subject to an **object**. Ask *"what?"* or *"whom?"* after the verb; if there is an answer, the verb is transitive.

- He **wrote** a letter. (wrote what? → a letter)
- The police **arrested** the thief. (arrested whom? → the thief)
- She **loves** her parents.

Double object (ditransitive): some verbs take two objects — an **indirect object** (usually a person, *to/for whom*) and a **direct object** (usually a thing): *give, lend, send, show, tell, teach, buy, offer, promise, pay, bring, ask, write.*

- He **gave me** (IO) **a book** (DO). = He gave a book **to me**.
- She **bought her son** a bicycle. = She bought a bicycle **for her son**.
- The teacher **asked him** a question.

11.4.2 Intransitive Verbs

An **intransitive verb** does not take an object; the action stays with the subject.

- The baby **sleeps**. / The sun **rises**. / Birds **fly**. / He **died** yesterday. / She **laughed** loudly.
- (*loudly, yesterday* are adverbs, not objects.)

Intransitive verbs cannot be put into the passive voice: ✘ *The baby was slept.*

11.4.3 Verbs Used Both Transitively and Intransitively

Verb	Transitive	Intransitive
ring	He **rang** the bell.	The bell **rang**.
open	She **opened** the door.	The door **opened**.
break	He **broke** the glass.	The glass **broke**.
move	They **moved** the table.	The table **moved**.
stop	The driver **stopped** the bus.	The bus **stopped**.
burn	He **burnt** the papers.	The candle **burns**.
fly	The boy **flies** a kite.	Birds **fly**.
run	He **runs** a business.	He **runs** fast.
grow	Farmers **grow** rice.	Rice **grows** in Bangladesh.
sell	They **sell** books.	These books **sell** well. (= are sold)
read	I **read** the newspaper.	This book **reads** well. (= reads pleasantly)
walk	He **walks** his dog.	He **walks** every morning.

11.4.4 Intransitive Verbs Used Transitively

1. **Cognate object** — an object with the same meaning (or same root) as the verb:

- He **lived a happy life**. / She **died a peaceful death**. / He **fought a good fight**. / She **sang a sweet song**. / He **slept a sound sleep**. / They **ran a race**. / She **smiled a sweet smile**. / He **dreamt a strange dream**.

2. **Causative use** — the subject *causes* someone/something to do the action:

- The horse **walks**. → He **walks the horse**. (makes it walk)
- The boat **floats**. → They **float the boat**.
- He **ran** fast. → He **runs a factory**.
- Birds **fly**. → Children **fly kites**.

3. **With a preposition** (prepositional verbs): *laugh at, look at, look for, listen to, wait for, depend on, think of* — the whole group is transitive: *Everybody* **laughed at** *him* → *He* **was laughed at** *by everybody.*

11.4.5 Transitive Verbs Used Intransitively

- The cake **cuts** easily. / These clothes **wash** well. / The door **won't shut**. / The book **sells** well.

11.5 Linking (Copular) Verbs and Complements

A **linking verb** does not show action; it **links** the subject to a word that describes or renames it — the **complement**.

be, become, seem, appear, look, feel, sound, smell, taste, grow, turn, get, remain, stay, keep, prove, fall (asleep/ill).

- He **is** a doctor. (noun complement)
- She **looks** beautiful. (adjective complement)
- The milk **turned** sour. / He **fell** ill. / The weather **grew** cold.
- He **remained** silent. / The food **tastes** delicious.

> **Adjective, not adverb, after a linking verb:** ✘ *She looks* **beautifully**. ✔ *She looks* **beautiful**. ✘ *The rose smells* **sweetly**. ✔ *The rose smells* **sweet**. ✘ *I feel* **badly**. ✔ *I feel* **bad**.

Verbs of incomplete predication need a complement to complete their meaning:

- **Intransitive verbs of incomplete predication** (need a subjective complement): *He became* **king**. *She seems* **happy**.
- **Factitive verbs** (transitive verbs that need an **objective complement**): *make, elect, appoint, call, name, choose, think, consider, crown, declare, find, keep, paint, render.*

- They **made** him **captain**. (*him* = object; *captain* = objective complement)
- The people **elected** her **President**.
- We **call** him **Babu**.
- The news **made** her **sad**.
- He **painted** the house **white**.
- They **found** the door **open**.
- I **consider** him **honest**. (✘ consider him **as** honest — see Chapter 38 on redundancy)

11.6 Regular and Irregular Verbs

- **Regular (weak) verbs** form their past tense and past participle by adding **-ed** / **-d** / **-t**: *walk – walked – walked; love – loved – loved; dwell – dwelt – dwelt.*
- **Irregular (strong) verbs** change the inner vowel or the whole word: *sing – sang – sung; go – went – gone; cut – cut – cut.*

11.6.1 Spelling Rules for Adding *-ed*

1. Most verbs: add *-ed* — *work → worked, play → played.*
2. Ending in *-e*: add *-d* — *love → loved, agree → agreed.*
3. Consonant + *y*: change *y* to *i* + *-ed* — *carry → carried, study → studied, try → tried.* (Vowel + *y*: *play → played, obey → obeyed.*) Exceptions: *pay → paid, lay → laid, say → said.*
4. One-syllable verb ending in **single vowel + single consonant**: double the consonant — *stop → stopped, plan → planned, rob → robbed, beg → begged.*
5. Two-syllable verb **stressed on the last syllable**: double the consonant — *prefer → preferred, occur → occurred, admit → admitted, refer → referred, permit → permitted, regret → regretted, commit → committed.* (Stress on first syllable — no doubling: *visit → visited, offer → offered, open → opened, happen → happened, benefit → benefited, target → targeted.*)
6. British English doubles final *-l* after a short vowel regardless of stress: *travel → travelled, cancel → cancelled, quarrel → quarrelled, label → labelled, model → modelled* (AmE: *traveled, canceled*).
7. Ending in *-c*: add *-k* — *picnic → picnicked, panic → panicked, mimic → mimicked, traffic → trafficked.*

11.6.2 Principal Parts of Important Irregular Verbs

(a) All three forms the same (A–A–A):

Present	Past	Past participle
bet	bet	bet
burst	burst	burst
cast	cast	cast
cost	cost	cost
cut	cut	cut
hit	hit	hit
hurt	hurt	hurt
let	let	let
put	put	put
quit	quit	quit
read (reed)	read (red)	read (red)
rid	rid	rid
set	set	set
shed	shed	shed
shut	shut	shut
slit	slit	slit
split	split	split
spread	spread	spread
thrust	thrust	thrust
upset	upset	upset
broadcast	broadcast	broadcast
forecast	forecast	forecast
bid (offer)	bid	bid

(b) Past and past participle the same (A–B–B):

Present	Past	Past participle
bend	bent	bent
bind	bound	bound
bleed	bled	bled
bring	brought	brought
build	built	built
burn	burnt / burned	burnt / burned
buy	bought	bought
catch	caught	caught
cling	clung	clung
creep	crept	crept
deal	dealt	dealt
dig	dug	dug
dream	dreamt / dreamed	dreamt / dreamed
dwell	dwelt	dwelt
feed	fed	fed
feel	felt	felt
fight	fought	fought
find	found	found
flee	fled	fled
fling	flung	flung
grind	ground	ground
hang (things)	hung	hung
hang (a person)	hanged	hanged
have	had	had
hear	heard	heard
hold	held	held
keep	kept	kept
kneel	knelt	knelt
lay	laid	laid
lead	led	led
lean	leant / leaned	leant / leaned
leap	leapt / leaped	leapt / leaped

Present	Past	Past participle
learn	learnt / learned	learnt / learned
leave	left	left
lend	lent	lent
light	lit / lighted	lit / lighted
lose	lost	lost
make	made	made
mean	meant	meant
meet	met	met
pay	paid	paid
say	said	said
seek	sought	sought
sell	sold	sold
send	sent	sent
shine	shone	shone
shoot	shot	shot
sit	sat	sat
sleep	slept	slept
slide	slid	slid
sling	slung	slung
smell	smelt / smelled	smelt / smelled
spell	spelt / spelled	spelt / spelled
spend	spent	spent
spill	spilt / spilled	spilt / spilled
spin	spun	spun
spit	spat	spat
stand	stood	stood
stick	stuck	stuck
sting	stung	stung
strike	struck	struck
string	strung	strung
sweep	swept	swept
swing	swung	swung
teach	taught	taught
tell	told	told
think	thought	thought
understand	understood	understood
weep	wept	wept
win	won	won
wind (turn)	wound	wound
wring	wrung	wrung

(c) All three forms different (A–B–C):

Present	Past	Past participle
arise	arose	arisen
awake	awoke	awoken
be (am/is/are)	was / were	been
bear (carry)	bore	borne
bear (give birth)	bore	born (passive: *He was born*) / borne (*She has borne three children*)
beat	beat	beaten
begin	began	begun
bid (command)	bade	bidden
bite	bit	bitten
blow	blew	blown
break	broke	broken
choose	chose	chosen
do	did	done
draw	drew	drawn
drink	drank	drunk
drive	drove	driven
eat	ate	eaten
fall	fell	fallen
fly	flew	flown
forbid	forbade	forbidden
forget	forgot	forgotten
forgive	forgave	forgiven
forsake	forsook	forsaken
freeze	froze	frozen
get	got	got (BrE) / gotten (AmE)
give	gave	given
go	went	gone
grow	grew	grown
hide	hid	hidden
know	knew	known
lie (recline)	lay	lain
ride	rode	ridden
ring	rang	rung
rise	rose	risen
see	saw	seen
shake	shook	shaken
show	showed	shown
shrink	shrank	shrunk
sing	sang	sung
sink	sank	sunk
slay	slew	slain
speak	spoke	spoken
spring	sprang	sprung
steal	stole	stolen
stride	strode	stridden
strive	strove	striven
swear	swore	sworn
swim	swam	swum
take	took	taken
tear	tore	torn
throw	threw	thrown
tread	trod	trodden
wake	woke	woken
wear	wore	worn
weave	wove	woven
write	wrote	written

(d) Present and past participle the same (A–B–A):

Present	Past	Past participle
come	came	come
become	became	become
overcome	overcame	overcome
run	ran	run

11.6.3 Verbs with Two Forms and Different Meanings

Verb	Meaning	Past – Past participle
hang	to suspend a thing	hung – hung (*He hung the picture.*)
hang	to kill by hanging	hanged – hanged (*The murderer was hanged.*)

Verb	Meaning	Past – Past participle
lie	to rest / recline (intransitive)	lay – lain (*He lay on the bed.*)
lie	to tell a lie	lied – lied (*He lied to me.*)
lay	to put / place (transitive)	laid – laid (*She laid the book on the table. The hen laid an egg.*)
find	to discover	found – found
found	to establish	founded – founded (*Tagore founded Visva-Bharati.*)
wind (wynd)	to turn	wound – wound (*He wound the clock.*)
wound (woond)	to injure	wounded – wounded
fly	to move in the air	flew – flown
flow	to move like water	flowed – flowed
flee	to run away	fled – fled
bear	to carry / to give birth	bore – borne / born
bore	to make a hole / to make tired	bored – bored
fall	to drop down (intr.)	fell – fallen
fell	to cut down (tr.)	felled – felled (*They felled the tree.*)
rise	to go up (intr.)	rose – risen (*The sun rose.*)
raise	to lift up (tr.)	raised – raised (*He raised his hand.*)
arise	to come into being	arose – arisen (*A problem arose.*)
arouse	to awaken feelings	aroused – aroused
sit	to be seated (intr.)	sat – sat
set	to put / to place (tr.)	set – set
seat	to cause to sit (tr.)	seated – seated (*Please be seated.*)
shine	to give light	shone – shone
shine	to polish	shined – shined (*He shined his shoes.*)
bid	to offer (price)	bid – bid
bid	to command / say	bade – bidden (*He bade me farewell.*)
welcome	always regular	welcomed – welcomed

Exam Tip — Lie / Lay / Rise / Raise / Sit / Set: The intransitive verbs (*lie, rise, sit*) take **no object**; the transitive verbs (*lay, raise, set*) **must** have an object.

- ✘ He **laid** in bed all day. ✔ He **lay** in bed all day.
- ✘ **Lay** down and rest. ✔ **Lie** down and rest.
- ✘ The prices have **raised**. ✔ The prices have **risen**.
- ✘ He **rose** the flag. ✔ He **raised** the flag.
- ✘ **Set** down, please. ✔ **Sit** down, please.
- ✘ The criminal was **hung**. ✔ The criminal was **hanged**.

11.7 Stative (State) Verbs and Dynamic (Action) Verbs

Dynamic verbs describe actions and can be used in continuous tenses: *run, eat, write, play.* **Stative verbs** describe states — feelings, thoughts, possession, senses — and are **normally not used in continuous tenses**.

Category	Stative verbs
Senses / perception	see, hear, smell, taste, feel, notice, recognise
Feelings / emotions	love, like, hate, dislike, prefer, want, wish, desire, adore, detest, mind, need, care
Thinking / opinion	know, believe, think (= believe), understand, realise, suppose, mean, remember, forget, doubt, imagine (= suppose), agree, disagree
Possession	have (= own), own, possess, belong, owe
Being / qualities	be, seem, appear, look (= seem), resemble, consist, contain, cost, weigh, measure, deserve, matter, fit, equal, include, lack, depend

- ✘ I **am knowing** him. ✔ I **know** him.
- ✘ She **is having** a car. ✔ She **has** a car.
- ✘ This book **is belonging** to me. ✔ This book **belongs** to me.
- ✘ I **am seeing** a bird in the tree. ✔ I **see** / **can see** a bird in the tree.
- ✘ He **is resembling** his father. ✔ He **resembles** his father.
- ✘ I **am understanding** the lesson. ✔ I **understand** the lesson.

Dual-use verbs. Some stative verbs can be continuous when they express an **action**: *I* **am having** *breakfast* (= eating). *She* **is seeing** *a doctor* (= consulting). *I* **am thinking** *of going* (= considering). *He* **is tasting** *the soup* (= testing its taste). *They* **are looking** *at the picture* (action). *I* **am feeling** *better today* (accepted). See also Chapter 21.

11.8 Causative Verbs: *make, have, get, let, help*

These verbs show that the subject **causes** someone else to do something.

Verb	Pattern	Example
make (force)	make + object + **bare infinitive**	The teacher **made** me **write** it again. (✘ to write)
let (allow)	let + object + **bare infinitive**	**Let** him **go**. (✘ to go)
have (arrange)	have + person + **bare infinitive**	I **had** the mechanic **repair** my car.
have (passive sense)	have + thing + **past participle**	I **had** my car **repaired**. / She **had** her hair **cut**.
get (persuade)	get + person + **to-infinitive**	I **got** him **to sign** the paper.
get (passive sense)	get + thing + **past participle**	I **got** my watch **mended**.
help	help + object + (to) infinitive	He **helped** me (**to**) **carry** the bag.

- ✘ He made me **to laugh**. ✔ He made me **laugh**.
- ✔ In the passive, *to* returns: *I* **was made to** *write it again.* (✘ I was made write)
- ✘ Let him **to** go. ✔ Let him go.
- ✘ I had my car **repair**. ✔ I had my car **repaired**.
- ✘ I got him **sign** the paper. ✔ I got him **to sign** the paper.

Other verbs followed by object + bare infinitive: verbs of perception — *see, hear, watch, notice, feel, observe*: *I* **saw** *him* **cross** *the road* (whole action) / *I saw him* **crossing** *the road* (action in progress). Also *bid*: *He* **bade** *me* **go**.

11.9 Mood of Verbs

Mood is the form of the verb that shows the **manner** in which the action is expressed.

1. **Indicative mood** — states a fact or asks a question: *He* **goes** *to school. Did you* **see** *him?*
2. **Imperative mood** — gives a command, request, advice or prayer: **Shut** *the door.* **Please help** *me.* **Do not smoke**. *May Allah* **bless** *you* (optative).
3. **Subjunctive mood** — expresses a wish, supposition, condition contrary to fact, purpose or demand. It is the trickiest and most tested.

11.9.1 The Subjunctive — Forms and Uses

Use	Form	Example
Unreal wish (present)	*wish* + past (with *were* for all persons)	I wish I **were** a bird. (✘ was) / I wish I **knew** the answer.
Unreal wish (past)	*wish* + past perfect	I wish I **had seen** him.
Imaginary condition	*if* + past (*were*)	If I **were** you, I would accept it.
As if / as though (unreal)	past / past perfect	He talks **as if** he **were** a king. / He looked **as though** he **had seen** a ghost.
It is (high) time	+ past simple	**It is high time** we **left**. (✘ leave)
Would rather / sooner + another subject	+ past	I **would rather** you **went** home now.
Demand / suggestion / necessity (mandative)	**bare infinitive** for all persons	I **suggest** that he **go** at once. / It is **necessary** that she **be** present. / The doctor **recommended** that he **take** rest.
Prayer / wish (formulaic)	bare form	**Long live** Bangladesh! **God bless** you! **Be** that as it **may**. **Come** what **may**.
Purpose with *lest*	*lest* + **should** + verb (or bare form)	Walk carefully **lest** you **should fall**. (✘ lest you should not fall)

Exam Tip — Mandative subjunctive. After *suggest, propose, recommend, insist, demand, order, request, urge, require, move* (in a meeting) and *it is necessary / essential / important / vital / imperative that*, the verb in the *that*-clause is the **base form** for all subjects (or *should* + base form in BrE): *He* **insisted** *that she* **attend** *the meeting* (✘ attends). This is also a favourite GMAT rule.

11.10 Phrasal Verbs and Prepositional Verbs (Introduction)

A verb + adverb particle or preposition can form a new meaning: *give up* (= quit), *look after* (= take care of), *put off* (= postpone), *bring up* (= rear), *carry on* (= continue). These are listed in **Chapter 47**.

- **Separable:** *Put off* the meeting. / *Put* the meeting *off*. / *Put* **it** *off* (✘ put off it — pronoun must go between).
- **Inseparable:** *Look after* the child (✘ look the child after). / *Look after* **him**.

11.11 Verbs Followed by Infinitive, Gerund or Both

This is treated in detail in Chapter 14, but the key lists are needed often:

Followed by to-infinitive	Followed by gerund (-ing)	Either (often different meaning)
afford, agree, aim, appear, arrange, attempt, choose, claim, decide, demand, deserve, expect, fail, hesitate, hope, intend, learn, manage, offer, plan, pretend, promise, refuse, seem, threaten, want, wish, would like	admit, appreciate, avoid, consider, delay, deny, dislike, enjoy, escape, finish, forgive, give up, imagine, involve, keep, mind, miss, postpone, practise, quit, recall, recommend, resent, resist, risk, suggest, tolerate, understand, can't help, can't stand, it's no use, it's worth, look forward to, be used to, object to	begin, start, continue, like, love, hate, prefer (little change); **remember, forget, stop, try, regret, mean, go on, need** (meaning changes)

- He **agreed to help** me. / He **avoided meeting** me.
- ✘ I enjoy **to swim**. ✔ I enjoy **swimming**.
- ✘ I look forward to **meet** you. ✔ I look forward to **meeting** you.
- ✘ He suggested **to go** there. ✔ He suggested **going** there. / He suggested **that we (should) go** there.
- He **stopped smoking** (gave up). / He **stopped to smoke** (paused in order to smoke).
- I **remember posting** the letter (I did it earlier). / **Remember to post** the letter (don't forget in future).

11.12 Common Errors with Verbs

1. ✘ He **didn't went** there. ✔ He **didn't go** there. (After *did*, use the base form.)
2. ✘ **Does** he **plays** football? ✔ **Does** he **play** football?
3. ✘ He **can sings**. ✔ He **can sing**.
4. ✘ The criminal was **hung**. ✔ The criminal was **hanged**.
5. ✘ He **laid** on the grass. ✔ He **lay** on the grass.
6. ✘ The price of rice has **raised**. ✔ The price of rice has **risen**.
7. ✘ He **made** me **to work**. ✔ He **made** me **work**.
8. ✘ I **am knowing** the answer. ✔ I **know** the answer.
9. ✘ I wish I **was** rich. (exam key) ✔ I wish I **were** rich.
10. ✘ It is time we **go** home. ✔ It is time we **went** home.
11. ✘ He **has broke** the glass. ✔ He **has broken** the glass.
12. ✘ She **has wrote** a letter. ✔ She **has written** a letter.
13. ✘ The sun **has rose**. ✔ The sun **has risen**.
14. ✘ He **sung** a song yesterday. ✔ He **sang** a song yesterday.
15. ✘ The ship **sunk** in the storm. ✔ The ship **sank** in the storm. (*sunk* = past participle)
16. ✘ I **seen** him yesterday. ✔ I **saw** him yesterday.
17. ✘ He **drunk** a glass of milk. ✔ He **drank** a glass of milk.
18. ✘ He **founded** the lost book. ✔ He **found** the lost book.
19. ✘ He **enjoyed** at the party. ✔ He **enjoyed himself** at the party.
20. ✘ The doctor suggested that he **takes** rest. ✔ … that he **take** rest / **should take** rest.
21. ✘ He was **borne** in 1971. ✔ He was **born** in 1971. (*borne* = carried: *The cost will be borne by the company.*)
22. ✘ The bird has **flew** away. ✔ The bird has **flown** away.
23. ✘ He **beated** the dog. ✔ He **beat** the dog.
24. ✘ We **discussed about** the matter. ✔ We **discussed** the matter. (*discuss* is transitive — no *about*)
25. ✘ He **ordered for** a cup of tea. ✔ He **ordered** a cup of tea.
26. ✘ He **resembles to** his father. ✔ He **resembles** his father.
27. ✘ He **reached at** the station. ✔ He **reached** the station.
28. ✘ He **entered into** the room. ✔ He **entered** the room. (But *enter into an agreement* ✔)
29. ✘ He **attacked on** the enemy. ✔ He **attacked** the enemy.
30. ✘ Please **return back** the book. ✔ Please **return** the book.

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Verb Form and Mood: The GMAT tests (1) the **mandative subjunctive** (*require that he* **be**, not *is*), (2) **would vs will** sequence (*He said that he* **would** *come*), (3) correct **past participles** (✘ *had swam* ✔ *had swum*; ✘ *has went* ✔ *has gone*), and (4) **lie/lay** distinctions. The SAT checks that the verb is **finite** in a main clause: ✘ *"The museum, which* **housing** *rare manuscripts, attracts…"* ✔ *"…which* **houses** *rare manuscripts…"*.

CHAPTER 12

Conjugation of Verb

Part A · Grammar

12.1 What Is Conjugation?

Conjugation is the systematic arrangement of all the forms of a verb — according to **tense, person, number, voice and mood**. When you conjugate a verb, you show how it changes with *I, we, you, he, she, it, they* in every tense, in the active and in the passive voice.

Learning conjugation is not only a classroom exercise: it trains you to produce the correct **auxiliary + verb form** automatically, which is exactly what *Right Form of Verbs*, *Tense*, *Voice* and *Correction* questions test.

12.2 The Building Blocks

Every English verb has five basic forms:

Form	*write*	*go*	*play*
Base form (V1)	write	go	play
-s form (V1 + s/es)	writes	goes	plays
Past (V2)	wrote	went	played
Past participle (V3)	written	gone	played
Present participle / gerund (V + ing)	writing	going	playing

The **auxiliaries** used to build tenses are: *am / is / are / was / were / be / being / been; have / has / had; do / does / did; shall / will / should / would.*

Formulae of the twelve active tenses (structure):

- Present Indefinite: Subject + V1 (+ s/es with third-person singular)
- Present Continuous: Subject + am/is/are + V-ing
- Present Perfect: Subject + have/has + V3
- Present Perfect Continuous: Subject + have/has + been + V-ing
- Past Indefinite: Subject + V2
- Past Continuous: Subject + was/were + V-ing
- Past Perfect: Subject + had + V3
- Past Perfect Continuous: Subject + had + been + V-ing
- Future Indefinite: Subject + shall/will + V1
- Future Continuous: Subject + shall/will + be + V-ing
- Future Perfect: Subject + shall/will + have + V3
- Future Perfect Continuous: Subject + shall/will + have + been + V-ing

12.3 Conjugation of the Verb *To Be*

Tense	I	We	You	He / She / It	They
Present	am	are	are	is	are
Past	was	were	were	was	were
Future	shall/will be	shall/will be	will be	will be	will be
Present Perfect	have been	have been	have been	has been	have been
Past Perfect	had been	had been	had been	had been	had been
Future Perfect	shall/will have been	shall/will have been	will have been	will have been	will have been
Subjunctive (past)	were	were	were	were	were

12.4 Conjugation of the Verb *To Have*

Tense	I / We / You / They	He / She / It
Present	have	has
Past	had	had
Future	shall/will have	will have
Present Perfect	have had	has had
Past Perfect	had had	had had
Future Perfect	shall/will have had	will have had
Present Continuous (action sense)	am/are having	is having

12.5 Conjugation of the Verb *To Do*

Tense	I / We / You / They	He / She / It
Present	do	does
Past	did	did
Present Perfect	have done	has done
Past Perfect	had done	had done
Future	shall/will do	will do

12.6 *Shall* and *Will* — Traditional Rule

Traditional British grammar (still followed in many Bangladeshi exam keys) uses:

Meaning	1st person (I, we)	2nd & 3rd person (you, he, she, it, they)
Simple future (plain prediction)	**shall**	**will**
Determination, promise, threat, command	**will**	**shall**

- I **shall** be twenty next year. (simple future)
- I **will** help you, I promise. (determination/promise)
- You **will** pass if you work hard. (simple future)
- You **shall** be punished if you are late again. (threat)
- He **shall** leave the room at once. (command)
- Thou **shalt** not kill. (command — Biblical)

In modern English, **will** is used for all persons in simple future, and *shall* is mainly used in questions offering help or suggestions: **Shall** *I open the window?* **Shall** *we go?*

12.7 Full Conjugation of *Write* — Active Voice (Affirmative)

12.7.1 Present Tenses

Person	Present Indefinite	Present Continuous	Present Perfect	Present Perfect Continuous
I	write	am writing	have written	have been writing
We	write	are writing	have written	have been writing
You	write	are writing	have written	have been writing
He / She / It	writes	is writing	has written	has been writing
They	write	are writing	have written	have been writing

12.7.2 Past Tenses

Person	Past Indefinite	Past Continuous	Past Perfect	Past Perfect Continuous
I	wrote	was writing	had written	had been writing

Person	Past Indefinite	Past Continuous	Past Perfect	Past Perfect Continuous
We	wrote	were writing	had written	had been writing
You	wrote	were writing	had written	had been writing
He / She / It	wrote	was writing	had written	had been writing
They	wrote	were writing	had written	had been writing

12.7.3 Future Tenses

Person	Future Indefinite	Future Continuous	Future Perfect	Future Perfect Continuous
I	shall write	shall be writing	shall have written	shall have been writing
We	shall write	shall be writing	shall have written	shall have been writing
You	will write	will be writing	will have written	will have been writing
He / She / It	will write	will be writing	will have written	will have been writing
They	will write	will be writing	will have written	will have been writing

12.8 Full Conjugation of *Write* — Passive Voice

Passive = **be** (in the right tense) + **past participle (V3)**. Only eight tenses are commonly used in the passive; the perfect continuous tenses and the future continuous are avoided.

Tense	I	You / We / They	He / She / It
Present Indefinite	am written	are written	is written
Present Continuous	am being written	are being written	is being written
Present Perfect	have been written	have been written	has been written
Past Indefinite	was written	were written	was written
Past Continuous	was being written	were being written	was being written
Past Perfect	had been written	had been written	had been written
Future Indefinite	shall be written	will be written	will be written
Future Perfect	shall have been written	will have been written	will have been written

> *Present perfect continuous, past perfect continuous, future continuous and future perfect continuous* have no normal passive forms. Sentences in these tenses are changed into the passive only with awkward forms (*has been being written*), which are avoided in exams. See Chapter 26.

12.9 Conjugation in the Negative and Interrogative

12.9.1 Rules

1. **With an auxiliary** (*am, is, are, was, were, have, has, had, shall, will, can, must…*): put **not** after the first auxiliary for negatives; move the first auxiliary **before the subject** for questions.
2. **Without an auxiliary** (present and past indefinite of ordinary verbs): use **do / does / did** + base form.

Tense	Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative	Negative-Interrogative
Present Indefinite	He writes.	He **does not write**.	**Does** he **write**?	**Doesn't** he write? / **Does** he **not** write?
Present Continuous	He is writing.	He **is not** writing.	**Is** he writing?	**Isn't** he writing?
Present Perfect	He has written.	He **has not** written.	**Has** he written?	**Hasn't** he written?
Present Perfect Continuous	He has been writing.	He **has not** been writing.	**Has** he been writing?	**Hasn't** he been writing?
Past Indefinite	He wrote.	He **did not write**.	**Did** he **write**?	**Didn't** he write?
Past Continuous	He was writing.	He **was not** writing.	**Was** he writing?	**Wasn't** he writing?
Past Perfect	He had written.	He **had not** written.	**Had** he written?	**Hadn't** he written?
Past Perfect Continuous	He had been writing.	He **had not** been writing.	**Had** he been writing?	**Hadn't** he been writing?
Future Indefinite	He will write.	He **will not** write.	**Will** he write?	**Won't** he write?
Future Continuous	He will be writing.	He **will not** be writing.	**Will** he be writing?	**Won't** he be writing?
Future Perfect	He will have written.	He **will not** have written.	**Will** he have written?	**Won't** he have written?
Future Perfect Continuous	He will have been writing.	He **will not** have been writing.	**Will** he have been writing?	**Won't** he have been writing?

> **After *do / does / did*, always use the base form (V1):** ✘ *Did he went?* ✔ *Did he go?* ✘ *He doesn't likes it.* ✔ *He doesn't like it.* ✘ *Does she sings?* ✔ *Does she sing?*

12.9.2 Contractions

Full	Contracted	Full	Contracted
I am	I'm	is not	isn't
you are	you're	are not	aren't
he is / he has	he's	was not	wasn't
it is / it has	it's	were not	weren't
we have	we've	have not	haven't
they had / they would	they'd	has not	hasn't
I will / I shall	I'll	had not	hadn't
let us	let's	do not	don't
—	—	does not	doesn't
—	—	did not	didn't
—	—	will not	**won't**
—	—	shall not	**shan't**
—	—	cannot	**can't**
—	—	must not	mustn't
—	—	ought not	oughtn't
—	—	am not (question)	**aren't I?** (✘ amn't I)

> **Exam Tip:** *Won't* (will not) and *shan't* (shall not) are irregular contractions. In tag questions, *I am* takes **aren't I?** (*I am right, aren't I?*). Contractions are informal; in formal essays and applications write the full forms.

12.10 Conjugation of Imperative, Infinitive and Participle Forms

Form	Active	Passive
Imperative	Write. / Don't write. / Let him write.	Let it be written. / Let it not be written.
Present infinitive	to write	to be written
Continuous infinitive	to be writing	—
Perfect infinitive	to have written	to have been written
Perfect continuous infinitive	to have been writing	—
Present participle	writing	being written
Past participle	—	written
Perfect participle	having written	having been written
Gerund	writing	being written
Perfect gerund	having written	having been written

- He seems **to be writing** a novel. (continuous infinitive)
- He is said **to have written** fifty books. (perfect infinitive)
- **Having written** the letter, he posted it. (perfect participle)
- The letter **being written**, he posted it. (absolute construction — passive participle)
- I hate **being disturbed**. (passive gerund)

12.11 Conjugation of Modal Verbs (Pattern)

Modals have no *-s* form, no infinitive, no participles. They are followed by the **bare infinitive** (or *have + V3* for past reference):

Modal +	Active	Passive
present/future reference	He **can write**. / He **may write**. / He **must write**.	It **can be written**. / It **must be written**.
continuous	He **may be writing**.	—
past reference (perfect)	He **should have written**. / He **might have written**. / He **must have written**.	It **should have been written**.

12.12 A Second Model: Conjugation of *Go* (Intransitive — No Passive)

Tense	I	He / She / It	We / You / They
Present Indefinite	go	goes	go
Present Continuous	am going	is going	are going
Present Perfect	have gone	has gone	have gone
Present Perfect Continuous	have been going	has been going	have been going
Past Indefinite	went	went	went
Past Continuous	was going	was going	were going
Past Perfect	had gone	had gone	had gone
Past Perfect Continuous	had been going	had been going	had been going
Future Indefinite	shall go	will go	shall go (we) / will go (you, they)
Future Continuous	shall be going	will be going	shall/will be going
Future Perfect	shall have gone	will have gone	shall/will have gone
Future Perfect Continuous	shall have been going	will have been going	shall/will have been going

> **Has gone / has been.** *He* **has gone** *to Dhaka* = he went and is still there (not here now). *He* **has been** *to Dhaka* = he visited Dhaka and has come back. *Have you ever* **been** *to Cox's Bazar?* (✘ gone to)

12.13 Conjugation Errors — Consolidated

1. ✘ He **do not** know me. ✔ He **does not** know me.
2. ✘ **Do** she like mangoes? ✔ **Does** she like mangoes?
3. ✘ I **didn't saw** him. ✔ I **didn't see** him.
4. ✘ They **was** playing. ✔ They **were** playing.
5. ✘ He **have** finished. ✔ He **has** finished.
6. ✘ She **is go** to school. ✔ She **goes** / **is going** to school.
7. ✘ We **has been** waiting for an hour. ✔ We **have been** waiting for an hour.
8. ✘ He **will has** finished by then. ✔ He **will have** finished by then.
9. ✘ The letter **was wrote** by him. ✔ The letter **was written** by him.
10. ✘ The house **is building** now (meaning passive). ✔ The house **is being built** now.
11. ✘ I **amn't** late, **am I**? ✔ I'm not late, **am I**? / I'm late, **aren't I**?
12. ✘ **Didn't** you **went** there? ✔ **Didn't** you **go** there?
13. ✘ He **can to** swim. ✔ He **can** swim.
14. ✘ She **musts** go. ✔ She **must** go.
15. ✘ He **has went** home. ✔ He **has gone** home.

> **SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Verb Phrase Integrity:** Many SAT/GMAT errors come from broken verb phrases: a modal followed by the wrong form (✘ *could of gone* ✔ *could have gone*; ✘ *should had known* ✔ *should have known*), a perfect tense with a simple past form (✘ *had ran* ✔ *had run*; ✘ *has began* ✔ *has begun*), or a continuous form missing *be* (✘ *The prices rising rapidly* ✔ *The prices are rising rapidly*). Conjugation tables are the cure: read them aloud until the correct pairs feel natural.

CHAPTER 13

Modal Auxiliary

Part A · Grammar

13.1 What Are Modal Auxiliaries?

Modal auxiliaries (modals) are helping verbs that express the speaker's **attitude** towards an action — whether it is possible, permitted, necessary, obligatory, advisable, certain, or desired. They "colour" the meaning of the main verb.

The modals: *can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must, ought (to).* **Semi-modals:** *need, dare, used to, had better, would rather, have to, be able to, be to.*

- He **can** swim. (ability)
- **May** I come in? (permission)
- It **might** rain today. (possibility)
- You **should** respect your teachers. (advice/duty)
- We **must** obey the law. (obligation)
- You **ought to** help the poor. (moral duty)

13.2 Grammatical Features of Modals

1. **No -s in the third person singular:** *He can* (✘ cans), *She must* (✘ musts).
2. **Followed by the bare infinitive** (base form without *to*): *He can* **swim** (✘ can to swim, ✘ can swims, ✘ can swimming). Exceptions: *ought* **to**, *used* **to**, *have* **to**, *be able* **to**.
3. **No infinitive, no participle, no gerund forms:** ✘ *to can*, ✘ *canning*, ✘ *musted*. Use substitutes: *to be able to, to have to.*
4. **Two modals cannot stand together:** ✘ *He will can come.* ✔ *He will be able to come.* ✘ *You must can do it.* ✔ *You must be able to do it.*
5. **Negatives and questions without *do*:** *He cannot go. Can he go?* (✘ Does he can go?)
6. **Past reference with *have* + *V3*:** *He* **must have gone**. *You* **should have told** *me.*

13.3 *Can* and *Could*

13.3.1 *Can*

Use	Example
Present ability	She **can** speak three languages. / I **can't** swim.
Permission (informal)	You **can** go now. / **Can** I use your phone?
Possibility (theoretical)	Anyone **can** make a mistake. / The road **can** be dangerous in the rain.
Request (informal)	**Can** you help me?
Impossibility (certain negative deduction)	It **can't** be true. / He **can't** be at home; I saw him at the market.

13.3.2 *Could*

Use	Example
Past ability (general)	He **could** run very fast when he was young.
Polite request	**Could** you please open the window?
Polite permission	**Could** I borrow your pen?
Possibility (present/future, weaker)	It **could** rain later. / This **could** be the answer.
Conditional (unreal)	If I had money, I **could** buy a car.
Past possibility (with *have* + *V3*)	He **could have** won, but he didn't try.
Indirect speech (past of *can*)	He said that he **could** swim.

Could vs was able to. For a **specific achievement** on one occasion in the past, use *was able to / managed to*, not *could*: ✘ *The fire spread fast, but everyone* **could** *escape.* ✔ *…everyone* **was able to** *escape / managed to escape.* In the **negative**, *couldn't* is fine: *I* **couldn't** *find the key.*

13.4 *May* and *Might*

13.4.1 *May*

Use	Example
Permission (formal)	**May** I come in, sir? / You **may** go now.
Possibility (present/future)	He **may** come today. / It **may** rain tonight.
Wish / prayer	**May** Allah bless you! / **May** you live long! / **May** our country prosper!
Purpose (after *so that / that*, present-future)	He works hard **so that** he **may** succeed.
Concession	Whatever you **may** say, I won't change my mind. / Try as he **may**, he cannot win.

13.4.2 *Might*

Use	Example
Past of *may* (reported speech)	He said that he **might** come.
Weaker possibility	It **might** rain, but I doubt it.
Purpose (past)	He worked hard **so that** he **might** succeed.
Polite suggestion / mild reproach	You **might** try calling him. / You **might** have told me earlier!
Past possibility	He **might have** missed the bus.

Exam Tip — *so that* + may/might. Use **may** after a present/future main verb and **might** after a past main verb: *He* **eats** *so that he* **may** *live.* / *He* **ate** *so that he* **might** *live.* ✘ *He worked hard so that he can pass* (informal) — the exam key prefers *might*.

13.5 *Shall* and *Should*

13.5.1 *Shall*

Use	Example
Simple future (1st person, traditional)	I **shall** be eighteen next month.
Offer / suggestion (questions)	**Shall** I carry your bag? / **Shall** we start?
Command, promise, threat (2nd/3rd person)	You **shall** get your reward. / He **shall** be punished.
Legal / formal obligation	The tenant **shall** pay the rent by the 5th of each month.

13.5.2 *Should*

Use	Example
Duty / advice / moral obligation	We **should** obey our parents. / You **should** see a doctor.
Probability / expectation	He **should** be home by now. / The parcel **should** arrive tomorrow.
After *lest*	Walk fast **lest** you **should** miss the train.
Mandative subjunctive (BrE)	It is necessary that he **should** go. / I suggest that he **should** apply.
Conditional (formal, uncertain)	If it **should** rain, the match will be cancelled. / **Should** you need help, call me. (inverted)

Use	Example
Past regret / criticism	You **should have** studied harder. (but you didn't)
Surprise / emotion (after *that*)	It is strange that he **should** say so.
In reported speech (past of *shall*)	I said that I **should** go.

Lest … should. *Lest* means "so that … not", so it never takes *not*: ✘ *Run fast lest you* **should not** *miss the bus.* ✔ *Run fast lest you* **should** *miss the bus.*

13.6 *Will* and *Would*

13.6.1 *Will*

Use	Example
Future (all persons in modern English)	She **will** come tomorrow.
Willingness / promise / determination	I **will** help you. / I **will** pass this time.
Request (informal)	**Will** you shut the door?
Habit / characteristic behaviour	Boys **will** be boys. / He **will** sit for hours without speaking.
Assumption	That **will** be the postman at the door.
Refusal (negative)	The car **won't** start. / He **won't** listen to me.

13.6.2 *Would*

Use	Example
Past of *will* (reported speech)	He said that he **would** come.
Polite request	**Would** you please help me?
Polite offer / invitation	**Would** you like some tea?
Past habit (repeated action)	When we were children, we **would** play in the field every afternoon.
Conditional (unreal)	If I were rich, I **would** help the poor.
Wish / preference	I **would** like to go. / I **would rather** stay home.
Past refusal	He **wouldn't** listen to my advice.
Unreal past	I **would have** helped you if you had asked.

Would vs used to. Both express **past habits** (actions): *We* **would** / **used to** *swim in the river.* But only **used to** expresses **past states**: *There* **used to** *be a pond here* (✘ would be). *He* **used to** *live in Khulna* (✘ would live).

13.7 *Must*

Use	Example
Strong obligation / necessity (from the speaker)	I **must** finish this today. / You **must** wear a helmet.
Prohibition (*must not*)	You **must not** smoke here. / Students **mustn't** use mobile phones in the exam hall.
Logical certainty (positive deduction)	He has worked all day; he **must** be tired. / She **must** be the new teacher.
Past deduction	The ground is wet; it **must have** rained last night.
Strong recommendation	You **must** visit Sylhet; it's beautiful.
Insistence	If you **must** go, go quietly.

13.7.1 *Must* vs *Have to*

- **Must** — obligation from the **speaker** (internal): *I* **must** *stop smoking.* (I feel it is necessary.)
- **Have to** — obligation from **outside** (rules, circumstances): *I* **have to** *wear a uniform at work.* (It is the rule.)
- *Must* has no past form; use **had to**: *Yesterday I* **had to** *go to the bank.* (✘ musted)
- Future: **will have to**: *You* **will have to** *wait.*

13.7.2 *Must not* vs *Need not / Don't have to*

Form	Meaning	Example
must not	prohibition — it is not allowed	You **must not** park here.
need not / needn't	no necessity — it is not necessary	You **needn't** come tomorrow; it's a holiday.
don't have to	no obligation	You **don't have to** pay; it's free.

13.7.3 Opposite of *must* (deduction)

The negative of *must* (logical certainty) is **can't**, not *mustn't*: *He* **must** *be at home* (I'm sure he is). → *He* **can't** *be at home* (I'm sure he isn't).

13.8 *Ought to*

Ought to expresses **moral duty, obligation or strong advisability** — similar to *should* but a little stronger and more formal. It is the only modal followed by **to**.

- We **ought to** love our country.
- You **ought to** respect your elders.
- He **ought not to** waste time. (✘ ought not waste)
- You **ought to have** helped him. (past — you didn't)
- **Ought** we **to** go? (formal question)

1. ✘ We **ought** obey our parents. ✔ We **ought to** obey our parents.
2. ✘ You **ought to not** do that. ✔ You **ought not to** do that.
3. ✘ He **oughts to** go. ✔ He **ought to** go.

13.9 *Need* and *Dare* — The Double Life

Need and *dare* can be used as **modals** (in negatives and questions; no *-s*, bare infinitive, no *do*) or as **ordinary verbs** (with *-s*, *to*-infinitive, *do*-support).

	As modal auxiliary	As main verb
need	You **need not** go. / **Need** I go? / He **needn't** worry.	You **don't need to** go. / Does he **need to** go? / He **needs to** work harder. / I **need** a pen.
dare	He **dare not** go there. / **Dare** he say so? / How **dare** you insult me!	He **doesn't dare to** go there. / He **dares to** challenge the champion. / I **dare** you **to** jump. (= challenge)

As a modal, *need/dare* is used only in negative and interrogative sentences. ✘ *He need go.* ✔ *He needs to go.* ✘ *He dares not go* — ✔ *He* **dare not** *go* (modal) or *He* **does not dare to** *go* (main verb).

- ✘ He **needs not** come. ✔ He **need not** come. / He **doesn't need to** come.
- ✘ How **dares** he speak like that? ✔ How **dare** he speak like that?
- **Needn't have** + V3 = it was done, but it was not necessary: *You* **needn't have bought** *bread; we had plenty.*
- **Didn't need to** = it was not necessary (and probably not done): *I* **didn't need to** *buy bread, so I didn't.*

13.10 *Used to*

13.10.1 *Used to* + base form (past habit or state, no longer true)

- I **used to** smoke, but I've stopped.
- There **used to** be a cinema hall here.
- **Did** you **use to** live in Rajshahi? (question)
- He **didn't use to** like rice. (negative) — also *He used not to like rice* (formal BrE).
- ✘ I **use to** go there every day (present). ✔ I **usually** go there every day.

13.10.2 *Be / Get used to* + gerund (be accustomed to)

Here *to* is a **preposition**, so it is followed by a **noun or gerund**.

- I **am used to getting** up early. (= accustomed to) ✘ am used to get up
- She **is used to** hard work.
- He will soon **get used to living** in the city.
- ✘ I am used to **walk** long distances. ✔ I am used to **walking** long distances.

Exam Tip — Three "used" structures: (1) *used to* + V1 = past habit (*I used to swim*); (2) *be used to* + V-ing = accustomed (*I am used to swimming*); (3) *be used to* + V1 = passive of *use* (*A knife* **is used to cut** *things* — it is employed for cutting). The other phrases that take *to* + V-ing: *look forward to, object to, with a view to, be accustomed to, be addicted to, be devoted to, take to, confess to, in addition to, when it comes to, adjust to.*

13.11 *Had better* and *Would rather*

Expression	Meaning	Pattern	Example
had better	advice/warning (stronger than *should*)	had better + V1	You **had better** consult a doctor. / You **had better not** be late. (✘ had better to; ✘ had not better)
would rather	preference	would rather + V1 + than + V1	I **would rather** walk **than** take a rickshaw.
would rather + another subject	preference about someone else's action	would rather + subject + past tense	I **would rather** you **stayed** here. / I'd rather you **didn't** smoke.
would sooner	same as *would rather*	—	I **would sooner** die **than** beg.

13.12 *Be to*, *Have to*, *Be able to*

- **Be to** + V1 = arrangement, plan, official order or destiny: *The Prime Minister* **is to** *visit Japan next week. You* **are to** *report at 9 a.m. He* **was** *never* **to** *see his homeland again.*
- **Have to / has to / had to** = necessity (external): *I* **have to** *catch the 8 o'clock train.*
- **Be able to** = ability (used where *can* has no form): *I* **will be able to** *finish it. I* **have been able to** *save some money.*

13.13 Modal Perfects — Talking About the Past

Modal + **have** + **past participle** refers to the past, usually to something that did **not** happen or to a deduction about the past.

Form	Meaning	Example
must have + V3	certain deduction about the past	The streets are wet; it **must have rained**.
can't / couldn't have + V3	impossible in the past	He **can't have seen** me; I wasn't there.
may / might have + V3	possible in the past	She **may have missed** the bus.
could have + V3	possible but didn't happen / unused ability	You **could have** won if you had tried.
should / ought to have + V3	it was right but wasn't done (criticism, regret)	You **should have** informed the police.
shouldn't have + V3	it was wrong but was done	You **shouldn't have** shouted at him.
needn't have + V3	done but unnecessary	You **needn't have** brought an umbrella.
would have + V3	unreal past result (3rd conditional)	I **would have** helped you if I had known.

1. ✘ He **must had** gone. ✔ He **must have** gone.
2. ✘ You **should of** told me. ✔ You **should have** told me. (*of* is a mishearing of *'ve*)
3. ✘ She **might has** forgotten. ✔ She **might have** forgotten.

13.14 Modals Expressing Degrees of Certainty

From most certain to least certain (present):

Certainty	Positive	Negative
100% (fact)	He **is** at home.	He **isn't** at home.
~95% (deduction)	He **must** be at home.	He **can't / couldn't** be at home.
~70% (expectation)	He **should / ought to** be at home.	He **shouldn't** be at home.
~50% (possibility)	He **may** be at home.	He **may not** be at home.
<50% (weak possibility)	He **might / could** be at home.	He **might not** be at home.

13.15 Modals in Reported Speech

Direct	Indirect (past reporting verb)
can	could
may	might
shall	should (or would)
will	would
must (obligation)	must / had to
could, might, should, would, ought to, used to	unchanged

(See Chapter 27.)

13.16 Common Errors with Modals — Consolidated

1. ✘ He **can speaks** English. ✔ He **can speak** English.
2. ✘ I **must to** go now. ✔ I **must** go now.
3. ✘ You **will can** do it. ✔ You **will be able to** do it.
4. ✘ **Do** you **can** swim? ✔ **Can** you swim?
5. ✘ He **musted** go yesterday. ✔ He **had to** go yesterday.
6. ✘ You **need not to** worry. ✔ You **need not** worry. / You **don't need to** worry.
7. ✘ He **dares not to** speak. ✔ He **dare not** speak.
8. ✘ You **had better to** go. ✔ You **had better** go.
9. ✘ I **would rather to** die. ✔ I **would rather** die.
10. ✘ I **used to getting** up early (past habit). ✔ I **used to get** up early.
11. ✘ I am used to **get** up early. ✔ I am used to **getting** up early.
12. ✘ Walk carefully **lest** you **may not** fall. ✔ … **lest** you **should** fall.
13. ✘ He worked hard so that he **may** pass. ✔ … so that he **might** pass.
14. ✘ **May** you **are** happy! ✔ **May** you **be** happy!
15. ✘ He **ought** respect his parents. ✔ He **ought to** respect his parents.
16. ✘ You **mustn't** come tomorrow; it's a holiday (= not necessary). ✔ You **needn't** come tomorrow.
17. ✘ She **must be** at home; her car isn't here (= deduction negative). ✔ She **can't be** at home.
18. ✘ I wish I **can** fly. ✔ I wish I **could** fly.
19. ✘ He said that he **will** come. ✔ He said that he **would** come.
20. ✘ It **might rained** yesterday. ✔ It **might have rained** yesterday.

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Modal Logic in Reading: In GRE/GMAT Critical Reasoning, modals signal the **strength** of a claim. *"The policy* **must** *reduce costs"* is a strong claim easily weakened; *"The policy* **may** *reduce costs"* is a weak claim that is hard to attack. Assumption and inference questions often turn on the difference between **can** (possibility) and **will** (prediction), or between **should** (recommendation) and **must** (necessity). In Sentence Correction, ✘ *"would have" in an if-clause* is always wrong: ✘ *If he* **would have** *known* → ✔ *If he* **had** *known*.

CHAPTER 14

Gerund & Participle

Part A · Grammar

14.1 Non-finite Verbs — An Overview

Non-finite verbs (also called *verbals*) are verb forms that are **not limited by the subject or tense**. They cannot be the main verb of a sentence by themselves, but they keep some verb qualities (they can take objects and be modified by adverbs) while doing the work of a **noun, adjective or adverb**.

Non-finite	Form	Works as	Example
Infinitive	(to) + V1	noun, adjective, adverb	I want **to learn**.
Gerund	V + ing	noun	**Swimming** is good exercise.
Present participle	V + ing	adjective (and in continuous tenses)	a **running** train
Past participle	V3	adjective (and in perfect tenses/passive)	a **broken** glass
Perfect participle	having + V3	adverbial (time/reason)	**Having finished** the work, he left.

Because the gerund and the present participle look the same (*-ing*), the main skill tested is **telling them apart by function**.

14.2 The Infinitive

14.2.1 Forms

	Active	Passive
Simple	to write	to be written
Continuous	to be writing	—
Perfect	to have written	to have been written
Perfect continuous	to have been writing	—

14.2.2 Uses of the *to*-Infinitive

(a) As a noun (noun infinitive):

- **To err** is human, **to forgive** divine. (subject)
- It is difficult **to please everyone**. (*it* = introductory subject; the infinitive is the real subject)
- He wants **to go** abroad. (object)
- Her aim is **to become** a doctor. (complement)
- He has no choice but **to resign**. (object of a preposition — rare)
- I don't know **what to do / how to begin / where to go**. (*wh-word* + infinitive)

(b) As an adjective (qualifying a noun — gerundial/qualifying infinitive):

- I have no money **to spend**. (= money that I can spend)
- Give me a chair **to sit on**.
- He was the first **to arrive** / the last **to leave**.
- This is a house **to let**. (to be let — for rent)
- She has a lot of work **to do**.

(c) As an adverb (purpose, cause, result, degree):

- He went to the market **to buy** vegetables. (purpose)
- I am glad **to see** you. (cause — qualifying an adjective)
- He is too weak **to walk**. (degree/result)
- She is old enough **to vote**.
- He worked hard **only to fail**. (unexpected result)
- **To tell the truth**, I forgot it. (sentence adverbial — independent infinitive)

14.2.3 The Bare Infinitive (without *to*)

The infinitive is used **without *to*** after:

1. **Modal auxiliaries**: *can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must* — *He can* **swim**.
2. **need, dare** (as modals): *You need not* **go**. *He dare not* **speak**.
3. **Verbs of perception** (active): *see, hear, watch, feel, notice, observe, behold, perceive* — *I saw him* **go** *out.* (In the passive *to* returns: *He was seen* **to go** *out.*)
4. **make, let, have, bid** (active): *He made me* **cry**. *Let him* **go**. *I had him* **repair** *it.* (Passive: *I was made* **to cry**.)
5. **had better, would rather, would sooner, rather than, sooner than**: *You had better* **go**. *I would rather* **die** *than* **beg**.
6. **but / except** after *do + anything/nothing/everything*: *He did nothing but* **cry**. *She could do nothing except* **wait**.
7. **why / why not** (questions/suggestions): *Why* **wait**? *Why not* **try** *again?*
8. **help** (optional *to*): *Help me* **(to) carry** *this.*
9. **than** in comparisons: *It is better to die* **than (to) live** *in disgrace.*

- ✘ He made me **to laugh**. ✔ He made me **laugh**.
- ✘ Let him **to** go. ✔ Let him **go**.
- ✘ You had better **to** consult a doctor. ✔ You had better **consult** a doctor.
- ✘ I heard her **to sing**. ✔ I heard her **sing**.
- ✔ She was heard **to sing**. (passive — *to* is used)

14.2.4 Split Infinitive

A **split infinitive** places an adverb between *to* and the verb: *to* **boldly** *go.* Traditional grammar (and many exam keys) considers this wrong; modern usage allows it when it sounds natural.

- ✘ (traditional) I want **to clearly understand** the problem. ✔ I want **to understand** the problem **clearly**.
- ✘ He decided **to immediately leave**. ✔ He decided **to leave immediately**.

14.2.5 Infinitive with *too … to* and *so … that*

- He is **too** weak **to walk**. = He is **so** weak **that** he **cannot** walk.
- The box is **too** heavy **for me to lift**. = The box is **so** heavy **that** I cannot lift **it**.
- ✘ The box is too heavy for me to lift **it**. ✔ The box is too heavy for me to lift. (no object pronoun in the *too … to* structure)

14.3 The Gerund

A **gerund** is the *-ing* form of a verb used as a **noun**. It names an action: *swimming, reading, smoking.* Because it is a verb-noun, it can take an object and be modified by an adverb, yet it does every job a noun does.

14.3.1 Functions of the Gerund

Function	Example
Subject of a verb	**Walking** is good exercise. / **Smoking** is injurious to health.
Object of a verb	I like **reading** novels. / He stopped **smoking**.
Object of a preposition	He is fond of **singing**. / She is good at **painting**. / Thank you for **coming**.
Complement	His hobby is **collecting** stamps. / Seeing is **believing**.
In apposition	His favourite pastime, **gardening**, keeps him busy.

Function	Example
In compound nouns (gerund + noun = purpose)	a **swimming** pool (a pool for swimming), a **walking** stick, a **reading** room, a **frying** pan, a **dining** table, **drinking** water, a **sewing** machine, a **driving** licence, a **sleeping** bag

14.3.2 Gerund after Prepositions

A verb that comes immediately after a preposition must be in the **gerund** form.

- He is fond **of swimming**. (✘ fond of swim / fond to swim)
- She is interested **in learning** French.
- I am tired **of waiting**.
- He left **without saying** goodbye.
- **Instead of going** home, he went to the cinema.
- **Before going** to bed, brush your teeth.
- He insisted **on paying** the bill.
- She succeeded **in passing** the exam.
- I am looking forward **to meeting** you. (*to* = preposition)
- He objected **to being** called a liar.

14.3.3 Possessive before the Gerund

In formal English, a noun or pronoun before a gerund takes the **possessive** form (because the gerund is a noun).

- I don't like **his** coming late. (✘ him coming late — informal)
- Do you mind **my** smoking here?
- I was surprised at **Rahim's** failing the exam.
- We insisted on **their** staying for dinner.

14.3.4 Verbs Followed Only by the Gerund

admit, anticipate, appreciate, avoid, consider, defer, delay, deny, detest, dislike, enjoy, escape, excuse, fancy, finish, forgive, give up, imagine, involve, keep (on), mention, mind, miss, pardon, postpone, practise, prevent, quit, recall, recollect, recommend, report, resent, resist, risk, stop (= cease), suggest, tolerate, understand

Phrases followed by the gerund: *can't help, can't stand, can't bear (also inf.), it's no use, it's no good, it's worth, there's no point in, be busy, feel like, look forward to, be used to, get used to, object to, with a view to, be accustomed to, be averse to, be addicted to, confess to, be committed to, take to, devote oneself to, in addition to.*

- ✘ I enjoy **to read**. ✔ I enjoy **reading**.
- ✘ He avoided **to meet** me. ✔ He avoided **meeting** me.
- ✘ Would you mind **to open** the window? ✔ Would you mind **opening** the window?
- ✘ I can't help **to laugh**. ✔ I can't help **laughing**.
- ✘ It's no use **to cry** over spilt milk. ✔ It's no use **crying** over spilt milk.
- ✘ This book is worth **to read**. ✔ This book is worth **reading**.
- ✘ He suggested **to go** for a walk. ✔ He suggested **going** for a walk.
- ✘ I look forward to **hear** from you. ✔ I look forward to **hearing** from you.
- ✘ He came here with a view to **see** me. ✔ He came here with a view to **seeing** me.
- ✘ He is addicted to **drink**. ✔ He is addicted to **drinking** (or to *drink* the noun = alcohol ✔).

14.3.5 Verbs Followed Only by the Infinitive

afford, agree, aim, appear, arrange, ask, attempt, beg, care, choose, claim, consent, decide, demand, deserve, determine, endeavour, expect, fail, hesitate, hope, intend, learn, long, manage, neglect, offer, plan, prepare, pretend, proceed, promise, prove, refuse, resolve, seek, seem, strive, swear, tend, threaten, undertake, venture, volunteer, vow, want, wish, would like.

- He **decided to** resign. / They **agreed to** help. / She **refused to** sign. / I **hope to** see you soon. / He **pretended to** be ill. / We **can't afford to** buy a car.

14.3.6 Verbs Followed by Either (Change in Meaning)

Verb	+ Gerund	+ Infinitive
remember	memory of a past action: *I remember* **posting** *the letter.* (I posted it and I recall it.)	duty, not to forget (future): *Remember* **to post** *the letter.*
forget	forget a past experience: *I'll never forget* **visiting** *the Taj Mahal.*	fail to do: *I forgot* **to lock** *the door.*
stop	quit an activity: *He stopped* **smoking**.	stop in order to do something else: *He stopped* **to smoke**.
try	experiment, test: *Try* **adding** *some salt.*	make an effort: *I tried* **to lift** *the box but couldn't.*
regret	be sorry about the past: *I regret* **telling** *him the secret.*	be sorry to announce: *I regret* **to inform** *you that you have failed.*
mean	involve: *Missing the bus means* **walking** *home.*	intend: *I meant* **to call** *you.*
go on	continue the same activity: *He went on* **talking**.	move on to a new activity: *After the speech, he went on* **to answer** *questions.*
need	passive meaning: *The car needs* **washing**. (= needs to be washed)	active: *I need* **to wash** *the car.*
like	enjoy (habit): *I like* **swimming**.	choose/think it right: *I like* **to see** *the dentist twice a year.*
be afraid of / be afraid to	fear something may happen: *I'm afraid of* **falling**.	be unwilling to do because of fear: *I'm afraid* **to jump**.
used to / be used to	*be used to* **working** (accustomed)	*used to* **work** (past habit)

Little or no change in meaning: *begin, start, continue, love, hate, prefer, intend, propose, can't bear, attempt — It began* **raining / to rain**.

14.4 The Participle

A **participle** is a verb form that works partly as a **verb** and partly as an **adjective**. It is a "verbal adjective".

14.4.1 Kinds of Participles

Kind	Form	Active/Passive	Example
Present participle	V + ing	active meaning, ongoing	a **sleeping** child, a **rolling** stone
Past participle	V3	passive or completed meaning	a **broken** chair, **fallen** leaves, a **lost** child
Perfect participle (active)	having + V3	action completed before another	**Having finished** his work, he went out.
Perfect participle (passive)	having been + V3	completed passive action	**Having been warned** twice, he was dismissed.

14.4.2 Uses of Participles

(a) As an adjective before a noun (attributive): *a* **burning** *house, a* **running** *train, a* **smiling** *face, the* **rising** *sun, a* **written** *test, a* **broken** *promise, a* **wounded** *soldier, a* **retired** *officer.*

(b) As a predicative adjective (after a linking verb): *The news is* **shocking**. *He seemed* **worried**. *The baby kept* **crying**.

(c) As part of a participial phrase qualifying a noun (reduced relative clause):

- The man **standing at the gate** is my uncle. (= who is standing)
- I saw a boy **crying for help**.
- The book **written by Tagore** is famous. (= which was written)
- Goods **made in Bangladesh** are sold abroad.

(d) In continuous tenses and the passive (with *be/have*): *He is* **reading**. *The letter was* **written**. *He has* **gone**.

(e) Adverbial participle phrases (time, reason, condition, manner, concession):

- **Walking along the road**, I met an old friend. (time: when I was walking)
- **Being ill**, he could not attend the class. (reason: as he was ill)
- **Having lost** all his money, he returned home. (time/reason: after he had lost)
- **Turning to the left**, you will find the post office. (condition: if you turn)
- He came **running**. (manner)
- **Admitting** what you say, I still cannot agree. (concession)

> **The subject of the participle must be the subject of the main clause.** Otherwise the participle "dangles" (has nothing to attach to) and makes the sentence wrong — often absurd.
>
> ✘ **Walking along the road**, *a snake bit him.* (The snake was not walking!) ✔ **Walking along the road**, *he was bitten by a snake.* / *While he was walking along the road, a snake bit him.*
>
> See Chapter 29 (Dangling Modifier).

14.4.3 The Absolute Construction (Nominative Absolute)

When a participle has **its own subject** (different from the subject of the main clause), the phrase is called an **absolute phrase** (or *nominative absolute*). It is grammatically independent and usually shows time, reason or condition.

- **The sun having set**, we returned home. (= When the sun had set)
- **The weather being fine**, we went for a picnic. (= As the weather was fine)
- **God willing**, we shall meet again. (= If God wills)
- **The teacher entering the room**, the students stood up.
- **All things considered**, the plan is good.
- **Weather permitting**, the match will be held tomorrow.

> In the absolute construction the noun/pronoun is in the **nominative** case: ✘ *Him being absent, the meeting was postponed.* ✔ **He being absent**, *the meeting was postponed.*

14.4.4 Present Participle vs Past Participle (Active vs Passive Meaning)

Present participle (active: doing)	Past participle (passive: done to)
a **boring** lecture (it bores us)	**bored** students (they are bored)
an **interesting** book	an **interested** reader
a **frightening** dream	a **frightened** child
a **loving** mother	a **loved** mother
the **governing** body	the **governed** people
falling leaves (in the act of falling)	**fallen** leaves (already on the ground)

14.5 Gerund vs Present Participle — How to Tell Them Apart

Both end in *-ing*. Ask: **Is it working as a noun or as an adjective/verb?**

Test	Gerund (noun)	Present participle (adjective/verb)
Can it be replaced by a noun / *it*?	**Swimming** is fun. → *It* is fun. ✔	—
Does it show the **purpose** of the noun after it?	a **walking** stick = a stick **for** walking	a **walking** man = a man **who is** walking
Is it after a preposition?	fond **of reading**	—
Is it part of a continuous tense?	—	He **is reading**.
Does it describe a noun (= *which/who is …ing*)?	—	a **barking** dog = a dog that barks

- **Reading** is my hobby. → gerund (subject)
- I saw a boy **reading** a book. → participle (describes *boy*)
- a **dancing** girl (a girl who is dancing) → participle / a **dancing** hall (a hall for dancing) → gerund
- a **swimming** fish (participle) / a **swimming** pool (gerund)
- a **sleeping** child (participle) / a **sleeping** pill (gerund)
- a **drinking** man (participle) / **drinking** water (gerund — water for drinking)
- a **running** horse (participle) / **running** shoes (gerund)

14.6 Verbal Nouns (vs Gerunds)

A **verbal noun** also ends in *-ing*, but it behaves **fully as a noun**: it takes an article (*the*) and an *of*-phrase, and cannot take a direct object.

- **The reading of** novels is a pastime. (verbal noun)
- **Reading** novels is a pastime. (gerund — takes object *novels*)
- **The killing of** birds is prohibited. / **Killing** birds is prohibited.
- ✘ **The reading** novels / ✘ **Reading of** novels (mixed forms) — choose one pattern.

14.7 Common Errors with Infinitives, Gerunds and Participles

1. ✘ He is fond **to swim**. ✔ He is fond **of swimming**.
2. ✘ I am looking forward **to see** you. ✔ … **to seeing** you.
3. ✘ She avoided **to answer**. ✔ She avoided **answering**.
4. ✘ He made me **to wait**. ✔ He made me **wait**.
5. ✘ I am used to **work** at night. ✔ I am used to **working** at night.
6. ✘ It is no use **to try**. ✔ It is no use **trying**.
7. ✘ **Being** a rainy day, we stayed at home. ✔ **It being** a rainy day, we stayed at home.
8. ✘ **Reaching** the station, the train had left. ✔ **Reaching** the station, I found that the train had left.
9. ✘ I don't mind **him** smoking (formal). ✔ I don't mind **his** smoking.
10. ✘ He insisted **to pay**. ✔ He insisted **on paying**.
11. ✘ He prevented me **to go**. ✔ He prevented me **from going**.
12. ✘ She is capable **to do** it. ✔ She is capable **of doing** it.
13. ✘ The box is too heavy for me to lift **it**. ✔ The box is too heavy for me to lift.
14. ✘ I saw him **to go**. ✔ I saw him **go** / **going**.
15. ✘ He refused **paying** the bill. ✔ He refused **to pay** the bill.
16. ✘ We decided **going** to Cox's Bazar. ✔ We decided **to go** to Cox's Bazar.
17. ✘ He stopped **to smoke** (meaning he quit). ✔ He stopped **smoking**.
18. ✘ I prefer **to walk than ride**. ✔ I prefer **walking to riding**. / I prefer **to walk rather than ride**.
19. ✘ He is busy **to write** letters. ✔ He is busy **writing** letters.
20. ✘ He came here with a view **to see** me. ✔ He came here with a view **to seeing** me.
21. ✘ The **interested** novel kept me awake. ✔ The **interesting** novel kept me awake.
22. ✘ After **finished** the work, he left. ✔ After **finishing** the work, he left. / After **he had finished** …
23. ✘ **Him** being ill, we postponed the trip. ✔ **He** being ill, we postponed the trip.
24. ✘ He was seen **steal** the money. ✔ He was seen **to steal** the money.
25. ✘ It is time **for going** to bed. ✔ It is time **to go** to bed.

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Idiomatic Infinitive vs Gerund: The GMAT idiom list is full of these: **“ability to”** (✘ ability of doing), **“capable of”** + V-ing, **“forbid X to do”** (✘ forbid from), **“prohibit X from doing”**, **“prevent X from doing”**, **“require X to do”**, **“in an attempt to”**, **“the attempt to”**, **“consider X Y”** (no *as* / *to be* in strict style), **“a tendency to”**, **“responsible for”** + V-ing, **“credit X with doing”**. And remember the GMAT’s dislike of the *-ing* form where a finite verb or a noun is clearer: ✘ *“The rising of prices…”* ✔ *“The rise in prices…”*.

CHAPTER 15

Adverb

Part A · Grammar

15.1 Definition

An **adverb** is a word that **modifies** (adds to the meaning of) a **verb, an adjective, another adverb**, a preposition, a conjunction, a phrase, or a whole sentence. The word means "added to a verb" (Latin *ad* = to + *verbum* = verb), because most adverbs modify verbs.

- She sings **sweetly**. (modifies the verb *sings*)
- He is **very** clever. (modifies the adjective *clever*)
- He walks **quite** slowly. (modifies the adverb *slowly*)
- The cat jumped **right** over the wall. (modifies the preposition *over*)
- He left **just** before I arrived. (modifies the conjunction *before*)
- He was punished **only** for his rudeness. (modifies the phrase)
- **Unfortunately**, the train was late. (modifies the whole sentence)

> **An adverb never modifies a noun or pronoun** — that is the job of an adjective. ✘ *He is a* **really** *man.* ✔ *He is a* **real** *man.* But adverbs like *only, even, also, almost, quite, just* can focus on a noun phrase: **Only** *Rahim passed.* **Even** *a child knows this.*

15.2 Kinds of Adverbs (by Meaning)

Kind	Question answered	Examples
Manner	How?	quickly, slowly, carefully, well, badly, fast, hard, loudly, bravely, happily, so, thus
Time	When?	now, then, today, yesterday, tomorrow, soon, late, early, already, yet, still, before, ago, lately, recently, since
Place	Where?	here, there, everywhere, nowhere, up, down, in, out, above, below, near, far, away, abroad, inside, outside, upstairs
Frequency	How often?	always, usually, often, frequently, generally, sometimes, occasionally, seldom, rarely, hardly ever, never, once, twice, daily, weekly
Degree / Quantity	How much? To what extent?	very, too, so, quite, rather, fairly, almost, nearly, enough, much, extremely, completely, hardly, scarcely, barely, entirely, partly
Affirmation / Negation	—	yes, certainly, surely, indeed, of course, no, not, never
Reason / Consequence	Why?	therefore, hence, consequently, so, thus
Interrogative	(asks questions)	when, where, why, how, how often, how long
Relative	(joins clauses)	when, where, why, how — *This is the house* **where** *I was born.*
Sentence / Viewpoint	(comments on the whole)	fortunately, luckily, frankly, honestly, obviously, evidently, surely, perhaps, probably

15.3 Formation of Adverbs

15.3.1 Adjective + *-ly*

Rule	Examples
Most adjectives: add *-ly*	quick → quickly, careful → carefully, brave → bravely, sad → sadly
Ending in *-y* (consonant + y): *y* → *ily*	happy → happily, easy → easily, busy → busily, heavy → heavily
Ending in *-le*: drop *e*, add *y*	simple → simply, gentle → gently, able → ably, possible → possibly
Ending in *-ic*: add *-ally*	basic → basically, tragic → tragically, scientific → scientifically (exception: public → publicly)
Ending in *-ll*: add *-y*	full → fully, dull → dully
Ending in *-ue*: drop *e*	true → truly, due → duly
Others	whole → wholly, shy → shyly, sly → slyly, dry → drily/dryly

15.3.2 Adverbs with the Same Form as Adjectives (Flat Adverbs)

fast, hard, late, early, high, low, near, far, long, straight, right, wrong, deep, daily, weekly, monthly, yearly, kindly, well, little, much, enough, loud, clean, direct, free, tight, wide.

Word	As adjective	As adverb
fast	a **fast** train	He runs **fast**.
hard	a **hard** task	He works **hard**.
late	the **late** train	He came **late**.
early	an **early** riser	She gets up **early**.
straight	a **straight** line	Go **straight** home.
daily	a **daily** newspaper	It is published **daily**.
well	I am **well**. (healthy)	She sings **well**.

> **Well** is the adverb of **good**: *He is a* **good** *player; he plays* **well**. (✘ plays good). But *well* is also an adjective meaning *healthy*: *I don't feel* **well**.

15.3.3 Pairs with Different Meanings (Very Frequently Tested)

Without *-ly*	With *-ly*
hard = with effort: *He works* **hard**.	**hardly** = almost not: *He* **hardly** *works.*
late = not early: *He came* **late**.	**lately** = recently: *I haven't seen him* **lately**.
near = close: *Come* **near**.	**nearly** = almost: *I* **nearly** *fell.*
high = at a height: *The bird flew* **high**.	**highly** = very much: *He is* **highly** *educated.*
short = suddenly: *He stopped* **short**.	**shortly** = soon: *He will arrive* **shortly**.
deep = far down: *He dug* **deep**.	**deeply** = greatly: *I am* **deeply** *sorry.*
free = without cost: *Children travel* **free**.	**freely** = without restriction: *Speak* **freely**.
most = superlative: *What I like* **most** *is…*	**mostly** = mainly: *The audience were* **mostly** *students.*
wide = fully: *Open the door* **wide**.	**widely** = in many places: *He has travelled* **widely**.
close = near: *Stay* **close**.	**closely** = carefully: *Watch* **closely**.
just = exactly/recently: *He has* **just** *left.*	**justly** = fairly: *He was* **justly** *punished.*
pretty = fairly: *It's* **pretty** *good.*	**prettily** = attractively: *She was* **prettily** *dressed.*

- ✘ He worked **hardly** and passed. ✔ He worked **hard** and passed.
- ✘ He is **high** educated. ✔ He is **highly** educated.

- ✘ I have not seen him **late**. ✔ I have not seen him **lately**.

15.4 Position of Adverbs

15.4.1 Adverbs of Manner, Place and Time — the "MPT" Order

When several adverbs come at the end of a clause, the usual order is **Manner → Place → Time** (MPT).

- He sang **beautifully** (M) **at the concert** (P) **last night** (T).
- She worked **hard** (M) **in the office** (P) **yesterday** (T).
- ✘ He went yesterday to Dhaka by bus. ✔ He went **to Dhaka** (P) **by bus** (M — with verbs of movement, place often comes first) **yesterday** (T).

> With verbs of movement (*go, come, arrive, leave*), **place** usually comes before manner: *He went* **home quickly**. *She came* **here by bus**.

15.4.2 Adverbs of Frequency (and *already, almost, just, never, also, only, even, still*)

They go:

- **before the main verb**: *He* **always** *comes late. I* **often** *visit my village.*
- **after *am / is / are / was / were***: *He is* **always** *late. She was* **never** *rude.*
- **after the first auxiliary**: *I have* **never** *seen a tiger. He can* **hardly** *walk. You should* **always** *tell the truth.*

- ✘ He **comes always** late. ✔ He **always comes** late.
- ✘ She **always is** punctual. ✔ She **is always** punctual.
- ✘ I **never have** seen it. ✔ I **have never** seen it.
- **Sometimes, usually, often, occasionally** can also start a sentence: **Sometimes** *I walk to work.* (But not *always, never, seldom, ever*: ✘ *Always I go.*)

15.4.3 Adverbs Modifying Adjectives/Adverbs

They come **before** the word they modify: *very good, extremely hot, quite well, too fast.* Exception: **enough** comes **after**: *good* **enough**, *fast* **enough** (✘ enough good).

15.4.4 The Position of *Only* (Meaning Changes!)

Only should be placed **immediately before** the word it modifies. Moving it changes the meaning:

- **Only** I saw him yesterday. (No one else saw him.)
- I **only** saw him yesterday. (I did not speak to him — only saw.)
- I saw **only** him yesterday. (I saw nobody else.)
- I saw him **only** yesterday. (It was as recent as yesterday.)
- ✘ He **only** has ten taka (meaning: he has no more). ✔ He has **only** ten taka.

The same applies to *even, just, almost, nearly, merely, hardly, scarcely*: *He* **almost** *ate the whole cake* vs *He ate* **almost** *the whole cake.*

15.4.5 Adverbs at the Start of a Sentence — Inversion

When negative or restrictive adverbs (*never, seldom, rarely, hardly, scarcely, no sooner, not only, little, nowhere, only then*) begin a sentence, the subject and auxiliary are **inverted**: **Never have I** *seen such a sight.* **Seldom does he** *come here.* (Chapter 16.)

15.5 Comparison of Adverbs

Type	Positive	Comparative	Superlative
One-syllable (and *early*)	fast, hard, soon, late, early	faster, harder, sooner, later, earlier	fastest, hardest, soonest, latest, earliest
Adverbs in *-ly*	carefully, quickly, beautifully	more carefully, more quickly	most carefully, most quickly
Irregular	well	better	best
	badly	worse	worst
	much	more	most
	little	less	least
	far	farther / further	farthest / furthest

- ✘ He ran **more fast** than me. ✔ He ran **faster** than me.
- ✘ She sings **more good** than her sister. ✔ She sings **better** than her sister.
- ✘ He drives **carefullier**. ✔ He drives **more carefully**.

15.6 Some Important Adverbs and Their Correct Use

15.6.1 *Very* and *Much*

Very	*Much*
with **positive** adjectives/adverbs: *very good, very fast*	with **comparatives**: *much better, much faster*; and with *too*: *much too heavy*
with **present participles** used as adjectives: *very interesting, very charming*	with **past participles** (verbal sense): *much admired, much obliged, much pleased* (also *very pleased*)
—	before *superlatives*: *much the best* (= by far)

- ✘ He is **very** better now. ✔ He is **much** better now.
- ✘ This is **much** interesting. ✔ This is **very** interesting.
- ✘ He was **very** praised. ✔ He was **much** praised.
- ✔ I am **very tired** / **very pleased** (adjectival participles — *very* accepted).

15.6.2 *Too* and *Very*

- **Very** = to a high degree (neutral): *It is* **very** *hot today.*
- **Too** = more than enough / excessively (negative result): *It is* **too** *hot to go out.*
- ✘ He is **too** kind (meaning *very* kind) → ✔ He is **very** kind. ✘ She is **too** beautiful (as praise) → ✔ She is **very** beautiful.
- *Too* also means *also* (at the end): *I like it* **too**.

15.6.3 *Too*, *Also*, *Either*, *As well*

- **Too** / **as well** — at the end of affirmative sentences: *He can swim* **too** / **as well**.
- **Also** — in mid-position: *He can* **also** *swim.*
- **Either** — at the end of **negative** sentences: *He can't swim* **either**. (✘ He can't swim too.)

15.6.4 *Enough*

Comes **after** adjectives and adverbs, **before** nouns: *He is old* **enough**. *She runs fast* **enough**. *We have* **enough** *money.*

15.6.5 *Ago*, *Before*, *Since*

- **Ago** — counts back from **now**; used with the **simple past**: *I met him two years* **ago**. (✘ I have met him two years ago.)
- **Before** — counts back from a **past point**; used with the **past perfect**: *He said he had met her two years* **before**. Or simply *earlier, previously*: *I have seen him* **before**.
- **Since** — from a point in time up to now (perfect tenses): *I have known him* **since** *2015.*

- ✘ He came here **before** two days. ✔ He came here two days **ago**.
- ✘ He **has left** an hour ago. ✔ He **left** an hour ago.

15.6.6 *Already*, *Yet*, *Still*

- **Already** — sooner than expected (affirmative): *He has* **already** *finished.*
- **Yet** — up to now (negatives and questions, end position): *He hasn't come* **yet**. *Has he come* **yet**?
- **Still** — continuing (mid-position): *He is* **still** *sleeping. He* **still** *hasn't paid.* (stronger negative than *yet*)

15.6.7 *Hardly*, *Scarcely*, *Barely*, *Seldom*, *Rarely* — Negative Adverbs

These already have a **negative meaning**, so they must **not** be used with *not / no / never* (double negative):

- ✘ I **can't hardly** believe it. ✔ I **can hardly** believe it.
- ✘ He **seldom or ever** comes. ✔ He **seldom, if ever,** comes. / He **seldom or never** comes.
- ✘ **Hardly** had he arrived **than** it began to rain. ✔ **Hardly** had he arrived **when** it began to rain.
- ✘ **Scarcely no** people came. ✔ **Scarcely any** people came. (*scarcely any* = almost no)
- Tag question after a negative adverb is positive: *He* **hardly** *works,* **does he**?

15.6.8 *So* and *Such*

- **So** + adjective/adverb: *He is* **so** *tired. She ran* **so** *fast.*
- **Such** + (a/an) + adjective + noun: *He is* **such** *a tired man. They are* **such** *good friends.*
- **So … that / such … that** for result: *He was* **so** *weak* **that** *he couldn't walk. It was* **such** *a hot day* **that** *we stayed in.*
- ✘ He is **so** a good man. ✔ He is **such** a good man. / He is **so** good **a** man (formal).

15.6.9 *Quite*, *Rather*, *Fairly*, *Pretty*

- **Fairly** — positive, moderate: *The film was* **fairly** *good.*
- **Rather** — often with unpleasant ideas or "more than expected": *It is* **rather** *cold. The exam was* **rather** *difficult.* With comparatives: **rather** *better*.
- **Quite** — (a) completely with absolute adjectives: **quite** *right,* **quite** *impossible*; (b) fairly with gradable ones: **quite** *good*.
- **Pretty** — informal, like *rather/fairly*: **pretty** *good.*

15.6.10 *Else* and *Than*

Else is followed by **but**, not *than*: ✘ *It is nothing else than pride.* ✔ *It is nothing else* **but** *pride.* (Also ✔ *nothing* **other than** *pride*.)

15.6.11 *Ever* and *Never*

- **Ever** = at any time (questions, negatives, comparisons): *Have you* **ever** *been to Sylhet? It is the best film I have* **ever** *seen.*
- **Never** = at no time: *I have* **never** *been there.*
- ✘ He is the best man I have **never** met. ✔ … I have **ever** met.

15.6.12 *Abroad*, *Home*, *Upstairs*, *Downstairs*, *Downtown* — no preposition

- ✘ He went **to abroad**. ✔ He went **abroad**.
- ✘ He came **to home**. ✔ He came **home**.
- ✘ She went **to upstairs**. ✔ She went **upstairs**.
- ✔ He is **at home**. (static — *at* is used)

15.7 Adverb Clauses and Phrases (Introduction)

An adverb can be a single word (*quickly*), a phrase (*with great care, in the morning*) or a clause (*when he came, because it rained*). Adverb clauses are discussed in **Chapter 31**; they are classified as time, place, reason, purpose, result, condition, concession, comparison and manner.

15.8 Conjunctive Adverbs (Sentence Connectors)

However, therefore, moreover, furthermore, nevertheless, nonetheless, consequently, otherwise, besides, hence, thus, meanwhile, still, then, instead, accordingly, indeed — these join ideas between **sentences** or independent clauses but are **not conjunctions**. Between two independent clauses they need a **semicolon** (or a full stop), followed by a comma.

- ✘ He was ill, **however** he attended the meeting. (comma splice) ✔ He was ill; **however**, he attended the meeting.
- ✔ He was ill. **Nevertheless**, he attended the meeting.
- ✔ It was raining; **therefore**, the match was postponed.

15.9 Common Errors with Adverbs

1. ✘ He speaks English **good**. ✔ He speaks English **well**.
2. ✘ She sings **sweet**. ✔ She sings **sweetly**.
3. ✘ He is **very** stronger than me. ✔ He is **much** stronger than me.
4. ✘ He worked **hardly** and passed. ✔ He worked **hard** and passed.
5. ✘ He came here **before** three days. ✔ He came here three days **ago**.
6. ✘ He **always is** late. ✔ He **is always** late.
7. ✘ I **can't hardly** hear you. ✔ I **can hardly** hear you.
8. ✘ He is **enough** strong. ✔ He is strong **enough**.
9. ✘ He went **to abroad** last year. ✔ He went **abroad** last year.
10. ✘ It is **too** hot today (meaning *very*). ✔ It is **very** hot today.
11. ✘ I don't like it **too**. ✔ I don't like it **either**.
12. ✘ He has **lately** come. ✔ He has come **late** / He has **recently** come.
13. ✘ She is **too** much beautiful. ✔ She is **very** beautiful.
14. ✘ He **seldom or ever** visits us. ✔ He **seldom, if ever,** visits us.
15. ✘ He is **highly** educated **from** Oxford. ✔ He was educated **at** Oxford. / He is **highly** educated.
16. ✘ He drove **careful**. ✔ He drove **carefully**.
17. ✘ This is the best book I have **never** read. ✔ … I have **ever** read.
18. ✘ He **only** died yesterday (meaning: as recently as yesterday). ✔ He died **only** yesterday.
19. ✘ **At first** I will discuss the causes, then the effects. ✔ **First**, I will discuss the causes, then the effects. (*At first* = in the beginning, as opposed to later.)
20. ✘ He returned **back** from Dhaka. ✔ He returned from Dhaka. (redundant *back*)

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Adjective/Adverb Confusion and Placement: SAT Writing questions frequently ask you to choose between an adjective and an adverb: ✘ "The new policy was implemented **quick**." ✔ "…implemented **quickly**." ✘ "a **real** impressive result" ✔ "a **really** impressive result". The GMAT tests the **placement** of *only*: ✘ "The company only hired three engineers last year." (ambiguous) ✔ "The company hired **only three** engineers last year." On the GRE, conjunctive adverbs (*however, moreover, consequently, nonetheless*) are the key "signal words" that reveal whether the next sentence continues or reverses the argument.

CHAPTER 16

Inversion

Part A · Grammar

16.1 What Is Inversion?

In a normal English statement, the **subject comes before the verb**: *He* **is** *happy. I* **have** *never seen such a sight.* **Inversion** means reversing this order — putting the **verb (or the auxiliary) before the subject**.

- Normal: I have **never** seen such a sight.
- Inverted: **Never have I** seen such a sight.

There are two types:

1. **Subject–auxiliary inversion** — only the auxiliary (*be, have, do, can, will…*) moves before the subject: **Never have I** *seen…* / **Seldom does he** *come…*
2. **Subject–verb (full) inversion** — the whole main verb moves before the subject (usually with *be* or verbs of place/movement): **Here comes** *the bus.* / **On the hill stood** *an old castle.*

Inversion is used in questions, in some conditionals, after negative/restrictive adverbs placed first, for emphasis and in literary style. It is a regular item in BCS, Bank and university admission tests (often as error detection: *"Seldom he comes here"*), and it is an important topic in SAT/GRE/GMAT sentence correction and reading.

16.2 Inversion in Questions

Questions are the most common form of inversion.

- **Are you** ready? / **Has he** come? / **Can she** swim? / **Will they** go?
- With ordinary verbs, *do/does/did* is added: **Does he** live here? **Did you** see him?
- Wh-questions: Where **are you** going? What **did he** say? Why **is she** crying?

> **No inversion when the wh-word is the subject:** *Who* **broke** *the glass?* (✘ Who did break…) / *What* **happened**? (✘ What did happen?)
>
> **No inversion in indirect (embedded) questions:** ✘ *I don't know where* **is he**. ✔ *I don't know where* **he is**. (Chapter 37.)

16.3 Inversion after Negative and Restrictive Adverbials at the Beginning

When a **negative** or **restrictive** word or phrase is placed **at the beginning** of a sentence for emphasis, **subject–auxiliary inversion** is compulsory. This is the most tested type.

16.3.1 The Trigger Words

Never, never before, seldom, rarely, hardly, scarcely, barely, little, no sooner, not only, not until, not once, nowhere, nor, neither, at no time, in no way, on no account, under no circumstances, in no case, by no means, only then, only after, only when, only by, only in this way, only if, not a single (word), not till, no longer, few times.

Normal order	Inverted (emphatic) order
I have never seen such a beautiful place.	**Never have I** seen such a beautiful place.
He seldom comes here.	**Seldom does he** come here.
We rarely meet these days.	**Rarely do we** meet these days.
I little knew that he was a thief.	**Little did I** know that he was a thief.
He had hardly reached the station when the train left.	**Hardly had he** reached the station **when** the train left.
He had scarcely sat down when the phone rang.	**Scarcely had he** sat down **when** the phone rang.
He had no sooner arrived than he fell ill.	**No sooner had he** arrived **than** he fell ill.
He is not only intelligent but also hard-working.	**Not only is he** intelligent **but** he is **also** hard-working.
You must not open this door under any circumstances.	**Under no circumstances must you** open this door.
You should not leave the room on any account.	**On no account should you** leave the room.
I did not realise my mistake until he told me.	**Not until he told me did I** realise my mistake.
I could not find my keys anywhere.	**Nowhere could I** find my keys.
I understood the problem only then.	**Only then did I** understand the problem.
We can succeed only by working hard.	**Only by working hard can we** succeed.
He did not say a single word.	**Not a single word did he** say.
I will never trust him again.	**Never again will I** trust him.
He was in no way responsible.	**In no way was he** responsible.
We were at no time informed.	**At no time were we** informed.

> **Correlative pairs after inversion:**
>
> - **No sooner … than** (✘ no sooner … when / then)
> - **Hardly / Scarcely / Barely … when / before** (✘ hardly … than)
> - **Not only … but also**
>
> ✘ *No sooner had he left* **when** *it started raining.* ✔ … **than** it started raining.
>
> ✘ *Hardly had I reached home* **than** *it began to rain.* ✔ … **when** it began to rain.
>
> ✘ *No sooner* **he had** *left than…* ✔ *No sooner* **had he** *left than…* (inversion is required)

16.3.2 *Only* + Time/Manner Expressions

Inversion happens **in the main clause**, not in the *only* clause:

- **Only when** the teacher came **did the students** stop talking. (✘ only when did the teacher come)
- **Only after** he had left **did I** realise the truth.
- **Only if** you work hard **will you** succeed.
- **Only in Bangladesh can you** see the Royal Bengal Tiger in mangrove forests.

> *Only* at the start without a time/manner phrase does **not** cause inversion when it modifies the subject: **Only Rahim** *knows the answer.* (✘ Only does Rahim know.)

16.3.3 *Not until / Not till*

- **Not until** I saw it with my own eyes **did I** believe it.
- **Not till** midnight **did he** return.

16.4 Inversion with *So*, *Neither*, *Nor* (Short Additions)

To say that something is also true of another person, use **so** (affirmative) or **neither / nor** (negative) + auxiliary + subject.

- I like mangoes. — **So do I**. (✘ So I do — that means "Yes, I really do")
- He can swim. — **So can she**.
- She was tired. — **So were we**.
- I don't like fish. — **Neither do I**. / **Nor do I**.
- He hasn't finished. — **Neither has she**.
- Rahim can't drive, and **nor can** his brother.
- ✘ I don't like tea. — **So do I** ✘ / **Me too** (informal) → ✔ **Neither do I**.

Exam Tip — *So do I* vs *So I do*. *So do I* (inverted) = "I also do". *So I do* (normal order) = agreement/surprise: "You're working hard." — "**So I am!**" (= Yes, indeed I am).

16.5 Inversion in Conditional Sentences (Omitting *If*)

In formal English, *if* can be dropped from a conditional clause beginning with **were, had, should**, and the auxiliary moves before the subject.

With *if*	Inverted (without *if*)
If I were you, I would accept the offer.	**Were I** you, I would accept the offer.
If he had worked harder, he would have passed.	**Had he** worked harder, he would have passed.
If you should need any help, call me.	**Should you** need any help, call me.
If it were not for your help, I would fail.	**Were it not for** your help, I would fail.
If it had not been for the doctor, he would have died.	**Had it not been for** the doctor, he would have died.

In the negative inverted conditional, **not** is never contracted: ✘ *Hadn't he come…* ✔ **Had he not** *come, we would have been in trouble.*

Do not use *if* **and** inversion together: ✘ *If had I known…* ✔ *Had I known…*

16.6 Inversion after Adverbs of Place and Direction (Full Inversion)

When an adverb or adverbial phrase of **place/direction** comes first, the **main verb** (often *be, come, go, stand, lie, sit, live, run, fly*) is placed before a **noun** subject. This is common in literary style and in SAT/GRE reading passages.

- **Here comes** the bus. / **There goes** the train.
- **Down came** the rain. / **Up went** the prices.
- **In the middle of the room stood** a large table.
- **On the hill stands** an old temple.
- **Under the tree sat** an old man.
- **Away flew** the bird.
- **Into the room rushed** the children.
- **Round the corner came** a police car.

With a pronoun subject, there is no inversion: *Here* **it comes** *(✘ Here comes it). Away* **they went**. *Here* **he is**. *There* **she goes**.

16.7 Inversion with *There* + *be* (Existential Sentences)

There is not the real subject; the real subject follows the verb, and the verb agrees with it.

- **There is** a book on the table. / **There are** two books on the table.
- **There was** a king. / **There were** many people.
- **There seems to be** a problem. / **There seem to be** some problems.
- **There exist** many theories about this. (literary)
- ✘ **There is** many reasons. ✔ **There are** many reasons.

16.8 Inversion after *So* / *Such* + Adjective at the Start

For emphasis, **so + adjective/adverb** or **such + be** may begin a sentence, followed by inversion:

- He was **so** weak that he could not stand. → **So weak was he** that he could not stand.
- The storm was **so** violent that trees were uprooted. → **So violent was the storm** that trees were uprooted.
- His anger was such that he could not speak. → **Such was his anger** that he could not speak.
- **So beautifully did she** sing that everyone wept.

16.9 Inversion after Comparisons with *as* and *than* (Formal)

- She is very hard-working, **as are** her sisters. (= as her sisters are)
- He spent more money **than did** his brother. (formal; also *than his brother did*)
- City dwellers earn more **than do** villagers.

16.10 Inversion in Exclamations and Wishes

- **May you** live long! / **May Allah** bless you! (optative)
- **Long live** Bangladesh! (full inversion: *Long live* + subject)
- **How beautiful is** the moon tonight! (literary; normal: *How beautiful the moon is tonight!*)
- **Isn't it** lovely! / **Wasn't it** a wonderful show! (exclamatory questions)

16.11 Inversion after Direct Speech (Reporting Verb)

In stories, the reporting verb may come before a noun subject after a quotation:

- "Where are you going?" **asked the teacher**. (also *the teacher asked*)
- "I am innocent," **said the prisoner**.
- With pronouns: "I am innocent," **he said**. (✘ said he — archaic)

16.12 Inversion in Literary Style — Object or Complement First

For emphasis, poets and writers may place the object or complement first:

- **Blessed are** the meek. (complement first — Bible)
- **Gone are** the days when we were young.
- **Great was** our joy.
- **Strange are** the ways of fate.
- **Sweet are** the uses of adversity. (Shakespeare, *As You Like It*)

16.13 Common Errors in Inversion

1. ✘ Never **I have** seen such a thing. ✔ Never **have I** seen such a thing.
2. ✘ Seldom **he comes** here. ✔ Seldom **does he come** here.
3. ✘ No sooner **he had** reached the station than the train left. ✔ No sooner **had he** reached …
4. ✘ No sooner had he reached the station **when** the train left. ✔ … **than** the train left.
5. ✘ Hardly had he gone out **than** it began to rain. ✔ … **when** it began to rain.
6. ✘ Little **he knew** about the danger. ✔ Little **did he know** about the danger.
7. ✘ Not only **he is** rich but also generous. ✔ Not only **is he** rich but he is also generous. / He is not only rich but also generous.
8. ✘ Only then **I realised** my mistake. ✔ Only then **did I realise** my mistake.
9. ✘ Under no circumstances **you should** tell him. ✔ Under no circumstances **should you** tell him.
10. ✘ I don't like coffee. — **So do I**. ✔ **Neither do I**.
11. ✘ He can sing. — **So he can** (meaning *he also*) ✔ **So can she** / **So can I**.
12. ✘ **If had I** known, I would have come. ✔ **Had I** known, I would have come.
13. ✘ **Hadn't he** helped us, we would have failed. ✔ **Had he not** helped us …
14. ✘ Here **comes he**. ✔ Here **he comes**.
15. ✘ I asked him where **was he** going. ✔ I asked him where **he was** going.
16. ✘ Rarely **we see** such honesty. ✔ Rarely **do we see** such honesty.
17. ✘ Not until he apologised **she forgave** him. ✔ Not until he apologised **did she forgive** him.
18. ✘ Scarcely **I had** finished my lunch when he arrived. ✔ Scarcely **had I** finished …
19. ✘ Nowhere **you will** find a better place. ✔ Nowhere **will you** find a better place.
20. ✘ **Were I knew** the answer, I would tell you. ✔ **If I knew** the answer, I would tell you. / **Were I to know** the answer, I would tell you.

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Agreement in Inverted Sentences: In inverted sentences the subject comes **after** the verb, which makes subject-verb agreement harder to see — a favourite SAT/GMAT trap. ✘ "Among the most important discoveries of the decade **was** the vaccines developed in record time." The subject is *the vaccines* (plural), so ✔ "…**were** the vaccines…". ✘ "There **is** in the archives several letters…" ✔ "There **are** in the archives several letters…". Always find the true subject after the verb before choosing the verb form.

CHAPTER 17

Preposition

Part A · Grammar

17.1 Definition

A **preposition** is a word placed **before a noun or pronoun** (or a noun-equivalent) to show its **relation** to some other word in the sentence. The noun or pronoun that follows is called the **object of the preposition**, and the two together form a **prepositional phrase**.

- The book is **on** the table. (relation between *book* and *table* — place)
- He came **after** lunch. (time)
- She is fond **of** music. (fixed relation with *fond*)
- I went there **with** him. (accompaniment — object pronoun *him*)

The word *preposition* means "placed before" (Latin *prae* = before + *positio* = placing).

The object of a preposition is always in the objective case: *between you and* **me** (✘ I), *for* **him** (✘ he), *with* **them** (✘ they), *to* **whom** (✘ who).

A verb after a preposition takes the gerund (-ing) form: *fond of* **singing**, *without* **saying**, *before* **leaving**.

17.2 Kinds of Prepositions

Kind	Explanation	Examples
Simple	single, short words	at, by, for, from, in, of, off, on, out, to, up, with, till, through
Compound	formed by prefixing *a-* (on) or *be-* (by) to a noun, adjective or adverb	about, above, across, along, amid, among, around, before, behind, below, beneath, beside, between, beyond, inside, outside, within, without, underneath, throughout
Double	two simple prepositions together	into, onto, upon, from behind, from beneath, from among, out of, from within, till after
Participial	present/past participles used as prepositions	concerning, considering, regarding, respecting, touching, during, pending, notwithstanding, barring, excepting, following, given, past, owing (to)
Phrasal (complex)	groups of words acting as one preposition	according to, because of, by means of, by way of, in front of, in spite of, instead of, on account of, in addition to, in place of, with regard to, with reference to, in order to, owing to, due to, in favour of, for the sake of, in the event of, on behalf of, in comparison with, in accordance with, by virtue of, in lieu of, with a view to, as regards, apart from, as for
Disguised	shortened forms that look like articles	*a* = on/in (*He went* **a**-*hunting*; *ten taka* **a** *kilo* = per), *o'* = of (*five* **o'**clock)

- **Considering** his age, he did well. (participial)
- **During** the war, many people died. (participial)
- **In spite of** his illness, he attended. (phrasal)
- He was absent **on account of** illness. (phrasal)
- **Owing to** heavy rain, the match was cancelled. (phrasal)

17.3 Prepositions of Time

17.3.1 *At*, *On*, *In*

Preposition	Used with	Examples
at	a **point** of time; clock times; festivals (as periods); fixed expressions	at 6 o'clock, at noon, at midnight, at sunrise, at sunset, at dawn, at night, at present, at the moment, at the weekend (BrE), at Eid, at Christmas, at the end of, at the age of 20
on	**days and dates**; specific parts of a particular day	on Friday, on 16 December, on 21st February 1952, on my birthday, on Independence Day, on Friday morning, on the morning of 26 March, on time (= punctually)
in	**longer periods**: months, years, seasons, centuries, parts of the day (general); future time "after"	in May, in 1971, in winter, in the 19th century, in the morning, in the evening, in the afternoon, in a week (= after a week), in time (= early enough), in the past, in the future

- He was born **in** 1971, **on** 26 March, **at** 4 a.m.
- I will see you **in** the morning. / I will see you **on** Sunday morning.
- ✘ He will come **after** two days (meaning from now). ✔ He will come **in** two days. (*after* is used with past reference: *He came after two days.*)
- ✘ **In** night ✔ **At** night / ✔ **In** the night (= during a particular night)
- ✘ **On** the morning ✔ **In** the morning / ✔ **On** the morning **of** 21st February
- ✘ **At** Sunday ✔ **On** Sunday
- **No preposition** before *this*, *last*, *next*, *every*, *today*, *tomorrow*, *yesterday*: ✘ *on next Friday* ✔ *next Friday*; ✘ *in this week* ✔ *this week*; ✘ *at yesterday* ✔ *yesterday*.

On time vs in time. *On time* = punctually, at the scheduled moment: *The train arrived* **on time**. *In time* = early enough (before it is too late): *We reached the station* **in time** *to catch the train.*

17.3.2 *For*, *Since*, *From*

Preposition	Meaning	Tense	Examples
for	a **period / duration** of time	any tense (often perfect)	for two hours, for three days, for a long time, for ten years
since	a **point** of time in the past up to now	perfect tenses	since Monday, since 2015, since morning, since childhood, since 10 o'clock
from	starting point (with *to/till/until* or future)	any	from 9 to 5, from Monday to Friday, from now on, from tomorrow

- I have lived here **for** ten years. / I have lived here **since** 2015.
- He has been ill **since** last Friday. (✘ from last Friday)
- It has been raining **since** morning. (✘ from morning)
- The office remains open **from** 9 a.m. **to** 5 p.m.
- The new rule will come into effect **from** next month.
- ✘ He has been absent **from** three days. ✔ … **for** three days.

17.3.3 *During*, *For*, *While*

- **During** + noun (when something happens, within a period): **During** *the war, many people died.* / *I fell asleep* **during** *the film.*
- **For** + duration (how long): *I slept* **for** *two hours.*
- **While** is a **conjunction** + clause: **While** *I was watching the film, I fell asleep.* (✘ during I was watching)

17.3.4 *By*, *Until/Till*, *Before*, *Within*

- **By** = not later than (deadline): *Submit the form* **by** *Friday. He will have finished* **by** *next week.*
- **Until / Till** = up to (continuous action that stops): *Wait here* **until** *5 o'clock. He worked* **till** *midnight.*
- **Before** = earlier than: *Come* **before** *10 a.m.*
- **Within** = inside a limit of time: *Finish it* **within** *a week.*

› ✘ I'll stay here **by** Friday. ✔ I'll stay here **until** Friday.

› ✘ Return the book **until** Monday. ✔ Return the book **by** Monday.

17.3.5 *Ago* and *Before* (Adverbs — Chapter 15)

Two years **ago** (from now, past simple) / *two years* **before** (from a past point, past perfect).

17.4 Prepositions of Place and Position

17.4.1 *At*, *In*, *On*

Preposition	Used for	Examples
at	a **point / specific location**; small places; addresses with numbers; events; public places seen as points	at the door, at the bus stop, at the station, at the corner, at 25 Mirpur Road, at home, at school, at work, at the meeting, at a party, at the top, at the bottom
in	**inside** an enclosed space; large areas (cities, countries, continents)	in the room, in the box, in the garden, in Dhaka, in Bangladesh, in Asia, in the sky, in the world, in a car, in a taxi, in the newspaper, in a book, in the picture, in bed
on	a **surface**; lines (roads, rivers, coasts); floors; public transport; devices	on the table, on the wall, on the floor, on the roof, on the first floor, on the Padma (situated on the river), on the coast, on the road, on a bus/train/plane/ship, on a bicycle, on TV, on the radio, on the internet, on page 10, on the left/right

› He lives **in** Dhaka. He lives **at** 12 Green Road. He lives **on** Green Road (AmE) / **in** Green Road (BrE).

› She is **at** home. / She is **in** the house.

› ✘ He is **in** the bus. ✔ He is **on** the bus. (*in* a car / taxi, *on* a bus / train / plane)

› ✘ Write **in** the board. ✔ Write **on** the board.

› I read it **in** a newspaper. / I saw it **on** television.

› Rajshahi is **on** the Padma. (located beside the river)

> **Exam Tip — *arrive at* vs *arrive in*.** *Arrive* **at** a small place or building (*at the station, at the airport, at school*); *arrive* **in** a city or country (*in Dhaka, in London*). Never *arrive to*. *Reach* takes **no** preposition: ✘ *reach at Dhaka* ✔ *reach Dhaka*.

17.4.2 *In* vs *Into*; *On* vs *Onto*

- **In** = position (rest): *He is* **in** *the room.*
- **Into** = movement towards the inside: *He came* **into** *the room.* / *She jumped* **into** *the river.* / *Translate it* **into** *English.*
- **On** = position: *The cat is* **on** *the roof.*
- **Onto** = movement to a surface: *The cat jumped* **onto** *the roof.*

› ✘ He fell **in** the well (movement). ✔ He fell **into** the well.

› ✘ He is **into** the room. ✔ He is **in** the room.

› ✔ *Divide the cake* **into** *four pieces.* / *Change water* **into** *ice.*

17.4.3 *Between* and *Among*

- **Between** — for **two** persons/things (or more when each is considered individually in a relationship): *Divide the mangoes* **between** *the two boys. A treaty* **between** *three countries* (each with each). *Between you and* **me** (✘ I).
- **Among / Amongst** — for **more than two** considered as a group: *Divide the mangoes* **among** *the five boys. He is popular* **among** *students.*

› ✘ Divide the property **among** the two brothers. ✔ … **between** the two brothers.

› ✘ There was a quarrel **between** the members of the club (as a mass). ✔ … **among** the members.

› ✘ **Between** you and **I** ✔ **Between** you and **me**.

› ✔ **Between** 10 and 11 o'clock / **between** Dhaka and Chattogram

17.4.4 *Beside* and *Besides*

- **Beside** = by the side of, next to: *He sat* **beside** *me.* / *a house* **beside** *the river.* Also *beside the point* (irrelevant), *beside oneself* (with anger/joy).
- **Besides** = in addition to, apart from: **Besides** *English, he knows French.* / *Who came* **besides** *Rahim?* (As an adverb = moreover.)

17.4.5 *Above*, *Over*, *Below*, *Under*, *Beneath*, *Underneath*

Preposition	Meaning	Example
above	higher than (not touching, not directly over)	The plane flew **above** the clouds. / He is **above** 60. / Her marks are **above** average.
over	directly above / covering / across / more than	Hold an umbrella **over** her. / Spread a sheet **over** the bed. / He jumped **over** the wall. / **over** 100 people / The meeting is **over** (finished).
below	lower than (not necessarily directly under)	The sun sank **below** the horizon. / **below** zero / **below** average
under	directly beneath / covered by / less than / subject to	The cat is **under** the table. / **under** 18 / **under** construction / **under** the rule of
beneath	under (formal, literary); unworthy of	**beneath** the sea / It is **beneath** his dignity.
underneath	directly under (often hidden)	He found the letter **underneath** the carpet.

17.4.6 *Across*, *Through*, *Along*, *Over*

- **Across** = from one side to the other of a surface (a line, a flat area): *He swam* **across** *the river. He walked* **across** *the road.*
- **Through** = from one end to the other **inside** something (3-D: tunnel, forest, crowd, window): *The train passed* **through** *a tunnel. We walked* **through** *the forest. He looked* **through** *the window.*
- **Along** = following the length of: *We walked* **along** *the river bank.*
- **Over** = across, going above: *He jumped* **over** *the fence.*

17.4.7 Other Place Prepositions

Preposition	Example
in front of / behind	The car is **in front of** the house. / The garden is **behind** the house.
opposite	The bank is **opposite** the post office. (✘ opposite to — in BrE *opposite* takes no *to* as a preposition)
near / next to / by	He lives **near** the school. / Sit **next to** me. / a house **by** the lake
against	He leaned **against** the wall.

Preposition	Example
around / round	They sat **around** the fire. / The earth moves **round** the sun.
towards	He walked **towards** the door.
up / down	He ran **up** the stairs / **down** the hill.
out of / off	He came **out of** the room. / He fell **off** the horse. (✘ off of)
from	He came **from** Sylhet.
to	He went **to** Dhaka. (movement)
within / without	**within** the city / **without** money
beyond	**beyond** the river / **beyond** my understanding / **beyond** doubt
amid / amidst	**amid** the noise

17.5 Prepositions of Agent, Instrument and Manner: *By* and *With*

- **By** = the **doer** (agent) in the passive; means of transport; method: *The letter was written* **by** *Rahim.* / *travel* **by** *bus, by train, by air* / *pay* **by** *cheque* / *learn* **by** *heart* / *by mistake, by chance, by post*.
- **With** = the **instrument** used: *He killed the snake* **with** *a stick.* / *Write* **with** *a pen.* / *cut* **with** *a knife*.

› ✘ The snake was killed **by** a stick. ✔ The snake was killed **with** a stick (by Rahim).

› ✘ He wrote it **by** pencil. ✔ He wrote it **in** pencil / **with** a pencil.

› ✔ He came **on** foot (✘ by foot — common but non-standard in exam keys).

› ✔ **By** bus — but ✔ **in** my car / **on** the 9 o'clock bus (with determiner).

17.6 Prepositions of Cause, Reason and Purpose

Preposition	Example
of (cause of death)	He died **of** cholera / cancer / hunger / grief.
from (indirect cause)	He died **from** a wound / overwork / an accident (injury).
for (purpose, reason)	He was punished **for** stealing. / He is famous **for** his honesty. / Thank you **for** coming.
because of / owing to / due to / on account of	The match was cancelled **because of** rain.
through (agency, cause)	He got the job **through** his uncle. / He failed **through** laziness.
with (cause of feeling)	He is trembling **with** fear / shivering **with** cold.
out of (motive)	He did it **out of** curiosity / pity / jealousy.

> **Due to vs owing to.** Traditionally, *due to* is an adjective (= caused by) and must follow a noun or *be*: *His absence was* **due to** *illness. Owing to / because of* is used adverbially at the start: **Owing to** *illness, he was absent.* (✘ *Due to illness, he was absent* — common but marked wrong by strict keys.)

17.7 Some Frequently Confused Prepositions

Pair	Distinction
in / within	*in* a week (at the end of); *within* a week (before the end of)
of / off	*of* = belonging/part; *off* = away from: *He fell* **off** *the tree.*
with / by	instrument / agent
die of / die from	disease / external cause
suffer from (✘ suffer with/by)	*He is suffering* **from** *fever.*
angry with / angry at	*with* a person; *at* a thing/action: *angry* **with** *him,* **at** *his behaviour*
agree with / agree to / agree on	*with* a person/opinion; *to* a proposal; *on* a point/decision
compare with / compare to	*with* (examine differences/similarities); *to* (show likeness, metaphor)
differ from / differ with	*differ* **from** (be unlike); *differ* **with** a person (disagree)
part from / part with	*from* a person; *with* a thing
live on / live in / live at	*on* food/income; *in* a city; *at* an address
wait for / wait on	*for* someone (await); *on* someone (serve)
look at / look for / look after / look into / look up to	see / search / take care / investigate / respect
sorry for / sorry about	*for* a person; *about* a thing
disappointed with / in / at	*with* a person or thing; *at* a result
in the end / at the end	finally / at the final point (*at the end of the road*)
in the way / on the way	obstructing / during a journey

17.8 Position of Prepositions

The preposition usually comes **before** its object. But it may come at the **end** of a clause in these cases:

1. **Wh-questions** (informal): *Who are you looking* **for**? (formal: *For whom are you looking?*)
2. **Relative clauses** with *that* or omitted relative: *This is the house (that) I live* **in**. (✘ *the house in that I live*)
3. **Passive**: *He was laughed* **at**. *The child was looked* **after**.
4. **Infinitive phrases**: *He has no house to live* **in**. *Give me a pen to write* **with**.
5. **Exclamations / emphasis**: *What a mess you are* **in**!

> The old rule "never end a sentence with a preposition" is not followed in modern English; *What are you talking about?* is perfectly natural. But in the passive and with *in which / to whom*, choose one position only: ✘ *the house in which he lives in* ✔ *the house in which he lives / the house which he lives in.*

17.9 Words That Can Be Prepositions, Adverbs or Conjunctions

Word	Preposition	Adverb	Conjunction
after	He came **after** me.	He came soon **after**.	He came **after** I had left.
before	Come **before** 10.	I have seen him **before**.	Think **before** you speak.
since	**since** Monday	I haven't seen him **since**.	**Since** you are ill, rest.
till/until	Wait **till** five.	—	Wait **till** I come.
for	This is **for** you.	—	He felt sad, **for** he had failed.
but	All **but** him came.	He is **but** a child.	He is poor **but** honest.
up / down / in / out / on / off / over	He went **up** the stairs.	He looked **up**.	—

17.10 Unnecessary and Missing Prepositions

17.10.1 Verbs That Take No Preposition (Do Not Add One)

discuss, describe, reach, resemble, order, attack, enter (a place), approach, accompany, marry, request, obey, answer, comprise, consider, emphasise, investigate, mention, lack, demand, recommend, inform (+ person), enjoy, ask (a person), await, return (= come back), stress, combat.

› ✘ We discussed **about** the problem. ✔ We discussed the problem.

› ✘ He reached **at** the station. ✔ He reached the station.

› ✘ He resembles **to** his father. ✔ He resembles his father.

› ✘ He ordered **for** a coffee. ✔ He ordered a coffee.

- ✘ The enemy attacked **on** the city. ✔ The enemy attacked the city.
- ✘ He entered **into** the room. ✔ He entered the room.
- ✘ She married **with** a doctor. ✔ She married a doctor. / She **got married to** a doctor.
- ✘ He requested **for** help. ✔ He requested help. / He made a request **for** help.
- ✘ He lacks **in** confidence. ✔ He lacks confidence. / He is lacking **in** confidence.
- ✘ The book comprises **of** ten chapters. ✔ The book comprises ten chapters. / The book **consists of** / **is composed of** ten chapters.
- ✘ He emphasised **on** honesty. ✔ He emphasised honesty. / He laid emphasis **on** honesty.
- ✘ They **awaited for** the result. ✔ They awaited the result. / They **waited for** the result.

17.10.2 Prepositions Often Missed

- ✘ He listened the radio. ✔ He listened **to** the radio.
- ✘ He explained me the problem. ✔ He explained the problem **to** me.
- ✘ Please reply my letter. ✔ Please reply **to** my letter.
- ✘ He is not capable this work. ✔ He is not capable **of** this work.
- ✘ I am waiting you. ✔ I am waiting **for** you.
- ✘ He complained the noise. ✔ He complained **about / of** the noise.
- ✘ Let us dispense this formality. ✔ Let us dispense **with** this formality.
- ✘ He is senior me. ✔ He is senior **to** me.
- ✘ Search the lost book. (meaning *look for*) ✔ Search **for** the lost book. (*search the room* = examine the room)

17.11 Common Errors with Prepositions

1. ✘ He was born **in** 26 March. ✔ He was born **on** 26 March.
2. ✘ I will meet you **on** the evening. ✔ I will meet you **in** the evening.
3. ✘ He has been ill **from** Monday. ✔ He has been ill **since** Monday.
4. ✘ He has been living here **since** five years. ✔ … **for** five years.
5. ✘ The train arrived **in** time (= punctually). ✔ … **on** time.
6. ✘ Divide the apple **among** the two boys. ✔ … **between** the two boys.
7. ✘ **Beside** Bangla, he knows English. ✔ **Besides** Bangla, he knows English.
8. ✘ He jumped **in** the river (movement). ✔ He jumped **into** the river.
9. ✘ He died **from** cholera. ✔ He died **of** cholera.
10. ✘ He is suffering **with** fever. ✔ He is suffering **from** fever.
11. ✘ He is angry **on** me. ✔ He is angry **with** me.
12. ✘ He killed the bird **by** a stone. ✔ He killed the bird **with** a stone.
13. ✘ I prefer tea **than** coffee. ✔ I prefer tea **to** coffee.
14. ✘ He is good **in** English. ✔ He is good **at** English.
15. ✘ She is married **with** an engineer. ✔ She is married **to** an engineer.
16. ✘ He arrived **to** Dhaka yesterday. ✔ He arrived **in** Dhaka yesterday.
17. ✘ He is afraid **from** the dog. ✔ He is afraid **of** the dog.
18. ✘ I congratulate you **for** your success. ✔ I congratulate you **on** your success.
19. ✘ He insisted **for** going. ✔ He insisted **on** going.
20. ✘ He is fond **for** music. ✔ He is fond **of** music.
21. ✘ This is different **than** that (BrE exam). ✔ This is different **from** that.
22. ✘ He fell **off of** the horse. ✔ He fell **off** the horse.
23. ✘ Translate this **in** English. ✔ Translate this **into** English.
24. ✘ He walked **on** the road (meaning *along*). ✔ He walked **along** the road.
25. ✘ **Due to** rain, the match was postponed (strict). ✔ **Owing to** rain, the match was postponed.

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Prepositional Idioms: Both the SAT and GMAT test idiomatic prepositions: *responsible* **for**, *capable* **of**, *consistent* **with**, *independent* **of**, *distinguish X* **from** *Y*, *prohibit X* **from**, *a debate* **over/about**, *an increase* **in**, *a decline* **in**, *the ability* **to**, *credit X* **with**, *depend* **on**, *in contrast* **to/with**, *a preference* **for**. They also test **"between X and Y"** (✘ between X to Y) and **"from X to Y"** (✘ from X and Y). See Chapter 18 for a full list.

CHAPTER 18

Appropriate Preposition

Part A · Grammar

18.1 Why Learn “Appropriate Prepositions”?

Many English nouns, verbs and adjectives are followed by a **fixed preposition** — *fond* **of**, *interested* **in**, *depend* **on**, *agree* **with**, *capable* **of**. There is no logical rule that tells you which preposition to use; the combination is fixed by **usage (idiom)**. These combinations are tested in every BCS, Bank, university admission and job exam (“Fill in the blank with an appropriate preposition”) and form a large share of the **idiom** questions in the SAT, GRE and GMAT.

The best way to master them is to learn each word together with its preposition and a short example sentence. The list below is arranged **alphabetically**. When one word takes different prepositions with different meanings, all the patterns are shown together.

> **How to study this list:** Learn 30–40 entries a day. Cover the preposition with your finger and test yourself. Write your own sentence for every entry marked as tricky. Notice “families”: most *-ed* adjectives of feeling take *at / with / about* (*annoyed with, surprised at, worried about*); most words of ability take *of / at* (*capable of, good at*); words of dependence take *on/upon*.

18.2 The Master List (A–Z)

A

Abide by (obey, keep) — We must *abide by* the rules. **Abide with** (live/stay with — old use) — *Abide with* me.

Abound in / with — Our rivers *abound in* fish. / The forest *abounds with* wild animals.

Absent from — He was *absent from* the class yesterday.

Absorbed in — She was *absorbed in* her studies.

Abstain from — We should *abstain from* smoking.

Accede to (agree to) — The authority *acceded to* our demand.

Access to — Every citizen should have *access to* education.

Accompanied by (a person) / **with** (a thing) — He was *accompanied by* his wife. / The fever was *accompanied with* a headache.

Accord with (agree) — His words do not *accord with* his actions. **In accordance with** — *in accordance with* the law.

According to — *According to* the report, prices will rise.

Account for (explain) — How do you *account for* your absence? **Account to** (a person) — You must *account to* the manager *for* the money.

Accuse of — He was *accused of* theft. (✘ accused for)

Accustomed to (+ V-ing) — I am *accustomed to* working at night.

Acquainted with — Are you *acquainted with* this man?

Acquit of — The court *acquitted* him *of* the charge.

Adapt to — We must *adapt to* the new situation.

Adapted for (suitable for) / **from** (taken from) — The novel was *adapted for* television. / The film is *adapted from* a novel.

Add to — This *adds to* our difficulties.

Addicted to — He is *addicted to* gambling.

Adequate for / to — The food is *adequate for* ten people.

Adhere to — We must *adhere to* our principles.

Adjacent to — The school is *adjacent to* the mosque.

Admit to / into (a place, institution) — He was *admitted to (into)* the hospital. **Admit of** (allow) — The matter *admits of* no delay.

Afraid of — The child is *afraid of* the dark.

Agree with (a person, opinion) — I *agree with* you. **Agree to** (a proposal) — He *agreed to* my proposal. **Agree on / upon** (a point) — They *agreed on* the price. **Agree about** (a subject).

Aim at — He *aimed at* the target.

Akin to — Pity is *akin to* love.

Alarmed at — We were *alarmed at* the news.

Alien to — Such cruelty is *alien to* his nature.

Alight from — He *alighted from* the train.

Alive to (aware of) — He is *alive to* the danger.

Allergic to — She is *allergic to* dust.

Alternative to — There is no *alternative to* hard work.

Amazed at / by — I was *amazed at* his courage.

Amount to — The bill *amounts to* five thousand taka.

Angry with (a person) / **at** (a thing) / **about** (a matter) — He was *angry with* me *for* coming late. / He was *angry at* the insult.

Annoyed with (a person) / **at / about** (a thing) — I am *annoyed with* him *about* his rude behaviour.

Answer for (be responsible) — You will *answer for* this crime. **Answer to** (a name / a description) — The dog *answers to* the name “Tommy”.

Antidote to / for / against — Milk is an *antidote to* certain poisons.

Anxious about (worried) / **for** (eager) — She is *anxious about* her son’s health. / He is *anxious for* success.

Apologise to (a person) **for** (a fault) — He *apologised to* me *for* his mistake.

Appeal to (a person) **for** (a thing) — They *appealed to* the government *for* help. **Appeal against** (a decision).

Apply to (a person/office) **for** (a thing) — He *applied to* the Managing Director *for* the post.

Appointed to (a post) — He was *appointed to* the post of manager.

Approve of — My father does not *approve of* my plan.

Apt at (clever) / **to** (likely) — He is *apt at* learning languages. / He is *apt to* forget.

Argue with (a person) **about / over** (a thing) — Don’t *argue with* him *about* politics.

Arrive at (a small place) / **in** (a big place) — He *arrived at* the station. / He *arrived in* Dhaka.

Ashamed of — He is *ashamed of* his conduct.

Aspire to / after — He *aspires to* become a writer.

Assent to — The President gave his *assent to* the bill.

Assist in — He *assisted* me *in* my work.

Associate with — Do not *associate with* bad people.

Assure of — I *assure* you *of* my support.

Astonished at — We were *astonished at* his success.

Attached to — He is deeply *attached to* his mother.

Attain to (formal) — He *attained to* great fame.

Attend to (pay attention / deal with) — *Attend to* your studies. **Attend on / upon** (serve) — The nurse *attended on* the patient. **Attend** (be present — no preposition) — He *attended* the meeting.

Authority on (an expert) / **over** (power) — He is an *authority on* Bengali literature. / He has *authority over* the staff.

Available to (a person) / **for** (a purpose) — The book is *available to* all students.

Averse to — He is *averse to* hard work.

Avail oneself of — You should *avail yourself of* this opportunity.

Aware of — Are you *aware of* the danger?

B

Bad at — He is *bad at* mathematics.

Bank on (rely on) — You can *bank on* him.

Bare of — The trees are *bare of* leaves.

Based on — The film is *based on* a true story.

Bear with (be patient with) — Please *bear with* me for a moment.

Beg of (a person) / **for** (a thing) — I *beg of* you not to go. / He *begged for* mercy.

Believe in (trust, have faith in) — I *believe in* God. **Believe** (a person's words — no preposition) — I *believe* you.

Belong to — This pen *belongs to* me.

Beneficial to — Exercise is *beneficial to* health.

Bent on (determined) — He is *bent on* mischief.

Bereft of (deprived of — abstract) — He was *bereft of* all hope. **Bereaved of** (a relative by death) — She was *bereaved of* her husband.

Beware of — *Beware of* pickpockets.

Blessed with — She is *blessed with* good health.

Blind to (unaware) / **in** (one eye) — He is *blind to* his own faults. / He is *blind in* one eye.

Blush at (a thing) / **for** (a person) — She *blushed at* the compliment.

Boast of / about — He *boasts of* his wealth.

Born of (parents) / **in** (place/time) / **into** (a family) — He was *born of* poor parents. / He was *born in* 1971 *in* Dhaka. / He was *born into* a rich family.

Borrow from — He *borrowed* money *from* his friend.

Bound for (going to) / **by** (obliged by) / **to** (certain to) — The ship is *bound for* Chattogram. / We are *bound by* the contract. / He is *bound to* succeed.

Brood over — Don't *brood over* the past.

Busy with (+ noun) / **busy** (+ V-ing) — He is *busy with* his work. / He is *busy writing*.

C

Call at (a place) / **on** (a person) / **for** (demand) / **off** (cancel) — I *called at* his house. / I *called on* him. / The situation *calls for* action. / The strike was *called off*.

Capable of — He is *capable of* doing this job.

Care for (like / look after) / **about** (be concerned) / **of** (on letters: c/o) — He doesn't *care for* money. / I don't *care about* his opinion.

Careful of / about / with — Be *careful of* your health. / Be *careful with* that knife.

Careless of / about — He is *careless of* his duties.

Cater to / for — The shop *caters to* the needs of students.

Certain of / about — I am *certain of* his success.

Charge with (an offence) / **for** (price) — He was *charged with* murder. / They *charged* me 500 taka *for* the repair.

Cheat of / out of — He *cheated* me *out of* my money.

Clear of — The road is *clear of* traffic.

Close to — The school is *close to* my house.

Coincide with — My birthday *coincides with* Eid this year.

Collide with — The bus *collided with* a truck.

Commensurate with — Pay should be *commensurate with* work.

Comment on — He refused to *comment on* the matter.

Commit to — He was *committed to* prison. / We are *committed to* peace.

Compare with (to find similarities and differences) / **to** (to show likeness) — *Compare* this book *with* that one. / Life is *compared to* a dream.

Compatible with — This software is *compatible with* Windows.

Compensate for — Nothing can *compensate for* the loss of life.

Compete with (a person) **for** (a thing) — He *competed with* his friends *for* the prize.

Complain to (a person) **of / about** (a thing) — He *complained to* the police *about* the noise. / He *complained of* a headache.

Complementary to — The two theories are *complementary to* each other.

Comply with — You must *comply with* the rules.

Composed of — Water is *composed of* hydrogen and oxygen.

Conceive of — I cannot *conceive of* such cruelty.

Concentrate on — *Concentrate on* your studies.

Concerned about / for (worried) / **with** (related to / involved in) — I am *concerned about* her health. / The book is *concerned with* rural life.

Condemn to (a punishment) / **for** (a crime) — He was *condemned to* death *for* murder.

Condole with (a person) **on** (a loss) — I *condoled with* him *on* the death of his father.

Conducive to — Exercise is *conducive to* good health.

Confer on / upon (give) / **with** (consult) — The university *conferred* a degree *on* him. / The minister *conferred with* his officials.

Confident of — I am *confident of* success.

Confide in (trust) / **to** (entrust) — I *confided in* my brother. / He *confided* his secret *to* me.

Confined to — He was *confined to* bed for a week.

Conform to — You must *conform to* the rules.

Confront with — He was *confronted with* the evidence.

Congratulate on / upon — I *congratulate* you *on* your success. (✘ for)

Connive at (secretly allow wrong) — The officer *connived at* the smuggling.

Conscious of — He is *conscious of* his weakness.

Consent to — His father *consented to* the marriage.

Consist of (be made up of) / **in** (lie in) — The book *consists of* ten chapters. / Happiness *consists in* contentment.

Consistent with — His statement is not *consistent with* the facts.

Contemporary with / of — Shakespeare was *contemporary with* Ben Jonson.

Content with — Be *content with* what you have.

Contrary to — *Contrary to* expectations, he passed.

Contribute to / towards — He *contributed* money *to* the relief fund.

Convenient for / to — Is Monday *convenient for* you?

Conversant with — He is *conversant with* computer programming.

Convert to / into — He was *converted to* Islam. / Water *converts into* steam.

Convict of — He was *convicted of* fraud.

Convince of — I *convinced* him *of* my innocence.

Cope with — We must *cope with* the situation.

Correspond with (exchange letters; agree) / **to** (be equivalent) — I *correspond with* my pen-friend. / The Bangla word *corresponds to* the English word.

Crave for — He *craves for* fame.

Cure of — The doctor *cured* him *of* fever.

Curious about — Children are *curious about* everything.

D

Deal in (trade) / **with** (handle; treat) — He *deals in* rice. / The book *deals with* poverty. / He knows how to *deal with* difficult people.

Debar from — He was *debarred from* the examination.

Decide on / upon (choose) / **against** — They *decided on* a new plan.

Dedicate to — He *dedicated* his life *to* the nation.

Defend from / against — Soldiers *defend* the country *from* enemies.

Deficient in — The food is *deficient in* vitamins.

Delight in — He *delights in* helping others.

Deliver from — *Deliver* us *from* evil.

Depend on / upon — Success *depends on* hard work.

Deprive of — He was *deprived of* his rights.

Derive from — Many English words are *derived from* Latin.

Descended from — He is *descended from* a noble family.

Deserving of — He is *deserving of* praise.

Desire for — He has a strong *desire for* knowledge.

Desirous of — He is *desirous of* meeting you.

Desist from — *Desist from* such activities.

Despair of — The doctors *despaired of* his life.

Destined for — He was *destined for* greatness.

Destitute of — He is *destitute of* common sense.

Detrimental to — Smoking is *detrimental to* health.

Deviate from — Don't *deviate from* the truth.

Devoid of — He is *devoid of* feeling.

Devote to — She *devoted* her life *to* the poor.

Die of (disease, hunger, grief) / **from** (wound, overwork) / **for** (a cause) / **by** (violent means) — He *died of* cancer. / He *died from* a snakebite. / They *died for* their motherland. / He *died by* the sword.

Differ from (be unlike) / **with** (disagree with a person) / **on** (a point) — Bangla *differs from* English. / I *differ with* you *on* this point.

Different from — This book is *different from* that one.

Disagree with — I *disagree with* you.

Disappointed with / in (a person) / **at** (a result) — I am *disappointed with* you. / He was *disappointed at* the result.

Disgusted with / at — I am *disgusted with* his behaviour.

Dispense with (do without) — We cannot *dispense with* his services.

Dispose of (get rid of) — He *disposed of* his old car.

Dissuade from — I *dissuaded* him *from* smoking.

Distinguish between (two) / **from** (one from another) — *Distinguish between* right and wrong. / *Distinguish* right *from* wrong.

Divert from — Don't *divert* your attention *from* study.

Divide into (parts) / **among / between** (persons) — *Divide* the cake *into* four parts. / *Divide* it *among* the children.

Doubt about / of — I have no *doubt about* his honesty.

Due to (caused by) / **for** (expected) — His failure was *due to* laziness. / The train is *due for* departure.

Dwell on / upon (think or speak at length) / **in** (live in) — Don't *dwell on* your past failures.

E

Eager for (a thing) / **to** (+ verb) — He is *eager for* fame. / He is *eager to* learn.

Eligible for — He is *eligible for* the post.

Embark on / upon — He *embarked on* a new career.

Emerge from — The sun *emerged from* behind the clouds.

Encroach on / upon — Don't *encroach upon* others' rights.

Endowed with — She is *endowed with* great talent.

Engaged in (busy) / **to** (promised in marriage) / **with** (occupied with a person) — He is *engaged in* business. / She is *engaged to* a doctor.

Enter into (an agreement, discussion) / **upon** (begin) / **enter** (a place — no preposition) — They *entered into* a contract. / He *entered* the room.

Entitled to — Every citizen is *entitled to* free speech.

Envious of — He is *envious of* my success.

Equal to — He is *equal to* the task.

Equivalent to — One dollar is *equivalent to* about 120 taka.

Escape from — The prisoner *escaped from* jail.

Essential to / for — Water is *essential to* life.

Exception to — There is an *exception to* every rule. **Take exception to** (object to).

Excel in (a subject) / **at** (an activity) — She *excels in* mathematics.

Exempt from — He is *exempt from* tax.

Expert in / at (a skill) / **on** (a subject) — He is an *expert in* computers. / an *expert on* climate change.

Exposed to — The children were *exposed to* danger.

F

Faith in — I have *faith in* him.

Faithful to — A dog is *faithful to* its master.

Familiar to (a person) / **with** (a thing) — The face is *familiar to* me. / I am *familiar with* the rules.

Famous for — Rajshahi is *famous for* mangoes.

Fascinated by / with — The children were *fascinated by* the magic show.

Fed up with — I'm *fed up with* his lies.

Fight with / against (an opponent) / **for** (a cause) — We *fought against* injustice. / We *fought for* freedom.

Fill with — *Fill* the bottle *with* water.

Fit for (suitable) / **to** (+ verb) — He is *fit for* the job. / He is not *fit to* travel.

Fond of — She is *fond of* music.

Free from (troubles, faults) / **of** (charge, cost) — He is *free from* worries. / Books are distributed *free of* cost.

Friendly with / to — He is *friendly with* his neighbours.

Frightened of / at — She is *frightened of* snakes.

Full of — The glass is *full of* water.

Furnish with — The room is *furnished with* modern furniture.

G

Generous to / towards (a person) / **with** (a thing) — He is *generous to* the poor. / He is *generous with* his money.

Get rid of — We must *get rid of* corruption.

Glad of / about (a thing) / **at** (news) — I am *glad of* your success.

Good at (skill) / **for** (beneficial) / **to** (kind) — He is *good at* English. / Exercise is *good for* health. / She is *good to* her servants.

Grateful to (a person) **for** (a thing) — I am *grateful to* you *for* your help.

Greedy of / for — He is *greedy of* money.

Grieve at / over / for — She *grieved over* her son's death.

Guard against — We should *guard against* disease.

Guilty of — He was found *guilty of* murder.

H

Habituated to — He is *habituated to* rising early.

Hanker after / for — Don't *hanker after* money.

Harmful to — Smoking is *harmful to* health.

Hint at — He *hinted at* resignation.

Hope for — We *hope for* the best.

Hopeful of / about — He is *hopeful of* success.

Hostile to — He is *hostile to* the new plan.

Hunger for / after — He *hungers for* knowledge.

I

Identical with / to — Your answer is *identical with* mine.

Ignorant of — He is *ignorant of* the law.

Ill with (a disease) — He is *ill with* fever.

Impatient of (intolerant of) / **with** (a person) / **for** (eager) — He is *impatient of* delay. / Don't be *impatient with* children.

Impose on / upon — A new tax was *imposed on* imports.

Inclined to — I am *inclined to* agree with you.

Independent of — He is *independent of* his parents.

Indifferent to — He is *indifferent to* praise.

Indebted to (a person) **for** (a favour) — I am *indebted to* you *for* your help.

Indulge in — He *indulges in* gossip.

Inferior to — This cloth is *inferior to* that.

Infested with — The house is *infested with* rats.

Inform of / about — *Inform* me *of* your arrival.

Initiate into — He was *initiated into* the society.

Inquire of (a person) / **into** (investigate) / **about / after** (a person's health) — I *inquired of* him whether he would come. / The police are *inquiring into* the case. / He *inquired after* my mother's health.

Insist on / upon — He *insisted on* paying.

Intent on — He is *intent on* winning.

Interested in — I am *interested in* history.

Interfere with (hinder) / **in** (meddle) — Don't *interfere in* my affairs. / The noise *interferes with* my work.

Introduce to — He *introduced* me *to* his wife.

Invest in — He *invested* money *in* shares.

Involved in — He was *involved in* the robbery.

Irrelevant to — The question is *irrelevant to* the topic.

J · K · L

Jealous of — He is *jealous of* his brother's success.

Jump at (accept eagerly) — He *jumped at* the offer.

Junior to — She is *junior to* me.

Justify in — You are not *justified in* doing this.

Keen on — She is *keen on* dancing.

Kind to — Be *kind to* animals.

Knock at / on — Someone is *knocking at* the door.

Lack of (noun) / **lacking in** (adjective) / **lack** (verb — no preposition) — There is a *lack of* water. / He is *lacking in* courage. / He *lacks* courage.

Lame of / in — He is *lame of (in)* one leg.

Laugh at — Don't *laugh at* the poor.

Lean against / on — He *leaned against* the wall.

Liable for (responsible) / **to** (likely; subject to) — He is *liable for* the debt. / He is *liable to* catch cold. / Offenders are *liable to* a fine.

Listen to — *Listen to* me carefully.

Live on (food/income) / **in** (a place) / **by** (a means) — Cows *live on* grass. / He *lives on* his pension. / He *lives by* teaching.

Long for — The prisoners *longed for* freedom.

Look after (take care of) / **for** (search) / **into** (investigate) / **at** (see) / **up to** (respect) / **down on** (despise) / **forward to** (expect eagerly) — She *looks after* her old parents.

Loyal to — He is *loyal to* his country.

M · N

Made of (material that remains recognisable) / **from** (material changed in the process) / **into** (product) — The table is *made of* wood. / Paper is *made from* bamboo. / Milk is *made into* butter.

Married to — She is *married to* a businessman. (✘ married with)

Marvel at — We *marvelled at* his skill.

Meddle with / in — Don't *meddle in* others' affairs.

Mindful of — Be *mindful of* your duties.

Mourn for / over — The nation *mourned for* its leader.

Necessary for / to — Food is *necessary for* life.

Need for / of — There is no *need for* anxiety.

Neglectful of — He is *neglectful of* his duties.

Negligent of / in — He is *negligent in* his work.

Notorious for — He is *notorious for* his cruelty.

O

Obedient to — Children should be *obedient to* their parents.

Object to (+ noun / V-ing) — I *object to* his proposal. / I *object to* being treated like a child.

Obliged to (a person) **for** (a favour) — I am *obliged to* you *for* your kindness.

Oblivious of / to — He was *oblivious of* the danger.

Obsessed with / by — He is *obsessed with* cricket.

Occupied with / in — He is *occupied with* his studies.

Offended with (a person) / **at** (an action) — I was *offended at* his remarks.

Opposed to — I am *opposed to* the plan.

Opposite to (adjective use) — His views are *opposite to* mine.

Overcome with / by — She was *overcome with* grief.

Owe to — I *owe* my success *to* my teachers.

P

Part from (a person) / **with** (a thing) — It is hard to *part from* friends. / He would not *part with* his money.

Partial to (biased in favour of) — The judge was *partial to* the rich.

Participate in — He *participated in* the debate.

Persist in — He *persists in* his error.

Pity for — Have *pity on* the poor. / I feel *pity for* him.

Pleased with (a person) / **at / about** (a thing) — The teacher is *pleased with* me. / I was *pleased at* the result.

Popular with / among — He is *popular with* the students.

Possessed of (having a quality) / **by** (controlled by) — He is *possessed of* great wealth. / He is *possessed by* an evil spirit.

Pray to (God) **for** (a thing) — We *pray to* Allah *for* mercy.

Precaution against — Take *precautions against* fire.

Prefer to — I *prefer* tea *to* coffee.

Prejudiced against / in favour of — He is *prejudiced against* women.

Prepare for — He is *preparing for* the BCS exam.

Preside over / at — The Principal *presided over* the meeting.

Prevent from — Rain *prevented* us *from* going out.

Pride in / pride oneself on — He takes *pride in* his work. / He *prides himself on* his honesty.

Prior to — He left *prior to* my arrival.

Proficient in — He is *proficient in* English.

Prohibit from — Students are *prohibited from* smoking.

Prone to — He is *prone to* anger.

Protect from / against — *Protect* the children *from* danger.

Proud of — We are *proud of* our heritage.

Provide for (a person — support) / **with** (supply) / **against** (prepare for) — He *provides for* his family. / They *provided* us *with* food. / We must *provide against* old age.

Punish for — He was *punished for* stealing.

Q · R

Qualified for — He is *qualified for* the post.

Quarrel with (a person) **about / over** (a thing) — He *quarrelled with* his brother *over* the land.

Quick at (learning) / **of** (understanding) — He is *quick at* figures.

Reconcile to (accept) / **with** (make friends again) — He *reconciled* himself *to* his fate. / He *was reconciled with* his brother.

Recover from — He has *recovered from* his illness.

Refer to — Please *refer to* page 10.

Refrain from — *Refrain from* smoking.

Rejoice at / in — We *rejoiced at* the victory.

Related to — He is *related to* the Prime Minister.

Relevant to — Your question is not *relevant to* the topic.

Relieve of — He was *relieved of* his duties.

Rely on / upon — You can *rely on* me.

Remind of — This photo *reminds* me *of* my childhood.

Repent of — He *repented of* his sins.

Replace with / by — We *replaced* the old chair *with* a new one.

Reply to — Please *reply to* my letter.

Resign from (a post) / **resign oneself to** (accept) — He *resigned from* his job. / He *resigned himself to* his fate.

Resort to — The police *resorted to* force.

Respect for — We should have *respect for* elders.

Respond to — He did not *respond to* my call.

Responsible to (a person) **for** (a thing) — The manager is *responsible to* the board *for* the losses.

Restrain from — I *restrained* him *from* fighting.

Result in (cause) / **from** (be caused by) — Carelessness *results in* accidents. / Accidents *result from* carelessness.

Revenge oneself on / upon — He *revenged himself on* his enemy.

Rich in — Bangladesh is *rich in* natural gas.

Rid of — We must get *rid of* this habit.

Rob of — The thief *robbed* him *of* his watch. (✘ robbed his watch)

S

Satisfied with — I am *satisfied with* the result.

Search for (look for) / **search** (examine — no preposition) — They *searched for* the missing child. / The police *searched* the house.

Secure against / from — The fort was *secure against* attack.

Senior to — He is *senior to* me by two years.

Sensitive to — Her skin is *sensitive to* the sun.

Sentenced to (a punishment) **for** (a crime) — He was *sentenced to* life imprisonment *for* murder.

Short of — We are *short of* money.

Shy of — She is *shy of* strangers.

Sick of (tired of) / **with** (ill with) — I am *sick of* his excuses.

Similar to — My views are *similar to* yours.

Smile at — She *smiled at* me.

Sorry for (a person) / **about** (a thing) — I am *sorry for* him. / I am *sorry about* the mistake.

Stick to — *Stick to* your promise.

Subject to — The plan is *subject to* approval.

Submit to — He refused to *submit to* injustice.

Substitute for — There is no *substitute for* hard work.

Succeed in (an effort) / **to** (inherit) — He *succeeded in* passing the exam. / He *succeeded to* the throne.

Suffer from — He is *suffering from* malaria.

Suitable for — This job is *suitable for* him.

Superior to — This cloth is *superior to* that.

Sure of — I am *sure of* his honesty.

Surprised at / by — I was *surprised at* his behaviour.

Suspicious of — The police are *suspicious of* him.

Sympathise with — I *sympathise with* you *in* your sorrow.

Sympathy for / with — I have great *sympathy for* the victims.

T · U

Take after (resemble a parent) — He *takes after* his father.

Talk to / with (a person) **about** (a subject) — I *talked to* him *about* the problem.

Tamper with — Someone has *tampered with* the lock.

Thankful to (a person) **for** (a thing) — I am *thankful to* you *for* the gift.

Think of / about — I am *thinking of* going abroad.

Thirst for / after — He has a *thirst for* knowledge.

Tired of (bored with) / **from** (physically tired by) — I am *tired of* his complaints. / He was *tired from* the journey.

Tolerant of / towards — We should be *tolerant of* other views.

True to — He is *true to* his word.

Trust in (have faith) / **with** (give in care) — *Trust in* God. / I *trusted* him *with* my money.

Unaware of — He was *unaware of* the danger.

Unfit for — He is *unfit for* the job.

Unworthy of — He is *unworthy of* trust.

Useful to (a person) / **for** (a purpose) — This book is *useful to* students.

V · W · Y · Z

Vain of — She is *vain of* her beauty.

Versed in — He is well *versed in* law.

Victim of / to — He fell a *victim to* cholera.

Vie with (compete) — The two teams *vied with* each other *for* the cup.

Void of — His speech was *void of* meaning.

Vote for / against — I *voted for* him.

Wait for (await) / **on** (serve) — I am *waiting for* the bus. / The waiter *waited on* us.

Want of — He died *for want of* treatment.

Warn of / about / against — He *warned* me *of* the danger. / *warned* me *against* the pickpockets.

Weak in (a subject) — He is *weak in* English.

Weary of — I am *weary of* waiting.

Wish for — He *wished for* success.

Wonder at — I *wonder at* his patience.

Worthy of — He is *worthy of* praise.

Yearn for — She *yearned for* home.

Yield to — He *yielded to* temptation.

Zeal for — He has a *zeal for* social work.

Zealous for / in — He is *zealous in* his work.

18.3 Words That Take Different Prepositions with Different Meanings

The following words are especially important because the choice of preposition changes the meaning. Review them carefully.

Word	Preposition	Meaning / Example
agree	with / to / on	with a person; to a proposal; on a point
angry	with / at / about	with a person; at an action; about a situation
anxious	about / for	worried about; eager for
attend	to / on / —	pay attention to / serve / be present at (no prep.)
call	at / on / for / off / in	visit a place / visit a person / demand / cancel / summon
compare	with / to	examine differences / show likeness
consist	of / in	made of / lies in
deal	in / with	trade in / handle
die	of / from / for / by	disease / wound / cause / means

Word	Preposition	Meaning / Example
differ	from / with	be unlike / disagree with a person
familiar	to / with	known to a person / knowing a thing
free	from / of	without troubles / without cost
good	at / for / to	skill / benefit / kindness
impatient	of / with / for	intolerant of / irritated with / eager for
inquire	of / into / about / after	ask a person / investigate / ask about / ask about health
interfere	with / in	hinder / meddle
liable	for / to	responsible for / likely to, subject to
live	on / in / by	food / place / means
look	after / for / into / at / up to / down on	care / search / investigate / see / respect / despise
made	of / from / into	visible material / changed material / product
part	from / with	a person / a thing
provide	for / with / against	support / supply / prepare for
result	in / from	cause / be caused by
succeed	in / to	achieve / inherit
tired	of / from	bored / physically weary
wait	for / on	await / serve

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — Idioms You Must Know Cold: *a means* **of**, *an ability* **to**, *attribute X* **to** *Y*, *based* **on**, *believe X* **to be** *Y*, *centre* **on** (✘ centre around), *conform* **to**, *contrast X* **with** *Y*, *credit X* **with** *Y*, *defend X* **against** *Y*, *depend* **on** *whether* (✘ depend on if), *differ* **from**, *estimate X* **to be** *Y*, *forbid X* **to** *do*, *mistake X* **for** *Y*, *prohibit X* **from** *doing*, *regard X* **as** *Y*, *require X* **to** *do*, *responsible* **for**, *target X* **at** *Y*, *view X* **as** *Y*, *worry* **about**. On the GMAT, ✘ *"regarded to be"*, ✘ *"considered as being"*, ✘ *"prohibited to"*, ✘ *"forbade from"* are always wrong.

CHAPTER 23

Subject-Verb Agreement

Part A · Grammar

23.1 What Is Subject-Verb Agreement?

Every complete sentence has a **subject** (the person or thing we are talking about) and a **verb** (what the subject does or is). *Subject-verb agreement* means that **the verb must match its subject in number and person.**

- **Number** means *singular* (one) or *plural* (more than one).
- **Person** means *first person* (I, we), *second person* (you) or *third person* (he, she, it, they, Rahim, the book, the students).

So, a singular subject needs a singular verb, and a plural subject needs a plural verb. This sounds very easy, and in short sentences it is. The difficulty appears when the subject is hidden, long, compound, collective, or separated from its verb by many words. Almost every competitive exam in Bangladesh — BCS Preliminary, Bank (Officer, Senior Officer, AD of Bangladesh Bank), university admission tests (DU, JU, RU, CU) and international exams like the SAT, GRE and GMAT — tests this topic every year, mainly through *Error Detection*, *Sentence Correction*, *Right Form of Verbs* and *Fill in the Blanks*.

- The boy **plays** football. (singular subject → singular verb)
- The boys **play** football. (plural subject → plural verb)
- She **is** a doctor. / They **are** doctors.
- I **am** ready. / We **are** ready.

23.1.1 Why the "s" Confuses Learners

In English, an **-s/-es** at the end of a **noun** usually makes it *plural* (book → books). But an **-s/-es** at the end of a **present-tense verb** makes it *singular* (they play → he play**s**). So in a correct present simple sentence, the "s" usually appears **only once** — either on the noun or on the verb, not on both.

- The dog bark**s**. (s on the verb → singular)
- The dog**s** bark. (s on the noun → plural)
- ✘ The dogs barks. ✔ The dogs bark.

> **Exam Tip — The "one s" trick:** In a simple present sentence with a normal noun subject, if both the subject and the verb end in -s, check again — one of them is probably wrong. (This trick does not work for nouns like *news*, *physics*, *police*, *people*, *children*, so learn those rules below.)

23.1.2 Where Agreement Matters

Agreement only shows in a few places in English, so you must know exactly where to look:

1. **Present simple tense** — *he works / they work.*
2. **The verb *be*** — *am / is / are* (present) and *was / were* (past).
3. **The verb *have*** — *has / have.*
4. **The verb *do*** — *does / do.*
5. **Present perfect and present continuous** — *has gone / have gone; is going / are going.*
6. **Past continuous** — *was going / were going.*

Modal auxiliaries (*can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must, ought to*) **never change** with the subject: *He can swim. They can swim.* The **past simple** of ordinary verbs also does not change: *He went. They went.*

Subject	be (present)	be (past)	have	do	Main verb (present)
I	am	was	have	do	write
We / You / They	are	were	have	do	write
He / She / It	is	was	has	does	writes
Singular noun (Rahim, the book)	is	was	has	does	writes
Plural noun (the boys)	are	were	have	do	write

> **Remember:** *You* always takes a plural verb even when it refers to one person: *You **are** my friend* (✘ You is). *I* takes *am* in the present but *was* in the past: *I **was** there* (✘ I were there — except in the subjunctive: *If I **were** you*).

23.2 Step One: Find the True Subject

Most agreement errors happen because the learner matches the verb with the wrong word. So before applying any rule, **find the real (head) subject**. Ask: *"Who or what is doing the action / being described?"* Then strip away everything that only describes it.

23.2.1 Words That Are Never the Subject

The subject of a sentence is **never** inside:

- a **prepositional phrase** (of the students, in the box, with his friends, for the poor);
- an **appositive** set off by commas (*Mr. Karim, our teachers' leader, …*);
- a **relative clause** (*who live next door, which were damaged*);
- a **participial phrase** (*sitting under the trees, written by Tagore*).

Cross these out mentally and look at what is left.

- The quality of the mangoes **is** (✘ are) excellent. → *quality* is the subject; *of the mangoes* is a prepositional phrase.
- The box of chocolates **was** (✘ were) stolen.
- The boys in the last bench **are** talking.
- The cost of all these books **has** (✘ have) risen.
- One of my friends **lives** (✘ live) in Sylhet.
- The leader of the workers, together with his followers, **was** (✘ were) arrested.
- A list of the successful candidates **has** (✘ have) been published.
- The use of mobile phones in classrooms **is** (✘ are) prohibited.
- The houses that stand beside the river **are** (✘ is) old.

> **SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — The "Long-Distance" Trap:** Standardised tests love to put 10–20 words between the subject and the verb so that a plural noun sits right before a singular verb (or vice versa). Example (GMAT style): *"The rise in the prices of essential commodities such as rice, lentils and edible oils **have** hurt low-income families."* The subject is *rise* (singular), so the correct verb is **has hurt**. Always ask: *What exactly has hurt the families? — The rise.*

23.2.2 Subject After the Verb (Inverted Order)

In some sentences the verb comes **before** the subject. You must look **after** the verb to find the subject.

(a) Sentences beginning with *There* or *Here*. *There* and *here* are never subjects; the real subject comes after the verb.

- There **is** a book on the table.
- There **are** many books on the table.
- There **was** a lot of noise.
- There **were** a lot of people.
- Here **is** your ticket. / Here **are** your tickets.
- ✘ There's three reasons for this. ✔ There **are** three reasons for this.

(b) Questions. The subject usually follows the auxiliary.

- Where **is** the key? / Where **are** the keys?
- **Does** your brother live here? / **Do** your brothers live here?
- **Has** any of the guests arrived? / **Have** all the guests arrived?
- What **are** the causes of the war? (subject = *the causes*)

(c) Inversion after adverbs or adverbial phrases of place (literary style, common in SAT/GRE reading).

- On the hill **stands** an old temple. (subject = *an old temple*)
- On the hill **stand** two old temples.
- Among the guests **was** the Prime Minister.
- In the middle of the room **were** a table and two chairs.
- Down **came** the rain. / Away **flew** the birds.

(d) Inversion after negative adverbs (*never, seldom, rarely, hardly, scarcely, no sooner, not only, nor, little*). The auxiliary still agrees with the subject that follows it.

- Never **has** he told a lie. / Never **have** they told a lie.
- Not only **does** she sing, but she also dances.
- Seldom **do** we see such honesty nowadays.

23.2.3 Long Subjects (Phrases and Clauses as Subjects)

When a **gerund phrase**, an **infinitive phrase** or a **noun clause** is the subject, it is treated as **one idea**, so the verb is **singular**.

- Swimming in rivers **is** good exercise.
- Reading books **makes** a man perfect.
- Taking long walks in the evening **helps** her relax.
- To err **is** human; to forgive **is** divine.
- To read many books **is** useful.
- What he says **is** true.
- That he is honest **is** known to all.
- Whether they will come **is** uncertain.
- Who stole the money **remains** a mystery.

> **Two gerunds joined by *and*** usually take a plural verb because they are two different activities: *Reading and writing **are** essential skills.* But if they form one combined activity, use singular: *Eating and drinking too much **is** harmful.* (Both are accepted in modern usage; in exams the plural is safer for two clearly separate activities.)

Special case — *What*-clauses with plural complements. When a *what*-clause is followed by a plural noun complement, many grammarians accept a plural verb: *What we need **are** more teachers.* The traditional (safe) answer for BCS is singular: *What we need **is** more teachers.* Both are seen in good writing; SAT and GMAT avoid testing this.

23.3 Rules for Compound Subjects

A **compound subject** has two or more nouns/pronouns joined by *and, or, nor, either…or, neither…nor, not only…but also*, etc.

Rule 1: Subjects joined by *and* → plural verb

> **Rule 1.** Two or more subjects joined by **and** generally take a **plural verb**.

- Rahim and Karim **are** friends.
- My father and my uncle **were** present.
- He and I **are** classmates.
- Honesty and hard work **are** the keys to success.
- Bangladesh and Nepal **are** neighbouring countries.
- The teacher and the students **have** gone to the museum.

There are several important **exceptions** to Rule 1. These are among the most frequently tested points in BCS and Bank exams.

Rule 2: Two nouns, one person → singular

> **Rule 2.** If two nouns joined by *and* refer to the **same person or thing**, the verb is **singular**. The sign: **the article (a/an/the) or possessive is used only once**, before the first noun.

- The poet and philosopher **is** dead. (one man who is both a poet and a philosopher)
- The poet and the philosopher **are** dead. (two different men)
- The Headmaster and Secretary **is** present. (one person)
- The Headmaster and the Secretary **are** present. (two persons)
- My friend and benefactor **has** come.
- A black and white cow **is** grazing. (one cow with two colours)
- A black and a white cow **are** grazing. (two cows)
- The writer and director of the film **was** awarded.

Rule 3: One idea or one dish → singular

> **Rule 3.** When two nouns joined by *and* express **one idea**, **one unit**, or **one combined thing** (often a dish, a pair or a proverb), the verb is **singular**.

- Bread and butter **is** his usual breakfast.
- Rice and curry **is** my favourite food.
- Bread and milk **is** good for children.
- Slow and steady **wins** the race.
- Fish and chips **is** popular in England.
- Law and order **has** deteriorated.
- The horse and carriage **is** at the door. (one vehicle)
- The long and the short of the matter **is** this.
- Gin and tonic **is** a common drink.
- Ups and downs **are** part of life. (*ups and downs* is plural in form and meaning)

> **Traditional proverb exception:** *Time and tide **wait** for none.* Here *time* and *tide* are treated as two separate things, so the verb is plural. Learn it as it is, since it appears often in BCS papers.

Bread and butter in its idiomatic sense *(means of livelihood)* is also singular: *Teaching **is** my bread and butter.*

Rule 4: *Each / Every / No* before *and*-subjects → singular

> **Rule 4.** If **each, every, many a** or **no** comes before singular subjects joined by *and*, the verb is **singular**.

- Every man and woman **is** equal before the law.
- Each boy and each girl **has** a book.
- Every teacher and every student **was** present.
- No man and no woman **was** spared.
- Every house and every shop **was** searched.
- Each day and each night **brings** its own problems.

Rule 5: *As well as, with, along with* etc. → verb follows the FIRST subject

> **Rule 5.** When two subjects are joined by **as well as, with, along with, together with, accompanied by, in addition to, besides, including, like, unlike, rather than, more than, no less than, and not, but not, except, but, plus**, the verb agrees with the **first subject**. The second part is only extra information and is usually set off by commas.

- The teacher, as well as the students, **was** present. (✘ were)
- The students, as well as the teacher, **were** present.
- The captain, along with his players, **has** arrived.
- The minister, with his secretaries, **is** coming.
- Rina, together with her sisters, **is** going to Cox's Bazar.
- He, and not you, **is** to blame.

- You, and not he, **are** to blame.
- The ship, with its crew, **was** lost.
- Mr. Hasan, accompanied by his wife, **was** at the party.
- The house, including its furniture, **was** sold.
- Karim, like his brothers, **is** a doctor.
- Gold, no less than silver, **has** fallen in price.
- He, rather than his friends, **deserves** punishment.
- The President, in addition to his ministers, **was** present.
- Nobody except the guards **was** allowed inside.

SAT / GMAT Corner — The "False Compound" trap: Test-makers use *along with, as well as, in addition to, together with* to make a singular subject *look* plural. E.g. *"The CEO, in addition to several board members, **were** accused of fraud."* ✘ → **was** accused. Only **and** can create a true compound (plural) subject. GMAT often uses this with long intervening phrases.

Rule 6: *Or, nor, either…or, neither…nor* → nearer subject (Proximity Rule)

Rule 6. When two subjects are joined by **or, nor, either…or, neither…nor, not only…but also, not…but**, the verb agrees with the subject **nearer (closer) to it**. This is called the **Law of Proximity**.

- Either Rahim or Karim **has** done it. (both singular → singular)
- Either the boys or their father **has** done it. (nearer = father)
- Either the father or his sons **have** done it. (nearer = sons)
- Neither he nor I **am** guilty. (nearer = I)
- Neither you nor he **is** responsible.
- Neither he nor you **are** responsible.
- Not only the students but also the teacher **was** surprised.
- Not only the teacher but also the students **were** surprised.
- Not the principal but the teachers **are** responsible.
- Either you or your brother **has** to go.
- **Has** either Rahim or Karim seen this? (In a question the auxiliary stands nearest to the *first* subject, so if one subject is plural, rewrite: *Have his friends or Rahim seen this?*)
- Ali or his brothers **are** coming.
- My brothers or Ali **is** coming.

Exam Tip — Placing the plural subject last: When one subject is singular and the other plural, good style puts the **plural subject nearer the verb** and uses a **plural verb**: *Neither the captain nor the players **were** happy.* This sounds more natural than *Neither the players nor the captain was happy*, though both are grammatically correct.

Person problem. When the subjects joined by *or/nor* are of different persons (*you* and *I*, *he* and *I*), the verb still agrees with the nearer subject. But because such sentences sound awkward, it is better to repeat the verb:

- Either you or I **am** wrong. → Better: Either you **are** wrong, or I **am**.
- Neither he nor you **are** to blame. → Better: He **is** not to blame, nor **are** you.

Order of persons with *and*. When pronouns of different persons are joined by *and*, the polite order in good English is **231** for ordinary/positive sentences: second person first, then third, then first (*You, he and I*). When admitting a fault or in negative sense, the order is **123** (*I, you and he are to blame*). The verb is always plural.

- You, he and I **are** good friends.
- I, you and he **are** guilty.

Rule 7: *Both…and* → plural

Both…and always joins two subjects firmly, so the verb is always **plural**.

- Both Rahim and Karim **are** absent.
- Both the cat and the dog **were** hungry.

23.4 Indefinite Pronouns and Distributive Words

Indefinite pronouns refer to people or things in a general way. Some are always singular, some always plural, and some can be either.

Rule 8: Always singular indefinite pronouns

Rule 8. The following words are **always singular** and take a **singular verb**: **each, every, either, neither, one, everyone, everybody, everything, someone, somebody, something, anyone, anybody, anything, no one, nobody, nothing, another, much, many a, more than one, little (amount).**

- Everybody **knows** the answer.
- Everyone **was** happy.
- Somebody **has** taken my pen.
- Nobody **likes** to be insulted.
- Nothing **is** impossible.
- Anyone **is** allowed to apply.
- Something **is** wrong with the engine.
- Much **has** been said about the matter.
- Each of the boys **was** given a prize.
- Every one of the students **has** passed.
- Either of the two roads **leads** to the station.
- Neither of the answers **is** correct.
- One of the girls **is** absent.
- One of the most important problems **is** unemployment.

Exam Tip — "One of the + plural noun + singular verb": *One of the boys **is*** (✘ one of the boy is / ✘ one of the boys are). Note two things: (i) the noun after *one of the* must be **plural**; (ii) the verb must be **singular** because the subject is *one*. Both errors are tested regularly.

Either / Neither are used for **two** persons or things only. For more than two, use *any one / none*.

- Either of the two brothers **is** suitable.
- Any one of the five candidates **is** suitable. (✘ Either of the five)
- Neither of the two sisters **sings** well.
- None of the ten students **has/have** passed. (✘ Neither of the ten)

In informal English, *neither of* + plural noun with a plural verb is common (*Neither of them **are** coming*). In BCS, Bank and admission exams, always use the **singular** verb: *Neither of them **is** coming.*

Rule 9: *Each* after a plural subject

When *each* comes **after** a plural subject (as an appositive), the verb is **plural**, because the subject is still plural. When *each* comes **before** (as the subject), the verb is singular.

- They each **have** a car. (subject = *they*)
- Each of them **has** a car. (subject = *each*)
- The students each **have** their own computers.
- We each **have** a different opinion.
- Each student **has** a different opinion.

Rule 10: Always plural indefinite pronouns

Rule 10. Both, few, a few, many, several, others are always **plural**.

- Both **are** guilty.
- Few **were** present at the meeting.
- Many **have** come, but a few **have** gone back.
- Several of the books **are** missing.
- Others **think** differently.

Rule 11: SANAM pronouns — singular or plural

> **Rule 11 (The SANAM Rule).** **S**ome, **A**ny, **N**one, **A**ll, **M**ost (and also *half, part, rest, enough, more, lot, plenty, majority, percent, fractions*) can be singular or plural. Look at the noun **after *of*** (or the noun they refer to): if it is **uncountable or singular → singular verb**; if it is **countable plural → plural verb**.

- Some of the milk **is** sour. / Some of the mangoes **are** sour.
- All of the money **was** stolen. / All of the books **were** stolen.
- Most of the work **is** done. / Most of the workers **are** absent.
- Any of the food **is** fine. / Are any of the boys here?
- Half of the cake **has** been eaten. / Half of the cakes **have** been eaten.
- Part of the building **was** damaged. / Part of the walls **were** damaged.
- The rest of the story **is** boring. / The rest of the students **are** in the hall.
- A lot of water **is** wasted. / A lot of people **are** waiting.
- Plenty of time **is** left. / Plenty of seats **are** available.
- All that glitters **is** not gold. (*all* = everything → singular)
- All **are** not thieves that dogs bark at. (*all* = all persons → plural)
- All is well. / All are well.

Rule 12: *None*

None means *not one* or *not any*. Traditional grammar treated it as singular, but modern usage (and most Bangladeshi exam keys) follows the SANAM rule:

- None of the information **was** useful. (uncountable → singular)
- None of the money **is** mine.
- None of the students **were/was** present. (countable plural → both accepted; plural is more common, singular is more formal)
- None **were** present. (= no persons)
- None but the brave **deserves** the fair. (famous line of Dryden — learn as it is)
- None of these two answers… ✘ → Neither of these two answers **is** correct.

> **Exam Tip on *none*:** If an option says *"None of the boys were present"* or *"None of the boys was present"*, both can be correct. Look for another clear error in the sentence. If you must choose, the singular is the "classic" formal answer, while the plural matches modern usage (SAT/GRE accept both). With an uncountable noun, only the singular is correct.

Rule 13: *Many a* → singular verb and singular noun

> **Rule 13. Many a / many an** is followed by a **singular noun** and a **singular verb** (and a singular pronoun), though its meaning is "many".

- Many a man **has** lost his life in this war.
- Many a student **was** absent yesterday.
- Many a flower **is** born to blush unseen. (Thomas Gray)
- Many an opportunity **has** been lost.
- ✘ Many a boys were present. ✔ Many a boy **was** present.

Compare: **A great many / a good many** take a **plural noun** and **plural verb**: *A great many students **were** present.* And **many** alone is plural: *Many students **were** present.*

Rule 14: *More than one* → singular; *More + plural noun + than one* → plural

- More than one boy **was** absent. (✘ More than one boys were)
- More than one student **has** failed.
- More boys than one **were** absent. (the subject is *boys*)
- More than two boys **were** absent. (*two* is plural)

Rule 15: *A number of* vs *The number of*

> **Rule 15. A number of** (= many) + plural noun → **plural verb**. **The number of** (= the total figure) + plural noun → **singular verb**.

- A number of students **are** absent today.
- The number of students **is** increasing day by day.
- A number of accidents **have** occurred on this road.
- The number of road accidents **has** risen sharply.
- A large number of people **were** killed.
- The number of unemployed youths **is** alarming.

The same logic applies to similar expressions:

- A variety of fruits **are** sold here. / The variety of fruits **is** amazing.
- A total of fifty people **were** injured. / The total **is** fifty.
- A majority of voters **support** him. / The majority **is** in favour.
- A couple of days **have** passed.
- A pair of shoes **is** under the bed. (a pair = one unit; see Rule 22)

23.5 Relative Pronouns (who, which, that)

A relative pronoun has no number of its own. The verb in a relative clause agrees with the **antecedent** (the noun or pronoun the relative pronoun refers to).

Rule 16: Verb agrees with the antecedent of *who/which/that*

> **Rule 16.** In a relative clause, the verb agrees in number **and person** with the antecedent of the relative pronoun.

- I, who **am** your friend, will help you. (✘ who is)
- You, who **are** my friend, should help me.
- He, who **is** my friend, will help me.
- It is I who **am** to blame. (✘ It is I who is to blame)
- It is you who **are** to blame.
- It is he who **is** responsible.
- It is they who **have** done this.
- The girl who **sings** well is my sister.
- The girls who **sing** well are my sisters.
- This is the book that **was** missing.
- These are the books that **were** missing.

Rule 17: *One of those who* → plural; *The only one of those who* → singular

This is a favourite trap of BCS, Bank and GMAT.

> **Rule 17.** In "**one of the + plural noun + who/that/which**", the antecedent of *who* is the **plural noun**, so the verb in the relative clause is **plural**. But in "**the only one of the + plural noun + who**", the antecedent is **one**, so the verb is **singular**.

- He is one of the best players who **have** ever played for Bangladesh. (many players have played; he is one of them)
- She is one of those women who **work** hard.
- This is one of the books that **are** worth reading.
- He is one of the boys who **are** always late.
- He is the only one of the boys who **is** always late. (only he is late)
- She is the only one of the applicants who **has** a driving licence.
- Rahim is the only one of my friends who **lives** in Dhaka.

> **Quick test:** Turn the sentence around: *"Of the boys who **are** always late, he is one."* — the plural is clearly correct. But for *the only one*: *"Of the boys, he is the only one who **is** always late."* — clearly singular.

23.6 Collective Nouns

A **collective noun** names a group of persons or things: *family, team, class, committee, jury, crowd, audience, army, crew, staff, government, council, public, board, company, flock, herd, fleet, mob, parliament, party, majority, enemy, union, orchestra, band, gang, association.*

Rule 18: Collective noun as a unit → singular; as individuals → plural

Rule 18. If the group acts **as one unit**, use a **singular verb** (and singular pronoun *it/its*). If the members act **separately or disagree**, use a **plural verb** (and plural pronoun *they/their*).

- The jury **has** given its verdict. (one decision)
- The jury **were** divided in their opinions. (members disagree)
- The committee **has** submitted its report.
- The committee **are** arguing among themselves.
- The team **is** playing well this season.
- The team **are** taking their seats on the bus.
- My family **is** a large one.
- My family **are** all early risers.
- The class **was** dismissed at noon.
- The class **were** busy with their own work.
- The army **is** marching forward.
- The audience **was** enormous. / The audience **were** clapping their hands.
- The crowd **has** dispersed. / The crowd **were** shouting slogans.
- The staff **is** small. / The staff **are** on leave.
- The public **is** requested not to litter. (unit) / The public **are** divided on this issue.

Consistency matters: Never mix singular and plural for the same collective noun in one sentence. ✘ *The committee **has** made **their** decision.* ✔ *The committee **has** made **its** decision.* This "verb–pronoun consistency" is heavily tested on the SAT and GMAT.

British vs American English: In American English (the standard of the SAT, GRE and GMAT), collective nouns are **almost always singular**: *The government **is** …, The team **is** …* In British English, plural is common when we think of members: *The government **are** …, The team **are** …* Bangladeshi exams mostly follow the traditional British "unit vs individuals" rule. In international tests, choose the **singular** unless the sentence clearly shows separate action (like *disagree among themselves*).

Rule 19: Nouns that look singular but are always plural

Rule 19. Some collective nouns are **always plural**, even though they have no -s: **people (= persons), police, cattle, poultry, gentry, clergy, peasantry, vermin, swine, folk, militia, livestock (often)**. They never take *a/an* and never add -s in this sense.

- The people **are** happy. (✘ The people is happy)
- Many people **were** killed.
- The police **have** arrested the thief. (✘ The police has)
- The police **are** investigating the case.
- The cattle **are** grazing in the field. (✘ cattles)
- Poultry **are** kept on this farm.
- The gentry **were** invited.
- The clergy **are** against the move.
- Vermin **are** destroying the crops.

People meaning "a nation / an ethnic group" is countable and has a plural ***peoples***: *The Bengalis **are** a brave people. The peoples of Asia **are** diverse.* ***A policeman / a police officer*** is the singular of *police*: ✘ *A police came.* ✔ *A policeman came.*

23.7 Nouns with Tricky Forms

Rule 20: Plural in form, singular in meaning

Rule 20. Some nouns end in **-s** but are **singular** in meaning and take a **singular verb**.

(a) Names of subjects / sciences: *mathematics, physics, economics, politics, ethics, statistics, phonetics, linguistics, civics, electronics, genetics, athletics, gymnastics.*

(b) Names of diseases: *measles, mumps, rickets, diabetes, shingles, rabies, herpes.*

(c) Names of games: *billiards, darts, draughts, dominoes, cards (as a game).*

(d) Other words: *news, innings, gallows, summons, means (method), wages (in some idioms), amends.*

- Mathematics **is** my favourite subject.
- Economics **is** a social science.
- Physics **deals** with matter and energy.
- Measles **is** an infectious disease.
- Diabetes **is** common in Bangladesh.
- Billiards **is** an indoor game.
- The news **is** true. (✘ The news are true) — *a piece of news*, not *a news*.
- No news **is** good news.
- Bangladesh's first innings **was** good. / An innings **lasts** for hours.
- The gallows **was** set up.
- A summons **has** been issued. (plural: *summonses*)

Subject words used in other senses take a plural verb: *His politics **are** confusing.* (his political views) *The statistics **show** a rise in crime.* (a set of figures) *The economics of the project **are** not clear.* (financial aspects) *His mathematics **are** weak.* (his calculations — some books accept). But as subjects of study: *Politics **is** a dirty game. Statistics **is** an important subject.*

Rule 21: Plural-only nouns (summation plurals)

Rule 21. Some nouns are used **only in the plural** and always take a **plural verb**: **scissors, trousers, pants, pyjamas, jeans, shorts, spectacles, glasses (eyeglasses), binoculars, tongs, pliers, bellows, shears, thanks, riches, alms, proceeds, premises, surroundings, outskirts, environs, arrears, savings, belongings, clothes, goods, contents, assets, annals, archives, credentials, earnings, remains, dregs, eaves, lodgings, odds, tidings, valuables, congratulations.**

- My trousers **are** new. (✘ my trouser is)
- Your spectacles **are** on the table.
- The scissors **are** sharp.
- Riches **do** not bring happiness.
- Alms **are** given to the poor.
- The proceeds of the show **were** donated.
- The premises **are** guarded.
- The surroundings of the lake **are** beautiful.
- His clothes **are** dirty.
- The goods **have** been dispatched.
- Thanks **are** due to the organisers.
- The contents of the letter **were** secret.

Rule 22: *A pair of* + plural noun → singular

- A pair of scissors **is** on the table.
- This pair of trousers **is** expensive.
- Two pairs of shoes **are** needed.
- My pair of spectacles **was** broken.

Rule 23: Same form in singular and plural

Some nouns have **the same form** in both numbers: *sheep, deer, swine, fish (usually), aircraft, spacecraft, series, species, means, headquarters, crossroads, works (factory), offspring, salmon, trout, cod, corps.* The determiner or context tells us the number.

- A sheep **is** grazing. / Ten sheep **are** grazing. (✘ sheeps)
- A deer **was** killed. / Many deer **were** killed.
- A series of lectures **was** arranged. / Two series of stamps **have** been issued.
- This species of bird **is** rare. / These species **are** endangered.
- Every means **has** been tried. / All means **have** been tried.
- The headquarters of the company **is/are** in Dhaka. (both accepted)
- An aircraft **was** missing. / Three aircraft **were** missing.

Rule 24: Uncountable (mass) nouns → always singular

> **Rule 24. Uncountable nouns** take a **singular verb** and never take *a/an* or a plural ending: **information, advice, furniture, luggage, baggage, equipment, machinery, scenery, poetry, jewellery, knowledge, homework, work (= labour), stationery, traffic, weather, bread, money, evidence, mischief, damage (harm), news, hair (on the head), dust, rubbish, grass, offspring (sometimes), crockery, cutlery, business (affairs), progress, research, behaviour, wealth, health, music, fun, patience, permission.**

- The information **is** correct. (✘ The informations are)
- His advice **was** helpful. (✘ advices)
- The furniture **is** new. (✘ furnitures) → *a piece of furniture / pieces of furniture*
- My luggage **has** been lost.
- The scenery of Rangamati **is** charming. (✘ sceneries)
- The machinery **was** imported from Japan.
- Her hair **is** long and black. (✘ hairs are) — but *There are two grey hairs on his head* (individual strands)
- Poetry **is** the music of the soul.
- The evidence **is** strong.
- Much progress **has** been made.
- The traffic **is** heavy today.

The British-sense **plural of measurement** follows the countable unit: *Two pieces of advice **were** given. Three items of furniture **were** sold.*

Rule 25: Foreign (Latin / Greek) plurals → plural verb

> **Rule 25.** Many nouns borrowed from Latin and Greek keep their foreign plurals, and those plurals take a **plural verb** in formal English.

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
datum	data	syllabus	syllabi / syllabuses
criterion	criteria	crisis	crises
phenomenon	phenomena	analysis	analyses
medium	media	thesis	theses
curriculum	curricula	hypothesis	hypotheses
memorandum	memoranda	basis	bases
bacterium	bacteria	oasis	oases
stratum	strata	axis	axes
alumnus	alumni	formula	formulae / formulas
stimulus	stimuli	index	indices / indexes
radius	radii	appendix	appendices
nucleus	nuclei	bureau	bureaux / bureaus
fungus	fungi		

- These data **are** reliable. (formal) / This data **is** reliable. (accepted in modern and computing English)
- The criteria for selection **are** strict. (✘ The criteria is)
- This criterion **is** important.
- These phenomena **are** rare. / This phenomenon **is** rare.
- The bacteria **multiply** quickly.
- The media **have** a great influence. (formal) / The media **has** … (modern, accepted)
- The crises **were** handled well.
- The alumni of DU **are** meeting today.

> **GRE / GMAT note:** *Criteria* and *phenomena* are **always plural** — a common trap. *Data* and *media* are accepted with both, but the GMAT tends to treat *data* as plural in formal contexts. If an answer choice says *"the criteria is"*, it is wrong.

23.8 Quantities, Amounts and Numbers

Rule 26: Amount of time, money, distance, weight as one sum → singular

> **Rule 26.** When a plural noun of **time, money, distance, weight, volume, or measurement** is thought of as **one total amount**, the verb is **singular**.

- Ten miles **is** a long distance.
- Five hundred taka **is** too much for this shirt.
- Two thousand dollars **is** a big sum.
- Five years **is** a long time.
- Fifty kilograms **is** too heavy for a child to carry.
- Two hours **is** enough to finish the exam.
- Twenty litres of water **is** required every day.
- Three-fourths of the distance **has** been covered.

But when the units are thought of **separately (one by one)**, the verb is **plural**:

- Five years **have** passed since his death. (years passing one after another)
- Ten taka coins **were** scattered on the floor.
- Many miles **were** walked by the pilgrims.
- Two hours **have** passed since he left.

Rule 27: Arithmetic

In addition and multiplication, both singular and plural verbs are used; in subtraction and division, the singular is used.

- Two and two **make/makes** four. (both accepted; *make* is more common in BCS keys)
- Five times six **is/are** thirty.
- Ten minus four **is** six.
- Twenty divided by five **is** four.
- Six multiplied by two **is** twelve.

Rule 28: Fractions and percentages → follow the noun after *of*

> **Rule 28.** With **fractions, percentages, proportions** (two-thirds of, half of, 50 percent of, a quarter of, a proportion of, a part of), the verb agrees with the **noun after *of***.

- Two-thirds of the land **is** under water.
- Two-thirds of the people **are** illiterate.
- Fifty percent of the work **has** been completed.
- Fifty percent of the workers **have** joined the strike.
- A quarter of the cake **was** eaten.
- Three-quarters of the students **were** present.
- One-third of the mangoes **are** rotten.
- Forty percent of the population **lives/live** in villages. (*population* is collective; singular is preferred, plural acceptable)
- What percentage of students **were** successful?

Rule 29: *One and a half* and decimal numbers

Expressions like *one and a half* refer to more than one but traditional grammar treats the head (*one*) as decisive: **one and a half + plural noun + singular verb** when seen as an amount. Many modern grammars accept a plural verb. The safest exam answer:

- One and a half hours **is** enough. (amount → singular)
- One and a half years **has** passed since then. (traditional) / **have** passed (modern)
- 1.5 kilograms **is** the weight of the parcel.
- 0.5 percent **is** a small amount.

Rule 30: Numbers as names, titles, words, letters

When a number, word, letter or phrase is mentioned **as a word**, it is singular.

- "Seven" **is** a lucky number for some people.
- "Ps and Qs" **is** an idiom meaning manners.
- Two **is** an even number.
- "Mice" **is** the plural of "mouse".

23.9 Titles, Names and Special Subjects

Rule 31: Titles of books, films, newspapers, songs → singular

> **Rule 31.** The **title** of a book, film, play, newspaper, magazine, song or painting is **singular** even if it is plural in form — because it is the name of **one** work.

- *The Arabian Nights* **is** an interesting book. (✘ are)
- *Gulliver's Travels* **was** written by Jonathan Swift.
- *Great Expectations* **is** a novel by Charles Dickens.
- *The Canterbury Tales* **was** written by Chaucer.
- *Sons and Lovers* **is** a novel by D. H. Lawrence.
- *The Daily Star* **is** a popular English daily.
- *Romeo and Juliet* **is** a tragedy by Shakespeare.
- *The Three Musketeers* **is** an adventure novel.
- *The Times* **has** published the report.

Rule 32: Names of countries, organisations, firms

Names of countries, states, organisations and companies that look plural are **singular** because each is one unit.

- The United States **is** a powerful country.
- The Netherlands **is** famous for tulips.
- The Philippines **is** an island nation.
- The United Nations **was** founded in 1945.
- Ahmed and Sons **is** a well-known firm.
- General Motors **has** opened a new plant.
- The Maldives **is** a beautiful tourist destination.

Note: When we mean the islands themselves, plural is possible: *The Maldives **are** a chain of coral islands.*

Rule 33: *The + adjective* → plural verb (when it means a class of people)

> **Rule 33.** When an adjective is used with *the* to mean a **group/class of people**, it is **plural**: **the rich, the poor, the old, the young, the sick, the blind, the deaf, the dead, the wounded, the unemployed, the educated, the honest, the brave, the wise, the injured.**

- The rich **are** not always happy.
- The poor **are** getting poorer.
- The wounded **were** taken to hospital.
- The young **have** a duty to the old.
- The honest **are** respected everywhere.
- The brave **deserve** the fair.

But when *the + adjective* refers to an **abstract quality** or a **single person**, use a **singular** verb:

- The beautiful **is** not always good. (abstract quality, *beauty*)
- The unknown **is** always frightening.
- The impossible **has** happened.
- The accused **was** acquitted. (one person; *the accused were* if more than one)
- The deceased **was** a teacher.

Nationalities ending in *-sh, -ch, -ese, -ss* (*the English, the French, the Dutch, the Chinese, the Japanese, the Swiss*) are plural: *The English **are** a practical people. The Japanese **are** hard-working.*

23.10 Subject and Complement

Rule 34: The verb agrees with the subject, not the complement

> **Rule 34.** A **linking verb** (*be, become, seem, remain*) agrees with its **subject** (the word before it in a normal statement), **not** with the complement (the word after it).

- Our only hope **is** your sons. (subject = *hope*)
- Your sons **are** our only hope. (subject = *sons*)
- The main problem **was** the floods.
- The floods **were** the main problem.
- His greatest strength **is** his teammates.
- Bad roads **are** the main cause of accidents.
- The main cause of accidents **is** bad roads.
- Books **are** my best friend.
- My best friend **is** books.

Rule 35: "It" as a dummy (anticipatory) subject → always singular

- It **is** the students who **are** protesting. (*It is* singular; *who are* agrees with *students*)
- It **was** the floods that **destroyed** the crops.
- It **is** they who **are** responsible.

23.11 Distributive, Partitive and Comparative Structures

Rule 36: *Kind of / sort of / type of*

> **Rule 36. This/That + kind (sort, type) of + singular noun + singular verb**; **These/Those + kinds (sorts, types) of + plural noun + plural verb**.

- This kind of book **is** useful. (✘ These kind of books are)
- These kinds of books **are** useful.
- That type of man **is** dangerous.
- Those types of men **are** dangerous.
- What sort of people **are** they?

In informal speech, "*these kind of things*" is common, but it is **wrong** in exams.

Rule 37: Comparisons do not change the subject

Words introduced by *than* or *as…as* do not affect the verb.

- My brother, more than my sisters, **likes** music.
- She is taller than her sisters **are**. (verb agrees with *sisters*)
- Rahim works harder than his friends **do**.
- He sings better than I **do**. (✘ better than me do)

Rule 38: *A great deal of / A large amount of / Much / Little / Less* → singular

- A great deal of money **has** been spent.

- A large amount of rice **is** wasted every year.
- Much water **has** flowed under the bridge.
- Little knowledge **is** a dangerous thing.
- Less work **is** required now.

Compare: *A large number of trees **were** cut down.* (countable → plural)

Rule 39: *Enough / Plenty / Lots / Heaps* → follow the noun

- Lots of food **is** available. / Lots of people **are** coming.
- Plenty of money **is** needed. / Plenty of jobs **are** available.
- Enough rice **is** stored. / Enough chairs **are** available.

23.12 Special Verb Forms Affecting Agreement

Rule 40: The subjunctive breaks the normal agreement

The **subjunctive mood** uses the **base form** of the verb (no -s) and **were** for all persons in unreal conditions. It is tested in GMAT, GRE and BCS.

(a) Unreal / hypothetical *were*:

- If I **were** a bird, I would fly. (✘ If I was a bird — informal)
- If he **were** rich, he would help the poor.
- I wish I **were** a king.
- He talks as if he **were** the owner.
- Suppose she **were** here, what would you say?

(b) Mandative (formal) subjunctive after verbs and expressions of demand, suggestion, order, necessity — *suggest, recommend, insist, demand, require, propose, request, order, urge, it is essential/necessary/important/vital/imperative that*:

- The teacher suggested that he **attend** the class regularly. (✘ attends)
- The doctor recommended that she **take** rest.
- It is essential that every student **submit** the form today.
- The court ordered that the prisoner **be** released.
- They demanded that the manager **resign**.
- I insist that he **leave** at once.
- It is important that she **be** present.

> **GMAT Corner:** After *require, demand, insist, recommend, suggest, request*, the GMAT expects the **bare subjunctive**: *"The law requires that every driver **carry** a licence"* — **not** *carries*, **not** *should carry* (often marked wordy) and **not** *to carry* after *that*. Also remember: *"require X to do"* (infinitive) is fine without *that*.

(c) Formulaic subjunctive in fixed wishes and prayers:

- God **bless** you. (✘ blesses)
- Long **live** Bangladesh! (✘ lives)
- God **save** the King.
- Heaven **help** us.
- Be that as it **may**…

Rule 41: Verb after *Let's / Let him* etc.

After *let*, the verb is in the bare form: *Let him **go**. Let them **come**. Let us **work** hard.* (✘ Let him goes.)

Rule 42: Verb after "*Who / What / Which*" as subjects in questions

Who and *what* used as subjects generally take a **singular** verb unless the answer is clearly expected to be plural.

- Who **is** there? (✘ Who are there — unless you know there are several persons)
- Who **are** those people?
- What **is** the matter?
- What **are** your plans? (subject = *your plans*)
- Which of these books **is** yours? (one book expected)
- Which of these books **are** yours? (more than one expected)

23.13 Pronoun–Antecedent Agreement

Agreement is not only between subject and verb. **A pronoun must also agree with the noun it refers to (its antecedent)** in number, person and gender. This topic is closely related and is heavily tested on the SAT and GMAT, and in BCS "error detection" items.

Rule 43: Singular antecedent → singular pronoun

- Every student must bring **his or her** own pen. (formal)
- Each of the boys has done **his** duty. (✘ their duty in formal exams)
- Everyone should love **his** country. (traditional) / **their** country (modern, gender-neutral; accepted by SAT style rules today)
- Neither of the girls has finished **her** homework.
- Many a man has lost **his** life.
- One should do **one's** duty. (✘ one should do his duty in strict British usage; American English accepts *his*)

> **Singular "they":** Modern English (and the College Board/SAT) accepts *they/their* for an indefinite person: *Someone left **their** umbrella.* But a **collective noun used as a unit** or a **named thing** must not take *they*: ✘ *The company announced **their** profits.* ✔ *The company announced **its** profits.* In BCS and Bank exams, prefer the traditional *his / his or her* with *each, every, everyone, everybody, anybody, nobody*.

Rule 44: Compound antecedents

- Joined by *and* → plural pronoun: *Rahim and Karim did **their** best.*
- Joined by *or/nor* → nearest antecedent: *Neither the teacher nor the students raised **their** hands. Neither the students nor the teacher raised **his** hand.*
- *As well as / with* → first antecedent: *The captain, as well as the players, did **his** best.*

Rule 45: Collective antecedents

The pronoun must follow the same logic as the verb: *The jury **has** given **its** verdict. / The jury **are** divided in **their** opinions.* (Never: *The jury has given their verdict.*)

23.14 Agreement in Sentences with *There* and Compound Subjects

Rule 46: *There is / There are* with compound subjects

When a compound subject follows *there*, formal grammar uses a **plural** verb. However, many grammars and native speakers use a **singular** verb when the **first noun is singular** (proximity). For exam purposes:

- There **are** a pen and two pencils in the box. (formal / safest with *and*)
- There **is** a pen and two pencils in the box. (accepted informally — proximity)
- There **are** two pencils and a pen in the box. (first noun plural → plural, no debate)
- There **is** a lot of work to do.
- There **are** a lot of mistakes.
- There **is** no one in the room.
- There **is** no water in the bottle. / There **are** no books on the shelf.
- There **is** more than one reason. (*more than one* → singular)

Rule 47: Agreement in correlative sentences with *as well as* at the start

When *as well as* begins the sentence, the subject after it is still the main one:

- As well as his brother, Rahim **is** coming.
- Along with his friends, the boy **was** arrested.
- In addition to the manager, the clerks **were** absent.

23.15 Agreement of Tense and Number in Complex Sentences

Rule 48: Each clause has its own subject

In complex and compound sentences, **each verb agrees with its own subject**, not with the main subject of the sentence.

- The boy who **plays** the guitar **lives** next door.
- The man whose sons **are** doctors **is** my uncle.
- I know that the students **are** ready and that the teacher **is** coming.
- The book I gave to the girls **was** expensive.
- The girls I gave the book to **were** happy.
- Everyone thinks that the questions **were** difficult.

Rule 49: Parallel verbs share the same subject

When one subject has two or more verbs, **all** must agree.

- She **reads**, **writes** and **speaks** English fluently. (✘ She reads, write and speaks)
- The students **have** completed the work and **are** waiting for the results.
- He neither **drinks** nor **smokes**.

23.16 Miscellaneous Rules Frequently Tested in Bangladesh

Rule 50: *Each other / one another* do not affect agreement

They love each other. We help one another. The verb agrees with *they/we*.

Rule 51: *Nobody but / No one except / Nothing but* → singular

- Nobody but the teachers **was** present. (✘ were)
- No one except his parents **knows** the truth.
- Nothing but leaves **was** found on the tree.
- Nothing but trees **is** seen here.

Rule 52: *Not one of / Not a single* → singular

- Not one of the students **has** done the homework.
- Not a single tree **was** left standing.

Rule 53: Infinitive or bare verb after certain verbs

Verbs after *to* never change: *He wants **to go**.* (✘ to goes) After auxiliaries *do/does/did*, use the base form: *He **does not know**.* (✘ does not knows) *Did she **come**?* (✘ did she came) These are "agreement" errors frequently placed in Right-Form-of-Verb items.

Rule 54: *The + superlative* + plural noun + relative clause

*He is the best of all the players who **have** played here.* The relative clause refers to *players* (plural).

Rule 55: *Either / Neither* as determiners

Either and *neither* before a noun take a **singular noun** and a **singular verb**: *Neither answer **is** correct. Either side **is** acceptable.* (✘ Neither answers are correct.)

Rule 56: "*A* + adjective + *number / few / many*"

A good many / a great many / a few / a large number → plural. *A great deal / a large amount / a little / a good deal* → singular.

Rule 57: Distributive *every* with numbers

Every can be followed by a number and a plural noun to show regular intervals: *every two days, every three hours, every five years.* Here the time expression is usually an adverbial, not the subject, so the verb agrees with the real subject: *Every three hours, a bus **leaves** the terminal. The census **is** held every ten years.*

Rule 58: Double subjects with *and* in negative form

Not only… but also follows proximity (Rule 6). But "*X, and not Y*" follows **X** (Rule 5): *The students, and not the teacher, **are** responsible.*

Rule 59: Hyphenated compound adjectives do not take plural

A number used as part of a compound adjective before a noun stays singular: *a five-year plan* (✘ five-years plan), *a ten-taka note* (✘ ten-takas note), *a two-mile walk, a three-day tour*. This is closely related to agreement and is a very common BCS error item.

- He made a ten-minute speech. (✘ ten-minutes speech)
- She has a five-year-old son. (✘ five-years-old son)
- Bangladesh launched its first five-year plan in 1973.

Rule 60: Nouns of number after a numeral: *dozen, score, hundred, thousand, million, pair, stone, head (of cattle), gross*

When these words follow a definite number, they take **no -s**: *two dozen eggs, three hundred people, five thousand taka, four score years, ten head of cattle.* (✘ two dozens eggs). With *of* and no number, -s is used: *dozens of eggs, hundreds of people, thousands of taka.*

- Two dozen pens **were** bought.
- Three hundred students **are** taking the test.
- Dozens of people **were** injured.
- Millions of people **live** in Dhaka.

23.17 Common Error Patterns: Incorrect vs Correct

The following sentences show the errors that appear most often in Bangladeshi competitive exams and in the error-identification sections of the SAT and GMAT. Study the reason for each correction.

1. ✘ The news are very sad. ✔ The news **is** very sad. — *news* is singular.
2. ✘ Each of the students have a book. ✔ Each of the students **has** a book. — *each* is singular.
3. ✘ Neither of the two boys were present. ✔ Neither of the two boys **was** present.
4. ✘ One of my friend is a doctor. ✔ One of my **friends** is a doctor.
5. ✘ The number of students are increasing. ✔ The number of students **is** increasing.
6. ✘ A number of boys was absent. ✔ A number of boys **were** absent.
7. ✘ Many a boys were present. ✔ Many a **boy was** present.
8. ✘ The police has arrested the thief. ✔ The police **have** arrested the thief.
9. ✘ The cattle is grazing. ✔ The cattle **are** grazing.
10. ✘ Mathematics are a difficult subject. ✔ Mathematics **is** a difficult subject.
11. ✘ The teacher as well as his students were present. ✔ … **was** present.
12. ✘ Either Rahim or his brothers has done it. ✔ … **have** done it.
13. ✘ Neither he nor I are guilty. ✔ Neither he nor I **am** guilty.
14. ✘ It is I who is to blame. ✔ It is I who **am** to blame.
15. ✘ He is one of the best boys who has ever studied here. ✔ … who **have** ever studied here.
16. ✘ He is the only one of the boys who have passed. ✔ … who **has** passed.
17. ✘ Bread and butter are his daily food. ✔ Bread and butter **is** his daily food.
18. ✘ Slow and steady win the race. ✔ Slow and steady **wins** the race.
19. ✘ The poet and the philosopher is dead. ✔ … **are** dead. (two persons) / The poet and philosopher **is** dead. (one person)
20. ✘ Every boy and girl were present. ✔ Every boy and girl **was** present.
21. ✘ Ten miles are a long distance. ✔ Ten miles **is** a long distance.
22. ✘ The Arabian Nights are a famous book. ✔ The Arabian Nights **is** a famous book.
23. ✘ The rich is not always happy. ✔ The rich **are** not always happy.
24. ✘ My trouser is torn. ✔ My **trousers are** torn.
25. ✘ A pair of shoes were bought. ✔ A pair of shoes **was** bought.
26. ✘ The furnitures are expensive. ✔ The **furniture is** expensive.
27. ✘ He gave me many advices. ✔ He gave me **much advice / many pieces of advice**.
28. ✘ The criteria is unclear. ✔ The criteria **are** unclear.
29. ✘ These kind of books are useful. ✔ **This kind of book is** useful. / **These kinds of books are** useful.

30. ✘ Everybody have done their duty. ✔ Everybody **has** done **his/his or her** duty.
31. ✘ More than one boys were absent. ✔ More than one **boy was** absent.
32. ✘ Two-thirds of the city are flooded. ✔ Two-thirds of the city **is** flooded.
33. ✘ Most of the milk have gone bad. ✔ Most of the milk **has** gone bad.
34. ✘ There is many mistakes in the letter. ✔ There **are** many mistakes in the letter.
35. ✘ Where is my glasses? ✔ Where **are** my glasses?
36. ✘ The quality of the products are poor. ✔ The quality of the products **is** poor.
37. ✘ The committee have submitted its report. ✔ The committee **has** submitted its report.
38. ✘ If I was a king, I would help the poor. ✔ If I **were** a king, …
39. ✘ I suggested that he goes home. ✔ I suggested that he **go** home.
40. ✘ He has a ten-years-old son. ✔ He has a **ten-year-old** son.
41. ✘ Two dozens eggs were bought. ✔ Two **dozen** eggs were bought.
42. ✘ The people is happy. ✔ The people **are** happy.
43. ✘ Either of these five roads lead to the city. ✔ **Any one** of these five roads **leads** to the city.
44. ✘ Nobody but the boys were punished. ✔ Nobody but the boys **was** punished.
45. ✘ What he says are true. ✔ What he says **is** true.
46. ✘ Long lives Bangladesh! ✔ Long **live** Bangladesh!
47. ✘ The leader, with his followers, were arrested. ✔ … **was** arrested.
48. ✘ Physics are my favourite subject. ✔ Physics **is** my favourite subject.
49. ✘ The sheeps are grazing. ✔ The **sheep** are grazing.
50. ✘ Measles are a contagious disease. ✔ Measles **is** a contagious disease.

23.18 A Step-by-Step Method for Any Agreement Question

When you face any agreement item in an exam, follow these steps in order:

1. **Find the verb(s)** in the sentence. Underline every finite verb (*is, are, was, were, has, have, does, do* and present-tense main verbs).
2. **Find the true subject** of each verb. Cross out prepositional phrases (*of…, in…, with…*), appositives and relative clauses. Look *after* the verb in sentences beginning with *There/Here*, in questions and in inverted sentences.
3. **Check the joining words.** *And* → usually plural (but check Rules 2, 3, 4). *Or/nor/either…or/neither…nor/not only…but also* → nearer subject. *As well as/with/along with/together with/besides* → first subject.
4. **Check special words.** Is the subject an indefinite pronoun (each, every, either, neither, everyone, none, all, some, most)? A collective noun? A noun of the *news/mathematics/measles* type? An uncountable noun? A *people/police/cattle* type noun? A Latin plural?
5. **Check amounts and titles.** Money, time, distance and weight as one sum → singular. Titles of books and names of countries → singular. Fractions → follow the noun after *of*.
6. **Check the relative clause.** *Who/which/that* → agrees with its antecedent (and in person: *I who am, you who are*). *One of the … who* → plural; *the only one of the … who* → singular.
7. **Check the mood.** *If I were / I wish I were*; mandative *that he go / that she be*; *Long live, God bless*.
8. **Check the pronouns.** A pronoun referring back to the subject must match it (*the committee … its; each … his*).

> **Final Advice:** Read the sentence **aloud in your mind without the extra words**. *"The box ~~of old and rusty iron nails~~ is heavy."* Once the "noise" is removed, the correct agreement becomes obvious. This single habit will solve more than half of all agreement questions in BCS, Bank, admission, SAT, GRE and GMAT papers.

PART B

Vocabulary & Usage

Chapters 45–53 · Words, spelling, phrasal verbs, idioms, foreign phrases, one-word substitution, analogy, confusables, proverbs

CHAPTER 45

Vocabulary with Synonyms & Antonyms

Part B · Vocabulary

45.1 What Are Synonyms and Antonyms?

A **synonym** is a word that has the **same or nearly the same meaning** as another word in a particular context. *Big* and *large*, *begin* and *commence*, *brave* and *courageous* are synonyms.

An **antonym** is a word that has the **opposite meaning** of another word. *Big* and *small*, *begin* and *end*, *brave* and *cowardly* are antonyms.

In the Preliminary tests of BCS, in Bank recruitment tests (Officer, Senior Officer, Cash, AD of Bangladesh Bank), in university admission tests and in the verbal sections of the SAT, GRE and GMAT, vocabulary is tested directly (*"Choose the word closest in meaning to …"* or *"The antonym of … is"*) and indirectly through sentence completion, reading comprehension, analogy and one-word substitution. A strong vocabulary therefore pays off across many sections at once.

45.1.1 Perfect Synonyms Are Rare

Very few words mean **exactly** the same thing in every context. Most synonyms differ in **degree**, **tone (connotation)**, **formality** or **usage**:

- **Degree:** *dislike → hate → abhor → loathe* (each is stronger than the last). *Happy → glad → elated → ecstatic.*
- **Connotation (positive / negative feeling):** *thrifty* (good: careful with money) vs *stingy / miserly* (bad: unwilling to spend). *Confident* (good) vs *arrogant* (bad). *Curious* (neutral/good) vs *nosy* (bad).
- **Formality:** *buy* (everyday) vs *purchase* (formal); *begin* vs *commence*; *end* vs *terminate*.
- **Usage / collocation:** We say *a large amount* but *a big mistake*; *heavy rain*, not *strong rain*; *strong tea*, not *powerful tea*.

So, in an exam, you are not looking for a "perfect" synonym — you are looking for the option that is **closest** in meaning **in that context**.

45.1.2 Kinds of Antonyms

1. **Complementary (absolute) antonyms** — one excludes the other: *alive / dead, true / false, pass / fail, present / absent.*
2. **Gradable antonyms** — two ends of a scale with middle points: *hot / cold* (warm, cool in between), *rich / poor, young / old, large / small.*
3. **Relational (converse) antonyms** — one implies the other: *buy / sell, teacher / student, give / receive, husband / wife, above / below.*
4. **Antonyms made with prefixes** — *happy / unhappy, legal / illegal, possible / impossible, regular / irregular, honest / dishonest, sense / nonsense, understand / misunderstand.*

45.2 How to Solve Synonym and Antonym Questions

45.2.1 Ten Golden Strategies

1. **Know the part of speech.** A synonym must be the same part of speech as the question word. If the word is a verb (*abate*), the answer must be a verb (*diminish*), not a noun (*diminution*).
2. **Make a sentence.** Put the word into a short sentence of your own, then replace it with each option. The one that keeps the meaning is right. *The storm **abated**. → The storm **subsided**.* ✔
3. **Use roots, prefixes and suffixes.** *Bene-* = good (benevolent, benefactor); *mal-* = bad (malevolent, malice); *-cide* = killing (homicide); *omni-* = all (omnipotent); *loqu/locu* = speak (loquacious, eloquent); *chron* = time (chronic, chronology). (See Chapter 40 for a full list.)
4. **Decide the "charge".** Is the word positive (+) or negative (−)? A positive word cannot have a negative synonym, and its antonym must be negative. *Laudable* (+) → synonym *praiseworthy* (+); antonym *contemptible* (−).
5. **Eliminate wrong options.** Remove options that are unrelated, that are the wrong part of speech, or that are synonyms when the question asks for antonyms (a very common trap: test-makers deliberately place a synonym among the antonym options).
6. **Watch the "related but not equal" trap.** For *frugal*, the option *poor* is related but wrong; *thrifty* is correct. For *verbose*, the option *verbal* is a look-alike trap; *wordy* is correct.
7. **Look-alike (homonym) traps.** *Eminent* (famous) vs *imminent* (about to happen); *elicit* (draw out) vs *illicit* (illegal); *complement* vs *compliment*; *venal* (corrupt) vs *venial* (forgivable). (See Chapter 52.)
8. **Multiple meanings.** *Grave* = serious (adj) or tomb (n); *Fair* = just / light-coloured / an exhibition; *Sound* = healthy / noise / a narrow sea channel. Choose the meaning that matches the options.
9. **Know common "false friends".** Some words look as if they mean one thing but mean another (see 45.2.3).
10. **Read widely and revise often.** Reading an English daily (editorials), magazines and good novels, and revising word lists in small daily doses, is the only long-term solution.

> **Exam Tip — The "opposite" options trick:** In an MCQ for antonyms, if two options are opposites of each other (e.g. *praise* and *criticise*), the answer is very often one of them. In a synonym question, if two options mean the same thing as each other, usually **neither** is the answer (because only one answer can be right).

45.2.2 Contronyms (Words That Are Their Own Opposites)

Some English words have two meanings that are opposite to each other. The GRE and SAT love them.

Word	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
Sanction	to approve / permit	a penalty / to punish
Cleave	to split apart	to stick closely to
Oversight	supervision	a mistake of not noticing
Dust	to remove dust	to sprinkle powder on
Left	departed	remaining
Fast	moving quickly	fixed firmly, not moving
Bolt	to fasten / lock	to run away suddenly
Screen	to show (a film)	to hide / shield
Weather	to wear away	to come through safely
Trim	to cut off	to add decorations
Garnish	to decorate food	to take money (wages) by law
Fine	excellent	a penalty
Overlook	to supervise / look over	to fail to notice
Temper	to soften / moderate	to harden (steel) / anger

45.2.3 False Friends (Commonly Misunderstood Words)

Word	It does NOT mean	It actually means
Enervate	energise	weaken, drain of energy
Noisome	noisy	offensive, foul-smelling
Restive	restful	restless, impatient
Fulsome	full, plentiful	excessive and insincere (praise)
Nonplussed	calm, unbothered	puzzled, confused
Disinterested	uninterested	impartial, unbiased
Enormity	enormousness	great wickedness
Peruse	skim quickly	read carefully
Ingenuous	ingenious	innocent, frank, naive
Prodigal	prodigy	wasteful, extravagant

Word	It does NOT mean	It actually means
Sanguine	bloody	optimistic, hopeful
Inflammable	not flammable	easily set on fire
Bemused	amused	bewildered, confused
Notorious	famous (good)	famous for something bad
Presently	(always) now	soon, shortly (BrE); now (AmE)
Officious	official	too eager to give orders/advice
Pristine	old	spotless, in original condition
Plethora	small amount	excess, too much
Temerity	timidity	reckless boldness
Factious	factual	causing disagreement
Fortuitous	fortunate	happening by chance
Histrionic	historic	overly dramatic
Penury	penalty	extreme poverty
Ravenous	ravishing	extremely hungry
Tortuous	torturous	twisting, winding

45.2.4 Forming Antonyms with Prefixes and Suffixes

Prefix / Suffix	Examples
un-	able–unable, fair–unfair, kind–unkind, known–unknown
in-	active–inactive, correct–incorrect, sane–insane, visible–invisible
im- (before b, m, p)	balance–imbalance, mature–immature, polite–impolite, possible–impossible
il- (before l)	legal–illegal, legible–illegible, literate–illiterate, logical–illogical
ir- (before r)	rational–irrational, regular–irregular, relevant–irrelevant, responsible–irresponsible
dis-	agree–disagree, honest–dishonest, obey–disobey, order–disorder
mis-	fortune–misfortune, understand–misunderstand, use–misuse
non-	sense–nonsense, violent–nonviolent, existent–nonexistent
anti- / counter-	social–antisocial, clockwise–anticlockwise, act–counteract
mal-	function–malfunction, nutrition–malnutrition, treat–maltreat
-ful / -less	careful–careless, useful–useless, hopeful–hopeless, meaningful–meaningless

> **Careful:** Not every *in-* word is negative. *Inflammable* = flammable; *invaluable* = extremely valuable (✘ not "without value"); *inhabit* = live in. And *valuable / invaluable* are near-synonyms, not antonyms — the antonym of *valuable* is *worthless*.

45.3 The Master Word List

How to use this list. Each entry gives: the **word**, its **part of speech** — *(n)* noun, *(v)* verb, *(adj)* adjective, *(adv)* adverb — its **Bangla meaning**, a simple **English meaning**, **SYN** (synonyms), **ANT** (antonyms) and an **example** sentence. A star ★ marks words that appear **very frequently** in Bangladeshi competitive exams. A GRE tag marks advanced words especially common in the SAT, GRE and GMAT. Learn the example sentence along with the word: words are remembered best in context.

A

Abandon ★ *(v)* পরিত্যাগ করা — to leave completely and for ever. **SYN** desert, forsake, quit, relinquish, renounce. **ANT** keep, retain, maintain, adopt, cherish. *Ex:* The crew abandoned the sinking ship.

Abase *(v)* হেয় করা, মর্যাদা হ্রাস করা — to lower in rank or dignity. **SYN** degrade, humiliate, demean, belittle. **ANT** elevate, exalt, honour, dignify. *Ex:* He would not abase himself by begging for favours.

Abate ★ *(v)* কমা, হ্রাস পাওয়া — to become less strong or intense. **SYN** subside, diminish, decrease, wane, ebb, lessen. **ANT** increase, intensify, aggravate, augment. *Ex:* The storm abated by evening.

Abdicate *(v)* সিংহাসন বা পদ ত্যাগ করা — to give up a throne, power or responsibility. **SYN** renounce, resign, relinquish, abandon. **ANT** assume, usurp, claim, retain. *Ex:* Edward VIII abdicated the British throne in 1936.

Aberration GRE *(n)* বিচ্যুতি, স্বাভাবিকতা থেকে সরে যাওয়া — a departure from what is normal. **SYN** deviation, anomaly, irregularity, abnormality. **ANT** norm, regularity, conformity. *Ex:* His rude remark was an aberration from his usual polite behaviour.

Abeyance *(n)* স্থগিত অবস্থা — a state of temporary suspension. **SYN** suspension, dormancy, pause, latency. **ANT** operation, continuation, activity. *Ex:* The project is in abeyance until funds are found.

Abhor ★ *(v)* ঘৃণা করা — to hate very strongly. **SYN** detest, loathe, abominate, despise, execrate. **ANT** love, adore, admire, cherish. *Ex:* Every civilised person abhors cruelty.

Abject *(adj)* হীন, শোচনীয় — extremely bad, miserable or humiliating. **SYN** wretched, miserable, pitiful, degraded, base. **ANT** dignified, proud, noble, exalted. *Ex:* The refugees lived in abject poverty.

Abjure GRE *(v)* শপথপূর্বক ত্যাগ করা — to formally give up a belief or claim. **SYN** renounce, recant, forswear, repudiate. **ANT** affirm, embrace, uphold, espouse. *Ex:* He abjured his former political views.

Abolish ★ *(v)* বিলোপ করা — to end a law, system or custom officially. **SYN** eradicate, annul, abrogate, repeal, revoke. **ANT** establish, institute, create, found. *Ex:* Slavery was abolished in the British Empire in 1833.

Abominable *(adj)* ঘৃণ্য, জঘন্য — causing disgust or hatred. **SYN** detestable, loathsome, odious, atrocious, vile. **ANT** admirable, delightful, pleasant, lovable. *Ex:* The prisoners were kept in abominable conditions.

Abortive *(adj)* ব্যর্থ, নিষ্ফল — failing to produce the intended result. **SYN** unsuccessful, futile, fruitless, vain. **ANT** successful, fruitful, effective. *Ex:* They made an abortive attempt to escape.

Abound *(v)* প্রচুর পরিমাণে থাকা — to exist in large numbers. **SYN** teem, overflow, proliferate, swarm. **ANT** lack, be scarce, dwindle. *Ex:* Fish abound in the rivers of Bangladesh.

Abridge ★ *(v)* সংক্ষেপ করা — to shorten a text without losing its sense. **SYN** shorten, condense, abbreviate, curtail, truncate. **ANT** expand, lengthen, elaborate, amplify. *Ex:* This is an abridged edition of the novel.

Abrogate GRE *(v)* বাতিল করা, রদ করা — to cancel a law or agreement formally. **SYN** repeal, revoke, annul, nullify, rescind. **ANT** enact, ratify, establish, uphold. *Ex:* The new government abrogated the treaty.

Abrupt *(adj)* আকস্মিক; রূঢ় — sudden and unexpected; rude and short in manner. **SYN** sudden, unexpected, hasty; curt, brusque. **ANT** gradual, expected; polite, courteous. *Ex:* The meeting came to an abrupt end.

Absolve *(v)* দায়মুক্ত করা, ক্ষমা করা — to declare free from guilt or blame. **SYN** acquit, exonerate, pardon, forgive, exculpate. **ANT** condemn, convict, blame, accuse. *Ex:* The court absolved him of all charges.

Abstain ★ *(v)* বিরত থাকা — to keep oneself from doing something. **SYN** refrain, desist, forgo, avoid, eschew. **ANT** indulge, participate, partake. *Ex:* Muslims abstain from food and drink while fasting.

Abstruse GRE *(adj)* দুর্বোধ্য — very difficult to understand. **SYN** obscure, esoteric, recondite, arcane, incomprehensible. **ANT** clear, simple, lucid, obvious. *Ex:* The lecture on quantum theory was too abstruse for us.

Absurd *(adj)* অযৌক্তিক, হাস্যকর — completely unreasonable or silly. **SYN** ridiculous, preposterous, ludicrous, irrational, senseless. **ANT** sensible, logical, reasonable, rational. *Ex:* It is absurd to blame the weather for your laziness.

Abundant ★ *(adj)* প্রচুর — existing in large quantities. **SYN** plentiful, ample, copious, profuse, bountiful, plenteous. **ANT** scarce, scanty, meagre, sparse, deficient. *Ex:* Bangladesh has abundant water resources.

Abysmal *(adj)* অতি নিকৃষ্ট; অতল — extremely bad; immeasurably deep. SYN dreadful, appalling, awful; bottomless. ANT excellent, superb; shallow. *Ex:* The team's performance was abysmal.

Accede *(v)* সম্মত হওয়া; পদে আসীন হওয়া — to agree to a demand; to take office. SYN consent, assent, comply, acquiesce. ANT refuse, reject, deny, dissent. *Ex:* The authority acceded to the students' demands.

Acclaim *(v/n)* প্রশংসা করা; প্রশংসা — to praise publicly and enthusiastically. SYN applaud, hail, laud, commend, extol. ANT criticise, condemn, censure, denounce. *Ex:* The film was acclaimed by critics.

Accolade *(n)* সম্মাননা, প্রশংসা — an award or expression of praise. SYN honour, tribute, award, praise, distinction. ANT criticism, condemnation, censure. *Ex:* Winning the Nobel Prize is the highest accolade for a writer.

Accord *(n/v)* সম্মতি, ঐক্য; প্রদান করা — agreement; to give or grant. SYN agreement, harmony, concord, treaty; grant. ANT disagreement, discord, conflict; deny. *Ex:* The two parties signed a peace accord.

Acerbic GRE *(adj)* তীক্ষ্ণ, কটু — sharp and bitter in speech or tone. SYN caustic, acrid, sarcastic, biting, trenchant. ANT mild, gentle, kind, sweet. *Ex:* The columnist is known for his acerbic wit.

Acme *(n)* শীর্ষবিন্দু, চূড়া — the highest point of achievement. SYN peak, pinnacle, zenith, apex, summit, culmination. ANT nadir, bottom, base, low point. *Ex:* He was at the acme of his career.

Acquiesce GRE *(v)* নীরবে মেনে নেওয়া — to accept something reluctantly without protest. SYN consent, comply, submit, accede, yield. ANT resist, protest, object, oppose. *Ex:* She acquiesced in her parents' decision.

Acquit ★ *(v)* খালাস দেওয়া — to declare someone not guilty. SYN absolve, exonerate, discharge, free, clear. ANT convict, condemn, sentence, punish. *Ex:* The jury acquitted the accused.

Acrimony *(n)* তিক্ততা — bitterness or ill feeling. SYN rancour, bitterness, animosity, hostility, resentment. ANT goodwill, harmony, friendliness, amity. *Ex:* The divorce was settled without acrimony.

Acumen *(n)* বিচক্ষণতা, তীক্ষ্ণবুদ্ধি — the ability to make good judgements quickly. SYN shrewdness, astuteness, insight, sagacity, keenness. ANT stupidity, ignorance, obtuseness. *Ex:* She has great business acumen.

Adamant ★ *(adj)* অনমনীয়, একগুঁয়ে — refusing to change one's mind. SYN unyielding, inflexible, obstinate, resolute, firm. ANT flexible, yielding, compliant, pliant. *Ex:* He was adamant that he would not resign.

Adept *(adj)* দক্ষ — very skilled. SYN expert, proficient, skilful, adroit, accomplished. ANT inept, clumsy, unskilled, amateurish. *Ex:* She is adept at solving puzzles.

Adhere *(v)* লেগে থাকা, মেনে চলা — to stick to; to follow a rule or belief. SYN stick, cling; obey, follow, observe. ANT detach; disobey, violate, defy. *Ex:* All players must adhere to the rules.

Adjourn ★ *(v)* মুলতবি করা — to stop a meeting for a time. SYN postpone, suspend, defer, put off, prorogue. ANT continue, resume, convene. *Ex:* The court adjourned the hearing till Monday.

Admonish *(v)* মৃদু ভর্ৎসনা করা, সতর্ক করা — to warn or scold gently. SYN reprimand, rebuke, reprove, caution, chide. ANT praise, commend, approve, applaud. *Ex:* The teacher admonished the boy for being late.

Adroit *(adj)* চতুর, নিপুণ — clever or skilful in using hands or mind. SYN deft, dexterous, adept, skilful, nimble. ANT clumsy, awkward, inept, maladroit. *Ex:* He is an adroit negotiator.

Adulation *(n)* অতিরিক্ত প্রশংসা, তোষামোদ — excessive admiration or praise. SYN flattery, adoration, worship, fawning. ANT criticism, contempt, censure, disdain. *Ex:* The singer enjoyed the adulation of her fans.

Adversary *(n)* প্রতিপক্ষ, শত্রু — an opponent in a contest or conflict. SYN enemy, foe, opponent, rival, antagonist. ANT ally, friend, supporter, partner. *Ex:* He defeated his adversary in the election.

Adverse ★ *(adj)* প্রতিকূল — harmful or unfavourable. SYN unfavourable, hostile, detrimental, harmful, contrary. ANT favourable, beneficial, advantageous, propitious. *Ex:* The drug has no adverse effects.

Advocate *(v/n)* সমর্থন করা; উকিল — to support publicly; a supporter or lawyer. SYN support, champion, endorse, recommend; proponent. ANT oppose, discourage, criticise; opponent. *Ex:* She advocates free education for girls.

Affable *(adj)* অমায়িক, সদালাপী — friendly and easy to talk to. SYN amiable, genial, cordial, sociable, courteous. ANT unfriendly, surly, aloof, hostile. *Ex:* Our new manager is an affable man.

Affluent ★ *(adj)* ধনী, সচ্ছল — wealthy. SYN rich, prosperous, wealthy, well-off, opulent. ANT poor, needy, impoverished, indigent, destitute. *Ex:* Gulshan is an affluent area of Dhaka.

Aggravate ★ *(v)* আরও খারাপ করা — to make a problem worse; (informal) to annoy. SYN worsen, intensify, exacerbate, compound; irritate. ANT alleviate, ease, mitigate, improve; soothe. *Ex:* Smoking aggravated his illness.

Agile *(adj)* চটপটে — able to move quickly and easily. SYN nimble, quick, sprightly, lithe, spry. ANT clumsy, sluggish, stiff, awkward. *Ex:* The goalkeeper was remarkably agile.

Alacrity GRE *(n)* তৎপরতা, উৎসাহপূর্ণ দ্রুততা — eager and cheerful readiness. SYN eagerness, readiness, promptness, enthusiasm, zeal. ANT reluctance, apathy, slowness, sluggishness. *Ex:* She accepted the invitation with alacrity.

Alleviate ★ *(v)* লাঘব করা, উপশম করা — to make pain or a problem less severe. SYN relieve, ease, mitigate, allay, assuage, lessen. ANT aggravate, worsen, intensify, exacerbate. *Ex:* The government took steps to alleviate poverty.

Allure *(n/v)* আকর্ষণ; প্রলুব্ধ করা — attractiveness; to attract or tempt. SYN charm, attraction, appeal; entice, tempt, lure. ANT repulsion; repel, deter, disgust. *Ex:* The allure of city life draws many villagers to Dhaka.

Aloof *(adj)* নির্লিপ্ত, দূরত্ব বজায় রাখা — not friendly; keeping at a distance. SYN distant, detached, reserved, unsociable, remote. ANT friendly, sociable, warm, approachable. *Ex:* He remained aloof from party politics.

Altruistic *(adj)* পরার্থপর, পরহিতৈষী — caring unselfishly for others. SYN selfless, unselfish, philanthropic, benevolent, humane. ANT selfish, egoistic, self-centred, mean. *Ex:* Her altruistic work in the slums is admired.

Amalgamate *(v)* একত্রিত করা, মিশ্রিত করা — to combine into one. SYN merge, unite, combine, integrate, fuse. ANT separate, divide, split, disunite. *Ex:* The two banks amalgamated last year.

Ambiguous ★ *(adj)* দ্ব্যর্থক, অস্পষ্ট — having more than one possible meaning. SYN equivocal, vague, unclear, obscure, cryptic. ANT clear, explicit, definite, unequivocal, lucid. *Ex:* His answer was deliberately ambiguous.

Ameliorate ★ GRE *(v)* উন্নত করা — to make something bad better. SYN improve, better, enhance, amend, reform. ANT worsen, deteriorate, aggravate, impair. *Ex:* Steps were taken to ameliorate the condition of the workers.

Amenable *(adj)* বাধ্য, সহজে রাজি — willing to accept or be influenced. SYN agreeable, compliant, cooperative, tractable, docile. ANT stubborn, obstinate, intractable, resistant. *Ex:* He is amenable to reason.

Amiable *(adj)* বন্ধুভাবাপন্ন, অমায়িক — friendly and pleasant (of a person). SYN affable, genial, friendly, good-natured, likeable. ANT unfriendly, hostile, disagreeable, surly. *Ex:* She is an amiable girl liked by all.

Amicable *(adj)* সৌহার্দ্যপূর্ণ — friendly and without disagreement (of relations or agreements). SYN friendly, cordial, harmonious, peaceable. ANT hostile, antagonistic, unfriendly, acrimonious. *Ex:* The dispute was settled amicably.

Ample *(adj)* পর্যাপ্ত — more than enough. SYN plentiful, abundant, sufficient, copious, generous. ANT insufficient, scanty, meagre, inadequate. *Ex:* There is ample time to finish the work.

Anarchy *(n)* নৈরাজ্য — total lack of government or order. SYN lawlessness, chaos, disorder, turmoil, mayhem. ANT order, law, government, discipline. *Ex:* The country fell into anarchy after the coup.

Animosity *(n)* শত্রুতা, বিদ্বেষ — strong hostility. SYN enmity, hostility, hatred, antagonism, rancour. ANT friendship, goodwill, amity, sympathy. *Ex:* There is no personal animosity between the two leaders.

Annihilate *(v)* ধ্বংস করা, নিশ্চিহ্ন করা — to destroy completely. SYN destroy, obliterate, exterminate, eradicate, wipe out. ANT create, build, preserve, protect. *Ex:* The enemy forces were annihilated.

Anomaly GRE *(n)* অসংগতি, ব্যতিক্রম — something unusual or not expected. SYN irregularity, aberration, deviation, oddity, exception. ANT norm, rule, regularity, standard. *Ex:* The auditor found several anomalies in the accounts.

Antipathy *(n)* বিতৃষ্ণা, বিরাগ — a strong feeling of dislike. SYN aversion, hostility, dislike, repugnance, animosity. ANT sympathy, affection, liking, fondness. *Ex:* He has an antipathy to modern art.

Antiquated *(adj)* সেকেলে — old-fashioned or outdated. SYN obsolete, outdated, archaic, outmoded, old-fashioned. ANT modern, new, up-to-date, contemporary. *Ex:* The office still uses antiquated machines.

Apathy ★ *(n)* উদাসীনতা — lack of interest or concern. SYN indifference, unconcern, passivity, lethargy, listlessness. ANT interest, enthusiasm, concern, zeal, passion. *Ex:* Voter apathy led to a low turnout.

Appease *(v)* শান্ত করা, তুষ্ট করা — to calm someone by giving what they want. SYN pacify, placate, mollify, conciliate, soothe. ANT provoke, enrage, incite, antagonise. *Ex:* The ruler tried to appease the angry mob.

Apprehensive *(adj)* শঙ্কিত — anxious that something bad may happen. SYN anxious, worried, uneasy, fearful, nervous. ANT confident, calm, assured, carefree. *Ex:* She was apprehensive about the interview.

Arbitrary ★ *(adj)* স্বেচ্ছাচারী, খেয়ালখুশিমতো — based on personal whim, not reason or rule. SYN random, capricious, whimsical, despotic, unreasoned. ANT rational, reasoned, logical, systematic, lawful. *Ex:* The arbitrary arrest of journalists was condemned.

Arduous ★ *(adj)* কষ্টসাধ্য, দুরূহ — requiring great effort. SYN laborious, strenuous, difficult, onerous, gruelling. ANT easy, effortless, simple, facile. *Ex:* Climbing Everest is an arduous task.

Arrogant ★ *(adj)* উদ্ধত, অহংকারী — having an exaggerated sense of one's importance. SYN haughty, proud, conceited, overbearing, insolent. ANT humble, modest, meek, unassuming. *Ex:* His arrogant behaviour annoyed everyone.

Articulate *(adj/v)* স্পষ্টভাষী; স্পষ্ট করে বলা — able to express ideas clearly; to express clearly. SYN eloquent, fluent, lucid; express, voice. ANT inarticulate, tongue-tied, incoherent. *Ex:* She is an articulate speaker.

Ascend *(v)* আরোহণ করা — to go up. SYN climb, rise, mount, soar, scale. ANT descend, fall, drop, sink. *Ex:* The plane ascended into the clouds.

Ascetic *(adj/n)* তপস্বী, সংযমী — practising severe self-discipline and avoiding pleasure. SYN austere, abstinent, self-denying; hermit, monk. ANT self-indulgent, hedonistic, sensual; hedonist. *Ex:* The monk led an ascetic life.

Assiduous GRE *(adj)* অধ্যবসায়ী, পরিশ্রমী — showing great care and persistence. SYN diligent, industrious, sedulous, painstaking, persevering. ANT lazy, negligent, careless, indolent. *Ex:* Assiduous study helped him top the exam.

Astute *(adj)* চতুর, বিচক্ষণ — clever at understanding situations and people. SYN shrewd, sharp, perceptive, sagacious, canny. ANT stupid, naive, foolish, obtuse. *Ex:* He is an astute politician.

Atrocious *(adj)* নৃশংস, জঘন্য — extremely cruel or very bad. SYN brutal, barbaric, heinous, monstrous, abominable. ANT kind, humane, admirable, pleasant. *Ex:* The army committed atrocious crimes in 1971.

Audacious *(adj)* দুঃসাহসী — very bold; willing to take risks (sometimes rudely bold). SYN daring, bold, fearless, intrepid; impudent. ANT timid, cautious, cowardly, meek. *Ex:* It was an audacious plan to cross the ocean on a raft.

Augment ★ *(v)* বৃদ্ধি করা — to make larger or greater. SYN increase, enlarge, expand, boost, amplify, supplement. ANT decrease, reduce, diminish, curtail. *Ex:* He took a part-time job to augment his income.

Auspicious ★ *(adj)* শুভ, মাঙ্গলিক — showing signs of future success. SYN favourable, promising, propitious, fortunate, lucky. ANT inauspicious, ominous, unfavourable, sinister. *Ex:* Pahela Baishakh is an auspicious day for Bengalis.

Austere *(adj)* কঠোর, আড়ম্বরহীন — severe; simple and without comfort. SYN strict, stern, harsh; plain, spartan, frugal. ANT lenient, mild; luxurious, ornate, lavish. *Ex:* He lived an austere life in a small room.

Authentic *(adj)* প্রামাণিক, খাঁটি — genuine; real. SYN genuine, real, bona fide, true, reliable. ANT fake, false, counterfeit, spurious, bogus. *Ex:* This is an authentic painting by Zainul Abedin.

Avarice ★ *(n)* লোভ, অর্থলিপ্সা — extreme greed for wealth. SYN greed, cupidity, covetousness, rapacity, acquisitiveness. ANT generosity, liberality, charity, munificence. *Ex:* Avarice is the root of many evils.

Averse *(adj)* বিরূপ, অনিচ্ছুক — strongly disliking or opposed (to). SYN opposed, reluctant, unwilling, hostile, loath. ANT eager, keen, willing, inclined. *Ex:* He is not averse to hard work.

Avid *(adj)* আগ্রহী, উৎসুক — very enthusiastic. SYN keen, eager, ardent, passionate, zealous. ANT indifferent, apathetic, unenthusiastic. *Ex:* She is an avid reader of detective novels.

B

Baffle *(v)* বিভ্রান্ত করা, হতবুদ্ধি করা — to confuse completely. SYN puzzle, perplex, bewilder, confound, mystify. ANT clarify, enlighten, explain, elucidate. *Ex:* The magician's trick baffled the audience.

Banal GRE *(adj)* গতানুগতিক, মামুলি — so ordinary as to be boring. SYN trite, commonplace, hackneyed, clichéd, platitudinous, insipid. ANT original, novel, fresh, innovative, striking. *Ex:* The speech was full of banal remarks.

Baneful *(adj)* ক্ষতিকর, অনিষ্টকর — harmful or destructive. SYN harmful, pernicious, deleterious, injurious, noxious. ANT beneficial, wholesome, salutary, harmless. *Ex:* Drugs have a baneful effect on the youth.

Barbarous *(adj)* বর্বর — extremely cruel; uncivilised. SYN savage, brutal, cruel, barbaric, uncivilised. ANT civilised, humane, cultured, gentle. *Ex:* It was a barbarous act of terrorism.

Barren ★ *(adj)* অনুর্বর, বন্ধ্যা — unable to produce crops or offspring. SYN infertile, sterile, arid, unproductive, desolate. ANT fertile, fruitful, productive, fecund, lush. *Ex:* The desert is a barren land.

Belie GRE *(v)* মিথ্যা প্রতিপন্ন করা, ভুল ধারণা দেওয়া — to give a false impression of; to show to be false. SYN contradict, disguise, misrepresent, refute. ANT reveal, confirm, attest, prove. *Ex:* His cheerful face belied his sorrow.

Belligerent ★ *(adj)* যুদ্ধংদেহী, কলহপ্রিয় — hostile and aggressive; engaged in war. SYN aggressive, hostile, bellicose, combative, pugnacious. ANT peaceful, friendly, conciliatory, pacific. *Ex:* The belligerent nations agreed to a ceasefire.

Benevolent ★ *(adj)* দয়ালু, পরোপকারী — kind and generous. SYN kind, charitable, generous, philanthropic, humane. ANT malevolent, cruel, unkind, spiteful. *Ex:* The benevolent man built a school for poor children.

Benign *(adj)* সদয়; নিরীহ (রোগ) — gentle and kind; (of disease) not harmful. SYN kind, gentle, benevolent; harmless, non-cancerous. ANT malign, hostile; malignant, harmful. *Ex:* Fortunately, the tumour was benign.

Berate *(v)* কঠোরভাবে তিরস্কার করা — to scold angrily. SYN scold, rebuke, reprimand, castigate, upbraid. ANT praise, commend, laud, compliment. *Ex:* The coach berated the players for their poor performance.

Bewilder *(v)* হতবুদ্ধি করা — to confuse. SYN baffle, puzzle, confuse, perplex, confound. ANT enlighten, clarify, explain. *Ex:* The complex rules bewildered the new students.

Bias *(n)* পক্ষপাত — an unfair preference for or against someone. SYN prejudice, partiality, favouritism, partisanship, leaning. ANT impartiality, fairness, neutrality, objectivity. *Ex:* A judge must decide without bias.

Blatant *(adj)* নির্লজ্জ, স্পষ্ট — done openly and shamelessly. SYN flagrant, obvious, glaring, brazen, overt. ANT hidden, subtle, covert, inconspicuous. *Ex:* It was a blatant lie.

Bleak *(adj)* অন্ধকারাচ্ছন্ন, নিরানন্দ — cold and empty; without hope. SYN desolate, grim, dismal, gloomy, hopeless. ANT bright, promising, hopeful, cheerful. *Ex:* The future looks bleak for the industry.

Blithe *(adj)* উৎফুল্ল; উদাসীন — happy and carefree; casually indifferent. SYN cheerful, carefree, light-hearted; casual, heedless. ANT gloomy, sad; careful, concerned. *Ex:* He showed blithe disregard for the rules.

Bliss *(n)* পরম আনন্দ — perfect happiness. SYN joy, ecstasy, rapture, delight, euphoria. ANT misery, sorrow, woe, agony, despair. *Ex:* Ignorance is bliss.

Boisterous *(adj)* হৈচৈপূর্ণ, উচ্ছৃঙ্খল — noisy, lively and energetic. SYN rowdy, noisy, unruly, exuberant, clamorous. ANT quiet, calm, restrained, sedate. *Ex:* The children were boisterous at the picnic.

Bold ★ *(adj)* সাহসী — brave and confident. SYN brave, daring, courageous, fearless, audacious. ANT timid, shy, cowardly, fearful, meek. *Ex:* It was a bold decision to start a business.

Bolster *(v)* সমর্থন জোগানো, শক্তিশালী করা — to support or strengthen. SYN strengthen, reinforce, support, boost, buttress. ANT weaken, undermine, sabotage, impair. *Ex:* The new evidence bolstered his claim.

Bombastic GRE *(adj)* আড়ম্বরপূর্ণ (ভাষা), দম্ভপূর্ণ — using high-sounding but empty language. SYN pompous, grandiloquent, pretentious, inflated, turgid. ANT simple, plain, modest, unpretentious. *Ex:* The politician gave a bombastic speech.

Boon ★ *(n)* আশীর্বাদ, বর — something helpful or beneficial. SYN blessing, benefit, advantage, godsend, gift. ANT bane, curse, disadvantage, blight. *Ex:* Mobile banking is a boon for rural people.

Boorish *(adj)* অভদ্র, গেঁয়ো — rough and bad-mannered. SYN rude, uncouth, coarse, vulgar, loutish. ANT refined, polite, cultured, courteous. *Ex:* His boorish behaviour embarrassed his hosts.

Brave ★ *(adj)* সাহসী — ready to face danger or pain. SYN courageous, valiant, gallant, intrepid, heroic, dauntless. ANT cowardly, timid, fearful, craven. *Ex:* The brave freedom fighters sacrificed their lives.

Brevity *(n)* সংক্ষিপ্ততা — shortness, especially of speech or writing. SYN conciseness, briefness, succinctness, terseness. ANT verbosity, wordiness, prolixity, length. *Ex:* Brevity is the soul of wit.

Brittle *(adj)* ভঙ্গুর — hard but easily broken. SYN fragile, breakable, frail, delicate, crisp. ANT flexible, durable, tough, sturdy, elastic. *Ex:* Old bones become brittle.

Brusque *(adj)* রূঢ়, কাটখোট্টা — abrupt and rude in speech or manner. SYN curt, blunt, abrupt, gruff, terse. ANT polite, courteous, gracious, gentle. *Ex:* The officer gave a brusque reply.

Bucolic GRE *(adj)* গ্রাম্য, রাখালিয়া — related to pleasant country life. SYN rural, pastoral, rustic, idyllic. ANT urban, metropolitan, industrial. *Ex:* Jasimuddin painted bucolic scenes in his poems.

Burgeon GRE *(v)* দ্রুত বৃদ্ধি পাওয়া — to grow or develop rapidly. SYN flourish, boom, mushroom, expand, thrive. ANT decline, wither, shrink, dwindle. *Ex:* The garment industry burgeoned in the 1990s.

Buoyant *(adj)* ভাসমান; প্রফুল্ল — able to float; cheerful and optimistic. SYN floating; cheerful, optimistic, lively, upbeat. ANT sinking; depressed, gloomy, despondent. *Ex:* The market remained buoyant this year.

C

Cajole *(v)* তোষামোদ করে রাজি করানো — to persuade by flattery or gentle urging. SYN coax, wheedle, persuade, entice, inveigle. ANT force, compel, coerce, bully. *Ex:* She cajoled her father into buying her a phone.

Callous ★ *(adj)* নির্দয়, অনুভূতিহীন — not caring about others' suffering. SYN heartless, unfeeling, cruel, insensitive, hard-hearted. ANT kind, compassionate, sympathetic, caring, tender. *Ex:* His callous remark hurt the widow.

Calm *(adj)* শান্ত — peaceful and quiet; not excited. SYN tranquil, serene, placid, composed, peaceful. ANT agitated, stormy, excited, turbulent, anxious. *Ex:* The sea was calm in the morning.

Candid ★ *(adj)* অকপট, স্পষ্টবাদী — honest and direct. SYN frank, open, outspoken, forthright, blunt. ANT evasive, secretive, guarded, deceitful. *Ex:* I want your candid opinion of my essay.

Candour *(n)* স্পষ্টবাদিতা, সরলতা — the quality of being honest and open. SYN frankness, honesty, openness, sincerity, directness. ANT deceit, evasiveness, secrecy, duplicity. *Ex:* He spoke with refreshing candour.

Capitulate *(v)* আত্মসমর্পণ করা — to surrender; to stop resisting. SYN surrender, yield, submit, give in, concede. ANT resist, fight, defy, withstand. *Ex:* The Pakistani forces capitulated on 16 December 1971.

Capricious ★ GRE *(adj)* খামখেয়ালি — changing mood or behaviour suddenly. SYN fickle, whimsical, erratic, volatile, mercurial, unpredictable. ANT steady, stable, consistent, constant, reliable. *Ex:* The weather in April is capricious.

Captivate *(v)* মুগ্ধ করা — to attract and hold the attention of. SYN charm, enchant, fascinate, enthral, bewitch. ANT repel, bore, disgust, alienate. *Ex:* Her voice captivated the audience.

Castigate *(v)* কঠোর সমালোচনা করা, শাস্তি দেওয়া — to criticise or punish severely. SYN chastise, rebuke, reprimand, berate, censure. ANT praise, commend, reward, laud. *Ex:* The report castigated the officials for negligence.

Catastrophe *(n)* মহাবিপর্যয় — a sudden great disaster. SYN disaster, calamity, cataclysm, tragedy, debacle. ANT blessing, success, boon, fortune, triumph. *Ex:* The cyclone of 1970 was a national catastrophe.

Caustic *(adj)* ক্ষয়কারক; তীব্র ব্যঙ্গাত্মক — able to burn chemically; bitterly sarcastic. SYN corrosive; sarcastic, acerbic, biting, scathing. ANT mild, soothing; kind, gentle. *Ex:* She made a caustic comment about his work.

Cautious *(adj)* সতর্ক — careful to avoid danger. SYN careful, wary, prudent, circumspect, vigilant. ANT careless, reckless, rash, heedless, imprudent. *Ex:* Be cautious while crossing the road.

Celebrated *(adj)* বিখ্যাত — famous and praised. SYN famous, renowned, eminent, illustrious, acclaimed. ANT unknown, obscure, unsung, notorious. *Ex:* Lalon is a celebrated mystic poet.

Censure ★ *(v/n)* নিন্দা করা; নিন্দা — to express strong formal disapproval. SYN condemn, criticise, denounce, rebuke, reprimand. ANT praise, approve, commend, endorse, applaud. *Ex:* Parliament passed a motion of censure against the minister.

Chaos *(n)* বিশৃঙ্খলা — complete disorder and confusion. SYN disorder, confusion, mayhem, turmoil, anarchy, pandemonium. ANT order, peace, calm, organisation, system. *Ex:* The power failure caused chaos at the airport.

Charlatan GRE *(n)* ভণ্ড, প্রতারক — a person who falsely claims special knowledge or skill. SYN fraud, quack, impostor, swindler, mountebank. ANT expert, professional, genuine article. *Ex:* The "doctor" turned out to be a charlatan.

Chaste *(adj)* সতী, পবিত্র; সরল — morally pure; simple in style. SYN pure, virtuous, modest, innocent; plain, simple. ANT impure, immoral, lewd; ornate, gaudy. *Ex:* Her prose style is chaste and elegant.

Chastise *(v)* শাস্তি দেওয়া, তিরস্কার করা — to scold or punish severely. SYN punish, discipline, castigate, rebuke, reprimand. ANT praise, reward, commend, compliment. *Ex:* The father chastised his son for lying.

Cherish *(v)* লালন করা, সযত্নে রাখা — to love and protect; to keep a memory or hope. SYN treasure, value, prize, adore, nurture, harbour. ANT neglect, abandon, despise, disregard. *Ex:* We cherish the memories of our childhood.

Chicanery GRE *(n)* প্রবঞ্চনা, কূটকৌশল — the use of tricks to deceive. SYN trickery, deception, deceit, subterfuge, sophistry. ANT honesty, candour, fairness, probity. *Ex:* The election was won through chicanery.

Circumspect GRE *(adj)* সতর্ক, বিবেচক — careful to consider all risks before acting. SYN cautious, wary, prudent, careful, discreet. ANT rash, reckless, careless, imprudent, heedless. *Ex:* Diplomats must be circumspect in what they say.

Clandestine ★ *(adj)* গোপন — done secretly, often illegally. SYN secret, covert, surreptitious, furtive, hidden, underground. ANT open, public, overt, legal, above-board. *Ex:* They held clandestine meetings at night.

Clemency *(n)* ক্ষমা, দয়া — mercy shown in punishment. SYN mercy, leniency, forgiveness, compassion, pardon. ANT severity, cruelty, harshness, ruthlessness. *Ex:* The prisoner appealed to the President for clemency.

Coerce *(v)* বলপ্রয়োগ করা — to force someone to do something by threats. SYN force, compel, pressure, intimidate, bully. ANT persuade, coax, induce, allow. *Ex:* He was coerced into signing the document.

Cogent GRE *(adj)* যুক্তিযুক্ত, জোরালো — clear, logical and convincing. SYN convincing, compelling, persuasive, forceful, sound. ANT weak, unconvincing, flimsy, illogical. *Ex:* She presented a cogent argument.

Coherent *(adj)* সুসংগত — logical and consistent; clear. SYN logical, consistent, rational, lucid, orderly. ANT incoherent, confused, illogical, rambling. *Ex:* The report lacks a coherent structure.

Colossal *(adj)* বিশাল — extremely large. SYN huge, enormous, gigantic, immense, mammoth, massive. ANT tiny, minute, small, minuscule. *Ex:* The Padma Bridge is a colossal project.

Commence *(v)* শুরু করা — to begin. SYN begin, start, initiate, launch, inaugurate. ANT end, finish, conclude, terminate, cease. *Ex:* The examination will commence at 10 a.m.

Compassion ★ *(n)* সহানুভূতি, করুণা — sympathy and concern for others' suffering. SYN sympathy, pity, kindness, mercy, empathy. ANT cruelty, indifference, callousness, mercilessness. *Ex:* Doctors should treat patients with compassion.

Compatible *(adj)* সামঞ্জস্যপূর্ণ — able to exist or work together. SYN consistent, harmonious, congruous, suited, in tune. ANT incompatible, contradictory, discordant, conflicting. *Ex:* This software is compatible with all computers.

Complacent ★ *(adj)* আত্মতুষ্ট — too satisfied with oneself and unaware of danger. SYN smug, self-satisfied, contented, unconcerned. ANT concerned, dissatisfied, vigilant, alert. *Ex:* We cannot afford to be complacent about dengue.

Comply *(v)* মেনে চলা — to act according to a request or rule. SYN obey, follow, conform, adhere, observe. ANT disobey, defy, violate, resist. *Ex:* All factories must comply with safety laws.

Concise ★ *(adj)* সংক্ষিপ্ত — giving information clearly in few words. SYN brief, succinct, terse, compact, pithy, laconic. ANT verbose, wordy, lengthy, prolix, long-winded. *Ex:* Write a concise summary of the passage.

Conciliate *(v)* মীমাংসা করা, শান্ত করা — to stop someone being angry; to reconcile. SYN pacify, placate, appease, reconcile, mollify. ANT antagonise, provoke, alienate, anger. *Ex:* The manager tried to conciliate the striking workers.

Condemn *(v)* নিন্দা করা; দণ্ড দেওয়া — to express strong disapproval; to sentence. SYN denounce, censure, deplore; convict, sentence. ANT praise, approve, commend; acquit, pardon. *Ex:* The world condemned the genocide.

Condone ★ *(v)* উপেক্ষা করা, মার্জনা করা — to accept or allow wrong behaviour. SYN overlook, excuse, pardon, forgive, disregard. ANT condemn, punish, censure, denounce. *Ex:* We cannot condone violence in any form.

Confident *(adj)* আত্মবিশ্বাসী — sure of oneself or of something. SYN self-assured, certain, sure, positive, poised. ANT diffident, unsure, doubtful, timid, insecure. *Ex:* She felt confident about the viva.

Confiscate *(v)* বাজেয়াপ্ত করা — to take property officially as a penalty. SYN seize, impound, appropriate, sequester. ANT return, restore, release, give back. *Ex:* Customs officers confiscated the smuggled gold.

Conspicuous ★ *(adj)* সুস্পষ্ট, দৃষ্টিগোচর — clearly visible; attracting attention. SYN noticeable, prominent, obvious, striking, evident, salient. ANT inconspicuous, hidden, invisible, unnoticeable. *Ex:* He was conspicuous by his absence.

Contemplate *(v)* গভীরভাবে চিন্তা করা — to think deeply about; to consider doing. SYN consider, ponder, reflect, meditate, deliberate. ANT ignore, disregard, neglect, overlook. *Ex:* He is contemplating a career change.

Contempt *(n)* ঘৃণা, অবজ্ঞা — the feeling that someone is worthless. SYN scorn, disdain, disrespect, derision, disregard. ANT respect, admiration, esteem, regard, reverence. *Ex:* He looked at the traitor with contempt.

Contemptible *(adj)* ঘৃণ্য — deserving contempt. SYN despicable, shameful, base, mean, detestable. ANT admirable, laudable, honourable, praiseworthy. *Ex:* Cheating the poor is a contemptible act.

Contentious *(adj)* বিতর্কিত; কলহপ্রিয় — causing disagreement; fond of arguing. SYN controversial, disputed, debatable; quarrelsome. ANT uncontroversial, agreed; peaceable, agreeable. *Ex:* Water-sharing is a contentious issue.

Contradict *(v)* বিরোধিতা করা, খণ্ডন করা — to state the opposite of. SYN deny, refute, dispute, oppose, gainsay. ANT confirm, agree, endorse, corroborate, support. *Ex:* The witness contradicted his earlier statement.

Convene *(v)* সভা আহ্বান করা — to call people together for a meeting. SYN assemble, summon, convoke, call, gather. ANT dismiss, adjourn, disperse, disband. *Ex:* The Speaker convened a special session.

Copious *(adj)* প্রচুর — abundant in supply. SYN abundant, plentiful, profuse, ample, lavish. ANT scarce, meagre, sparse, scanty. *Ex:* She took copious notes during the lecture.

Cordial *(adj)* আন্তরিক, সৌহার্দ্যপূর্ণ — warm and friendly. SYN friendly, warm, affable, genial, hearty. ANT hostile, cold, unfriendly, frosty. *Ex:* The two leaders had a cordial meeting.

Corroborate GRE *(v)* সমর্থন করা, প্রমাণ দৃঢ় করা — to confirm with evidence. SYN confirm, verify, substantiate, support, validate. ANT contradict, refute, deny, disprove. *Ex:* Two witnesses corroborated her story.

Covert *(adj)* গোপন — not openly shown; secret. SYN secret, hidden, clandestine, surreptitious, veiled. ANT overt, open, public, manifest. *Ex:* The agency ran a covert operation.

Covet *(v)* লোভ করা — to want eagerly something belonging to another. SYN desire, crave, envy, hanker after, lust after. ANT renounce, disdain, reject, spurn. *Ex:* Do not covet your neighbour's property.

Cowardly *(adj)* ভীরু, কাপুরুষোচিত — lacking courage. SYN fearful, timid, craven, faint-hearted, pusillanimous. ANT brave, bold, courageous, valiant, heroic. *Ex:* Attacking unarmed people is a cowardly act.

Credible *(adj)* বিশ্বাসযোগ্য — able to be believed. SYN believable, plausible, reliable, trustworthy, convincing. ANT incredible, unbelievable, implausible, dubious. *Ex:* We need a credible witness.

Credulous GRE *(adj)* সহজে বিশ্বাসকারী — too ready to believe things. SYN gullible, naive, trusting, unsuspecting. ANT sceptical, suspicious, wary, incredulous. *Ex:* Credulous villagers were cheated by the fraudster.

Cryptic *(adj)* রহস্যময়, দুর্বোধ্য — mysterious or obscure in meaning. SYN enigmatic, mysterious, obscure, puzzling, arcane. ANT clear, plain, obvious, explicit. *Ex:* He left a cryptic message on the door.

Culpable *(adj)* দোষী, নিন্দনীয় — deserving blame. SYN guilty, blameworthy, responsible, at fault. ANT innocent, blameless, guiltless. *Ex:* The officials were held culpable for the fire.

Cumbersome *(adj)* ভারী ও অসুবিধাজনক — large, heavy and difficult to use; slow and complicated. SYN unwieldy, bulky, awkward, clumsy; complicated. ANT manageable, handy, convenient; simple, efficient. *Ex:* The old procedure was cumbersome.

Curb *(v)* দমন করা, নিয়ন্ত্রণ করা — to control or limit. SYN restrain, check, control, limit, suppress. ANT encourage, free, release, foster, unleash. *Ex:* The government is trying to curb inflation.

Curt *(adj)* রূঢ়, সংক্ষিপ্ত — rudely brief. SYN brusque, abrupt, terse, blunt, short. ANT polite, courteous, expansive, gracious. *Ex:* She gave a curt nod and left.

Cynical *(adj)* মানুষের সদিচ্ছায় অবিশ্বাসী — believing that people act only in self-interest. SYN sceptical, distrustful, pessimistic, sardonic. ANT trusting, optimistic, idealistic, naive. *Ex:* Many voters have grown cynical about politics.

D

Daunt *(v)* ভীত করা, দমিয়ে দেওয়া — to make someone feel afraid or discouraged. SYN intimidate, discourage, dismay, frighten, cow. ANT encourage, embolden, hearten, inspire. *Ex:* Nothing could daunt her spirit.

Dauntless *(adj)* নির্ভীক — showing fearlessness. SYN fearless, intrepid, bold, valiant, undaunted. ANT timid, fearful, cowardly, faint-hearted. *Ex:* The dauntless soldiers held their position.

Dearth ★ *(n)* অভাব, ঘাটতি — a scarcity or lack of something. SYN scarcity, shortage, lack, paucity, deficiency, insufficiency. ANT abundance, plenty, profusion, surplus, glut. *Ex:* There is a dearth of skilled nurses in the country.

Debacle *(n)* চরম ব্যর্থতা, বিপর্যয় — a sudden and complete failure. SYN fiasco, disaster, failure, collapse, catastrophe. ANT success, triumph, victory, achievement. *Ex:* The launch of the product was a debacle.

Debilitate *(v)* দুর্বল করা — to make very weak. SYN weaken, enfeeble, enervate, sap, exhaust. ANT strengthen, invigorate, fortify, energise. *Ex:* The long illness debilitated him.

Decadence *(n)* অবক্ষয়, পতন — moral or cultural decline. SYN decline, decay, degeneration, corruption, debauchery. ANT rise, growth, flourishing, virtue, morality. *Ex:* The decadence of the Roman Empire led to its fall.

Deceit *(n)* প্রতারণা — dishonest behaviour meant to trick. SYN deception, fraud, trickery, duplicity, guile. ANT honesty, candour, sincerity, frankness. *Ex:* He won the election through deceit.

Decipher *(v)* পাঠোদ্ধার করা — to work out the meaning of something difficult. SYN decode, interpret, unravel, decrypt, solve. ANT encode, encipher, garble, confuse. *Ex:* Scholars deciphered the ancient inscription.

Decorum *(n)* শিষ্টাচার, শালীনতা — polite and correct behaviour. SYN propriety, decency, etiquette, dignity, good manners. ANT impropriety, indecorum, rudeness, vulgarity. *Ex:* Members must maintain decorum in Parliament.

Decry *(v)* প্রকাশ্যে নিন্দা করা — to criticise publicly. SYN denounce, condemn, criticise, disparage, belittle. ANT praise, extol, laud, acclaim. *Ex:* Many decried the decision to cut trees for the road.

Defer *(v)* স্থগিত করা; মেনে নেওয়া — to postpone; to yield respectfully to another's opinion. SYN postpone, delay, put off, adjourn; submit, yield. ANT advance, expedite, hasten; resist, defy. *Ex:* The decision was deferred until next week.

Deference *(n)* শ্রদ্ধা, সম্মান প্রদর্শন — polite respect. SYN respect, regard, esteem, reverence, submission. ANT disrespect, contempt, disregard, defiance. *Ex:* In deference to his wishes, we kept quiet.

Defiant *(adj)* উদ্ধত, অবাধ্য — openly resisting or challenging. SYN rebellious, disobedient, insubordinate, recalcitrant. ANT obedient, submissive, compliant, docile. *Ex:* The defiant prisoner refused to answer.

Deft *(adj)* দক্ষ, নিপুণ — quick and skilful. SYN adroit, dexterous, nimble, skilful, adept. ANT clumsy, awkward, inept, maladroit. *Ex:* With a deft touch, he fixed the watch.

Defunct *(adj)* অচল, বিলুপ্ত — no longer existing or working. SYN extinct, obsolete, dead, inoperative, discontinued. ANT active, alive, working, functioning, extant. *Ex:* The defunct jute mill is now a warehouse.

Delectable *(adj)* সুস্বাদু, মনোরম — delicious; delightful. SYN delicious, tasty, appetising, scrumptious, delightful. ANT unappetising, distasteful, unpleasant, revolting. *Ex:* She served a delectable plate of biryani.

Deleterious GRE *(adj)* ক্ষতিকর — causing harm. SYN harmful, detrimental, damaging, injurious, pernicious. ANT beneficial, harmless, salutary, advantageous. *Ex:* Air pollution has deleterious effects on health.

Deliberate *(adj/v)* ইচ্ছাকৃত; চিন্তা করা — done on purpose; to think carefully. SYN intentional, planned, calculated; consider, ponder. ANT accidental, unintentional, spontaneous. *Ex:* It was a deliberate attempt to mislead us.

Delineate *(v)* বর্ণনা করা, রূপরেখা দেওয়া — to describe or outline precisely. SYN outline, describe, depict, portray, sketch. ANT obscure, confuse, blur. *Ex:* The report delineates the main problems.

Demolish *(v)* ভেঙে ফেলা — to pull down; to destroy. SYN destroy, raze, tear down, wreck, level. ANT build, construct, erect, create. *Ex:* The illegal building was demolished.

Denounce *(v)* প্রকাশ্যে নিন্দা করা — to criticise strongly in public. SYN condemn, censure, decry, criticise, castigate. ANT praise, commend, support, endorse. *Ex:* The UN denounced the attack.

Deplete *(v)* নিঃশেষ করা — to use up or reduce greatly. SYN exhaust, drain, consume, reduce, use up. ANT replenish, refill, restore, increase. *Ex:* Overfishing has depleted the hilsa stock.

Deplore *(v)* দুঃখ প্রকাশ করা, নিন্দা করা — to feel or express strong disapproval. SYN condemn, regret, lament, denounce, deprecate. ANT praise, approve, celebrate, applaud. *Ex:* We deplore all acts of violence.

Depravity *(n)* নৈতিক অধঃপতন — moral corruption. SYN wickedness, corruption, immorality, vice, degeneracy. ANT virtue, morality, goodness, purity. *Ex:* The crime showed the depth of his depravity.

Derelict *(adj)* পরিত্যক্ত; কর্তব্যে অবহেলাকারী — abandoned and in poor condition; negligent. SYN abandoned, deserted, dilapidated; negligent, remiss. ANT occupied, maintained; dutiful, conscientious. *Ex:* The derelict house is said to be haunted.

Deride *(v)* উপহাস করা — to mock. SYN ridicule, mock, scoff, jeer, taunt, belittle. ANT praise, respect, admire, flatter. *Ex:* His ideas were derided at first but later accepted.

Derogatory *(adj)* অবমাননাকর — showing a critical or disrespectful attitude. SYN disparaging, insulting, offensive, pejorative, defamatory. ANT complimentary, flattering, laudatory, respectful. *Ex:* He made derogatory remarks about women.

Desecrate *(v)* অপবিত্র করা — to treat a sacred place or thing with violent disrespect. SYN profane, defile, violate, pollute, vandalise. ANT sanctify, consecrate, hallow, revere. *Ex:* Vandals desecrated the graves.

Despondent *(adj)* হতাশ, বিষণ্ণ — in low spirits from loss of hope. SYN dejected, hopeless, downcast, disheartened, gloomy. ANT hopeful, cheerful, optimistic, buoyant. *Ex:* He became despondent after failing the exam.

Despot *(n)* স্বৈরশাসক — a ruler who uses power cruelly. SYN tyrant, dictator, autocrat, oppressor. ANT democrat, liberal ruler. *Ex:* The despot crushed every protest.

Destitute ★ *(adj)* নিঃস্ব, অসহায় — extremely poor and lacking basic needs. SYN penniless, impoverished, indigent, needy, impecunious. ANT rich, wealthy, affluent, prosperous, opulent. *Ex:* The flood left thousands destitute.

Deter *(v)* নিবৃত্ত করা, বাধা দেওয়া — to discourage someone from doing something. SYN discourage, dissuade, prevent, hinder, restrain. ANT encourage, persuade, induce, motivate. *Ex:* Strict punishment may deter crime.

Detrimental *(adj)* ক্ষতিকর — tending to cause harm. SYN harmful, damaging, deleterious, injurious, adverse. ANT beneficial, advantageous, helpful, favourable. *Ex:* Smoking is detrimental to health.

Devious *(adj)* কুটিল, বাঁকা — dishonestly clever; not straightforward. SYN deceitful, cunning, sly, wily, crafty, tortuous. ANT honest, frank, straightforward, direct. *Ex:* He used devious means to get the job.

Devout *(adj)* ধার্মিক, নিষ্ঠাবান — deeply religious; sincere. SYN pious, religious, godly, devoted, faithful. ANT irreligious, impious, sceptical, insincere. *Ex:* His mother is a devout Muslim.

Dexterity *(n)* দক্ষতা, নৈপুণ্য — skill, especially with the hands. SYN skill, deftness, adroitness, agility, finesse. ANT clumsiness, awkwardness, ineptitude. *Ex:* The surgeon operated with great dexterity.

Diatribe GRE *(n)* তীব্র নিন্দাবাদ — a bitter verbal attack. SYN tirade, harangue, invective, denunciation, philippic. ANT praise, eulogy, panegyric, compliment. *Ex:* He launched into a diatribe against the press.

Didactic GRE *(adj)* শিক্ষামূলক; উপদেশমূলক — intended to teach, often in a moralising way. SYN instructive, educational, pedagogic, preachy, moralistic. ANT entertaining, uninstructive, amusing. *Ex:* Aesop's fables are didactic stories.

Diffident ★ *(adj)* আত্মবিশ্বাসহীন, লাজুক — shy and lacking self-confidence. SYN shy, timid, modest, bashful, reserved, unassertive. ANT confident, bold, assertive, self-assured. *Ex:* The diffident student never spoke in class.

Dilapidated *(adj)* জরাজীর্ণ — in a state of disrepair because of age or neglect. SYN ruined, decrepit, ramshackle, crumbling, run-down. ANT well-kept, sound, renovated, new. *Ex:* The school building is dilapidated.

Dilatory GRE *(adj)* দীর্ঘসূত্রী, বিলম্বকারী — slow to act; intended to cause delay. SYN slow, tardy, sluggish, procrastinating, lax. ANT prompt, quick, punctual, diligent, expeditious. *Ex:* The office is known for its dilatory tactics.

Dilemma *(n)* উভয়সংকট — a situation requiring a choice between two difficult options. SYN quandary, predicament, plight, problem. ANT solution, certainty, resolution. *Ex:* She was in a dilemma whether to study abroad or stay.

Diligent ★ *(adj)* পরিশ্রমী, অধ্যবসায়ী — careful and hard-working. SYN industrious, assiduous, hard-working, conscientious, sedulous. ANT lazy, idle, indolent, negligent, slothful. *Ex:* Diligent students rarely fail.

Diminish *(v)* হ্রাস পাওয়া — to make or become less. SYN decrease, lessen, reduce, dwindle, wane, abate. ANT increase, augment, enlarge, magnify. *Ex:* His popularity has diminished.

Discern *(v)* উপলব্ধি করা, পার্থক্য বোঝা — to perceive or recognise. SYN perceive, detect, distinguish, recognise, notice. ANT overlook, miss, confuse, ignore. *Ex:* It is hard to discern truth from rumour on social media.

Discord *(n)* বিরোধ, অনৈক্য — disagreement; lack of harmony. SYN conflict, dissension, strife, disagreement, friction. ANT harmony, accord, concord, agreement, peace. *Ex:* There was discord among the party members.

Discreet *(adj)* বিচক্ষণ, সাবধানী — careful not to cause offence or reveal secrets. SYN tactful, prudent, careful, cautious, diplomatic. ANT indiscreet, tactless, careless, imprudent. *Ex:* Please be discreet about this matter.

Disdain *(n/v)* ঘৃণা, তাচ্ছিল্য — the feeling that someone is unworthy; to scorn. SYN contempt, scorn, derision, disregard; spurn. ANT respect, admiration, esteem; admire. *Ex:* She looked at the shabby room with disdain.

Disparage *(v)* হেয় করা — to speak of as having little value. SYN belittle, deprecate, denigrate, decry, underrate. ANT praise, extol, laud, commend, acclaim. *Ex:* Never disparage the efforts of others.

Disparity *(n)* বৈষম্য, পার্থক্য — a great difference. SYN inequality, difference, gap, discrepancy, imbalance. ANT equality, parity, similarity, uniformity. *Ex:* There is a huge disparity between the rich and the poor.

Disseminate GRE *(v)* প্রচার করা, ছড়িয়ে দেওয়া — to spread information widely. SYN spread, circulate, propagate, broadcast, distribute. ANT suppress, conceal, withhold, contain. *Ex:* The media disseminates news quickly.

Distinct *(adj)* স্বতন্ত্র; স্পষ্ট — clearly different; easy to see or hear. SYN different, separate, discrete; clear, evident, obvious. ANT similar, identical; vague, indistinct, blurred. *Ex:* Bangla and Assamese are related but distinct languages.

Docile *(adj)* বাধ্য, শান্ত স্বভাব — quiet and easy to control. SYN obedient, submissive, compliant, tame, meek, tractable. ANT unruly, rebellious, defiant, wild, obstinate. *Ex:* The cow is a docile animal.

Dogmatic *(adj)* গোঁড়া, মতান্ধ — insisting that one's beliefs are certainly right. SYN opinionated, doctrinaire, rigid, dictatorial, bigoted. ANT open-minded, flexible, tolerant, undogmatic. *Ex:* A good scientist is never dogmatic.

Dormant *(adj)* সুপ্ত, নিষ্ক্রিয় — temporarily inactive. SYN inactive, latent, sleeping, quiescent, inert. ANT active, awake, alive, operative. *Ex:* The volcano has been dormant for centuries.

Dubious *(adj)* সন্দেহজনক — doubtful; not to be relied on. SYN doubtful, suspicious, questionable, uncertain, shady. ANT certain, reliable, trustworthy, definite. *Ex:* He made his money by dubious means.

Durable *(adj)* টেকসই — able to last long. SYN lasting, long-lasting, enduring, sturdy, robust. ANT fragile, flimsy, perishable, brittle. *Ex:* Jute bags are cheap and durable.

E

Eccentric *(adj)* খামখেয়ালি, অদ্ভুত — unusual and slightly strange. SYN odd, peculiar, strange, quirky, idiosyncratic, bizarre. ANT normal, ordinary, conventional, typical. *Ex:* The eccentric professor wore two watches.

Eclectic GRE *(adj)* বিভিন্ন উৎস থেকে নির্বাচিত — drawing ideas or styles from many sources. SYN diverse, varied, wide-ranging, broad, heterogeneous. ANT narrow, uniform, limited, homogeneous. *Ex:* She has an eclectic taste in music.

Ecstasy *(n)* পরমানন্দ — overwhelming happiness. SYN rapture, bliss, euphoria, elation, joy. ANT misery, despair, agony, sorrow. *Ex:* The fans were in ecstasy after the victory.

Edify *(v)* নৈতিক বা বুদ্ধিবৃত্তিক উন্নতি সাধন করা — to instruct or improve morally or intellectually. SYN enlighten, educate, instruct, uplift, inform. ANT corrupt, mislead, degrade. *Ex:* The lectures were meant to edify the youth.

Efface *(v)* মুছে ফেলা — to erase a mark or memory. SYN erase, obliterate, wipe out, eradicate, delete. ANT preserve, retain, restore, create. *Ex:* Time cannot efface the memory of 1971.

Effervescent *(adj)* বুদবুদপূর্ণ; প্রাণবন্ত — bubbly; lively and enthusiastic. SYN bubbly, fizzy; lively, vivacious, exuberant, sparkling. ANT flat; dull, lifeless, apathetic. *Ex:* Her effervescent personality made her popular.

Efficacy *(n)* কার্যকারিতা — the ability to produce the intended result. SYN effectiveness, efficiency, potency, power, success. ANT inefficacy, uselessness, ineffectiveness, futility. *Ex:* The efficacy of the vaccine has been proved.

Egalitarian *(adj)* সমতাবাদী — believing that all people are equal. SYN equal, democratic, fair, impartial, unbiased. ANT elitist, hierarchical, unequal, discriminatory. *Ex:* We dream of an egalitarian society.

Egregious GRE *(adj)* চরম খারাপ, জঘন্য — outstandingly bad; shocking. SYN flagrant, glaring, outrageous, shocking, atrocious. ANT minor, trivial, slight, insignificant. *Ex:* It was an egregious error to delete the files.

Elated *(adj)* উল্লসিত — extremely happy. SYN overjoyed, jubilant, ecstatic, thrilled, euphoric. ANT dejected, depressed, sad, despondent. *Ex:* She was elated at her success.

Elegant *(adj)* মার্জিত, সুরুচিসম্পন্ন — graceful and stylish. SYN graceful, stylish, refined, polished, tasteful. ANT clumsy, crude, inelegant, gaudy, tasteless. *Ex:* She wore an elegant Jamdani sari.

Elicit *(v)* বের করে আনা — to draw out a response or information. SYN evoke, extract, draw out, obtain, provoke. ANT suppress, repress, withhold. *Ex:* The question elicited no response. (Do not confuse with *illicit* = illegal.)

Eloquent ★ *(adj)* বাগ্মী, সুবক্তা — fluent and persuasive in speaking or writing. SYN articulate, fluent, expressive, persuasive, silver-tongued. ANT inarticulate, halting, tongue-tied, faltering. *Ex:* Bangabandhu's speech of 7 March was eloquent and inspiring.

Elusive *(adj)* অধরা, ধরা-ছোঁয়ার বাইরে — difficult to find, catch or achieve. SYN evasive, slippery, fleeting, intangible, baffling. ANT obtainable, attainable, catchable, clear. *Ex:* Success remained elusive for the team.

Emaciated *(adj)* কৃশকায়, শীর্ণ — abnormally thin and weak. SYN gaunt, skinny, scrawny, haggard, wasted. ANT plump, fat, stout, well-fed, chubby. *Ex:* The famine victims were emaciated.

Emancipate *(v)* মুক্ত করা — to set free from legal, social or political restrictions. SYN liberate, free, release, deliver, unshackle. ANT enslave, subjugate, confine, oppress. *Ex:* Lincoln emancipated the slaves.

Embellish *(v)* অলংকৃত করা; রং চড়ানো — to decorate; to add untrue details to a story. SYN decorate, adorn, ornament; exaggerate, embroider. ANT simplify, strip, mar; understate. *Ex:* He embellished the story to make it exciting.

Embezzle *(v)* আত্মসাৎ করা — to steal money one has been trusted with. SYN misappropriate, steal, defraud, peculate, pilfer. ANT return, restore, safeguard. *Ex:* The cashier embezzled bank funds.

Eminent ★ *(adj)* বিশিষ্ট, প্রখ্যাত — famous and respected. SYN distinguished, renowned, prominent, illustrious, celebrated. ANT unknown, obscure, undistinguished, insignificant. *Ex:* Dr. Muhammad Yunus is an eminent economist. (Do not confuse with *imminent* = about to happen.)

Empathy *(n)* সমানুভূতি — the ability to understand and share another's feelings. SYN understanding, compassion, sympathy, sensitivity, rapport. ANT indifference, apathy, callousness, insensitivity. *Ex:* A good teacher shows empathy towards weak students.

Emulate *(v)* অনুকরণ করা, সমকক্ষ হতে চেষ্টা করা — to try to equal or excel by imitating. SYN imitate, copy, follow, match, mirror. ANT ignore, disregard, neglect. *Ex:* Young cricketers try to emulate Shakib Al Hasan.

Encomium GRE *(n)* প্রশস্তি — a speech or piece of writing praising someone highly. SYN eulogy, tribute, panegyric, praise, accolade. ANT criticism, condemnation, diatribe, invective. *Ex:* The poet wrote an encomium on the national hero.

Encourage *(v)* উৎসাহ দেওয়া — to give support or hope. SYN hearten, inspire, motivate, embolden, foster, promote. ANT discourage, deter, dishearten, dissuade. *Ex:* Parents should encourage children to read.

Endorse *(v)* সমর্থন করা, অনুমোদন করা — to declare public approval of. SYN support, approve, back, sanction, champion. ANT oppose, reject, disapprove, condemn. *Ex:* The committee endorsed the proposal.

Enervate GRE *(v)* দুর্বল করা, নিস্তেজ করা — to make weak or drained of energy (NOT "energise"). SYN weaken, exhaust, debilitate, sap, enfeeble. ANT invigorate, energise, strengthen, vitalise. *Ex:* The hot, humid weather enervated us.

Enhance *(v)* বৃদ্ধি করা, উন্নত করা — to improve the quality or value. SYN improve, increase, boost, heighten, augment. ANT reduce, diminish, decrease, impair, worsen. *Ex:* The new road will enhance trade.

Enigma *(n)* রহস্য, ধাঁধা — a mysterious person or thing. SYN mystery, puzzle, riddle, conundrum, paradox. ANT certainty, explanation, solution, clarity. *Ex:* How the pyramids were built is still an enigma.

Enmity *(n)* শত্রুতা — the state of being an enemy. SYN hostility, animosity, antagonism, hatred, rancour. ANT friendship, amity, goodwill, harmony. *Ex:* There was long-standing enmity between the two families.

Enormous *(adj)* বিশাল — very large. SYN huge, vast, immense, gigantic, colossal, massive. ANT tiny, small, minute, little, minuscule. *Ex:* The project costs an enormous amount of money.

Ephemeral ★ GRE *(adj)* ক্ষণস্থায়ী — lasting for a very short time. SYN transient, transitory, fleeting, momentary, evanescent, short-lived. ANT permanent, lasting, enduring, eternal, perennial. *Ex:* Fame on social media is often ephemeral.

Equanimity GRE *(n)* মানসিক স্থিরতা — calmness in a difficult situation. SYN composure, calmness, serenity, poise, self-possession. ANT agitation, anxiety, panic, discomposure. *Ex:* She accepted the loss with equanimity.

Equivocal GRE *(adj)* দ্ব্যর্থবোধক — deliberately unclear; ambiguous. SYN ambiguous, vague, evasive, unclear, cryptic. ANT unequivocal, clear, definite, explicit. *Ex:* The minister gave an equivocal answer.

Eradicate ★ *(v)* নির্মূল করা — to destroy completely. SYN eliminate, wipe out, uproot, abolish, exterminate, extirpate. ANT create, establish, plant, foster, nurture. *Ex:* We must eradicate corruption from society.

Erratic *(adj)* অনিয়মিত, অস্থির — not even or regular. SYN irregular, inconsistent, unpredictable, unstable, capricious. ANT regular, consistent, steady, stable, predictable. *Ex:* The power supply here is erratic.

Erudite ★ GRE *(adj)* পণ্ডিত, বিদ্বান — having great knowledge from study. SYN learned, scholarly, knowledgeable, well-read, cultured. ANT ignorant, illiterate, uneducated, unlettered. *Ex:* Dr. Muhammad Shahidullah was an erudite scholar.

Eschew GRE *(v)* পরিহার করা — to deliberately avoid. SYN avoid, shun, abstain from, forgo, renounce. ANT embrace, seek, welcome, adopt, indulge in. *Ex:* Good writers eschew unnecessary jargon.

Esoteric GRE *(adj)* গূঢ়, স্বল্পজ্ঞাত — understood only by a small group. SYN obscure, arcane, abstruse, recondite, mysterious. ANT common, popular, familiar, simple, exoteric. *Ex:* The book is full of esoteric terms.

Euphemism *(n)* কোমল শব্দের ব্যবহার — a mild word used instead of a harsh one. SYN polite term, understatement, softened expression. ANT dysphemism, blunt term. *Ex:* "Passed away" is a euphemism for "died".

Evade *(v)* এড়িয়ে যাওয়া, ফাঁকি দেওয়া — to escape or avoid, often by trickery. SYN avoid, elude, dodge, escape, sidestep. ANT face, confront, meet, encounter. *Ex:* He was jailed for evading tax.

Evanescent GRE *(adj)* ক্ষণস্থায়ী, মিলিয়ে যাওয়া — quickly fading or disappearing. SYN fleeting, ephemeral, transient, momentary, vanishing. ANT permanent, lasting, enduring, everlasting. *Ex:* Youth is evanescent.

Exacerbate GRE *(v)* তীব্রতর করা — to make a problem worse. SYN aggravate, worsen, intensify, inflame, compound. ANT alleviate, mitigate, soothe, improve, relieve. *Ex:* Unplanned building exacerbates waterlogging in Dhaka.

Exalt *(v)* উন্নীত করা; প্রশংসা করা — to raise in rank; to praise highly. SYN elevate, promote; glorify, extol, praise. ANT degrade, demote; criticise, debase, humble. *Ex:* Poets exalt the beauty of Bengal.

Exasperate *(v)* অতিশয় বিরক্ত করা — to irritate intensely. SYN annoy, infuriate, irritate, provoke, vex. ANT soothe, calm, please, pacify. *Ex:* The constant delays exasperated passengers.

Exemplary *(adj)* দৃষ্টান্তমূলক, অনুকরণীয় — serving as a good example; (of punishment) serving as a warning. SYN ideal, model, perfect, commendable; deterrent. ANT deplorable, imperfect, poor, unworthy. *Ex:* The court awarded exemplary punishment.

Exonerate ★ *(v)* দোষমুক্ত করা — to clear someone from blame. SYN acquit, absolve, clear, vindicate, exculpate. ANT accuse, blame, convict, incriminate. *Ex:* The inquiry exonerated the officer.

Exorbitant ★ *(adj)* অত্যধিক, মাত্রাতিরিক্ত — (of price) unreasonably high. SYN excessive, extortionate, outrageous, inflated, unreasonable. ANT reasonable, moderate, fair, cheap, modest. *Ex:* Hotels charge exorbitant rates during Eid.

Expedite *(v)* ত্বরান্বিত করা — to make something happen sooner. SYN hasten, accelerate, speed up, hurry, quicken. ANT delay, hinder, slow down, impede, obstruct. *Ex:* Please expedite the delivery of the goods.

Explicit *(adj)* সুস্পষ্ট — stated clearly and in detail. SYN clear, plain, specific, unambiguous, definite. ANT implicit, vague, ambiguous, hidden, tacit. *Ex:* He gave explicit instructions.

Extol ★ *(v)* উচ্চ প্রশংসা করা — to praise enthusiastically. SYN praise, laud, acclaim, glorify, eulogise, exalt. ANT criticise, condemn, belittle, disparage, denigrate. *Ex:* The critics extolled the novel.

Extravagant ★ *(adj)* অমিতব্যয়ী — spending too much; excessive. SYN wasteful, lavish, spendthrift, profligate, prodigal. ANT thrifty, frugal, economical, parsimonious. *Ex:* An extravagant man soon becomes poor.

F

Fabricate *(v)* বানানো (মিথ্যা); নির্মাণ করা — to invent something false; to manufacture. SYN invent, concoct, forge, falsify; construct, make. ANT tell the truth, verify; destroy, dismantle. *Ex:* The story was fabricated by the tabloid.

Facetious *(adj)* ঠাট্টাপূর্ণ (অসময়ে) — treating serious issues with inappropriate humour. SYN flippant, joking, frivolous, jocular, glib. ANT serious, solemn, earnest, grave. *Ex:* His facetious remarks at the funeral offended people.

Facile GRE *(adj)* সহজসাধ্য; অগভীর — too simple, showing little thought; easily achieved. SYN superficial, simplistic, glib, shallow; easy, effortless. ANT profound, thoughtful, complex; difficult, laborious. *Ex:* He offered a facile solution to a complex problem.

Fallacy *(n)* ভ্রান্ত ধারণা — a mistaken belief; a false argument. SYN misconception, delusion, error, myth, illusion. ANT truth, fact, reality, certainty. *Ex:* It is a fallacy that money brings happiness.

Fastidious GRE *(adj)* খুঁতখুঁতে — very attentive to detail; hard to please. SYN fussy, meticulous, particular, finicky, punctilious. ANT careless, easy-going, sloppy, undemanding. *Ex:* He is fastidious about his clothes.

Fatigue *(n)* ক্লান্তি — extreme tiredness. SYN tiredness, weariness, exhaustion, lethargy, lassitude. ANT energy, vigour, freshness, liveliness. *Ex:* He collapsed from fatigue after the march.

Feasible *(adj)* সম্ভবপর, বাস্তবায়নযোগ্য — possible to do easily or conveniently. SYN practicable, viable, achievable, workable, possible. ANT impractical, unfeasible, impossible, unworkable. *Ex:* A metro rail was found feasible for Dhaka.

Feeble ★ *(adj)* দুর্বল — lacking strength. SYN weak, frail, infirm, delicate, puny, debilitated. ANT strong, robust, sturdy, vigorous, powerful. *Ex:* The old man's voice was feeble.

Felicity *(n)* পরম সুখ; উপযুক্ততা — great happiness; the ability to find suitable words. SYN bliss, joy, happiness; aptness, appropriateness. ANT misery, sorrow; inappropriateness. *Ex:* He writes with great felicity of expression.

Ferocious *(adj)* হিংস্র — savagely fierce. SYN fierce, savage, vicious, brutal, wild. ANT gentle, tame, mild, docile. *Ex:* The Royal Bengal Tiger is a ferocious animal.

Fertile *(adj)* উর্বর — able to produce many crops or ideas. SYN fruitful, productive, rich, fecund, prolific. ANT barren, sterile, infertile, arid, unproductive. *Ex:* The land of Bangladesh is very fertile.

Fervent *(adj)* উৎসাহী, আবেগপূর্ণ — having or showing intense feeling. SYN passionate, ardent, zealous, fervid, intense. ANT apathetic, indifferent, cool, lukewarm. *Ex:* He is a fervent supporter of the national team.

Fickle ★ *(adj)* চঞ্চল, অস্থির চিত্ত — changing frequently in loyalty or interest. SYN capricious, inconstant, changeable, mercurial, volatile. ANT constant, steadfast, loyal, faithful, stable. *Ex:* Fortune is fickle.

Fictitious *(adj)* কাল্পনিক, মিথ্যা — not real or true. SYN imaginary, invented, false, fabricated, made-up, bogus. ANT real, true, genuine, factual, authentic. *Ex:* He gave a fictitious name to the police.

Flagrant *(adj)* স্পষ্ট ও নির্লজ্জ — (of wrongdoing) obvious and shocking. SYN blatant, glaring, egregious, outrageous, open. ANT hidden, subtle, concealed, minor. *Ex:* It was a flagrant violation of human rights.

Flamboyant *(adj)* জাঁকজমকপূর্ণ — attracting attention by confidence and style. SYN showy, ostentatious, flashy, colourful, extravagant. ANT modest, restrained, plain, sober, understated. *Ex:* The singer is famous for his flamboyant costumes.

Flaw *(n)* ত্রুটি — a mark, fault or weakness. SYN defect, fault, imperfection, blemish, shortcoming. ANT perfection, merit, strength, virtue. *Ex:* There is a flaw in your argument.

Flimsy *(adj)* ঠুনকো, দুর্বল — weak and easily damaged; (of an excuse) unconvincing. SYN fragile, frail, weak; feeble, unconvincing, thin. ANT sturdy, strong, solid; convincing, sound. *Ex:* He gave a flimsy excuse for his absence.

Florid *(adj)* অতিরিক্ত অলংকৃত; রক্তিম — excessively decorated; reddish (complexion). SYN ornate, flowery, elaborate, baroque; ruddy, flushed. ANT plain, simple, austere; pale, pallid. *Ex:* His florid writing style is hard to follow.

Flourish ★ *(v)* সমৃদ্ধ হওয়া — to grow or develop well. SYN thrive, prosper, bloom, boom, burgeon. ANT decline, wither, fade, languish, decay. *Ex:* Trade flourished under the Mughals.

Fluctuate *(v)* ওঠানামা করা — to rise and fall irregularly. SYN vary, oscillate, swing, waver, change. ANT stabilise, remain constant, steady. *Ex:* Onion prices fluctuate every season.

Forbearance *(n)* ধৈর্য, সহিষ্ণুতা — patient self-control. SYN patience, tolerance, restraint, endurance, leniency. ANT impatience, intolerance, anger, severity. *Ex:* She showed great forbearance with her difficult neighbours.

Forlorn *(adj)* নিঃসঙ্গ, হতাশ — pitifully sad and lonely. SYN lonely, desolate, abandoned, wretched, hopeless. ANT cheerful, happy, hopeful, cared-for. *Ex:* A forlorn child stood at the station.

Formidable *(adj)* ভয়ংকর, দুর্দমনীয় — inspiring fear or respect through power; very difficult. SYN daunting, intimidating, powerful, redoubtable; arduous. ANT weak, easy, harmless, trivial. *Ex:* India posed a formidable target of 350 runs.

Fortitude *(n)* মনোবল, সহিষ্ণুতা — courage in pain or difficulty. SYN courage, endurance, resilience, grit, bravery. ANT cowardice, weakness, timidity, faint-heartedness. *Ex:* She bore her illness with fortitude.

Fragile *(adj)* ভঙ্গুর — easily broken or damaged. SYN breakable, delicate, brittle, frail, flimsy. ANT strong, sturdy, durable, robust, tough. *Ex:* Handle the glassware carefully; it is fragile.

Frail *(adj)* দুর্বল, ক্ষীণ — weak and delicate. SYN weak, feeble, infirm, delicate, fragile. ANT strong, robust, healthy, sturdy. *Ex:* My grandmother has become frail.

Frank ★ *(adj)* স্পষ্টবাদী, অকপট — honest and direct. SYN candid, open, outspoken, straightforward, blunt. ANT evasive, secretive, guarded, deceitful. *Ex:* To be frank, I did not like the film.

Frenzy *(n)* উন্মত্ততা — a state of wild excitement. SYN hysteria, madness, mania, fury, agitation. ANT calm, composure, serenity, tranquillity. *Ex:* The crowd was whipped into a frenzy.

Frivolous *(adj)* তুচ্ছ, লঘুচিত্ত — not serious; silly. SYN trivial, petty, flippant, silly, superficial. ANT serious, important, earnest, grave, sensible. *Ex:* Don't waste time on frivolous matters.

Frugal ★ *(adj)* মিতব্যয়ী — careful and economical with money or food. SYN thrifty, economical, sparing, prudent, provident. ANT extravagant, wasteful, lavish, prodigal, spendthrift. *Ex:* He lived a frugal life and saved money.

Furtive GRE *(adj)* গোপন, চোরাগোপ্তা — attempting to avoid notice; secretive. SYN secret, stealthy, sly, surreptitious, clandestine. ANT open, overt, candid, forthright. *Ex:* He cast a furtive glance at the answer sheet.

Futile ★ *(adj)* নিষ্ফল, বৃথা — producing no useful result. SYN useless, vain, fruitless, pointless, abortive, ineffectual. ANT useful, fruitful, effective, productive, worthwhile. *Ex:* It is futile to argue with a fool.

G

Gallant *(adj)* সাহসী; ভদ্র — brave; polite and attentive to women. SYN brave, valiant, heroic, courageous; chivalrous, courteous. ANT cowardly, craven; rude, discourteous. *Ex:* The gallant freedom fighters are our national heroes.

Garish *(adj)* চোখ-ধাঁধানো, অতি উজ্জ্বল — unpleasantly bright and showy. SYN gaudy, flashy, loud, lurid, tawdry. ANT sober, tasteful, subdued, muted, elegant. *Ex:* The room was painted in garish colours.

Garrulous ★ GRE *(adj)* বাচাল — talking too much about unimportant things. SYN talkative, loquacious, verbose, chatty, voluble. ANT taciturn, reticent, silent, reserved, laconic. *Ex:* The garrulous old man told us his life story.

Generous *(adj)* উদার — willing to give more than expected. SYN liberal, charitable, munificent, magnanimous, bountiful. ANT mean, stingy, miserly, selfish, parsimonious. *Ex:* He made a generous donation to the hospital.

Genial *(adj)* অমায়িক, হাসিখুশি — friendly and cheerful. SYN affable, amiable, cordial, warm, friendly. ANT unfriendly, cold, hostile, surly. *Ex:* Our genial host welcomed us warmly.

Genuine ★ *(adj)* খাঁটি, আসল — truly what it is said to be. SYN real, authentic, true, bona fide, sincere. ANT fake, false, counterfeit, spurious, sham. *Ex:* Is this a genuine diamond?

Gloomy *(adj)* বিষণ্ণ; অন্ধকার — dark; sad and without hope. SYN dark, dim, dismal; sad, melancholy, depressed, despondent. ANT bright, sunny; cheerful, happy, hopeful. *Ex:* The economic outlook is gloomy.

Glorious *(adj)* গৌরবময় — having or bringing great fame; magnificent. SYN illustrious, celebrated, splendid, magnificent, triumphant. ANT shameful, inglorious, ignominious, dishonourable. *Ex:* 1971 is the most glorious chapter of our history.

Glut *(n)* অতিরিক্ত সরবরাহ — an excessive supply. SYN surplus, excess, surfeit, oversupply, plethora. ANT scarcity, shortage, dearth, lack. *Ex:* A glut of potatoes caused prices to fall.

Gracious *(adj)* সদয়, ভদ্র — courteous, kind and pleasant. SYN courteous, kind, polite, cordial, benevolent. ANT rude, ungracious, impolite, discourteous. *Ex:* She was gracious in defeat.

Gratuitous GRE *(adj)* অহেতুক; বিনামূল্যে — uncalled for, lacking good reason; free of charge. SYN unjustified, unwarranted, needless, unprovoked; free. ANT justified, warranted, necessary; paid. *Ex:* The film contains gratuitous violence.

Gregarious ★ GRE *(adj)* দলপ্রিয়, মিশুক — fond of company; sociable; (of animals) living in groups. SYN sociable, outgoing, convivial, friendly, companionable. ANT unsociable, reclusive, introverted, solitary, aloof. *Ex:* Man is a gregarious animal.

Grievous *(adj)* গুরুতর, মারাত্মক — very serious or severe. SYN serious, severe, grave, dreadful, heinous. ANT slight, minor, trivial, trifling. *Ex:* He suffered grievous injuries in the accident.

Grim *(adj)* ভয়াবহ, কঠোর — very serious, gloomy or forbidding. SYN stern, forbidding, harsh; bleak, dismal, dreadful. ANT cheerful, pleasant, genial; hopeful, bright. *Ex:* The report presents a grim picture of child labour.

Guile *(n)* ছলনা — clever but dishonest intelligence. SYN cunning, craftiness, deceit, trickery, wiliness. ANT honesty, candour, sincerity, ingenuousness. *Ex:* He used guile to win their trust.

Gullible *(adj)* সহজে প্রতারিত হয় এমন — easily deceived. SYN credulous, naive, trusting, unsuspecting, ingenuous. ANT sceptical, suspicious, shrewd, astute, wary. *Ex:* Gullible people fall for online scams.

H

Hackneyed ★ *(adj)* বহুল ব্যবহৃত, গতানুগতিক — (of a phrase or idea) overused and unoriginal. SYN trite, banal, clichéd, stale, stereotyped, commonplace. ANT original, fresh, novel, new, innovative. *Ex:* Avoid hackneyed expressions in your essay.

Haggard *(adj)* ক্লান্ত ও শীর্ণ — looking exhausted and unwell. SYN gaunt, drawn, worn, wan, careworn. ANT fresh, healthy, robust, hale. *Ex:* After days without sleep, he looked haggard.

Halcyon GRE *(adj)* শান্তিপূর্ণ ও সুখময় (অতীত) — (of a past time) idyllically happy and peaceful. SYN peaceful, serene, idyllic, golden, tranquil. ANT turbulent, stormy, troubled, chaotic. *Ex:* He remembered the halcyon days of his youth.

Hamper *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া — to hinder the progress of. SYN hinder, impede, obstruct, hold back, encumber. ANT help, assist, aid, facilitate, expedite. *Ex:* Heavy rain hampered the rescue work.

Haphazard *(adj)* এলোমেলো — lacking order or plan. SYN random, disorganised, chaotic, unsystematic, careless. ANT orderly, systematic, methodical, planned. *Ex:* Haphazard urbanisation is a big problem.

Harass *(v)* হয়রানি করা — to subject to repeated pressure or intimidation. SYN torment, pester, harry, bully, persecute. ANT help, comfort, assist, soothe. *Ex:* It is a crime to harass women in public.

Harbinger *(n)* অগ্রদূত — a person or thing that signals the approach of another. SYN herald, forerunner, precursor, omen, sign. ANT successor, follower, aftermath. *Ex:* The cuckoo is the harbinger of spring.

Harmony *(n)* সম্প্রীতি, মিল — agreement; peaceful co-existence. SYN accord, concord, agreement, unity, peace. ANT discord, conflict, disagreement, strife. *Ex:* People of all religions live in harmony here.

Harsh *(adj)* কঠোর, রুক্ষ — cruel or severe; unpleasantly rough. SYN severe, cruel, stern, strict; rough, grating. ANT mild, gentle, lenient, kind; soft, smooth. *Ex:* The punishment was too harsh.

Haughty ★ *(adj)* উদ্ধত, অহংকারী — arrogantly superior. SYN arrogant, proud, conceited, disdainful, supercilious. ANT humble, modest, meek, unassuming. *Ex:* The haughty landlord ignored the poor tenants.

Hazardous *(adj)* ঝুঁকিপূর্ণ — risky; dangerous. SYN dangerous, risky, perilous, precarious, unsafe. ANT safe, secure, harmless, protected. *Ex:* Shipbreaking is a hazardous job.

Heinous ★ *(adj)* জঘন্য, ঘৃণ্য — (of a crime) utterly wicked. SYN atrocious, monstrous, abominable, odious, vile, nefarious. ANT admirable, good, noble, virtuous, commendable. *Ex:* Murder is a heinous crime.

Heresy *(n)* ধর্মদ্রোহিতা, প্রচলিত মতবিরোধী — a belief contrary to accepted religious or general opinion. SYN dissent, nonconformity, heterodoxy, apostasy, unorthodoxy. ANT orthodoxy, conformity, belief, doctrine. *Ex:* Galileo was accused of heresy.

Hesitate *(v)* ইতস্তত করা — to pause before acting. SYN pause, waver, falter, vacillate, dither. ANT decide, proceed, act promptly. *Ex:* Don't hesitate to ask questions.

Heterogeneous *(adj)* বিভিন্ন প্রকারের, বিষমসত্ত্ব — diverse in content. SYN diverse, varied, mixed, assorted, miscellaneous. ANT homogeneous, uniform, similar, alike. *Ex:* Dhaka has a heterogeneous population.

Hilarious *(adj)* অত্যন্ত হাস্যকর — extremely amusing. SYN very funny, comical, side-splitting, hysterical, uproarious. ANT sad, serious, solemn, tragic. *Ex:* The comedy show was hilarious.

Hinder *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া — to make it difficult for something to happen. SYN hamper, obstruct, impede, block, thwart. ANT help, aid, facilitate, assist, promote. *Ex:* Lack of funds hindered the project.

Holistic *(adj)* সামগ্রিক — dealing with the whole rather than parts. SYN comprehensive, integrated, overall, total. ANT partial, fragmentary, piecemeal. *Ex:* We need a holistic approach to education.

Homogeneous *(adj)* সমজাতীয়, সমসত্ত্ব — of the same kind; uniform. SYN uniform, alike, similar, identical, consistent. ANT heterogeneous, diverse, varied, different. *Ex:* Bangladesh has a largely homogeneous linguistic population.

Hostile ★ *(adj)* শত্রুভাবাপন্ন, বৈরী — unfriendly; antagonistic. SYN unfriendly, antagonistic, belligerent, inimical, adverse. ANT friendly, amicable, cordial, warm, favourable. *Ex:* The crowd was hostile to the speaker.

Humane *(adj)* মানবিক, দয়ালু — showing kindness and compassion. SYN kind, compassionate, merciful, benevolent, considerate. ANT inhumane, cruel, brutal, barbaric. *Ex:* Prisoners should be treated in a humane way.

Humble ★ *(adj)* বিনয়ী; নিম্ন — modest; low in rank. SYN modest, meek, unassuming; lowly, ordinary, simple. ANT proud, arrogant, haughty; noble, exalted. *Ex:* Despite his fame, he remained humble.

Hypocrisy *(n)* ভণ্ডামি — pretending to have higher standards than one actually has. SYN insincerity, pretence, duplicity, sanctimony, falseness. ANT sincerity, honesty, genuineness, candour. *Ex:* Preaching honesty while taking bribes is hypocrisy.

Hypothetical *(adj)* অনুমানভিত্তিক, কাল্পনিক — based on a suggested idea, not on facts. SYN theoretical, supposed, conjectural, speculative, assumed. ANT actual, real, factual, proven, concrete. *Ex:* Let's consider a hypothetical situation.

I

Iconoclast GRE *(n)* প্রচলিত বিশ্বাসবিরোধী ব্যক্তি — a person who attacks established beliefs. SYN rebel, dissenter, nonconformist, radical, heretic. ANT conformist, traditionalist, follower, believer. *Ex:* Nazrul was an iconoclast in Bengali literature.

Idle ★ *(adj)* অলস; অকেজো — lazy; not working; without purpose. SYN lazy, indolent, slothful; inactive, unused; pointless. ANT busy, diligent, industrious; active, employed. *Ex:* An idle brain is the devil's workshop.

Ignominy *(n)* অপমান, লজ্জা — public shame or disgrace. SYN disgrace, dishonour, shame, humiliation, infamy. ANT honour, glory, credit, esteem, dignity. *Ex:* The team suffered the ignominy of defeat.

Illicit *(adj)* অবৈধ — forbidden by law or custom. SYN illegal, unlawful, illegitimate, prohibited, criminal. ANT legal, lawful, legitimate, licit, permitted. *Ex:* Police seized illicit drugs.

Illustrious *(adj)* খ্যাতিমান, গৌরবময় — well known and respected because of past achievements. SYN famous, celebrated, distinguished, eminent, renowned. ANT unknown, obscure, undistinguished, humble. *Ex:* Sher-e-Bangla came from an illustrious family.

Imbibe *(v)* শোষণ করা, গ্রহণ করা — to drink; to absorb ideas. SYN drink, consume; absorb, assimilate, take in, learn. ANT reject, discard, ignore. *Ex:* Children imbibe values from their parents.

Immaculate *(adj)* নিষ্কলঙ্ক, নিখুঁত — perfectly clean; without fault. SYN spotless, pristine, flawless, impeccable, unblemished. ANT dirty, filthy, stained, flawed, tarnished. *Ex:* Her uniform was immaculate.

Imminent ★ *(adj)* আসন্ন — about to happen. SYN impending, approaching, forthcoming, near, looming. ANT distant, remote, far-off, unlikely. *Ex:* A cyclone is imminent; fishermen should return to shore.

Impartial ★ *(adj)* নিরপেক্ষ — treating all equally; fair. SYN unbiased, neutral, fair, objective, disinterested, just. ANT biased, partial, prejudiced, partisan, one-sided. *Ex:* An election commission must be impartial.

Impeccable *(adj)* নিখুঁত, ত্রুটিহীন — in accordance with the highest standards. SYN flawless, faultless, perfect, immaculate, exemplary. ANT flawed, imperfect, faulty, defective. *Ex:* She speaks impeccable English.

Impede *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া — to delay or prevent by obstructing. SYN hinder, hamper, obstruct, block, thwart. ANT help, facilitate, expedite, assist, aid. *Ex:* Corruption impedes development.

Imperative *(adj)* অপরিহার্য; আদেশসূচক — of vital importance; giving a command. SYN vital, essential, crucial, necessary, urgent; mandatory. ANT unnecessary, optional, trivial, inessential. *Ex:* It is imperative that we act now.

Imperious *(adj)* আদেশপ্রবণ, কর্তৃত্বপরায়ণ — arrogant and domineering. SYN domineering, overbearing, bossy, dictatorial, haughty. ANT humble, meek, submissive, modest. *Ex:* The manager's imperious manner upset the staff.

Impetuous *(adj)* হঠকারী, আবেগপ্রবণ — acting quickly without thought. SYN rash, impulsive, hasty, reckless, headstrong. ANT cautious, careful, prudent, circumspect, deliberate. *Ex:* His impetuous decision cost him his job.

Implicit *(adj)* অন্তর্নিহিত; প্রশ্নাতীত — implied, not directly stated; absolute. SYN implied, tacit, unspoken, inherent; absolute, total. ANT explicit, stated, express; partial, qualified. *Ex:* There was an implicit threat in his words. / She has implicit faith in God.

Impromptu *(adj/adv)* উপস্থিত, তাৎক্ষণিক — done without preparation. SYN spontaneous, unrehearsed, improvised, extempore, ad-lib. ANT planned, prepared, rehearsed, premeditated. *Ex:* He gave an impromptu speech.

Imprudent *(adj)* অবিবেচক — not showing care for consequences. SYN unwise, rash, reckless, injudicious, careless. ANT prudent, wise, careful, sensible, judicious. *Ex:* It was imprudent to invest all your savings in one share.

Impudent *(adj)* ধৃষ্ট, বেয়াদব — not showing due respect. SYN insolent, rude, impertinent, cheeky, brazen. ANT respectful, polite, courteous, deferential. *Ex:* The impudent boy talked back to the teacher.

Inadvertent *(adj)* অনিচ্ছাকৃত, অসাবধানতাবশত — not intentional. SYN accidental, unintentional, involuntary, careless. ANT deliberate, intentional, conscious, planned. *Ex:* It was an inadvertent mistake.

Inane *(adj)* অর্থহীন, বোকা — silly; lacking sense. SYN silly, foolish, absurd, senseless, vacuous. ANT sensible, intelligent, meaningful, sound. *Ex:* Stop asking inane questions.

Incessant ★ *(adj)* অবিরাম — continuing without pause. SYN constant, ceaseless, unending, perpetual, continuous, relentless. ANT intermittent, occasional, sporadic, periodic. *Ex:* Incessant rain flooded the streets.

Incisive *(adj)* তীক্ষ্ণ, সুস্পষ্ট — clear and sharp in thinking or expression. SYN penetrating, sharp, keen, acute, perceptive. ANT dull, vague, superficial, woolly. *Ex:* He gave an incisive analysis of the budget.

Incorrigible *(adj)* সংশোধনের অযোগ্য — not able to be corrected or reformed. SYN incurable, hopeless, inveterate, hardened, irredeemable. ANT reformable, correctable, manageable, curable. *Ex:* He is an incorrigible liar.

Indifferent *(adj)* উদাসীন; মাঝারি মানের — having no interest; mediocre. SYN apathetic, unconcerned, detached; mediocre, average. ANT interested, concerned, eager; excellent, superior. *Ex:* He is indifferent to politics.

Indigenous *(adj)* আদিবাসী, দেশীয় — native to a place. SYN native, aboriginal, local, original, endemic. ANT foreign, alien, imported, exotic. *Ex:* The Chakma are an indigenous people of the Chittagong Hill Tracts.

Indigent GRE *(adj)* দরিদ্র, অভাবী — poor; needy. SYN poor, needy, destitute, impoverished, impecunious. ANT rich, wealthy, affluent, prosperous. *Ex:* The trust gives scholarships to indigent students.

Indolent ★ *(adj)* অলস — wanting to avoid activity. SYN lazy, idle, slothful, sluggish, lethargic. ANT industrious, diligent, active, energetic, assiduous. *Ex:* An indolent student cannot expect good results.

Indomitable *(adj)* অদম্য — impossible to subdue or defeat. SYN invincible, unconquerable, unyielding, resolute, steadfast. ANT weak, submissive, defeatable, feeble. *Ex:* The Bengalis showed indomitable courage in 1952.

Industrious *(adj)* পরিশ্রমী — diligent and hard-working. SYN hard-working, diligent, assiduous, sedulous, busy. ANT lazy, idle, indolent, slothful. *Ex:* Bangladeshi farmers are very industrious.

Inevitable ★ *(adj)* অবশ্যম্ভাবী, অনিবার্য — certain to happen. SYN unavoidable, inescapable, certain, sure, inexorable. ANT avoidable, uncertain, preventable, doubtful. *Ex:* Death is inevitable.

Infamous *(adj)* কুখ্যাত — well known for a bad quality or deed. SYN notorious, disreputable, scandalous, ignominious. ANT famous, reputable, honourable, illustrious. *Ex:* He was an infamous smuggler. (Note: *infamous* is NOT the opposite of *famous* in the sense "unknown".)

Ingenious *(adj)* উদ্ভাবনী শক্তিসম্পন্ন — clever, original and inventive. SYN inventive, clever, creative, resourceful, original. ANT unimaginative, dull, stupid, uninventive. *Ex:* What an ingenious idea!

Ingenuous GRE *(adj)* সরল, অকপট — innocent and unsuspecting; frank. SYN naive, innocent, artless, guileless, frank. ANT sly, crafty, cunning, disingenuous, artful. *Ex:* The ingenuous girl believed every word.

Inherent *(adj)* অন্তর্নিহিত, সহজাত — existing as a natural, permanent part. SYN intrinsic, innate, built-in, essential, inborn. ANT extrinsic, acquired, external, incidental. *Ex:* There are risks inherent in every business.

Inhibit *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া, সংযত করা — to hinder or restrain. SYN restrain, hinder, check, curb, suppress. ANT encourage, promote, allow, foster. *Ex:* Fear inhibits creativity.

Innate *(adj)* সহজাত — inborn; natural. SYN inborn, inherent, natural, intrinsic, congenital. ANT acquired, learned, cultivated, extrinsic. *Ex:* She has an innate talent for music.

Innocuous GRE *(adj)* নিরীহ, ক্ষতিহীন — not harmful or offensive. SYN harmless, inoffensive, safe, benign, mild. ANT harmful, noxious, dangerous, offensive, pernicious. *Ex:* It was an innocuous joke.

Insipid *(adj)* স্বাদহীন; নীরস — lacking flavour; dull. SYN tasteless, bland, flavourless; dull, boring, uninteresting. ANT tasty, flavourful; interesting, lively, exciting. *Ex:* The hospital food was insipid.

Insolent ★ *(adj)* উদ্ধত, অবিনয়ী — rude and disrespectful. SYN rude, impertinent, impudent, insulting, arrogant. ANT polite, respectful, courteous, humble, civil. *Ex:* The insolent clerk was suspended.

Instigate *(v)* উসকানি দেওয়া — to bring about or provoke an action. SYN provoke, incite, initiate, foment, stir up. ANT stop, prevent, discourage, quell, suppress. *Ex:* He was arrested for instigating the riot.

Intrepid ★ *(adj)* নির্ভীক — fearless; adventurous. SYN fearless, brave, bold, daring, valiant, dauntless. ANT timid, cowardly, fearful, afraid, craven. *Ex:* The intrepid explorer reached the North Pole.

Intricate *(adj)* জটিল — very complicated or detailed. SYN complex, complicated, elaborate, involved, convoluted. ANT simple, plain, straightforward, easy. *Ex:* Nakshi kantha has intricate designs.

Inundate *(v)* প্লাবিত করা — to flood; to overwhelm. SYN flood, deluge, submerge, swamp, overwhelm. ANT drain, dry up, trickle. *Ex:* The office was inundated with complaints.

Invincible *(adj)* অজেয় — too powerful to be defeated. SYN unbeatable, unconquerable, indomitable, invulnerable. ANT beatable, vulnerable, weak, conquerable. *Ex:* The army thought it was invincible.

Irascible GRE *(adj)* বদমেজাজি, খিটখিটে — easily made angry. SYN irritable, short-tempered, testy, choleric, cantankerous. ANT calm, even-tempered, placid, good-natured. *Ex:* The irascible old man shouted at the children.

Irrational *(adj)* অযৌক্তিক — not logical or reasonable. SYN illogical, unreasonable, absurd, senseless, groundless. ANT rational, logical, reasonable, sensible. *Ex:* He has an irrational fear of cats.

Itinerant *(adj)* ভ্রাম্যমাণ, যাযাবর — travelling from place to place. SYN wandering, roving, nomadic, migrant, peripatetic. ANT settled, stationary, resident, sedentary. *Ex:* Baul singers were itinerant musicians.

J

Jaded *(adj)* ক্লান্ত, অবসন্ন — tired or lacking enthusiasm after too much of something. SYN weary, exhausted, bored, sated, world-weary. ANT fresh, eager, enthusiastic, refreshed. *Ex:* After years of routine work, he felt jaded.

Jeopardy *(n)* বিপদ, ঝুঁকি — danger of loss or harm. SYN danger, peril, risk, hazard, threat. ANT safety, security, protection. *Ex:* Many jobs are in jeopardy.

Jocular *(adj)* রসিক, কৌতুকপূর্ণ — fond of joking; humorous. SYN humorous, playful, witty, facetious, jovial. ANT serious, solemn, grave, sober. *Ex:* He was in a jocular mood.

Jovial *(adj)* হাসিখুশি, প্রাণবন্ত — cheerful and friendly. SYN cheerful, jolly, merry, genial, convivial. ANT gloomy, morose, sullen, sad. *Ex:* Our jovial uncle kept everyone laughing.

Jubilant *(adj)* উল্লসিত — feeling great happiness, especially at success. SYN joyful, elated, exultant, triumphant, overjoyed. ANT sad, dejected, despondent, depressed. *Ex:* Jubilant crowds celebrated the victory.

Judicious ★ *(adj)* বিচক্ষণ — having good judgement. SYN wise, prudent, sensible, sagacious, discerning. ANT injudicious, foolish, rash, unwise, imprudent. *Ex:* A judicious use of resources is needed.

K

Keen *(adj)* আগ্রহী; তীক্ষ্ণ — eager; sharp. SYN eager, enthusiastic, avid; sharp, acute, piercing. ANT reluctant, indifferent; blunt, dull. *Ex:* She is keen on learning French.

Kindle *(v)* প্রজ্বলিত করা; জাগিয়ে তোলা — to light a fire; to arouse a feeling. SYN ignite, light; arouse, stir, inspire, provoke. ANT extinguish, quench, douse; dampen, suppress. *Ex:* The teacher kindled our interest in poetry.

Knave *(n)* দুর্বৃত্ত, প্রতারক — a dishonest man. SYN rogue, scoundrel, villain, rascal, cheat. ANT gentleman, hero, saint, honest man. *Ex:* The knave cheated the old woman.

Knack *(n)* দক্ষতা, কৌশল — a special skill or ability. SYN talent, skill, flair, gift, aptitude. ANT inability, ineptitude, incompetence. *Ex:* He has a knack for making friends.

L

Laconic ★ GRE *(adj)* স্বল্পভাষী, সংক্ষিপ্ত — using very few words. SYN brief, concise, terse, succinct, taciturn. ANT verbose, wordy, garrulous, loquacious, long-winded. *Ex:* His laconic reply was simply "No."

Lament *(v/n)* বিলাপ করা; শোক — to express deep sorrow. SYN mourn, grieve, bewail, deplore; elegy. ANT rejoice, celebrate, exult. *Ex:* The nation lamented the death of the poet.

Languid *(adj)* নিস্তেজ, অলস — slow and relaxed; lacking energy. SYN sluggish, lethargic, listless, lazy, weak. ANT energetic, lively, vigorous, active. *Ex:* The heat made everyone languid.

Lavish ★ *(adj/v)* প্রচুর, অমিতব্যয়ী; অকাতরে দেওয়া — rich and generous; to give freely. SYN sumptuous, luxurious, extravagant, generous; heap, shower. ANT meagre, frugal, simple, sparse; withhold. *Ex:* They held a lavish wedding party.

Lax *(adj)* শিথিল, ঢিলেঢালা — not strict or careful enough. SYN slack, careless, negligent, lenient, loose. ANT strict, rigorous, stringent, careful. *Ex:* Security at the airport was lax.

Legitimate *(adj)* বৈধ, ন্যায্য — lawful; reasonable. SYN legal, lawful, valid, rightful; justifiable, reasonable. ANT illegal, illegitimate, unlawful; unjustified. *Ex:* Workers have legitimate demands.

Lenient ★ *(adj)* নরম, উদার (শাস্তিতে) — merciful or tolerant in punishment. SYN merciful, tolerant, forgiving, clement, indulgent. ANT strict, severe, harsh, stern, rigorous. *Ex:* The judge was lenient with the first-time offender.

Lethargic *(adj)* অলস, নিস্তেজ — sluggish and apathetic. SYN sluggish, listless, lazy, languid, inert. ANT energetic, active, lively, vigorous, dynamic. *Ex:* I felt lethargic after a heavy lunch.

Liberal *(adj)* উদার; উদারপন্থী — generous; open to new ideas. SYN generous, bountiful; tolerant, broad-minded, progressive. ANT mean, stingy; conservative, bigoted, narrow-minded. *Ex:* He holds liberal views on education.

Linger *(v)* দীর্ঘক্ষণ থাকা, বিলম্ব করা — to stay longer than necessary. SYN remain, stay, loiter, dawdle, tarry, persist. ANT leave, depart, hurry, hasten. *Ex:* The smell of smoke lingered in the room.

Lofty *(adj)* সুউচ্চ; মহৎ; উদ্ধত — very tall; noble; haughty. SYN high, towering; noble, exalted, grand; arrogant, haughty. ANT low, short; base, ignoble; humble, modest. *Ex:* He has lofty ideals.

Loquacious ★ GRE *(adj)* বাচাল — very talkative. SYN talkative, garrulous, voluble, chatty, verbose. ANT taciturn, reticent, quiet, laconic, silent. *Ex:* The loquacious taxi driver talked all the way.

Lucid ★ *(adj)* স্পষ্ট, প্রাঞ্জল — easy to understand; clear. SYN clear, intelligible, plain, transparent, comprehensible. ANT obscure, confusing, vague, unclear, ambiguous. *Ex:* The book explains grammar in lucid language.

Lucrative ★ *(adj)* লাভজনক — producing a great deal of profit. SYN profitable, gainful, remunerative, rewarding, fruitful. ANT unprofitable, unrewarding, loss-making. *Ex:* Shrimp farming is a lucrative business.

Ludicrous *(adj)* হাস্যকর — so foolish as to be amusing. SYN absurd, ridiculous, preposterous, laughable, farcical. ANT sensible, reasonable, logical, serious. *Ex:* It is ludicrous to charge 500 taka for a cup of tea.

Luminous *(adj)* উজ্জ্বল, দীপ্তিমান — giving off light; very bright. SYN bright, shining, radiant, glowing, brilliant. ANT dark, dim, dull, shadowy, gloomy. *Ex:* The watch has a luminous dial.

Lurid *(adj)* ভয়ংকর; অতি উজ্জ্বল — shocking and sensational; unpleasantly bright. SYN sensational, graphic, shocking; garish, glaring. ANT mild, restrained; pale, dull. *Ex:* The newspaper printed lurid details of the murder.

Luxuriant *(adj)* ঘন ও প্রচুর — (of vegetation or hair) rich and plentiful. SYN lush, abundant, profuse, dense, thick. ANT sparse, thin, scanty, barren. *Ex:* The forest has luxuriant vegetation. (Do not confuse with *luxurious* = expensive and comfortable.)

M

Magnanimous ★ *(adj)* মহানুভব, উদারচিত্ত — generous or forgiving, especially towards a rival. SYN generous, noble, big-hearted, charitable, benevolent. ANT mean, petty, selfish, vindictive, small-minded. *Ex:* He was magnanimous in victory.

Magnificent *(adj)* চমৎকার, জাঁকালো — impressively beautiful or grand. SYN splendid, grand, superb, majestic, glorious. ANT modest, ordinary, poor, unimpressive. *Ex:* The Taj Mahal is a magnificent monument.

Malevolent *(adj)* বিদ্বেষপূর্ণ — wishing evil to others. SYN malicious, spiteful, hostile, vindictive, malignant. ANT benevolent, kind, friendly, well-meaning. *Ex:* He gave me a malevolent stare.

Malicious *(adj)* বিদ্বেষপরায়ণ — intending to do harm. SYN spiteful, malevolent, vicious, hateful, mean. ANT kind, benevolent, friendly, good-natured. *Ex:* Spreading malicious rumours is a crime.

Malign *(v/adj)* নিন্দা করা; ক্ষতিকর — to speak badly of; harmful. SYN slander, defame, vilify, disparage; evil, harmful. ANT praise, defend, extol; benign, kind. *Ex:* Do not malign a person behind his back.

Malleable GRE *(adj)* নমনীয়; সহজে প্রভাবিত — able to be shaped; easily influenced. SYN pliable, ductile, soft; impressionable, tractable, flexible. ANT rigid, hard, brittle; intractable, stubborn. *Ex:* Gold is a malleable metal.

Mammoth *(adj)* বিশাল — huge. SYN huge, giant, enormous, colossal, gigantic. ANT tiny, small, minute, minuscule. *Ex:* Building the Padma Bridge was a mammoth task.

Mandatory *(adj)* বাধ্যতামূলক — required by law or rules. SYN compulsory, obligatory, required, binding, requisite. ANT optional, voluntary, discretionary, elective. *Ex:* Wearing a helmet is mandatory for motorcyclists.

Manifest *(adj/v)* স্পষ্ট; প্রকাশ করা — clear and obvious; to show. SYN obvious, clear, evident, apparent, patent; display, reveal. ANT hidden, latent, obscure; conceal, hide. *Ex:* His guilt was manifest.

Meagre ★ *(adj)* স্বল্প, অপর্যাপ্ত — lacking in quantity or quality. SYN scanty, insufficient, inadequate, paltry, sparse. ANT abundant, ample, plentiful, copious, generous. *Ex:* He lives on a meagre income.

Meek *(adj)* নম্র, শান্ত — quiet, gentle and easily imposed on. SYN humble, docile, submissive, mild, gentle. ANT assertive, bold, arrogant, aggressive. *Ex:* Blessed are the meek.

Mendacious GRE *(adj)* মিথ্যাবাদী — not telling the truth. SYN lying, untruthful, dishonest, deceitful, false. ANT truthful, honest, sincere, veracious. *Ex:* The mendacious advertisement misled buyers.

Mercenary *(adj/n)* অর্থলোভী; ভাড়াটে সৈন্য — working only for money; a hired soldier. SYN greedy, venal, grasping, money-minded. ANT altruistic, unselfish, generous, idealistic. *Ex:* His motives are purely mercenary.

Meticulous ★ *(adj)* অতি যত্নশীল, খুঁটিনাটি বিষয়ে মনোযোগী — showing great attention to detail. SYN careful, precise, painstaking, scrupulous, thorough. ANT careless, sloppy, slapdash, negligent. *Ex:* She keeps meticulous records.

Mitigate ★ *(v)* প্রশমিত করা — to make less severe. SYN alleviate, reduce, lessen, ease, allay, palliate. ANT aggravate, intensify, worsen, exacerbate. *Ex:* Planting trees helps mitigate climate change.

Modest ★ *(adj)* বিনয়ী; পরিমিত — not boastful; moderate. SYN humble, unassuming, unpretentious; moderate, limited. ANT arrogant, boastful, vain; excessive, lavish. *Ex:* She is modest about her achievements.

Mollify *(v)* শান্ত করা — to calm someone's anger. SYN pacify, placate, appease, soothe, calm. ANT provoke, enrage, anger, incite. *Ex:* The apology mollified the angry customer.

Monotonous *(adj)* একঘেয়ে — dull because unchanging. SYN boring, tedious, dull, repetitive, humdrum. ANT interesting, varied, exciting, lively. *Ex:* Factory work can be monotonous.

Morose *(adj)* বিষণ্ণ, গোমড়ামুখো — sullen and ill-tempered. SYN sullen, gloomy, glum, sulky, moody. ANT cheerful, happy, jovial, genial. *Ex:* He became morose after losing his job.

Mundane *(adj)* জাগতিক; সাধারণ — ordinary and dull; worldly. SYN ordinary, routine, commonplace, humdrum; worldly, earthly. ANT extraordinary, exciting, unusual; spiritual, heavenly. *Ex:* She was tired of mundane household chores.

Munificent GRE *(adj)* অতি উদার, দানশীল — very generous. SYN generous, bountiful, liberal, lavish, philanthropic. ANT mean, stingy, miserly, parsimonious. *Ex:* The munificent donor funded the whole library.

Myriad *(adj/n)* অসংখ্য — countless; a very great number. SYN countless, innumerable, numerous, multitudinous. ANT few, limited, scant. *Ex:* The night sky has myriad stars.

N

Naive *(adj)* সরল, অনভিজ্ঞ — lacking experience or judgement. SYN innocent, ingenuous, gullible, credulous, unsophisticated. ANT sophisticated, worldly, experienced, shrewd. *Ex:* It is naive to believe every news on Facebook.

Nadir *(n)* নিম্নতম বিন্দু — the lowest point. SYN bottom, lowest point, depths, rock bottom. ANT zenith, peak, acme, summit, apex. *Ex:* His career reached its nadir after the scandal.

Nascent GRE *(adj)* নবজাত, উদীয়মান — just coming into existence. SYN emerging, budding, developing, incipient, embryonic. ANT mature, developed, established, dying. *Ex:* The nascent democracy faced many challenges.

Nefarious *(adj)* জঘন্য, দুষ্ট — wicked or criminal. SYN wicked, evil, villainous, heinous, iniquitous. ANT good, virtuous, honourable, noble. *Ex:* The gang was involved in nefarious activities.

Negligent *(adj)* অবহেলাকারী — failing to take proper care. SYN careless, neglectful, remiss, lax, heedless. ANT careful, attentive, diligent, conscientious. *Ex:* The negligent driver caused the accident.

Nimble *(adj)* চটপটে — quick and light in movement or thought. SYN agile, quick, deft, sprightly, alert. ANT clumsy, slow, sluggish, awkward. *Ex:* Her nimble fingers wove the mat quickly.

Nocturnal *(adj)* নিশাচর — active at night. SYN nightly, night-time, night-time-active. ANT diurnal, daily, daytime. *Ex:* The owl is a nocturnal bird.

Notorious ★ *(adj)* কুখ্যাত — famous for something bad. SYN infamous, disreputable, scandalous, ill-famed. ANT reputable, honourable, respected, acclaimed. *Ex:* He is a notorious criminal.

Novice ★ *(n)* শিক্ষানবিশ, আনাড়ি — a beginner. SYN beginner, learner, apprentice, tyro, neophyte, novitiate. ANT expert, veteran, master, professional. *Ex:* This book is written for novices in grammar.

Noxious *(adj)* বিষাক্ত, ক্ষতিকর — harmful or poisonous. SYN poisonous, toxic, harmful, deadly, pernicious. ANT harmless, wholesome, beneficial, innocuous. *Ex:* The factory releases noxious fumes.

Nullify *(v)* বাতিল করা — to make legally void; to cancel out. SYN annul, cancel, invalidate, revoke, negate. ANT validate, confirm, enforce, ratify. *Ex:* The court nullified the election result.

O

Obdurate GRE *(adj)* একগুঁয়ে, কঠোরহৃদয় — stubbornly refusing to change. SYN stubborn, obstinate, unyielding, inflexible, intransigent. ANT flexible, yielding, compliant, amenable. *Ex:* The obdurate official refused every request.

Obese *(adj)* স্থূলকায় — very fat. SYN fat, overweight, corpulent, portly, stout. ANT thin, slim, lean, skinny, emaciated. *Ex:* Fast food is making children obese.

Obligatory *(adj)* বাধ্যতামূলক — required by rule or custom. SYN compulsory, mandatory, required, binding, requisite. ANT optional, voluntary, elective. *Ex:* Attendance at the seminar is obligatory.

Obscure ★ *(adj/v)* অস্পষ্ট; অখ্যাত; ঢেকে দেওয়া — not clear; not well known; to hide. SYN unclear, vague, cryptic; unknown, little-known; conceal, cloud. ANT clear, plain; famous, eminent; reveal, clarify. *Ex:* He was born in an obscure village.

Obsequious GRE *(adj)* চাটুকারপূর্ণ, তোষামুদে — too eager to please or obey. SYN servile, sycophantic, fawning, ingratiating, subservient. ANT domineering, assertive, arrogant, independent. *Ex:* The obsequious clerk bowed to every officer.

Obsolete ★ *(adj)* অপ্রচলিত, সেকেলে — no longer used; out of date. SYN outdated, outmoded, antiquated, archaic, defunct. ANT current, modern, contemporary, new, in use. *Ex:* Typewriters are now obsolete.

Obstinate ★ *(adj)* একগুঁয়ে — stubbornly refusing to change one's opinion. SYN stubborn, headstrong, obdurate, mulish, pig-headed, adamant. ANT flexible, compliant, docile, amenable, tractable. *Ex:* The obstinate child refused to eat.

Obstruct *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া — to block; to hinder. SYN block, impede, hinder, hamper, bar. ANT clear, open, assist, facilitate, help. *Ex:* Illegal shops obstruct the footpaths.

Obtuse *(adj)* স্থূলবুদ্ধি; স্থূল (কোণ) — slow to understand; (of an angle) more than 90°. SYN stupid, slow, dull, dense, imperceptive. ANT bright, sharp, acute, perceptive, astute. *Ex:* He was too obtuse to see the joke.

Ominous *(adj)* অশুভ — giving the impression that something bad will happen. SYN threatening, menacing, sinister, foreboding, inauspicious. ANT auspicious, promising, favourable, propitious. *Ex:* Ominous dark clouds gathered in the sky.

Omnipotent *(adj)* সর্বশক্তিমান — having unlimited power. SYN all-powerful, almighty, supreme, invincible. ANT powerless, impotent, weak, helpless. *Ex:* Muslims believe Allah is omnipotent.

Omniscient *(adj)* সর্বজ্ঞ — knowing everything. SYN all-knowing, all-seeing, all-wise. ANT ignorant, unknowing, uninformed. *Ex:* The novel has an omniscient narrator.

Onerous *(adj)* কষ্টসাধ্য, ভারী (দায়িত্ব) — involving heavy effort or difficulty. SYN burdensome, arduous, laborious, heavy, taxing. ANT easy, light, effortless, simple, trivial. *Ex:* Running a big family is an onerous task.

Opaque *(adj)* অস্বচ্ছ; দুর্বোধ্য — not able to be seen through; hard to understand. SYN non-transparent, cloudy; obscure, unclear, impenetrable. ANT transparent, clear, translucent; lucid, plain. *Ex:* The decision-making process is opaque.

Optimistic *(adj)* আশাবাদী — hopeful about the future. SYN hopeful, positive, sanguine, confident, upbeat. ANT pessimistic, gloomy, despairing, cynical. *Ex:* We are optimistic about our economic growth.

Opulent *(adj)* ঐশ্বর্যশালী, জাঁকজমকপূর্ণ — rich and luxurious. SYN luxurious, lavish, sumptuous, affluent, wealthy. ANT poor, impoverished, humble, shabby, austere. *Ex:* The Nawab lived in an opulent palace.

Ostensible *(adj)* বাহ্যিক, আপাত — stated or appearing to be true, but not necessarily so. SYN apparent, outward, seeming, professed, supposed. ANT real, actual, genuine, true. *Ex:* The ostensible reason for the visit was trade.

Ostentatious ★ GRE *(adj)* জাঁকালো, লোক-দেখানো — showy, designed to impress. SYN showy, flamboyant, pretentious, flashy, extravagant. ANT modest, simple, unpretentious, restrained, plain. *Ex:* Their ostentatious wedding was criticised.

Ostracise *(v)* একঘরে করা — to exclude from a society or group. SYN exclude, banish, shun, boycott, exile. ANT include, accept, welcome, embrace. *Ex:* The villagers ostracised the family.

Outrageous *(adj)* অত্যন্ত আপত্তিকর — shockingly bad or excessive. SYN shocking, scandalous, atrocious, monstrous, exorbitant. ANT acceptable, reasonable, moderate, mild. *Ex:* The price of medicine is outrageous.

P

Pacify *(v)* শান্ত করা — to calm someone's anger. SYN calm, soothe, appease, placate, mollify. ANT enrage, provoke, anger, agitate. *Ex:* The mother pacified the crying baby.

Palpable *(adj)* স্পর্শযোগ্য; স্পষ্ট — able to be touched or felt; obvious. SYN tangible, touchable; obvious, evident, clear, manifest. ANT intangible, impalpable; unclear, hidden. *Ex:* There was palpable tension in the room.

Paltry *(adj)* তুচ্ছ, নগণ্য — (of an amount) very small; worthless. SYN meagre, trifling, negligible, insignificant, petty. ANT considerable, substantial, large, significant. *Ex:* Workers are paid a paltry wage.

Panacea GRE *(n)* সর্বরোগহর ঔষধ — a solution for all problems. SYN cure-all, remedy, universal solution, elixir. ANT poison, bane, affliction. *Ex:* Education is not a panacea for all social ills.

Paradox *(n)* আপাতবিরোধী সত্য — a statement that seems absurd but may be true. SYN contradiction, anomaly, inconsistency, enigma, puzzle. ANT consistency, truism, certainty. *Ex:* "The child is father of the man" is a paradox.

Paragon *(n)* আদর্শ, উৎকৃষ্ট দৃষ্টান্ত — a perfect example of a quality. SYN model, ideal, epitome, exemplar, archetype. ANT failure, disgrace, mediocrity. *Ex:* He is a paragon of honesty.

Parsimonious GRE *(adj)* কৃপণ — unwilling to spend money; extremely frugal. SYN stingy, miserly, mean, tight-fisted, niggardly, penurious. ANT generous, extravagant, lavish, munificent, liberal. *Ex:* The parsimonious man refused to buy new shoes.

Partisan *(adj/n)* পক্ষপাতদুষ্ট; দলীয় সমর্থক — strongly supporting a party; biased. SYN biased, partial, one-sided, prejudiced; supporter, adherent. ANT impartial, neutral, unbiased, objective. *Ex:* The media should not be partisan.

Paucity ★ *(n)* স্বল্পতা, অভাব — the presence of something in small quantities. SYN scarcity, dearth, shortage, lack, insufficiency. ANT abundance, plenty, profusion, surplus. *Ex:* The research was weak due to a paucity of data.

Peevish *(adj)* খিটখিটে — easily irritated. SYN irritable, petulant, cross, grumpy, testy. ANT good-natured, easy-going, cheerful, genial. *Ex:* The sick child was peevish all day.

Penitent *(adj)* অনুতপ্ত — feeling sorry for wrongdoing. SYN repentant, remorseful, contrite, regretful, apologetic. ANT unrepentant, impenitent, remorseless, defiant. *Ex:* The penitent thief returned the money.

Pensive *(adj)* চিন্তামগ্ন — engaged in deep, often sad, thought. SYN thoughtful, reflective, contemplative, meditative, wistful. ANT thoughtless, carefree, unthinking, shallow. *Ex:* She sat in a pensive mood by the river.

Penury *(n)* চরম দারিদ্র্য — extreme poverty. SYN poverty, destitution, indigence, want, need. ANT wealth, affluence, opulence, prosperity, luxury. *Ex:* The poet died in penury.

Perennial *(adj)* চিরস্থায়ী; বহুবর্ষজীবী — lasting a very long time; (of plants) living several years. SYN lasting, enduring, perpetual, constant, everlasting. ANT temporary, ephemeral, transient, annual. *Ex:* Traffic jams are a perennial problem in Dhaka.

Perfidious GRE *(adj)* বিশ্বাসঘাতক — deceitful and untrustworthy. SYN treacherous, disloyal, faithless, traitorous, false. ANT loyal, faithful, trustworthy, true. *Ex:* Mir Jafar's perfidious act led to the fall of Bengal.

Perfunctory GRE *(adj)* দায়সারা — carried out with minimum effort or care. SYN cursory, superficial, careless, hasty, token. ANT thorough, careful, painstaking, meticulous. *Ex:* The guard gave our bags a perfunctory check.

Peripheral *(adj)* প্রান্তিক, গৌণ — on the edge; of minor importance. SYN marginal, outer, minor, secondary, incidental. ANT central, core, main, essential, crucial. *Ex:* These are peripheral issues; let us focus on the main one.

Pernicious ★ GRE *(adj)* ক্ষতিকর, সর্বনাশা — having a harmful effect, especially gradually. SYN harmful, destructive, deleterious, damaging, baneful. ANT beneficial, harmless, benign, wholesome. *Ex:* Corruption has a pernicious effect on society.

Perpetual *(adj)* চিরস্থায়ী, অবিরাম — never ending or changing. SYN everlasting, eternal, permanent, continual, unending. ANT temporary, momentary, transient, brief. *Ex:* The Permanent Settlement made zamindari perpetual.

Perplex *(v)* বিভ্রান্ত করা — to make someone confused. SYN puzzle, baffle, bewilder, confuse, confound. ANT enlighten, clarify, explain. *Ex:* The question perplexed even the teacher.

Persevere *(v)* অধ্যবসায় চালিয়ে যাওয়া — to continue despite difficulty. SYN persist, continue, carry on, keep going, endure. ANT give up, quit, abandon, desist, falter. *Ex:* If you persevere, you will succeed.

Pertinent *(adj)* প্রাসঙ্গিক — relevant to the subject. SYN relevant, applicable, apposite, germane, apt. ANT irrelevant, inapplicable, unrelated, extraneous. *Ex:* She asked a very pertinent question.

Pessimistic *(adj)* নৈরাশ্যবাদী — expecting the worst. SYN gloomy, negative, cynical, despairing, defeatist. ANT optimistic, hopeful, positive, sanguine. *Ex:* Don't be so pessimistic about the result.

Philanthropist *(n)* জনহিতৈষী, মানবপ্রেমী — a person who helps others, especially by donating money. SYN benefactor, humanitarian, patron, donor, altruist. ANT misanthrope, miser, egoist. *Ex:* Haji Muhammad Mohsin was a great philanthropist.

Placid *(adj)* শান্ত, স্থির — calm and peaceful. SYN calm, tranquil, serene, peaceful, unruffled. ANT agitated, excitable, turbulent, stormy. *Ex:* The placid lake reflected the hills.

Plausible *(adj)* আপাতগ্রাহ্য, বিশ্বাসযোগ্য — seeming reasonable or probable. SYN credible, believable, reasonable, likely, convincing. ANT implausible, unlikely, improbable, unbelievable. *Ex:* He offered a plausible explanation.

Plethora GRE *(n)* প্রাচুর্য, আধিক্য — an excess of something. SYN excess, surplus, glut, surfeit, abundance. ANT shortage, lack, scarcity, dearth, paucity. *Ex:* There is a plethora of coaching centres in Dhaka.

Pliable *(adj)* নমনীয়; সহজে প্রভাবিত — easily bent; easily influenced. SYN flexible, pliant, malleable, supple; docile, compliant. ANT rigid, stiff, inflexible; stubborn, obstinate. *Ex:* Cane is pliable and good for furniture.

Pompous *(adj)* দাম্ভিক, আড়ম্বরপূর্ণ — self-important; grand but solemn. SYN self-important, pretentious, arrogant, conceited, bombastic. ANT modest, humble, unpretentious, simple. *Ex:* The pompous officer liked to hear himself talk.

Ponderous *(adj)* ভারী; একঘেয়ে — slow and clumsy because of great weight; dull. SYN heavy, cumbersome, unwieldy; laboured, dull, tedious. ANT light, graceful; lively, interesting. *Ex:* The essay was written in a ponderous style.

Potent *(adj)* শক্তিশালী — having great power or effect. SYN powerful, strong, effective, forceful, mighty. ANT impotent, weak, ineffective, powerless. *Ex:* This is a potent medicine.

Pragmatic ★ *(adj)* বাস্তববাদী — dealing with things sensibly and realistically. SYN practical, realistic, sensible, matter-of-fact, down-to-earth. ANT idealistic, impractical, unrealistic, romantic. *Ex:* We need a pragmatic solution to the traffic problem.

Precarious *(adj)* অনিশ্চিত, বিপজ্জনক — not secure; dangerously likely to fall. SYN insecure, unstable, risky, perilous, shaky. ANT secure, stable, safe, steady. *Ex:* Many day labourers live a precarious life.

Precocious *(adj)* অকালপক্ক — (of a child) developed earlier than usual. SYN advanced, gifted, mature, forward, talented. ANT backward, slow, retarded, immature. *Ex:* The precocious child could read at three.

Prejudice *(n)* কুসংস্কার, পূর্বধারণা — an unfair opinion not based on reason. SYN bias, partiality, preconception, bigotry, intolerance. ANT fairness, impartiality, tolerance, objectivity. *Ex:* We must fight racial prejudice.

Prevalent *(adj)* প্রচলিত, ব্যাপক — widespread in a particular area or time. SYN widespread, common, prevailing, current, rampant. ANT rare, uncommon, infrequent, scarce. *Ex:* Dengue is prevalent during the monsoon.

Prodigal ★ *(adj)* অমিতব্যয়ী — wasteful with money. SYN wasteful, extravagant, spendthrift, profligate, improvident. ANT thrifty, frugal, economical, careful, prudent. *Ex:* The prodigal son wasted his father's wealth.

Prodigious *(adj)* বিস্ময়কর, বিশাল — remarkably great in size or degree. SYN enormous, huge, colossal; amazing, phenomenal, extraordinary. ANT tiny, small; ordinary, unremarkable. *Ex:* She has a prodigious memory.

Profane *(adj/v)* অপবিত্র; অপবিত্র করা — not religious; disrespectful to sacred things. SYN secular, irreverent, blasphemous; desecrate, defile. ANT sacred, holy, religious; sanctify, consecrate. *Ex:* He was punished for using profane language.

Proficient *(adj)* দক্ষ — competent or skilled. SYN skilled, expert, adept, accomplished, competent. ANT incompetent, inept, unskilled, amateurish. *Ex:* She is proficient in three languages.

Profound ★ *(adj)* গভীর — very great; showing deep knowledge. SYN deep, intense, great; wise, learned, philosophical. ANT shallow, superficial, slight, trivial. *Ex:* Tagore's poems have profound meaning.

Profuse *(adj)* প্রচুর — abundant; plentiful. SYN abundant, copious, plentiful, lavish, prolific. ANT scanty, meagre, sparse, scarce. *Ex:* He offered profuse apologies.

Prolific ★ *(adj)* প্রচুর সৃষ্টিশীল, উর্বর — producing much fruit or many works. SYN productive, fertile, fruitful, abundant, creative. ANT unproductive, barren, sterile, unfruitful. *Ex:* Humayun Ahmed was a prolific writer.

Prompt *(adj/v)* তৎপর; প্ররোচিত করা — done without delay; to cause or encourage. SYN quick, immediate, punctual, swift; prompt, induce, provoke. ANT late, slow, tardy, delayed; deter. *Ex:* Thank you for your prompt reply.

Propagate *(v)* প্রচার করা; বংশবিস্তার করা — to spread an idea; to breed. SYN spread, disseminate, promote, circulate; breed, reproduce. ANT suppress, restrict, conceal; kill, destroy. *Ex:* They tried to propagate false news.

Propitious GRE *(adj)* অনুকূল, শুভ — giving or indicating a good chance of success. SYN favourable, auspicious, promising, advantageous, opportune. ANT unfavourable, inauspicious, ominous, adverse. *Ex:* It is a propitious time to invest.

Prosaic *(adj)* নীরস, গদ্যময় — lacking imagination or poetic beauty. SYN dull, ordinary, unimaginative, mundane, humdrum. ANT imaginative, poetic, interesting, exciting. *Ex:* He gave a prosaic description of a beautiful sunset.

Prosperity *(n)* সমৃদ্ধি — the state of being successful, especially financially. SYN wealth, affluence, success, riches, opulence. ANT poverty, adversity, failure, misfortune, penury. *Ex:* We wish for peace and prosperity.

Prudent ★ *(adj)* বিচক্ষণ, বিবেচক — acting with care for the future. SYN wise, judicious, sensible, careful, circumspect, provident. ANT imprudent, rash, foolish, reckless, careless. *Ex:* It is prudent to save money for bad days.

Pugnacious GRE *(adj)* কলহপ্রিয়, ঝগড়াটে — eager to argue or fight. SYN combative, belligerent, aggressive, quarrelsome, bellicose. ANT peaceful, peaceable, conciliatory, mild. *Ex:* The pugnacious player was sent off.

Punctual *(adj)* সময়ানুবর্তী — happening or doing things at the agreed time. SYN on time, prompt, timely, regular. ANT late, tardy, unpunctual, delayed. *Ex:* Be punctual for the interview.

Pungent *(adj)* ঝাঁঝালো, তীক্ষ্ণ — having a sharp, strong taste or smell; biting. SYN strong, sharp, acrid, spicy; caustic, biting. ANT mild, bland, sweet; gentle. *Ex:* Mustard oil has a pungent smell.

Q

Quaint *(adj)* অদ্ভুত সুন্দর, সেকেলে আকর্ষণীয় — attractively unusual or old-fashioned. SYN charming, picturesque, old-fashioned, curious, unusual. ANT modern, ordinary, normal, commonplace. *Ex:* They stayed in a quaint old cottage.

Qualm *(n)* দ্বিধা, অস্বস্তি — an uneasy feeling of doubt or guilt. SYN misgiving, doubt, scruple, hesitation, unease. ANT confidence, certainty, assurance. *Ex:* He had no qualms about lying.

Quarrelsome *(adj)* কলহপ্রিয় — inclined to argue. SYN argumentative, belligerent, pugnacious, contentious, combative. ANT peaceful, peaceable, easy-going, friendly. *Ex:* The quarrelsome neighbour fought with everyone.

Quell *(v)* দমন করা — to put an end to a rebellion or disorder; to calm a fear. SYN suppress, crush, quash, subdue; allay, calm. ANT incite, provoke, encourage, foment, stir up. *Ex:* The police quelled the riot.

Querulous GRE *(adj)* খিটখিটে, অভিযোগপ্রবণ — complaining in a whining manner. SYN complaining, peevish, petulant, irritable, fretful. ANT contented, uncomplaining, cheerful, easy-going. *Ex:* The querulous patient annoyed the nurses.

Quiescent GRE *(adj)* নিষ্ক্রিয়, শান্ত — in a state of inactivity. SYN inactive, dormant, latent, passive, still. ANT active, busy, agitated, dynamic. *Ex:* The disease was quiescent for years.

Quixotic GRE *(adj)* অবাস্তব আদর্শবাদী — extremely idealistic and impractical. SYN idealistic, unrealistic, romantic, visionary, impractical. ANT practical, realistic, pragmatic, sensible. *Ex:* His plan to end poverty in a year was quixotic.

R

Rampant *(adj)* ব্যাপক, অনিয়ন্ত্রিত — (of something bad) flourishing and spreading unchecked. SYN widespread, unchecked, uncontrolled, rife, prevalent. ANT controlled, restrained, limited, rare. *Ex:* Corruption is rampant in some offices.

Rancour *(n)* বিদ্বেষ, তিক্ততা — bitterness or resentment, especially long-lasting. SYN bitterness, resentment, malice, animosity, spite. ANT goodwill, friendship, harmony, kindness. *Ex:* He spoke without rancour about his rivals.

Rapacious GRE *(adj)* লোভী, লুণ্ঠনপ্রবণ — aggressively greedy. SYN greedy, grasping, avaricious, predatory, voracious. ANT generous, unselfish, content, liberal. *Ex:* The rapacious landlord raised the rent again.

Rash *(adj)* হঠকারী — acting without careful thought. SYN reckless, hasty, impulsive, impetuous, foolhardy. ANT careful, cautious, prudent, considered. *Ex:* Don't take a rash decision.

Ravage *(v)* ধ্বংস করা — to cause severe damage. SYN devastate, destroy, ruin, wreck, despoil. ANT build, repair, restore, preserve. *Ex:* The cyclone ravaged the coastal area.

Rebuke *(v/n)* তিরস্কার করা — to express sharp disapproval. SYN reprimand, scold, reproach, admonish, chide. ANT praise, commend, compliment, approve. *Ex:* The boss rebuked him for being late.

Recalcitrant GRE *(adj)* অবাধ্য, একগুঁয়ে — uncooperative towards authority. SYN defiant, disobedient, intractable, unruly, refractory. ANT obedient, compliant, docile, amenable. *Ex:* The recalcitrant student refused to wear the uniform.

Reckless *(adj)* বেপরোয়া — without thinking about danger. SYN rash, careless, heedless, foolhardy, daredevil. ANT careful, cautious, prudent, wary. *Ex:* Reckless driving causes accidents.

Reconcile *(v)* মিলন ঘটানো, সামঞ্জস্য করা — to restore friendly relations; to make compatible. SYN reunite, conciliate, pacify; harmonise, square. ANT estrange, alienate, divide, separate. *Ex:* The brothers were finally reconciled.

Redundant *(adj)* অপ্রয়োজনীয়, বাহুল্য — no longer needed; unnecessary. SYN superfluous, unnecessary, surplus, excess, needless. ANT necessary, essential, needed, required. *Ex:* Remove the redundant words from the sentence. (See Chapter 38.)

Refute *(v)* খণ্ডন করা — to prove a statement to be wrong. SYN disprove, rebut, deny, negate, invalidate. ANT prove, confirm, support, verify. *Ex:* The scientist refuted the old theory.

Relinquish ★ *(v)* ছেড়ে দেওয়া — to give up voluntarily. SYN give up, abandon, surrender, renounce, cede, waive. ANT retain, keep, hold, maintain, seize. *Ex:* He relinquished his claim to the property.

Remorse *(n)* অনুশোচনা — deep regret for a wrong committed. SYN regret, repentance, contrition, guilt, penitence. ANT indifference, satisfaction, pride, shamelessness. *Ex:* The killer showed no remorse.

Renounce *(v)* ত্যাগ করা — to formally give up. SYN give up, relinquish, abandon, forgo, abdicate. ANT claim, keep, retain, assert, embrace. *Ex:* Buddha renounced worldly pleasures.

Replenish *(v)* পুনরায় পূর্ণ করা — to fill up again. SYN refill, restock, top up, renew, restore. ANT empty, drain, deplete, exhaust. *Ex:* Rain replenishes the ponds.

Reprimand *(v/n)* ভর্ৎসনা করা — to rebuke formally. SYN rebuke, reproach, scold, admonish, censure. ANT praise, commend, applaud, compliment. *Ex:* The officer was reprimanded for negligence.

Repudiate *(v)* প্রত্যাখ্যান করা, অস্বীকার করা — to refuse to accept or be associated with. SYN reject, disown, renounce, deny, disavow. ANT accept, acknowledge, embrace, endorse. *Ex:* He repudiated the allegations.

Resilient *(adj)* স্থিতিস্থাপক, সহনশীল — able to recover quickly from difficulties. SYN tough, strong, hardy, buoyant, adaptable. ANT vulnerable, weak, fragile, delicate. *Ex:* The people of the coastal belt are resilient.

Reticent ★ GRE *(adj)* স্বল্পভাষী, চাপা স্বভাবের — not revealing one's thoughts readily. SYN reserved, taciturn, quiet, uncommunicative, restrained. ANT talkative, communicative, open, loquacious, garrulous. *Ex:* She was reticent about her personal life.

Revere *(v)* শ্রদ্ধা করা — to respect deeply. SYN respect, venerate, admire, honour, worship. ANT despise, scorn, disrespect, disdain. *Ex:* Nazrul is revered as our national poet.

Robust ★ *(adj)* বলিষ্ঠ, শক্তিশালী — strong and healthy; strongly built. SYN strong, sturdy, vigorous, healthy, hardy. ANT weak, frail, feeble, delicate, sickly. *Ex:* The country needs a robust economy.

Rudimentary *(adj)* প্রাথমিক, মৌলিক — involving only basic matters; undeveloped. SYN basic, elementary, fundamental, primitive, crude. ANT advanced, sophisticated, developed, complex. *Ex:* He has only a rudimentary knowledge of computers.

Ruthless *(adj)* নির্দয় — without pity or compassion. SYN merciless, pitiless, cruel, heartless, brutal. ANT merciful, compassionate, kind, humane, lenient. *Ex:* The dictator was ruthless towards his opponents.

S

Sagacious GRE *(adj)* বিচক্ষণ, প্রাজ্ঞ — having good judgement; wise. SYN wise, shrewd, astute, perceptive, judicious. ANT foolish, unwise, stupid, obtuse. *Ex:* We need a sagacious leader in times of crisis.

Salient *(adj)* প্রধান, উল্লেখযোগ্য — most noticeable or important. SYN main, chief, prominent, striking, principal, conspicuous. ANT minor, insignificant, inconspicuous, peripheral. *Ex:* Write the salient features of the budget.

Salubrious GRE *(adj)* স্বাস্থ্যকর — health-giving; pleasant. SYN healthy, wholesome, beneficial, salutary, invigorating. ANT unhealthy, insalubrious, harmful, noxious. *Ex:* The hill tracts have a salubrious climate.

Sanguine GRE *(adj)* আশাবাদী — optimistic, especially in a bad situation. SYN optimistic, hopeful, confident, positive, buoyant. ANT pessimistic, gloomy, despondent, hopeless. *Ex:* He is sanguine about his chances of winning.

Sarcastic *(adj)* ব্যঙ্গাত্মক — using irony to mock or show contempt. SYN ironic, sardonic, mocking, caustic, satirical. ANT sincere, kind, complimentary, respectful. *Ex:* His sarcastic comments hurt her.

Scanty ★ *(adj)* অপ্রতুল, অল্প — small or insufficient in quantity. SYN meagre, sparse, insufficient, inadequate, scant. ANT abundant, plentiful, ample, copious, sufficient. *Ex:* Rainfall was scanty this year.

Scrupulous *(adj)* নীতিনিষ্ঠ; অতি যত্নশীল — careful about doing what is right; very thorough. SYN honest, principled, conscientious; meticulous, careful. ANT unscrupulous, dishonest; careless, slapdash. *Ex:* She is scrupulous in her accounts.

Scrutinise *(v)* সূক্ষ্মভাবে পরীক্ষা করা — to examine closely. SYN examine, inspect, study, analyse, investigate. ANT ignore, overlook, glance at, skim. *Ex:* The examiner scrutinised the documents.

Sedate *(adj/v)* শান্ত, ধীরস্থির; ঘুমের ঔষধ দেওয়া — calm and unhurried; to calm with drugs. SYN calm, composed, serene, staid, dignified. ANT excited, agitated, wild, lively. *Ex:* We walked at a sedate pace.

Serene *(adj)* শান্ত, প্রশান্ত — calm, peaceful and untroubled. SYN calm, tranquil, peaceful, placid, composed. ANT agitated, turbulent, stormy, troubled, noisy. *Ex:* The village looked serene in the moonlight.

Servile *(adj)* দাসসুলভ, হীন — too willing to serve or please others. SYN obsequious, subservient, sycophantic, fawning, submissive. ANT independent, assertive, proud, domineering. *Ex:* His servile attitude towards the boss was disgusting.

Shrewd *(adj)* চতুর, বিচক্ষণ — having sharp judgement. SYN astute, sharp, clever, canny, perceptive. ANT foolish, naive, stupid, gullible. *Ex:* He is a shrewd businessman.

Sinister *(adj)* অশুভ, অমঙ্গলজনক — giving the impression that something harmful will happen. SYN menacing, threatening, ominous, evil, malevolent. ANT auspicious, benign, harmless, favourable. *Ex:* There was something sinister about the stranger.

Slander *(n/v)* অপবাদ, কুৎসা — a false spoken statement damaging a person's reputation. SYN defamation, calumny, libel, vilification; defame, malign. ANT praise, commendation; extol, eulogise. *Ex:* He sued the newspaper for slander.

Sluggish *(adj)* মন্থর, ধীর — slow-moving; inactive. SYN slow, lethargic, inactive, lazy, torpid. ANT quick, active, brisk, energetic, lively. *Ex:* Exports were sluggish last quarter.

Solace *(n)* সান্ত্বনা — comfort in distress. SYN comfort, consolation, relief, support, succour. ANT distress, misery, torment, agony. *Ex:* Music was his only solace.

Sombre *(adj)* বিষণ্ণ, গম্ভীর; গাঢ় — dark; serious and sad. SYN dark, dull, drab; gloomy, grave, solemn, melancholy. ANT bright, colourful; cheerful, happy, joyful. *Ex:* The mood at the funeral was sombre.

Soporific GRE *(adj)* ঘুম পাড়ানো — tending to cause sleep. SYN sleep-inducing, sedative, hypnotic; boring, tedious. ANT stimulating, invigorating, exciting. *Ex:* The lecture was soporific.

Spontaneous *(adj)* স্বতঃস্ফূর্ত — done without planning; natural. SYN unplanned, impromptu, natural, voluntary, instinctive. ANT planned, deliberate, forced, contrived. *Ex:* The crowd gave a spontaneous round of applause.

Sporadic ★ *(adj)* বিক্ষিপ্ত, মাঝে মাঝে ঘটে এমন — occurring at irregular intervals. SYN occasional, intermittent, scattered, irregular, infrequent. ANT constant, regular, continuous, frequent, incessant. *Ex:* There were sporadic clashes in the city.

Spurious *(adj)* জাল, নকল — false or fake. SYN fake, false, counterfeit, bogus, forged. ANT genuine, authentic, real, true. *Ex:* Spurious medicines are a threat to public health.

Squander ★ *(v)* অপচয় করা — to waste money or time carelessly. SYN waste, fritter away, misspend, dissipate, lavish. ANT save, conserve, hoard, economise, husband. *Ex:* He squandered his inheritance on gambling.

Stagnant *(adj)* বদ্ধ; স্থবির — not flowing; showing no activity. SYN still, motionless, standing; inactive, static, sluggish. ANT flowing, moving; active, growing, dynamic. *Ex:* Mosquitoes breed in stagnant water.

Steadfast *(adj)* অটল, স্থির — resolutely firm and unwavering. SYN firm, resolute, constant, loyal, unwavering. ANT wavering, fickle, inconstant, disloyal. *Ex:* She remained steadfast in her beliefs.

Stingy *(adj)* কৃপণ — unwilling to spend or give. SYN miserly, mean, tight-fisted, parsimonious, niggardly. ANT generous, liberal, lavish, munificent. *Ex:* The stingy man never gave to charity.

Stoic *(adj)* সহিষ্ণু, নির্বিকার — enduring pain without complaint. SYN patient, uncomplaining, long-suffering, impassive, unflinching. ANT complaining, emotional, excitable, impatient. *Ex:* He remained stoic despite his injuries.

Stringent *(adj)* কঠোর — (of rules) strict and precise. SYN strict, rigorous, rigid, tough, severe. ANT lax, lenient, flexible, loose. *Ex:* Stringent laws are needed to stop food adulteration.

Subjugate *(v)* পরাধীন করা — to bring under control by force. SYN conquer, subdue, vanquish, enslave, oppress. ANT liberate, free, emancipate, release. *Ex:* The British subjugated the Indian subcontinent.

Substantial *(adj)* যথেষ্ট, উল্লেখযোগ্য — of considerable importance, size or worth. SYN considerable, significant, large, sizeable, ample. ANT insignificant, small, negligible, trivial. *Ex:* There has been a substantial increase in exports.

Succinct *(adj)* সংক্ষিপ্ত ও সুস্পষ্ট — briefly and clearly expressed. SYN concise, brief, terse, compact, pithy. ANT verbose, wordy, long-winded, rambling. *Ex:* Give a succinct answer.

Superficial ★ *(adj)* অগভীর, ভাসাভাসা — existing only on the surface; shallow. SYN shallow, surface, cursory, perfunctory, slight. ANT deep, profound, thorough, in-depth, comprehensive. *Ex:* He has only a superficial knowledge of history.

Superfluous ★ *(adj)* অপ্রয়োজনীয়, বাড়তি — unnecessary, more than enough. SYN unnecessary, redundant, surplus, excess, needless. ANT necessary, essential, required, needed, vital. *Ex:* Cut out superfluous words from your writing.

Surreptitious GRE *(adj)* গোপন, চুপিসারে — kept secret because it would not be approved. SYN secret, clandestine, covert, furtive, stealthy. ANT open, overt, public, blatant. *Ex:* He took a surreptitious look at his phone in class.

Sycophant GRE *(n)* চাটুকার, তোষামোদকারী — a person who flatters powerful people for gain. SYN flatterer, toady, bootlicker, yes-man, lackey. ANT critic, detractor, rebel, independent. *Ex:* The king was surrounded by sycophants.

T

Taciturn ★ GRE *(adj)* স্বল্পভাষী — saying very little. SYN reserved, silent, reticent, uncommunicative, laconic. ANT talkative, garrulous, loquacious, voluble, chatty. *Ex:* The taciturn farmer nodded but said nothing.

Tactful *(adj)* কৌশলী, বিচক্ষণ — careful not to offend people. SYN diplomatic, discreet, sensitive, considerate, politic. ANT tactless, indiscreet, blunt, insensitive. *Ex:* She gave a tactful reply to an awkward question.

Tangible *(adj)* স্পর্শযোগ্য, বাস্তব — able to be touched; real and clear. SYN touchable, palpable, concrete, real, material. ANT intangible, abstract, imaginary, vague. *Ex:* We need tangible results, not promises.

Tardy *(adj)* দেরি করা, বিলম্বিত — slow; late. SYN late, slow, delayed, belated, dilatory. ANT punctual, prompt, early, quick. *Ex:* He was punished for his tardy arrival.

Tedious ★ *(adj)* ক্লান্তিকর, একঘেয়ে — too long, slow or dull. SYN boring, monotonous, tiresome, dull, wearisome. ANT interesting, exciting, stimulating, lively. *Ex:* Copying the register was a tedious job.

Temerity GRE *(n)* দুঃসাহস, ধৃষ্টতা — excessive boldness; audacity. SYN audacity, nerve, boldness, effrontery, impudence. ANT timidity, caution, shyness, prudence. *Ex:* He had the temerity to question the judge's honesty.

Temperate *(adj)* মৃদু, নাতিশীতোষ্ণ; সংযমী — mild; moderate; self-controlled. SYN mild, moderate, clement; self-restrained, sober. ANT extreme, harsh; intemperate, excessive. *Ex:* Bangladesh has a temperate winter.

Tenacious ★ *(adj)* দৃঢ়প্রতিজ্ঞ, নাছোড়বান্দা — holding firmly; persistent. SYN persistent, determined, resolute, dogged, steadfast. ANT irresolute, weak, yielding, wavering. *Ex:* Her tenacious efforts finally paid off.

Tentative *(adj)* অস্থায়ী, পরীক্ষামূলক — not certain or fixed; hesitant. SYN provisional, experimental, uncertain; hesitant, cautious. ANT definite, final, certain; confident, decisive. *Ex:* Here is the tentative schedule of the exam.

Terse *(adj)* সংক্ষিপ্ত, রূঢ় — brief and abrupt. SYN curt, brusque, concise, laconic, short. ANT wordy, verbose, long-winded, rambling. *Ex:* He sent a terse email refusing the offer.

Thrifty *(adj)* মিতব্যয়ী — careful with money. SYN frugal, economical, careful, prudent, provident. ANT extravagant, wasteful, spendthrift, prodigal. *Ex:* Thrifty housewives save for the future.

Timid ★ *(adj)* ভীরু, লাজুক — lacking courage or confidence. SYN shy, fearful, timorous, diffident, nervous. ANT bold, brave, confident, daring, audacious. *Ex:* The timid child hid behind his mother.

Torpid GRE *(adj)* নিস্তেজ, জড় — mentally or physically inactive. SYN lethargic, sluggish, inactive, inert, listless. ANT active, energetic, lively, vigorous. *Ex:* The heat made the animals torpid.

Tranquil ★ *(adj)* শান্ত, নিরুদ্বেগ — free from disturbance; calm. SYN calm, peaceful, serene, placid, quiet. ANT turbulent, agitated, noisy, chaotic, disturbed. *Ex:* We spent a tranquil weekend in Sreemangal.

Transient ★ *(adj)* ক্ষণস্থায়ী — lasting only for a short time. SYN temporary, fleeting, ephemeral, short-lived, transitory, momentary. ANT permanent, lasting, enduring, perpetual, everlasting. *Ex:* Youth and beauty are transient.

Trepidation *(n)* উদ্বেগ, ভয় — a feeling of fear about something that may happen. SYN fear, anxiety, apprehension, dread, alarm. ANT calm, confidence, composure, courage. *Ex:* She entered the exam hall with trepidation.

Trite *(adj)* বহুল ব্যবহৃত, মামুলি — overused and lacking originality. SYN banal, hackneyed, clichéd, stale, commonplace. ANT original, fresh, novel, imaginative. *Ex:* The story ended with a trite moral.

Trivial *(adj)* তুচ্ছ, নগণ্য — of little value or importance. SYN unimportant, insignificant, petty, trifling, negligible. ANT important, significant, serious, crucial. *Ex:* They quarrelled over a trivial matter.

Truculent GRE *(adj)* আগ্রাসী, যুদ্ধংদেহী — eager to argue or fight. SYN aggressive, belligerent, hostile, defiant, combative. ANT gentle, cooperative, amiable, docile. *Ex:* The truculent prisoner attacked a guard.

Turbulent *(adj)* অশান্ত, বিক্ষুব্ধ — characterised by conflict, disorder or confusion. SYN stormy, rough, violent; chaotic, unstable, tumultuous. ANT calm, peaceful, tranquil, stable. *Ex:* The 1960s were turbulent years in East Pakistan.

U

Ubiquitous ★ GRE *(adj)* সর্বব্যাপী, সর্বত্র বিরাজমান — present everywhere. SYN omnipresent, pervasive, universal, everywhere, widespread. ANT rare, scarce, uncommon, absent. *Ex:* Mobile phones are ubiquitous today.

Unanimous *(adj)* সর্বসম্মত — fully in agreement. SYN united, agreed, concordant, of one mind, uncontested. ANT divided, split, disputed, contested. *Ex:* The decision was unanimous.

Unkempt *(adj)* অপরিচ্ছন্ন, এলোমেলো — (of appearance) untidy. SYN untidy, messy, dishevelled, scruffy, slovenly. ANT neat, tidy, groomed, smart, trim. *Ex:* He came to the interview with unkempt hair.

Unscrupulous *(adj)* নীতিহীন — having no moral principles. SYN unprincipled, dishonest, corrupt, immoral, shameless. ANT scrupulous, honest, principled, ethical. *Ex:* Unscrupulous traders hoard goods before Ramadan.

Upbraid *(v)* তিরস্কার করা — to scold. SYN scold, reproach, rebuke, berate, reprimand. ANT praise, commend, compliment. *Ex:* She upbraided her son for coming home late.

Urbane *(adj)* মার্জিত, ভদ্র — (of a man) courteous and refined. SYN suave, sophisticated, polished, refined, cultivated. ANT boorish, crude, uncouth, rude. *Ex:* The urbane diplomat charmed the guests.

Usurp *(v)* জোর করে দখল করা — to take a position of power illegally or by force. SYN seize, take over, commandeer, appropriate, grab. ANT restore, return, give up, abdicate. *Ex:* The general usurped power in a coup.

Utopian *(adj)* কাল্পনিক আদর্শ — idealistic, perfect but impractical. SYN idealistic, visionary, perfect, fanciful, quixotic. ANT realistic, practical, pragmatic, dystopian. *Ex:* A society without crime is a utopian dream.

V

Vacillate ★ GRE *(v)* দোদুল্যমান থাকা — to waver between opinions. SYN waver, hesitate, dither, fluctuate, oscillate. ANT decide, resolve, persist, stand firm. *Ex:* He vacillated between law and medicine.

Vague *(adj)* অস্পষ্ট — not clear or definite. SYN unclear, indistinct, hazy, ambiguous, obscure. ANT clear, definite, precise, explicit, distinct. *Ex:* He gave a vague answer.

Valiant *(adj)* সাহসী, বীর — showing courage. SYN brave, courageous, heroic, gallant, valorous. ANT cowardly, timid, fearful, craven. *Ex:* The valiant soldier saved his comrades.

Vanity *(n)* অহংকার; অসারতা — excessive pride; futility. SYN conceit, pride, arrogance, egotism; futility, emptiness. ANT modesty, humility; worth, usefulness. *Ex:* Her vanity made her spend hours before the mirror.

Vehement *(adj)* তীব্র, প্রবল — showing strong feeling. SYN forceful, passionate, intense, fervent, ardent. ANT mild, calm, half-hearted, feeble, subdued. *Ex:* The proposal met with vehement opposition.

Venal GRE *(adj)* ঘুষখোর, অর্থলোভী — open to bribery. SYN corrupt, bribable, mercenary, dishonest, crooked. ANT honest, incorruptible, upright, principled. *Ex:* Venal officials sold licences for money. (Do not confuse with *venial* = forgivable.)

Venerate *(v)* শ্রদ্ধা করা — to regard with great respect. SYN revere, respect, honour, worship, esteem. ANT despise, scorn, disrespect, dishonour. *Ex:* We venerate the martyrs of 1952.

Verbose ★ *(adj)* শব্দবহুল — using more words than needed. SYN wordy, long-winded, prolix, garrulous, loquacious. ANT concise, brief, succinct, laconic, terse. *Ex:* The report was verbose and repetitive.

Versatile *(adj)* বহুমুখী প্রতিভাসম্পন্ন — able to adapt to many activities. SYN adaptable, all-round, flexible, multitalented, resourceful. ANT limited, inflexible, specialised, one-dimensional. *Ex:* Nazrul was a versatile genius.

Vex *(v)* বিরক্ত করা — to annoy or worry. SYN annoy, irritate, anger, trouble, exasperate. ANT please, soothe, calm, delight. *Ex:* It vexes me to see people littering.

Viable *(adj)* কার্যকর, টেকসই — capable of working successfully. SYN feasible, workable, practicable, sustainable, possible. ANT unworkable, impractical, unfeasible, impossible. *Ex:* Solar power is a viable alternative energy.

Vigilant ★ *(adj)* সতর্ক, সজাগ — watchful for possible danger. SYN watchful, alert, wary, attentive, observant. ANT careless, negligent, inattentive, heedless. *Ex:* Citizens must be vigilant against terrorism.

Vigorous *(adj)* তেজস্বী, জোরালো — strong, healthy and full of energy. SYN energetic, robust, strong, lively, dynamic. ANT weak, feeble, lethargic, frail, languid. *Ex:* Take vigorous exercise every day.

Vilify *(v)* কুৎসা রটানো — to speak or write about in an abusive way. SYN defame, malign, slander, denigrate, disparage. ANT praise, extol, laud, glorify. *Ex:* He was vilified by the press.

Vindicate *(v)* নির্দোষ প্রমাণ করা; সঠিক প্রমাণ করা — to clear of blame; to show to be right. SYN exonerate, acquit, clear; justify, support, confirm. ANT accuse, convict, blame; disprove, refute. *Ex:* The new evidence vindicated him.

Virtuous *(adj)* গুণী, সৎ — having high moral standards. SYN good, moral, righteous, upright, honourable. ANT wicked, immoral, corrupt, vicious, sinful. *Ex:* He was a virtuous ruler.

Vivacious *(adj)* প্রাণবন্ত — attractively lively and animated. SYN lively, animated, spirited, bubbly, sparkling. ANT dull, lifeless, listless, languid, boring. *Ex:* She is a vivacious young woman.

Vociferous *(adj)* উচ্চকণ্ঠ, সোচ্চার — expressing opinions loudly and forcefully. SYN loud, vocal, clamorous, outspoken, strident. ANT quiet, silent, reticent, soft-spoken. *Ex:* There were vociferous protests against price hikes.

Volatile *(adj)* উদ্বায়ী; অস্থির — evaporating easily; likely to change suddenly. SYN unstable, explosive, unpredictable, erratic, mercurial. ANT stable, calm, constant, steady. *Ex:* The political situation is volatile.

Voluntary *(adj)* স্বেচ্ছামূলক — done of one's own free will. SYN optional, willing, discretionary, unforced, spontaneous. ANT compulsory, mandatory, obligatory, forced. *Ex:* Blood donation is a voluntary service.

Voracious *(adj)* অতি ক্ষুধার্ত, পেটুক; অতি আগ্রহী — wanting great quantities of food; very eager. SYN ravenous, greedy, insatiable, gluttonous; avid, enthusiastic. ANT sated, satisfied; indifferent, apathetic. *Ex:* He is a voracious reader.

Vulnerable *(adj)* ঝুঁকিপূর্ণ, অরক্ষিত — exposed to harm or attack. SYN exposed, defenceless, susceptible, unprotected, weak. ANT invulnerable, protected, safe, secure, resilient. *Ex:* Bangladesh is vulnerable to climate change.

W

Wane *(v)* ক্ষয় পাওয়া, হ্রাস পাওয়া — to decrease in size, power or extent. SYN decrease, decline, diminish, ebb, fade. ANT wax, grow, increase, strengthen. *Ex:* His influence began to wane.

Wanton *(adj)* অকারণ, উচ্ছৃঙ্খল — deliberate and unprovoked (of a cruel act); immoral. SYN wilful, gratuitous, malicious, senseless; dissolute. ANT justified, provoked; moral, chaste. *Ex:* The wanton destruction of trees must stop.

Wary *(adj)* সতর্ক, সাবধানী — cautious about possible dangers. (Do not confuse with *weary* = tired.) SYN cautious, careful, alert, vigilant, suspicious. ANT careless, unwary, trusting, reckless. *Ex:* Be wary of strangers offering free gifts.

Wax *(v)* বৃদ্ধি পাওয়া (বিশেষত চাঁদ) — to grow larger or stronger. *Wax* and *wane* are a classic antonym pair. SYN increase, grow, expand, swell, enlarge. ANT wane, decrease, diminish, shrink. *Ex:* The moon waxes and wanes every month.

Weary *(adj)* ক্লান্ত — very tired. SYN tired, exhausted, fatigued, worn out, jaded. ANT fresh, energetic, refreshed, lively. *Ex:* The weary traveller rested under a banyan tree.

Whimsical *(adj)* খামখেয়ালি — playfully unusual; acting on sudden ideas. SYN fanciful, capricious, playful, quirky, fickle. ANT serious, sober, steady, predictable. *Ex:* The story has a whimsical charm.

Wholesome *(adj)* স্বাস্থ্যকর; নৈতিকভাবে ভালো — good for health or morals. SYN healthy, nutritious, beneficial; moral, decent, clean. ANT unhealthy, unwholesome, harmful; immoral, corrupt. *Ex:* Children need wholesome food and entertainment.

Wicked *(adj)* দুষ্ট, পাপী — evil or morally wrong. SYN evil, sinful, vicious, villainous, nefarious. ANT good, virtuous, righteous, moral, kind. *Ex:* The wicked stepmother mistreated Cinderella.

Wily *(adj)* ধূর্ত — skilled at gaining an advantage by deceit. SYN cunning, crafty, sly, shrewd, artful. ANT naive, ingenuous, honest, simple. *Ex:* The wily fox tricked the crow.

Witty *(adj)* রসিক, বুদ্ধিদীপ্ত — showing quick and clever humour. SYN humorous, clever, amusing, droll, funny. ANT dull, boring, humourless, stupid. *Ex:* Syed Mujtaba Ali was a witty writer.

X · Y · Z

Xenophobia *(n)* বিদেশিভীতি — dislike or fear of people from other countries. SYN racism, chauvinism, intolerance, nativism. ANT xenophilia, tolerance, hospitality, cosmopolitanism. *Ex:* Xenophobia is rising in some parts of Europe.

Yearn *(v)* আকুলভাবে কামনা করা — to have an intense longing for. SYN long, crave, pine, hanker, desire. ANT dislike, spurn, be indifferent to. *Ex:* Migrant workers yearn for home during Eid.

Yield *(v/n)* ফলন দেওয়া; নতি স্বীকার করা — to produce; to give way; the amount produced. SYN produce, generate; surrender, submit, give in; harvest, output. ANT withhold; resist, defy, withstand. *Ex:* The new rice variety yields more crops. / He refused to yield to pressure.

Zany *(adj)* হাস্যকর রকমের অদ্ভুত — amusingly unconventional. SYN eccentric, comical, wacky, crazy, madcap. ANT serious, sober, conventional, sensible. *Ex:* He is known for his zany sense of humour.

Zeal ★ *(n)* উদ্যম, উৎসাহ — great energy or enthusiasm for a cause. SYN enthusiasm, passion, fervour, ardour, eagerness. ANT apathy, indifference, lethargy, half-heartedness. *Ex:* She worked with great zeal for the poor.

Zealous *(adj)* উদ্যমী, উৎসাহী — having great zeal. SYN fervent, ardent, passionate, enthusiastic, eager. ANT apathetic, indifferent, lukewarm, unenthusiastic. *Ex:* He is a zealous supporter of environmental causes.

Zenith ★ *(n)* সর্বোচ্চ বিন্দু, শীর্ষ — the highest point. SYN peak, summit, acme, pinnacle, apex, climax. ANT nadir, bottom, base, lowest point. *Ex:* The Mughal Empire reached its zenith under Akbar.